

20 BELOW



A CHARACTER DRIVEN RPG OF FATE,
THE GIFTED AND WORLDS BELOW OUR OWN

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PLAYER'S GUIDE

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LICENCE

The core mechanics of this book are Licensed Material under the ORC License, and you may build on them freely, commercially, forever. That covers the 2d10 roll, Difficulty, Advantage and Disadvantage, the five Attributes and their sub-stats, Ki, combat resolution, and the Gift, Boon, Flaw and Skill systems themselves: their point costs, their structure, and how they resolve.

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WHAT THIS GAME IS

Someone made a choice. They decided that you would be here at this specific time and place. After all, that is what *Fated* means. For the record, that is not the compliment that it sounds like. 20 Below is a world that looks normal in every way until you have a reason to really look at it. Your character has that reason. Your character has seen the currents of Fate flowing deep below the surface and kept looking. You and your friends decided to keep looking and what you have seen will not go back into the box.

WHAT YOU NEED

Two ten-sided dice per player. Something to write on. Three or four people and an evening. And this book.

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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

You've felt it.

You know the feeling. A room that is always cold, even in the height of summer. A response to a question you only *thought*. The shadow that is too deep and you just *know* it is watching you. That moment when the veneer of ordinary stops sticking to reality and peels back a little. The world stops being real and you perceive the reality underneath the matte painting.

Those moments happen to everyone. Most people experience them, decide that they must be tired or imagining things and never look again. 20 Below is about people who look at the man behind the curtain - and what they can do once they have.

The rest of this book is *how* they do it.

WHAT IS 20 BELOW?

20 Below is a tabletop roleplaying game. I'm sure you know what one is. I mean, you picked up this book.

What's that? You don't know what a TTRPG is? Well, allow me the pleasure of explaining it to you!

Simple explanation: a tabletop roleplaying game is like a game of make-believe. You remember running around as a kid - roaming the neighborhood with your friends. The stick you found in the woods was your sword, your wizard's staff or laser rifle. Remember those epic arguments?

Kevin: *I got you!*

Mia: *No. You didn't!*

Kevin: *Yes, I did!*

Mia: *Nope. You missed!*

Kevin: *You always cheat! I quit!*

A TTRPG is exactly like that, except when Kevin says, "I got you!", there are rules in place so he can say, "I got you... honest."

Complex explanation: at the core, any tabletop roleplaying game is an exercise in collaborative storytelling. The game master crafts a world, creates the characters you interact with and sets events in motion. The players decide how their characters react in every situation. It is a mutual dance of give and take that guides a shared universe and story. When anything is in doubt - a physical stunt, a mystic effect, deception or a fight - fate settles it.

In this case, fate is a pair of ten-sided dice. I know, it's an underwhelming face for such a grand concept, but it's what I've got. You roll the dice and add them together. Compare them to your target number. If you roll your target number or under, you succeed. Roll a 2 and you've done something people will talk about for years. Roll a 20 and you may never live it down.

WHY YOU ROLL WHAT YOU ROLL

That's how you roll, but what do you roll and why?

Earth, Air, Fire, Water, Moira - the building blocks of the universe. These are the raw metaphysical materials that everything is made from - people, animals, the cosmos. All of it. This is the stuff running under the hood, governing everything that happens. Your Skills are what happens when you take one of these broad forces of the universe and hone it to a razor's edge. The Elements are your potential. Your Skills are what you are actually good at.

Then there are Gifts. Gifts are the extraordinary abilities that the average person just doesn't possess. Some call it magic, a knack, psionics, a blessing, mutations - whatever the flavor of your story calls for. The names change, but the structure never does. A Gift is a specific supernatural ability that is yours and yours alone. No two players will build their characters the same way.

Most TTRPGs have a setting - a world that the game is run in - baked right in. 20 Below is different in that it is "setting and design agnostic." That is to say, it was designed to be an RPG system that can be used for any setting of any genre. 20 Below is the engine that propels the action, not the car.

The same Elements and dice will drive a haunted village, a generation ship in the depths of space, a war fought over machines that control the weather. Nothing under the hood changes when you switch from one setting to another. You craft the world, the system manages what happens within it. If you don't feel up to making your own setting, my first campaign book - Backwater Static: a New

Orleans floating on deep currents of weirdness - will always be free.

That is just one shape that 20 Below can take. There are many others. Most of them are yours.

WHAT YOU NEED TO PLAY

It doesn't take much:

- A character - either on paper or in the app
- 2 ten-sided dice per person
- This book - either a physical copy or online
- 2 or more people. One of you is the Game Master (the person who runs the game). Everyone else plays a character.

That's it. The whole exhaustive list. Hell, you don't even need the dice - I built a free character creator that includes a built-in dice roller. Everything else - miniatures/tokens, maps, a GM screen - is optional.

HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

I've made it as simple as possible to get into. You don't need to read this book from cover to cover - almost no one does.

If you are a player, turn to the character creation chapter and work through the steps in order. Each step sends you to the chapter you need - Skills, Boons, Gifts, Flaws - exactly when you need it. You learn the game as you build your character.

If you are the GM, run through the character creation process once yourself. Then read the Combat section and get comfortable with the Difficulty Chart before Session Zero - those are the two things you'll lean on most in play.

(Unless you manage to write a campaign that eschews combat while still holding the table's attention. It's not easy to do, but it *has* been done.)

Everything else in the book is reference. Each chapter is a deep dive into one type of character option and is built to be opened mid-game and closed again a moment later. The Glossary at the front has everything you need to know going in and anything that only matters in a fight is in the Combat section.

FREE. ALWAYS.

20 Below is and always will be free. The core rules (which you are reading now) will always be available to play - not a demo, not a simplified primer, not a trimmed down teaser - the whole system. Every rule in this book, the Character Creator, the desktop apps... all of them will always be free. I won't release a second edition and make you pay for it. In fact, the apps are being designed so that they update as I refine the rules. In fact, as long as you have an internet connection, you will always have the most up to date ruleset.

Backwater Static - my first full setting - will also always be free, on the web and as a PDF.

Eventually, I will release things that aren't free. The split is simple: the core game is always free; expansions will be paid add-ons.

- **Physical books** in several tiers - plain text, black and white with art, full color with art, etc

- **Genre Books** - rules to play 20 Below in Sci-Fi, Fantasy, Horror, Post Apocalypse, etc.
- **Setting Books in print** - a full setting (bestiary, NPCs, locations, maps and more) bound as a physical book. The setting itself is always free on the web and as a PDF, Backwater Static included - the printed copy is the paid part.
- **Digital Packs** - files of the monsters, NPCs, creatures, etc. All packaged to make the GM's job smoother.

These will be optional and never required to play the game.

SETTING THE STAGE

Being setting and design agnostic, 20 Below can't set the scene for you. It can't give you the tone or feel for a campaign. As such, that is a conversation to have before anyone puts pen to paper. It doesn't have to be a long talk, but it should be a real one.

The GM should walk the table through four things before anyone commits to a character.

Concept. The campaign in one sentence.

Goal. What the characters are here to do - win, survive, or just find out what happens. The whole table decides.

Tone. Pulp adventure? Slow-burn psychological thriller? Existential horror?

Subject matter. What belongs in this story and what doesn't. Set the boundaries as a group, and talk about what happens off-screen.

Remember: 20 Below asks players to lean into their character's worst moments. Their Flaws, bad luck and rolls that go wrong are far more interesting than getting everything you want. This is intentional and the system rewards them for it. This means that the conversation on tone does a lot more heavy lifting than in a lot of TTRPGs and it is meant to. This five minute conversation at the beginning can prevent a bad day at the table down the road.

A WORD FROM THE DESIGNER

The opening paragraph - hell, the opening *sentence* - of every book is the hardest one to write. The opening sentence of my first novel took a decade. The suggestion for this section of the book was "give them one evocative paragraph, set the tone, don't hit them with mechanics yet." I gotta tell you - the moment someone tells you to be evocative, you lose the ability to be eloquent. So, instead, you get the inane ramblings about my obsession and passion project.

20 Below exists because I always wanted to do more with the games I loved. Either they had a system that was inextricably linked to the setting, or they were so generic that they felt like we were playing with Spooderman and Bortman. Don't get me wrong, there are

a couple "generic" RPG systems that are fantastic, but they are super crunchy and math heavy. I wanted an engine that I could aim at any setting and it would just work.

That is why 20 Below is heavily inspired by anime. Anime has a depth and breadth of genres and settings that defies simple explanation, but is defined by broad tropes that can be seen in most of them. I wanted 20 Below to function a lot like that.

This all started out with a lot of big ideas. Most of them ended up filed down, polished, and refined into what you see here. Everything good about the system comes from someone telling me something was wrong or it didn't work. And they were right. Stats got shuffled. Descriptors got overhauled fifteen times over. A status effect for characters pushed past their limit got cut. All of this made the game better.

All of that has been a hopelessly complex tangle and journey.

One part, however, was never complicated: it's free because I want everyone to play.

CHAPTER 2: GLOSSARY

This chapter isn't meant for reading. Not in the normal way, at least. It's a reference that collects the terms that everything is scaffolded around and gives them a simple, short definition.

I recommend skimming it at least once before you build your character so there is less mystery when the terms are used in the character creation chapter. After that, flip through these pages whenever you need to.

Everything mentioned in the character creation walkthrough is defined here. I also put some terms in here that mostly come up in a fight because other entries mention them and a glossary that sends you to another location in the book isn't of much use to anybody. The rest of the combat-only terminology is in the combat section, defined when you first encounter it.

Some entries have a line of flavor text along with their mechanics. That is on purpose - those terms are more than just their mechanics.

Action Bracket - Each combat round is broken into one of three categories - Fast, Normal, and Slow. Players declare their Action Bracket at the beginning (the top) of each round. Each Action Bracket acts in order of Initiative. Fast Actions happen first, Normal Actions follow and Slow Actions happen last.

Adder - An Adder is a permanent, but optional, upgrade to a Gift. These upgrades customize your Gifts and make them more powerful.

Advantage/Disadvantage - When Fate smiles (or frowns) on you - you roll an extra die. Advantage rolls 3d10 and keeps the lowest two.

Disadvantage rolls 3d10 and keeps the highest two.

Air - One of the five Elements that defines the essence of a character - breath and weather, never in one place long. Air is the Attribute that covers agility, adaptability, intelligence, sharpness of mind, how fast you react, and how well you handle it when things change around you. It is further divided into Initiative and Psyche.

Atropos - One of Moira's two sub-stats, named for the Fate who cuts the thread and can't be turned aside. It sets your Defense - how hard you are to touch by a blade, a word, or a mind alike - at 10 minus your Atropos. Sample descriptors: Fated, Untouchable, Uncanny, Unsevered, Passed-Over, and so on.

Attack - Any deliberate attempt to hurt someone, in any of the three ways the game recognizes - Physical, Social, or Mental. All three run on the same two steps. First you have to connect: roll your Attribute against their Defense, no Skill involved. Only if that lands do you roll the attack's dice, and those go against the matching Wall - Soak, Presence, or Psyche. A Physical die that gets through costs a Health Level, a Social die costs Poise, a Mental die costs Sanity.

Attribute - One of the five universal forces that shape your character - Earth, Air, Fire, Water and Moira. Each Element is a broad measure of your natural (or supernatural) capabilities that are pulled from the classical elements themselves. These are assigned at character creation. Each Attribute governs two sub-stats.

Boon - A small, permanent perk that isn't a Skill and isn't a Gift. Boons don't add to your dice - they let you do or claim something you otherwise couldn't. Most are a flat yes-or-no; a handful come in tiers.

Bump Action Bracket - Spend 1 Ki to move a declared action up a step - Slow to Normal, or Normal to Fast. Two Ki jumps two steps. No roll, no check; you're just buying speed with Ki.

Called Shot - Picking out something specific to hit instead of just hitting them - a hand, a knee, the strap holding their pack on, the camera housing on a drone, the weapon they're pointing at you. A Called Shot is a Slow Action. What landing it does depends on what you aimed at, and that's the GM's call.

Carrying Capacity - How much you can lift, carry, or drag without straining: your Potence squared, times ten, in kilograms. Squared rather than flat, so a strong character pulls dramatically ahead of an ordinary one.

Condition - The catch-all for a temporary bad state you can be put into - Distracted, Surprised, Flustered, Exhausted, Overwhelmed, and the rest. Each has its own trigger and its own way out, under its own entry. A Fate Token can shrug any of them off for a moment. Dying isn't one: it's where your Health Levels are, and a Token gets you up from it instead.

Core Roll - The basic move of the whole system. Roll 2d10, add them up, and check the total against your target number (your Attribute plus the Difficulty). Land on or under it and you succeed; go over and you don't.

Critical Hit - A critical success on a to-hit roll. Half the attack's dice, rounded up, connect automatically - no roll, no wall. The rest roll and each adds your Klotho, with Ki Infusion still available on top. It is amplification rather than

an attack, which is why Moira can touch it at all. Crossing zero still applies, so a critical can drop a target to 0 but never past it.

Critical Success / Catastrophic Failure - Roll a 2 - both dice showing 1 - and it's a critical success, the best possible result. Roll a 20 - both showing 10 - and it's a catastrophic failure. A few Skill tiers widen the good end or cushion the bad one. On an attack, a critical success sends half the damage dice through untouched and puts Klotho behind the rest - see Critical Hit.

Defense - How hard you are to touch: 10 minus your Atropos. Fate doesn't distinguish the shape of the blow, so the same number answers a blade, a word meant to wound, and a mind reaching where it isn't welcome. When someone attacks you, your Defense is the number they have to beat.

Descriptor - A one- or two-word adjective - Brutal, Brawny, Indefatigable, Headstrong - that pins down the flavor of a sub-stat you've invested in. You get one free with the point that earns it, and it's the hook you point at when you want a Skill to run off a different Element than usual.

Dice Notation - "XdY" means "roll X dice with Y sides and add them up." 20 Below runs on ten-sided dice, so 2d10 is two of them totaled (a 2 to 20), 1d10 is one, and 3d10 is three - that's Advantage and Disadvantage.

Difficulty - A 0-to-10 dial the GM sets for each roll - 0 is nearly impossible, 10 is trivial. It gets added to your Attribute to form the target number. In a fight, the target's Defense takes Difficulty's place.

Discretionary Points - A loose pool - 10 to start, plus whatever your Flaws hand you - that you can spend at creation on almost anything: Resources, Skills, Fate Tokens, Boons, Gifts, or Attributes.

Distracted - What happens when you take a hit, or catch a Kotodama effect, part-way through a Slow Action. Roll Atropos + Difficulty to keep your focus; miss it and the action drops to a Normal one, losing the called shot and the Advantage that made going Slow worth it.

Dying - Where you are below 0 Health Levels: unconscious and out of the fight. It doesn't get worse on its own - only more damage moves you toward death. A Fate Token puts you back up at 1 Health Level, even while you're out cold, and stabilizing you brings you to 0. The row runs the same distance below zero as above, so a character with 7 Health Levels is Dying from -1 and dead at -7 - whatever it took to put them down, it takes that much again to finish them.

Earth - One of the five Elements that defines the essence of a character - flesh and stone, the solid ground under everything else. Earth is the Attribute that covers raw physical force, endurance and mass, how strong you are, how hard you hit, and how much you can take before you stop being able to take it. It is further divided into Soak and Potence.

Everyman Skills - A short list, set by the GM, of things everyone can just do - the competence any working adult picks up by living in the world. Every character gets them free, at Trained.

Exhausted - Wear from pushing a hard effort past what your Stamina covers. It stacks in levels, 1 through 5, each one worse than the

last. A Short Rest clears one level; a full night's sleep clears the lot.

Fast Action - The Fast bracket. You go before everyone in Normal or Slow, but you only get the one action - a move, an attack, or a single Skill use. You're trading how much you do for going first.

Fate Token - The currency you earn and spend. You pick them up from your Nature, from taking Disadvantage on purpose, from your Flaws, from a daily top-up, from story Milestones, or whenever the GM hands one over. You spend them on Kotodama or the Fate Triggers. You can hold three times your Stamina, plus one, and no more - anything earned at that cap is lost rather than banked.

Fate Triggers - The things a Fate Token buys: a Kotodama, shrugging off one of your Flaws for a Scene, an automatic success, shrugging off a condition, a full Ki refill, or getting back up from Dying. Spending the Token is the whole cost - nothing else is rolled. Only a Kotodama counts against the per-Scene cap; the flat ones don't.

Ferocity - One of Fire's two sub-stats, will burned down to an ember. When you spend Ki to put more behind a physical strike - that's Ki Infusion - Ferocity is what you're adding. Sample descriptors: Brutal, Savage, Relentless, Merciless, Feral, and so on.

Figured Characteristics - The stats you don't buy - they fall out of choices you already made. Health Levels, Poise, Sanity, Defense, Movement Rate, Carrying Capacity, and Ki. You work them out at step 14 of character creation.

Fire - One of the five Elements that defines the essence of a character - drive and hunger. Fire is the Attribute that covers push and force of personality, appetite and intensity, how hard you lean on a situation, how much of yourself you put into a confrontation, and whether anyone in the room can ignore you while you're doing it. It is further divided into Ferocity and Presence.

Flaw - An optional problem you take on at creation - the mirror of a Boon. Each one is worth a set number of points that feed your Discretionary pool. If a Flaw never actually costs you anything in play, it's worth nothing.

Flustered - Where you land at 0 Poise. Every Social roll - and anything else that needs composure - is at Disadvantage until the Scene ends. You can spend an action and a Presence + Difficulty roll to shake it off early.

The Fray - The spirit realm, where the dead go.

Game Master (GM) - The person running the game. They set the scenes, play everyone who isn't a player character, decide when to roll and how hard, and have the final call on the rules. Everyone else runs a single character.

Gift - A genuinely supernatural ability - magic, psionics, a mutation, a blessing, whatever suits the setting. Each one is a single, specific, named thing rather than a broad category, and each has five levels that stack, the effect getting bigger or stronger as you climb.

Gift Check - The risk some Gifts carry when you use them. Roll 2d10 against your current Ki, under to pass. Pass and it's free; fail and it costs you a point of Ki.

Hardness - How hard an item or a piece of armor is to get through, on the same 0-10 scale as Soak. Living bodies have Soak; things have

Hardness. Hitting an item costs it a Health Level for each die over its Hardness; armor shielding someone loses at most one per attack. See Materials.

Health - One of Water's two sub-stats, the depth of the well you draw endurance from. It sets your Health Levels - 5 plus your Health - which is how many hits you can take before you drop. How far past 0 you can be carried before you die mirrors that same number, so a character with 8 Levels is out at 0 and dead at -8. Sample descriptors: Hale, Resilient, Stalwart, Unbreakable, Hard-to-Kill, and so on.

Health Levels - How many hits you can take, as a row of boxes rather than a pool of points. You have 5 plus your Health. Each solid hit checks one off; at zero, you're out, and below zero you're Dying. The row runs the same distance again below zero, and the far end of it is where you die.

Humiliated - One step past Flustered, where you go if Poise drops below 0. You can't take the lead, negotiate, or speak for the group - you defer and go along. You're still acting under your own power; it's your standing that's broken, not your body. It clears when Poise climbs back to 0.

Initiative - One of Air's two sub-stats, the flick of readiness that decides who moves first. You roll it once at the start of a fight - 1d10 plus your Initiative - and that order holds for the whole thing. Sample descriptors: Alert, Reflexive, Vigilant, Sharp-Eyed, Quick, and so on.

Ki - The pool that powers everything supernatural. It's your strongest Element plus 8, so every character has one worth spending - 13 at the least, 18 at the most. Ordinary people without a Gift have 1, for the one moment they need it. You spend it to save a Health, Poise or Sanity Level, to put more behind an attack, to move up an Action Bracket, and to use most Gifts. Below 0 it brings Poise or Sanity back to 1 without waiting for a rest. A Short Rest brings back Klotho points of it; a full night brings it all back.

Ki Infusion - Paying 1 Ki per die to add a sub-stat - Ferocity, Presence, or Psyche, whichever matches the attack - to that die. You roll the damage dice first and then choose which to boost, so nothing is spent on a die that already got through. It's how you push a hit through a wall that would otherwise stop it cold.

Klotho - One of Moira's two sub-stats, the thread still being spun. It sets how much Ki a Short Rest brings back and fixes your Lucky Number. Sample descriptors: Charmed, Star-Touched, Quickening, Replenishing, Ever-Spinning, and so on.

Kotodama - (言霊, "word spirit.") Spending Fate Tokens to state something true about the world instead of touching a die roll. You say it, you pay for it - the cost is built from how big it is, how far it reaches, how believable it is, and whether it has to last - and the story rearranges to fit. Several players can pool tokens for something none of them could afford alone.

Level - A step on a ladder. Several different things in the game use them, and they don't otherwise have much to do with each other. Gifts have five Levels, each stacking on the last. Resources run 1 to 5. Your Vitals - Health, Poise, and Sanity - are counted in Levels, boxes you check off as you take hits. Exhausted stacks in

levels of its own, 1 through 5. When a rule just says "Level," the thing it's attached to tells you which ladder it means.

Limiter - A permanent catch you accept on one specific Gift at creation. Each one you take knocks a point off the cost of every Level of that Gift. Stack them as deep as you like, but never below 1 point per Level.

Lucky Number - Your Klotho rating, doing double duty. Any time one of your own core rolls comes up exactly equal to it - the 2d10 total, or the kept pair on an Advantage or Disadvantage roll - you get a Fate Token, free, no more than one per roll. It's the total that has to match, not a single die, and big handfuls of damage dice don't count.

Milestone Award - A Fate Token for every player when the group clears a real hurdle - the fight a session was building toward, a turning point in the story. Figure about one a session.

Moira - One of the five Elements that defines the essence of a character - fate, and the threads nobody living gets to see. Moira is the Attribute that covers luck, destiny, and the supernatural itself, how the world bends around you, and whether it bends your way. It is further divided into Atropos and Klotho.

Movement Rate - How far you can move in a step, in meters: 5 plus your Air. That's the move on a Fast Action, or the move half of a Normal one.

Named - A player character, or an NPC the GM has given a name. Named characters go Dying below 0 Health Levels, recover, and carry scars. An unnamed NPC who reaches 0 is out of the fight and out of the story, dead or down at the GM's call.

Nature - A short label for what drives your character, or how they meet the world - picked from a list or written yourself. Lean into it at the right dramatic moment and you earn a Fate Token.

Normal Action - The Normal bracket - the middle option. Two actions this round, usually a move and something else, resolved after the Fast crowd and before the Slow one.

NPC - Anyone the GM plays instead of a player - short for non-player character. Most are built the same way as a player character, at whatever power level the GM chooses. A Gifted NPC has Ki the way a player character does, an ordinary one has 1, and only a special NPC has Fate Tokens of their own.

Overwhelmed - Where you land at 0 Sanity. You pick up a temporary Mental scar effect and roll everything at Disadvantage, but you're still yourself and still acting. It lifts once you're away from whatever caused it and get to rest - or you spend 1 Ki, which also fills Sanity back up.

PC - The one character at the table that's yours - short for player character.

Poise - Your composure when someone comes at you socially, tracked as boxes like Health. You have 5 plus your Presence. Hit 0 and you're Flustered; drop below and you're Humiliated. The row runs the same distance again below zero, and the far end of it costs you a point of Sanity and puts your Poise back to 0. Poise can't kill you - there's no bottom that ends the character.

Potence - One of Earth's two sub-stats, stone poured into muscle. Straight strength - what you can carry, what you can break, who wins when two people push against each other. Sample descriptors: Brawny, Mighty, Herculean, Hulking, Iron-Armed, and so on.

Presence - One of Fire's two sub-stats, the heat that turns every head in the room. It's your wall against Social attacks, and it sets how many dice you throw when you make one. Sample descriptors: Magnetic, Commanding, Radiant, Imposing, Regal, and so on.

Psyche - One of Air's two sub-stats, the steady current that carries a clear head through a storm. It's your wall against Mental attacks, and it sets how many dice you throw when you make one. Sample descriptors: Steadfast, Composed, Unshaken, Iron-Willed, Clear-Headed, and so on.

Resource - Stuff and support you can buy - money, gear, a place to work out of. Not a personal knack (that's a Boon) and not supernatural (that's a Gift), just backing.

Resource Check - A roll to lean on a Resource harder than its Level covers for free. Roll 2d10 against the Resource's Level plus Difficulty, under to pass. Pass and it costs nothing. Fail and you still get what you were after, but the Resource drops a Level (never below 1) until a Month goes by.

Rests - Two ways to recover. A Short Rest is about an hour of real downtime, and you only get the benefit of one between full nights. A Full Night's Rest is a proper night's sleep. Above 0 a Short Rest gives back half the governing sub-stat, rounded up, and a full night gives everything back. Below 0 the rates stop: Health gets nothing from a Short Rest and exactly one Level from a full night, while Poise and Sanity come back to 1 on either, or for 1 Ki.

Sanity - Your grip on your own mind under a Mental attack, tracked as boxes like Health. You have 5 plus your Psyche. At 0 you're Overwhelmed; below 0, Shattered. The row runs the same distance again below zero, and the far end of it saddles you with a temporary Mental scar effect and puts your Sanity back to 0.

Scar - What going below 0 on a Vital leaves behind: one narrow, lasting effect - Physical from Health, Social from Poise, Mental from Sanity. One per crossing, the GM's pick or agreed with the player. It's permanent until healed, and a Social scar can't be healed at all - a reputation has to be rebuilt.

Scene - One unbroken stretch of the story in roughly one place - a fight, a conversation, a chase. It's a rung on the Time Bands ladder, and a few limits reset when a new one starts (your Fate Token cap for the Scene, Flustered).

Shattered - Below 0 Sanity. You're panicking and can't act on your own - someone has to lead you clear. A point of Ki or a rest only brings Sanity back to 1, and going below 0 always leaves a Mental scar.

Skill - Something you've learned and practiced. Every Skill has a home Element it normally rolls off, but you can argue for a different one in the moment - as long as you can point to a Descriptor that backs the pairing and sell it to the GM.

Skill Training Tier - How good you are at a Skill, on a five-step ladder: Untrained, Trained, Adept, Expert, Master. Each step changes how you build the roll - from no Attribute at all, up to rolling with Advantage and a wider critical range. It also sets your damage dice on a Social attack: one at Untrained, rising to six at Master.

Slow Action - The Slow bracket. One action, and you go last - but it's a better action. It can be a called shot and it rolls with Advantage. You're trading speed for one concentrated, harder-hitting move. (All spellcasting is Slow.)

Soak - One of Earth's two sub-stats, the hide the world's hits don't quite get through. It's your wall against physical damage - the number an attacker's dice have to clear to actually hurt you. Sample descriptors: Hardy, Rugged, Unyielding, Thick-Skinned, Battle-Worn, and so on.

Stamina - One of Water's two sub-stats, the reserve that keeps you going past the point most people stop. It caps how many Fate Tokens you can hold - three times your Stamina, plus one - and how many counted spends you can make in a single Scene - your Stamina, plus one - and it's what you lean on against exhaustion outside a fight. Sample descriptors: Tireless, Enduring, Dogged, Unflagging, Relentless, and so on.

Sub-stat - The two halves each Attribute splits into - Earth into Soak and Potence, Air into Initiative and Psyche, and so on down the line. Sub-stats are where your creation points actually go, where Descriptors attach, and what most of the figured stats are built from.

Surprised - Getting caught before a fight starts with no idea it's coming. Until the round ends, you roll everything at Disadvantage.

Target Number (TN) - The number a core roll has to hit or come under: your Attribute plus the Difficulty. Creature cards shorten it to TN. See Core Roll.

Time Bands - The standard ladder the rules use whenever something needs a duration: Round, Minute, Hour, Scene, Day, Week, Month, Year, Decade, Century. A Round is about 6 seconds, so a Minute is exactly ten of them. The Round is the base - if a rule doesn't name a bigger band, it means Rounds.

Untrained Roll - A roll for something you have no Skill in. Your Attribute doesn't help here - the target number is just the Difficulty.

Vitals - Health, Poise and Sanity: the three things an attack can take from you. Each is 5 plus a sub-stat, counted in Levels rather than points, and each runs the same distance below zero as it does above. A connecting Physical die costs Health, a Social die costs Poise, a Mental die costs Sanity, and a point of Ki preserves a Level on any of them. Ki itself is not a Vital - it's the pool you spend, not a row you lose. See Wall for the other side of the same exchange.

Wall - The number an attack's dice have to beat to do anything to you. You have three, one for each kind of attack - Soak against Physical, Presence against Social, Psyche against Mental. Once an attack has connected, its dice are checked one at a time: any die over your Wall gets through and costs you a Level, and any die at or under it is absorbed completely. A Wall of 10 can't be beaten by an ordinary die at all - the only way through is Ki Infusion.

Water - One of the five Elements that defines the essence of a character - tide and undertow. Water is the Attribute that covers perception and empathy, patience and staying power, how tuned in you are to the world and the people in it, and how much you can weather before it wears you down. It is further divided into Stamina and Health.

CHAPTER 3: CREATING A CHARACTER

Character creation is broken down into 15 discrete steps. I know that sounds like a lot, but most of them only take a few seconds to complete. The list is designed to keep you from painting yourself into a corner and having to backtrack. If you go in the order presented in this guide, you shouldn't have to back up and redo anything.

Don't worry about dice yet. Now, you are working out who this person is and writing down what they are good at. If you encounter a word in this guide that is confusing, it is probably in the glossary.

One thing to consider - you *can* do all of this on paper, but you don't have to. I know a lot of you old school players will want to crunch numbers and make a character the *old* way, but 20 Below has a character creator app that can do all of the math for you. It knows every pool and cost and - most importantly - won't let you go over budget.

1. NAME

Name your character.

That's the whole step. It's cosmetic - nothing else in this book touches it and no rule cares what you picked, but it is the most important step in character creation. I've seen one player spend half an hour on this step. Another just rolled some dice for a random name.

2. CONCEPT

Your concept is a phrase that tells someone who your character is at a glance. It's not a sentence. It's not a paragraph. It's not your

backstory. It's a quick description that you can express to someone in a couple seconds.

A burned-out paramedic who just can't stop running towards the danger.

An ex-soldier turned burned-out bodyguard.

A retired cat-burglar who sucks at downtime.

Like your character's name, there is nothing mechanical at this stage. However, the next two steps hinge on it. Your character's nature (Step 3) is normally sitting right there in the concept and, many times, your character's flaws (Step 11) are as well.

3. NATURE

Your nature is who your character is deep down. It's what you do when the stakes are high, the pressure is on, and no one is watching them decide. If you lean into your nature during a moment that costs you something, and it will net you a Fate Token. Acting on your character's core nature will always reward you.

The Nature and Fate system don't reward you for effectiveness or convenience. It rewards you for consistently playing your Nature.

WRITING YOUR OWN NATURE

If none of the premade Natures quite do the trick, you can write your own. The following steps will guide you in the process. They are the same steps that were used to write the premade Natures.

One or two words. A label, not a paragraph. If it can't be read at a glance, it's too long.

Write the drive as one sentence. - This is what your character wants - how they face the world. It's not a detail from your backstory. It needs to be a driving motivation or goal. "I lost my brother" is backstory. "I don't let anyone else lose someone they could have saved" is a Nature.

Make the trigger concrete and repeatable. A character's Nature should drive their actions in a very real and palpable way. If you have to ask the GM if your Nature applies in a certain situation, it is probably too vague. Opportunities to exercise your nature should come up often, not once a campaign.

Your nature doesn't have to cause problems, but the best ones always do. A character who blows their cover to make a dramatic entrance is playing to their Nature *and* making a problem for everyone. And really, isn't that when it is the most fun?

PREMADE NATURES

ANALYST

You read the manual. All of it, including the safety pages, for the thing everybody else already plugged in and started using. You have been right about this often enough that it has stopped being funny. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you stop everyone to work out how the thing actually works, and the delay costs you the opening you had.

AVENGER

You remember the name. It has been years and you could still spell it, still pick the face out of a crowd, still say exactly what was done and in what order. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you go after the person who earned it instead of the thing that would have helped, and it makes everything harder.

CAREGIVER

You carry plasters. Actual plasters, in your actual bag, along with paracetamol and a spare charger and a bottle of water that is not for you. Somebody always needs one and you have stopped pretending to be surprised. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you stop to look after somebody while the clock is running, and it costs you the window.

CHARMER

You have been let into places you had no business being, by people who could not explain afterwards why they opened the door. Nobody has ever described you as pushy. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you turn somebody hostile into somebody helpful on nothing but conversation, somewhere force would have been quicker.

COMPETITOR

You have turned a walk to the shop into a race. Against yourself. And won, and felt good about it, and told nobody. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you push past what the job actually needed because somebody was keeping score, or might have been.

DAREDEVIL

There is a video of you. Several people have asked you to take it down. You have watched it more times than any of them. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you take the option with the drop, the speed or the odds, and the safe one was sitting right there.

DIPLOMAT

Two people who cannot stand each other have both told you their side. Neither of them knows you spoke to the other one. You are still holding both. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you talk two sides down instead of picking one, and picking one would have been faster.

ENFORCER

You keep a note of what people owe. Not on your phone. On paper, somewhere, in handwriting that is not quite your normal handwriting. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you make somebody answer for a broken word, at a moment when letting it go would have cost you nothing.

FIXER

You know a guy. You knew a guy before anybody had finished saying what the problem was. Your phone is mostly numbers with no names attached to them. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you solve it with a favour, a name or an angle, in a room where everybody else had already reached for something heavier.

GHOST

You have never been tagged in a photograph. You have checked. You check about once a month and you do not think that is strange. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you choose to go unseen or unrecorded, and being known would have got it done quicker.

GUARDIAN

You sit facing the door. You found the exits before you sat down, and you already know which of the people at this table would not make it to one. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you hold your ground over something you have claimed, and moving would have been the sensible thing to do.

IDEALIST

You still sign the petitions. You know the numbers. You have read the same article about how little it changes, twice, and you signed one this morning. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you take the principled option out loud, in front of people who had already reached for the cynical one.

JUDGE

You have ended a dinner party. You were right, which did not help, and you would say it again, which is the part people find difficult. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you name what somebody did, to their face, when saying nothing would have cost you nothing.

LEADER

When it goes quiet and everybody looks at each other, they end up looking at you. You have never worked out when that started. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you make the call nobody wanted to make, and then stand in front of what it costs.

LONER

You have moved a sofa up a flight of stairs by yourself. It took four hours. Three people would have come if you had called, and you did not call. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you turn down help or peel off from the group, and doing it together would obviously have worked better.

MENTOR

Somebody still has your old notes. You copied them out neater before you handed them over, and you have never mentioned that to anyone. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you stand back so somebody else takes the lesson, the lead or the credit, on a job you could have done faster yourself.

OPPORTUNIST

You have made money out of a very bad week that was happening to somebody else. You did not cause it. You would like that on the record. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you turn somebody's disaster into your own advantage while it is still going on.

PERFECTIONIST

You have rewritten a text message four times before sending it. It was three sentences long. You are aware of how that sounds and it did not change anything. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you refuse to hand over a result everybody else had already accepted, and the delay hurts.

PROTECTOR

You walk on the traffic side. You do it without noticing, you do it for everybody, and you have done it for people you do not like. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you take the hit, the risk or the loss that was coming for somebody who could not have taken it.

REBEL

You have read a sign, understood it completely, and done the other thing. Not for a reason. The sign was the reason. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you break a rule specifically because somebody with authority gave it, and following it would have been easier.

SHOWMAN

You have an entrance. You have practised it. You have a second one for when the first would be too much, and you have used that one considerably less. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you make it a performance, at the cost of your cover, your subtlety, or a perfectly good plan.

SKEPTIC

You have looked something up in front of the person who told you. They did not enjoy it. You have done it again since, to somebody else.

Trigger: Take a Fate Token when you refuse the easy explanation and go and look, while everybody else is relieved and moving on.

SURVIVOR

You have eaten worse and slept somewhere worse, and you would do both again tomorrow without making a thing of it. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you take the ugly, practical option in front of people who would much rather you took the proud one.

TRICKSTER

You have got into a building with a clipboard and a confident walk. Nobody stopped you. Somebody held a door. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you get it done with a lie, a misdirection or a bit, when walking in and asking would have worked.

TRUE BELIEVER

There is one thing you will not do. Everybody who knows you knows what it is, and two of them have tested it. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you keep to the code at the exact moment breaking it would have solved everything.

WANDERER

Everything you own fits in the car. You have checked recently, which probably tells you something about where your head is. *Trigger:* Take a Fate Token when you walk away from a place, a group or a claim that had started to look permanent.

4. ATTRIBUTES

Here comes the part where some people get nervous: numbers.

Every character is described by a series of numbers. The first, and arguably, the most important numbers are your Attributes. I use the words Attributes and Elements interchangeably throughout the book, so don't get confused by that.

Each of your Attributes starts at 1 for free. You have **20 points** to spend across them however you see fit. However, **no attribute goes above 10**. There is nothing to keep you from specializing in a couple of them and nothing prevents an even spread. Both builds are equally valid. This is the biggest decision in the chapter.

The next step gives you more points for every point you spend here.

EARTH SOAK / POTENCE

Flesh and stone. Raw physical force.

How strong you are, how hard you hit, how much punishment you can take. Splits into Soak and Potence.

AIR INITIATIVE / PSYCHE

Breath and weather. Agility, adaptability and sharpness of mind.

How fast you react, how well you keep pace when things change, how clearly you think under pressure. Splits into Initiative and Psyche.

FIRE FEROCITY / PRESENCE

Drive and hunger.

How hard you push, and how much of yourself you put into a confrontation, whether that's a shouting match or a knife fight. Splits into Ferocity and Presence.

WATER STAMINA / HEALTH

Tide and undertow. Perception and empathy.

How tuned in you are to the world and the people in it, and how much you can weather before it wears you down. Splits into Stamina and Health.

MOIRA ATROPOS / KLOTHO

Fate and the threads nobody living gets to see.

Luck, destiny, combat instinct, and whatever is otherworldly about you. Splits into Atropos and Klotho.

5. SUB-STAT DIVISION

Every element is divided into two Sub-Stats. In this step, you divide the points in a given Element into its Sub-stats. A rating of 7 in Earth gives you 7 points to divide between its Sub-Stats - Soak and Potence.

This step is where your character stops being a cardboard cut-out and starts becoming a person. Two characters with Fire 8 are nothing alike if one dumped it all into Ferocity and the other into Presence. The first will win the fight. The second will make sure there is no fight.

There is nothing preventing you from putting all of your points into one Sub-Stat. However, caution is recommended - a Klotho rating of zero will slow your Ki regeneration to a crawl and you won't have a lucky number while a Health rating of zero makes it harder to survive and reduces the damage you can take while unconscious to nothing.

Spend wisely.

SOAK (EARTH)

Your wall against Physical damage: the number an attacker's dice have to beat to hurt you.

POTENCE (EARTH)

Raw strength. What you can carry, what you can break, who wins when two people push.

INITIATIVE (AIR)

Turn order in a fight.

PSYCHE (AIR)

Your wall against Mental attacks, and what a boosted die adds when you make one.

FEROCITY (FIRE)

What you add to a Physical strike when you spend Ki to put more behind it.

PRESENCE (FIRE)

Your wall against Social attacks, and what a boosted die adds when you make one.

STAMINA (WATER)

Caps how many Fate Tokens you can hold (three times your Stamina, plus one) and how many counted spends you can make in a Scene (your Stamina, plus one), and carries you against exhaustion outside a fight.

HEALTH (WATER)

Feeds your Health Levels, which is how many hits you can take.

ATROPOS (MOIRA)

Feeds Defense, which is how hard you are to touch at all, whether by a blade, a word, or a mind.

KLOTHO (MOIRA)

How much Ki a Short Rest brings back, and your Lucky Number.

6. DESCRIPTORS

Descriptors add fine details to your character. For every point you spent in a Sub-Stat in step 5, you get a descriptor - a word or two describing the specific flavor that Sub-Stat brings to your character. These traits are free - they come with the points spent in Sub-Stats. Once you pick them, you can't change them. There's no way to buy extras. If you want more, you have to raise the Sub-Stat.

If you put three points in Soak, you get three descriptors for Soak. They should be different ways to shrug off damage rather than three synonyms. A character who is Hardy, Weathered, and Unyielding has a body that holds up, has been through it all, and will not give in.

These descriptors aren't just decorative and descriptive - they are load bearing and one of the core ways that your Target Number is determined. Every skill defaults to a specific Element. When you want to use a different Element to roll, and you will, your Descriptors are how you do it.

IS THIS A GOOD DESCRIPTOR?

The easiest way to tell if a descriptor will work for your character is to try it by saying "Ronan is _____."

FUNCTIONAL DESCRIPTORS

- brawny
- sinuous
- unstoppable
- rico suave.

NON-FUNCTIONAL DESCRIPTORS

- Corwin of Amber
- government intelligence
- sexual favors
- Kia Niro EV

Player: I want Ronan to jump up to the top of the building.

GM: That's acrobatics, so it's air. That's a long way, so the difficulty is going to be a difficulty of four. Your air is 1. You have to roll a 5 or less.

Player: Well, Ronan is Mighty. I think he's strong enough to make that jump.

GM: Yeah. I'll allow that. Your Earth is 8, so you are aiming for a 12.

Your descriptors are what you point to to justify using an element other than the default. The exchange above is one example of how it works. Intimidation relies on your Presence, so it defaults to fire. However, you can be Intimidating in many ways. For instance:

Sorn *serenely* describes, in exquisite detail, all the ways in which she can inflict pain. She rolls Intimidate using Air.

Ronan picks up a chair and *forcefully* folds it into a ball. He rolls Intimidate using Earth.

Serafina pounds *tirelessly* on a heavy bag for a while and then issues a quiet threat. She rolls Intimidate using Water.

Descriptors aren't decorative. Or, rather, they aren't *just* decorative - they are load bearing decorations. Below, you will find some sample descriptors. You can pick from the lists, but are not restricted to them. In fact, players are encouraged to make their own.

SOAK (EARTH)

Hardy, Rugged, Stoic, Weathered, Unyielding, Sturdy, Grizzled, Armored, Callused, Thick-Skinned, Leathery, Battle-Worn, Steeled, Resistant, Flinty

POTENCE (EARTH)

Brawny, Herculean, Mighty, Strapping, Muscular, Titanic, Forceful, Robust, Hulking, Sinewy, Vigorous, Burly, Formidable, Stout, Iron-Armed

INITIATIVE (AIR)

Alert, Reflexive, Twitchy, Vigilant, Quickened, Sharp-Eyed, Instinctive, Keen, Fleet, Snappy, Watchful, Attentive, Sharp, Nimble-Minded, Anticipatory

PSYCHE (AIR)

Steadfast, Composed, Disciplined, Unshaken, Focused, Resolute, Headstrong, Serene, Level-Headed, Calm, Iron-Willed, Grounded, Unflappable, Determined, Clear-Headed

FEROCITY (FIRE)

Brutal, Savage, Relentless, Feral, Merciless, Ruthless, Vicious, Predatory, Fierce, Aggressive, Bloodthirsty, Wrathful, Untamed, Cutthroat, Rabid

PRESENCE (FIRE)

Magnetic, Commanding, Charismatic, Radiant, Imposing, Captivating, Dominant, Alluring, Striking, Charming, Bold, Regal, Magnificent, Unforgettable, Larger-Than-Life

STAMINA (WATER)

Indefatigable, Tireless, Enduring, Hardened, Persistent, Unflagging, Dogged, Steady, Untiring, Unwavering, Gritty, Marathon-Bodied, Long-Winded, Driven, Unrelenting

HEALTH (WATER)

Hale, Vital, Resilient, Stalwart, Ironclad, Unbreakable, Durable, Tenacious, Hearty, Sound, Thriving, Hard-to-Kill, Long-Lived, Wholesome, Sturdy-Framed

ATROPOS (MOIRA)

Fated, Untouchable, Uncanny, Ghostly, Warded, Veiled, Overlooked, Passed-Over, Unmarked, Inviolable, Unsevered, Thread-Bound, Unreachable, Spared, Unbroken

KLOTHO (MOIRA)

Lucky, Charmed, Serendipitous, Auspicious, Star-Touched, Timely, Quickening, Renewing, Replenishing, Rekindling, Brimming, Deep-Welled, Spring-Fed, Ever-Spinning, Unspent

7. SKILLS

Skills come in two categories: Everyman Skills and Purchased Skills.

The GM presents everyone with a list of **Everyman Skills**. These are skills that any functional adult in the setting can do because they live there. They are free. You have your Everyman Skills at Trained.

A modern day campaign may have Athletics, Bureaucracy, Computer Use, Cooking, Driving, Etiquette, First Aid, Perception, Persuasion, and Streetwise as its Everyman Skills. The rest of the list is up to your GM, but Perception is always on it.

You have **15-points** to spend on **Purchased Skills**. Each tier costs 1 point and you climb through them in order, so Trained costs 1 point, Adept costs 2 in total, Expert 3, and Master 4. Those 15 points won't go as far as you would like. As with everything else in 20 Below, this is intentional. You can have two skills at Master tier and a few at Adept, or 7 at Adept, or a wide spread of moderate skill. What you can't have is everything and choosing makes it interesting.

Every Skill has an Element attached to it. This is the default Element that is used to calculate the Target Number for your roll when using the skill.

Untrained: your target number is just the Difficulty, you don't get to add your attribute.

Trained: Attribute plus Difficulty.

Adept: Attribute plus Difficulty, with Advantage.

Expert: as Adept, and your critical success widens to a roll of 2 or 3.

Master: as Expert, and a catastrophic failure gets one reroll. That reroll can only soften the blow to an ordinary failure; it never turns into a success.

8. BOONS

You have **10 Points** to spend on Boons. Boons come in tiers based on how powerful they are - Trivial, Lesser, Greater and Legendary. Trivial boons cost 1 point, Lesser cost 3, Greater cost 5 and Legendary cost 7 point.

A boon is an edge that your character has - a close contact that always answers the phone, a knack for reading the room, ambidexterity. None of them will add dice. They are not quite as powerful as gifts, but they aren't anything to sneeze at.

Anything leftover from these 10 points rolls over into Discretionary points (Step 12). Don't try to force the math to avoid waste - there isn't any.

9. RESOURCES

You have **6 points** to spend on Resources. Each Level costs 1 point.

Resources are the material side of your character - money, gear, a place to work out of, people who owe you a favor. If it's a personal knack, that's a Boon. If it's supernatural, that's a Gift. Resources are just backing.

You'll notice that buying equipment isn't part of this step. That's step 13, and the wait is on purpose. Discretionary points can raise your Wealth, and shopping runs its math against your final Wealth, so Wealth has to stop moving before you can spend against it.

10. GIFTS

You have **21 points** to spend on Gifts. This is your supernatural budget, and it's the biggest pool in the chapter.

Every Level of a Gift costs **3 points**. A Gift at Level 3 costs 9. A Gift at Level 5 costs 15. Twenty-one points will buy you one Gift at Level 5 with change left over, or two at Level 3, or seven at Level 1 if you want a character who does a little bit of everything.

Two things bend those numbers.

Adders are permanent upgrades to a Gift you already have. A Lesser Adder costs 3 points, a Greater costs 6.

Limiters go the other direction. A Limiter is a permanent catch you accept on one of your Gifts, and it knocks a point off every Level of that Gift. Stack as many as you can live with - there's no ceiling - though the cost per Level never drops below 1.

Limiters are how you afford a Gift you couldn't otherwise, and you should expect to pay for it at the table. A Limiter that never inconveniences you isn't worth anything, and your GM will notice.

Because Limiters leave the math uneven, leftover Gifts points don't evaporate. They convert to Discretionary points at **2:1**.

11. FLAWS

Flaws are optional. Take them or don't.

Every Flaw carries its own point value - there's no formula, so you'll have to check the Flaw itself. Whatever they're worth feeds straight into your Discretionary points at step 12. Your GM decides how many you can cash in this

way, so ask before you build a character around six of them.

Here's the part that matters. A Flaw that never costs you anything is worth nothing. If it doesn't make something harder for this character, in play, at the table, then it isn't a Flaw - it's a note in the margin. Flaws are the one place in this game where you get paid up front for trouble you've promised to have later. Take the money and have the trouble.

12. DISCRETIONARY POINTS

Everyone starts with **10 Discretionary points**, flat. Add whatever your Flaws earned you, plus anything left over from your Boons pool at 1:1 and your Gifts pool at 2:1.

Now spend them. The rate gets worse the closer you get to raw power.

Resources, Skills or Fate Tokens: 1 point each.

A Boon point: 2 points.

A Gift point: 4 points.

An Attribute point: 8 points.

Fate Tokens have a ceiling. You can't hold more than three times your Stamina, plus one, so buying past that number gets you nothing.

Eight points for a single Attribute point is brutal, and it's supposed to be. Discretionary points are for finishing a character, not rebuilding one. If you want a higher Attribute, go back to step 4 and buy it there, where it costs you one.

13. EQUIPMENT

Your Wealth has stopped moving. Go shopping.

Buy your starting gear out of the Weapons & Equipment catalog, against your creation-Wealth. The whole procedure - where creation-Wealth starts, how a Wealth Check runs, and what failing one costs you - lives in Resources, under Wealth at Character Creation.

The short version is that every purchase is a roll. Nothing is automatically free. Failing the roll still gets you the thing - it just costs you Wealth to have insisted on it.

14. FIGURED CHARACTERISTICS

You don't buy any of these. They fall out of decisions you already made.

Health Levels: 5 plus your Health.

Poise: 5 plus your Presence.

Sanity: 5 plus your Psyche.

Defense: 10 minus your Atropos.

Movement Rate: 5 plus your Air, in meters.

Carrying Capacity: your Potence squared, times ten, in kilograms.

Ki: your strongest Element, plus 8.

Work them out and write them down. If one of these numbers is an unpleasant surprise, this is the last comfortable moment to go back and move some points around.

15. FINISHING TOUCHES

You start play with **1 Fate Token**. That's the same as your daily refill, so you're starting topped up rather than ahead. If you want a cushion, buy more back at step 12 - up to three times your Stamina, plus one, which is as many as you can hold at once.

Everything that doesn't have a number attached goes here. What they look like. How they talk. All the little details that grew out of your step 2 concept while you were busy doing arithmetic.

Then hand the sheet to your GM and let them look it over.

That's a character. Go play them.

HOW TO PLAY

20 Below runs on two dice mechanics. Two. Everything in this book is one of them, or both of them in order, and this chapter is about knowing which one you're holding.

The first is the **Core Roll**. It handles almost everything - climbing a wall, picking a lock, talking your way past a guard, and the first half of every attack.

Yes, the first half. I spent a long time trying to make the Core Roll do the whole job, combat included, and every version of it turned into something nobody could hold in their head. Violence needed its own answer.

So there's a second mechanic. It only comes up when something is trying to hurt you - or you're trying to hurt something.

ROLLING THE DICE

THE CORE ROLL

Roll two ten-sided dice and add them together. If the total is equal to or under your **Target Number**, you succeed at whatever you were trying to do.

Your Target Number is the Element you can justify using plus the **Difficulty** the GM sets. Difficulty runs from 0 to 10, and this is the part that trips everyone - it runs backwards from what you expect. Zero is nearly impossible. Ten is laughable. A high Difficulty means an easy task.

I know. I can hear the grinding of gears from here.

It works that way because the Difficulty is added to your Attribute. A generous Difficulty

gives you a higher Target Number, and a higher Target Number is easier to roll under. After a few rolls it stops feeling backwards and starts feeling like what it is - the GM telling you how much room you have.

Your Target Number can run anywhere from 1 to 20. Two d10s can roll anywhere from 2 to 20, and they cluster hard around 11 - so a target of 1 is an automatic failure, a target of 20 is a sure thing, and everything interesting happens in the middle, where a couple of points either way genuinely changes your odds.

Two results ignore your target number entirely.

Roll a 2 - both dice showing 1 - and it's a critical success. The best thing that could have happened, and GMs are encouraged to be generous about what that means. What it does in a fight is under *Making an Attack*.

Roll a 20 - both dice showing 10 - and it's a catastrophic failure. Whatever you were attempting fails, and something else goes wrong on top of it - the GM decides what, out of whatever you were doing. In a fight it also leaves you **Off Balance** until the end of your next turn, rolling everything at Disadvantage. A Fate Token clears that, but never the rest of it.

Neither one cares what your target number was. A critical success on a hopeless task still lands. A catastrophic failure on a walk in the park still hurts. Some Skill tiers widen the good end or take some of the sting out of the bad one, which is covered in Skills.

Player: Ronan is going to scale the fire escape.

GM: There's a ladder that you have to pull down to start it. But the weather is good and it's not raining, so this is pretty easy. Let's call it a 7 difficulty.

Player: Cool. Ronan's Earth is an 8, so that's a Target Number of 15.

GM: Roll it.

Player: Nine.

GM: Ronan makes it up the fire escape without issue and you are pretty sure no one hear him out there.

Each skill has an Element attached to it. This Element is the default number you will use to perform that skill. That is, unless you argue to use a different element for the roll. That argument is what you use Descriptors for.

SETTING THE DIFFICULTY

The GM decides the Difficulty of any task. The Difficulty tiers are below

DIFFICULTY

#	DIFFICULTY	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
0	Nearly Impossible	Catch an arrow out of the air mid-flight.
1	Extremely Hard	Pick a masterwork lock with no tools, blindfolded.
2	Very Hard	Scale a sheer, rain-slicked cliff face.
3	Hard	Convince a hostile guard captain to stand down.
4	Challenging	Track a careful quarry through a rainstorm.
5	Moderate	A tense but ordinary check under pressure.
6	Fairly Easy	Pick a simple lock with the right tools.
7	Easy	Climb a sturdy rope with knots tied in it.
8	Very Easy	Recall a well-known fact in your field.
9	Nearly Trivial	Walk a straight line on level ground.
10	Trivial	Tie your own shoes.

NOTE TO THE GM

Don't agonize over assigning a difficulty. Pick the number that describes what the character is doing and move on. This isn't about precision - it's here to give a concrete feel to what is happening so you don't have to pull a number out of thin air... or your ass. There isn't going to be a performance review and no one is going to audit it. Go with your gut and move on with the game.

ADVANTAGE AND DISADVANTAGE

Most of the time, there is a level playing field. However, sometimes the balance of events leans to one side or another. 20 Below uses a single mechanic for that in all situations - Advantage and Disadvantage.

Where most TTRPG systems simulate advantageous or detrimental circumstances by adding or subtracting from your difficulty or your roll, 20 Below simplifies this with Advantage and Disadvantage. When an event, gift, ally, environmental effect, etc. would benefit you, you roll at Advantage. If anything would impede you, you roll at Disadvantage.

Advantage and Disadvantage are binary. That is to say: You either have it or you don't - they don't stack. They also cancel each other out on a one for one basis.

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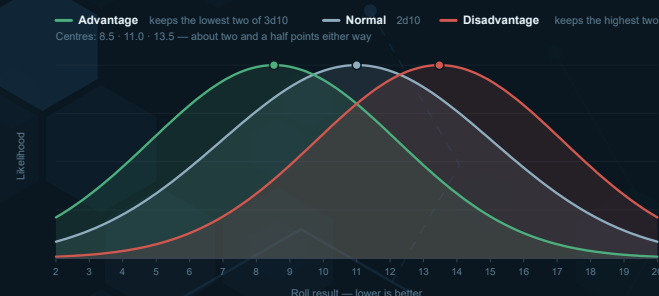
EXAMPLE: The group is looking for a ritual to reinforce the wall between dimensions, a task that is solidly within the bounds of the Research skill. Ronan is (shockingly) Adept at Research. This gives him advantage. However, the library where the book is kept is abandoned and without power, a situation that makes researching the information harder. This imposes disadvantage. The advantage and disadvantage in this instance cancel each other out because there is one source of each.

Marcus (Ronan's player), argues that Ronan knows *exactly* what he is looking for and can guide the party so they can help him find it. The GM agrees that this is enough to give Ronan advantage, so he rolls at advantage.

To simplify it: if there are multiple sources that would grant Advantage or Disadvantage, treat each instance of Advantage as "+1" and disadvantage as "-1." Add them up. If the result is 1 or more, roll at Advantage. If it is 0, roll normally. If it is less than 0, roll at Disadvantage.

But what does all of this mean? I am glad you asked. **Advantage:** When you roll at Advantage, you roll 3d10 and keep the lowest two.

Disadvantage: When you roll at Disadvantage, you roll 3d10 and keep the highest two.



THE ROLL CURVE, WITH ADVANTAGE AND DISADVANTAGE

Yes. Lower is better. Advantage gives you a third chance to get a smaller number. Disadvantage does the opposite.

Off-hand. Doing something that needs manual dexterity or precision with your off-hand - attacking, picking a lock, anything where which hand is doing it actually matters - is at Disadvantage. The Ambidextrous Boon removes that penalty.

ROLLING WITHOUT THE SKILL

Sometimes you want to do something that you just aren't prepared for. In game terms, this means you don't have a skill that applies in the specific situation. When this happens, you still get to roll - you just don't get to add your Element to the Target Number.

That's right - your target number for an Untrained Skill is the Difficulty of the task alone.

You might have noticed that this means you could have a Target Number that is impossible to roll - 0 or 1. Don't despair. Make the roll anyway. There is always a chance - a critical success will always succeed.

OPPOSED ROLLS

When two characters want opposite things - one sneaking, one watching, one hiding a lie and one looking for it - you both roll, against the same Difficulty, each with your own Element and Skill. If only one of you succeeds, that one wins. If you both succeed, whoever came in further under their target number wins. A tie goes to whoever is resisting, and so does both of you failing: nothing changes.

A creature doesn't roll its side. Its card gives you the number - *Stealth 6 vs. Perception* means you roll Perception at Difficulty 6.

HELPING

Somebody who is at least Trained in the Skill you're rolling can help, and that gives you Advantage. A second helper doesn't give you more of it - Advantage doesn't stack - but it can cancel out something working against you. If you're Adept or better you already roll with Advantage, so help only matters when something is making it harder.

Helping means being there when it goes wrong. On a catastrophic failure, whoever was helping is caught in it too.

TRYING AGAIN

You don't get to roll again because you didn't like the result. A failed roll stands until something changes - a different approach, a better tool, somebody helping, more time. Then it's a new roll, and a new chance at a catastrophic failure.

GROUP ROLLS

When everyone has to pull it off - sneaking past a guard, crossing a ledge together - everyone rolls. If at least half of you succeed, the group

makes it: the ones who are good at it cover for the ones who aren't. A catastrophic failure spoils it for everyone, however the rest of you rolled.

TAKING YOUR TIME

If nothing is coming and nobody is watching, you can trade time for a better chance. Take the next Time Band up - a Minute instead of a Round, an Hour instead of a Minute - and roll with Advantage. If failing wouldn't cost anything either, you probably don't need to roll at all. Ask your GM.

ATTACKS

MAKING AN ATTACK

The two mechanics in 20 Below meet here. Each attack has 2 steps

Attack Roll

Damage Roll

Make an Attack Roll (To-Hit Roll): An Attack Roll is a Core Roll like any other. The Target number for this roll is your attribute+the target's Defense.

If you roll at or below this Target Number, your hit lands. If you roll higher than your Target Number, nothing else happens.

A Fistful of Dice: This is where the wall mechanic is used. The number of dice you roll for damage is determined by a few possibilities:

The weapon you are using

The gift you are using

Your Training Tier in the Skill you are using, for a social attack.

Roll those dice. All of them at once. Then compare each one to the appropriate wall (Soak for Physical, Presence for Social, and Psyche for Mental). Any die that rolls higher than the wall, does a level of damage to the appropriate Vital Statistic (Health for Physical, Poise for Social and Sanity for Mental).

Critical Success in Combat. Most TTRPGs handle critical hits by doubling the damage dice rolled or something similar. The effectiveness of the Damage Walls would make doubling the dice pretty ineffective. Instead, when you roll a total of 2 on your To-hit Roll, and you are guaranteed to deal some damage.

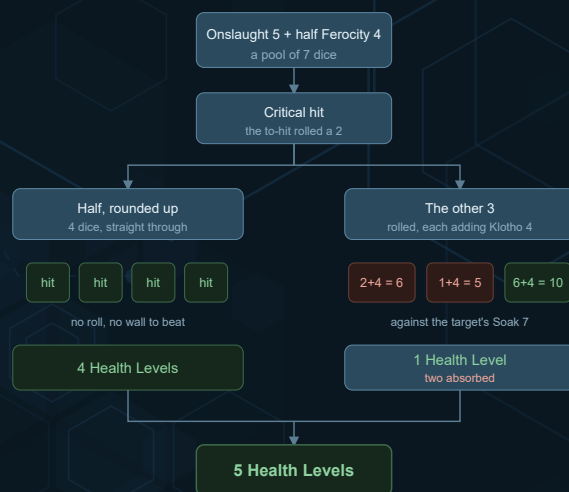
When you score a Critical Hit, half of the Damage Dice (rounded up) you would roll are considered to have succeeded. You roll the rest of the remaining dice. Since these dice have been chosen by Fate - add your Klotho score to them. Additionally, you can still use Ki to infuse the dice you roll on a Critical Hit.

NOTE: A Critical Hit can't kill on its own. No matter how devastating it is, a single attack can only reduce a character to zero health (Unconscious).

Example: Ronan has been verbally sparring with an enemy. Ronan isn't very smart or witty, so it isn't going well. He decides to punch him instead. After all, Ronan is the "God Puncher." Ronan decides to attack his opponent with his Gift, Onslaught. He rolls a 2 - a critical hit. Ronan has Onslaught at level 5 and a Ferocity of 4, so he would normally roll 7 dice for damage.

7 dice, divided by 2 is 3.5. Round it up and you have 4. His opponent takes 4 health levels of damage. Ronan also gets to roll those last 3 dice boosted by his Klotho score. His Klotho is

4. He rolls 2, 1, and 6. His opponent's soak is 7, so only one of the extra dice does damage.



HOW A CRITICAL HIT RESOLVES

WHICH ELEMENT ARE YOU ATTACKING WITH

Your weapon doesn't decide. Your approach does.

****Earth - Force.**** *I put my whole weight behind it and smash through his guard.*

****Air - Precision.**** *I wait for him to shift his guard, then thrust through the opening.*

****Fire - Intensity.**** *I charge him screaming and don't let up.*

****Water - Adaptation.**** *I let the swing go past, redirect it, and hit him when he overextends.*

****Moirai - Fate.**** *I say the thing he has been afraid somebody would notice. Social and Mental attacks only.*

Same sword in the first four. Describe what you're doing before you roll, and the GM confirms which Element fits. You don't get to pick it afterward, once you've seen how the numbers landed.

NOTE: Moira never governs a Physical attack. Fate doesn't swing a bat. It carries a Social or a Mental one readily, because finding the one word that lands is exactly what fate is for.

DEFENSE AND HOW IT'S CALCULATED

Defense is one of the most important numbers to consider in combat. Combat is the one time where the GM isn't determining the difficulty part of the Target Number equation. When you make an attack, your Target Number is calculated as the Your Element+Target's Defense.

Physical Defense: Physical Defense=10-your Atropos score. Your Fate decides when it is your time and it's not your time... yet.

Social Defense: Social Defense=10-your Psyche score. Insight into human behavior helps a character recognize motives, read intentions, and see through social deception.

Mental Defense: Mental Defense=10-your Presence score. A strong sense of self and personal identity provides an anchor against manipulation, intimidation, and psychological intrusion.

THE THREE WALLS

There are three types of damage in 20 Below: Physical, Social, and Mental. When someone lands an attack, the next step is to determine how much (if any) damage gets through. They roll their damage dice for the attack and compare the results of each die to the appropriate wall: **Soak vs. Physical** attacks, **Presence vs Social** attacks, and **Psyche vs Mental** attacks.

All three of these walls are similar to a levee - it stops damage from getting through. Anything that goes over the top deals damage. When an

attacker rolls for damage, he throws a fistful of dice. Each die is compared to the wall. If the number on the die is higher than the wall, it deals damage.

A high Soak, Presence or Psyche makes you extremely resilient and difficult to harm. Any of these sub-stats at 10 means that a rolled die effectively can't harm you sine you can't roll higher than a 10 on a d10. This means that someone who dumps 10 points into earth and dedicates those 10 sub-stat points into Soak is going to be relatively indestructible. This is intentional. Anime is stuffed with characters like this.

SOCIAL ATTACKS

A social attack goes after somebody's standing. Ridicule, intimidation, manipulation, public pressure, whatever undermines their ability to deal with the people around them.

A weapon has a Damage Rating. Nothing on your belt tells you how hard you can hit someone with a sentence, so that number has to come from somewhere else. It comes from you.

Your Dice Are Your Training

Whatever Skill you're using, its Training Tier is how many dice you roll.

Untrained. One die

Trained. Three.

Adept. Four.

Expert. Five.

Master. Six.

Untrained gets one die for the same reason bare fists do. Anyone can say something cruel. Most of it bounces.

That's the whole calculation. Nobody at the table has to rate how good your line was, and you don't have to be quick on your feet in real life to play somebody who is. Your sheet already said how good they are at this.

Which Skill, and Which Element

Say what you're doing and you've named the Skill. Name the Skill and you've settled the Element too, because every Skill already rolls off a home Element.

Fire. Ridicule, Intimidation, Persuasion, Public Speaking, Performance, Leadership, Deception.

Moir. Insight.

As with any Skill, you can argue for a different Element in the moment if you've got a Descriptor that backs it.

After that it runs like a punch. Your Element against their Social Defense to land it, then your dice one at a time against their Presence, rolling high. Every die that gets through costs them a Poise.

Example: A Social Attack

Aiden is Adept at Intimidation, so four dice, rolled off Fire. Vance has Psyche 3, so his Social Defense is 7. Aiden's Fire is 6, which makes his target number 13, and he rolls a 9. It lands.

Vance has Presence 4, so that is what each die has to beat. Aiden rolls 3, 7, 5 and 9. The 3 is absorbed. The other three get through, and Vance loses 3 Poise.

MENTAL ATTACKS

A Gift is the only way you will ever make one.

That's the whole rule, and the rest of this section is what it means.

It is the one place the three attack types stop being symmetrical, and it's deliberate. Anyone can throw a punch and anyone can throw an insult - a fist and a bad word are both standard human equipment. Reaching into somebody's head is not, and no amount of nerve or gear substitutes for the thing you either have or don't.

If your character has a Gift that does it, the Gift says how many dice it throws, and everything after that runs like any other attack: Element against their Mental Defense, then those dice one at a time against their Psyche, and every one that gets through costs them a level of Sanity. Ki boosts a die through by adding your own Psyche. A Signature Move built to resolve against Psyche counts, because a Signature Move is a Gift.

If your character doesn't have one, Psyche is a wall you have no way to push on. This is a decision and not a gap in the rules.

Plenty of things out there are better equipped than you. A nightmare's cry doesn't bother with a to-hit roll and throws more dice than any person could bring to bear. Psyche is the wall you will spend the most time hiding behind and the least time attacking.

KI

WHAT KI IS

More than Gifts or Boons, Ki is what sets your character aside from the rest of the world. It is the fuel tank you pull from when the ordinary just isn't going to cut it. Ki is what takes you from ordinary to extraordinary.

Ki Pool: The thing that defines you - your strongest element - is also what defines your Ki Pool. At the start of play, your **Ki Pool is your strongest element+8**. This was an intentional design choice. Nothing else about your build effects your Ki Pool. The Nerdy Hacker and the Brick draw from the same font of power and every character in the game starts with a Ki Pool somewhere between 13 and 18.

This is deliberate. Everyone in 20 Below is supposed to have plenty of Ki to draw upon.

Why is Ki so important? Ki is used in the following ways:

Gift usage. Most gifts cost Ki points to use

Gift Check. When gift calls for a Gift Check, you roll 2d10 and your current Ki is your target number. There is no Advantage or Disadvantage on this roll. Yes, with experience points, it is possible to have a Ki over 20. Remember - a roll of 20 is a catastrophic failure and will fail even if your target number is 25.

Preventing Damage. When you would take damage to one of your vitals (Health, Poise, or Sanity) - you can prevent that damage at the cost of 1 Ki per level of damage.

Recovering from Vitals Loss. When your Poise or Sanity is at zero or below, you may spend 1 Ki point to recover from the Humiliated or Shattered state and go back to 1 in that Vital. Ki can't get you up from Dying - a Fate Token can.

Boosting Damage. After you land an attack with a successful 2d10 roll, you can Boost your Damage Dice. To do so, spend 1 Ki point per boosted die and add Ferocity (Physical), Psyche (Mental), or Presence (Social) to the number rolled on the die.

Bump your Action Bracket. You can spend Ki points to move quicker. You can bump yourself

from a Slow Action to a Normal Action for 1 Ki point and from a Normal Action to a Fast Action for 1 Ki point. This means you can take a Slow Action in the Fast Action Band for 2 Ki points.

Recovering Ki: Recover Ki by resting. A Short Rest restores a number of Ki points equal to your Klotho rating, minimum of 1. A Full Night's Rest recovers all of your Ki. You are playing the big damn heroes of this universe. Ki fuels you. It isn't a limited resource that you hoard.

SPENDING KI ON THE DICE

While anime is rife with characters that are *Nigh Indestructible™*, it's also crammed full of characters that can overcome it. You've seen it - "This isn't my true power!"

That is why you can boost your damage with Ki. It allows you to roll numbers that are higher than that 10. Roll the damage dice first. With them on the table, you pick which ones to boost, at **1 Ki each**. A boosted die adds your matching sub-stat to its own result - Ferocity for Physical, Presence for Social, Psyche for Mental.

This is how damage gets over the levees. A boosted die from a character with a 10 in Ferocity will deal damage 100% of the time, and a 2 in Ferocity has a 20% chance of topping that wall. The second one isn't good odds, but it is immeasurably better than the 0% chance you had a second ago.

HARM AND RECOVERY

LOSING HEALTH, POISE AND SANITY

The three health statistics are collectively called the Vital Statistics. Each level you have in

AT ZERO AND BELOW

	AT 0	BELOW 0	AT THE BOTTOM	CAN IT KILL?
Health	Unconscious	Dying	Dead	Yes
Poise	Flustered	Humiliated	Poise resets to 0 and costs a Sanity Level	No
Sanity	Overwhelmed	Shattered	A temporary Mental scar effect; Sanity resets to 0	No

Each Level you have gives you one negative Level on the same track. If you have 8 Health Levels, you can take 8 levels of damage below zero.

Health

- **At 0**, you are unconscious. You can take more damage after you are rendered unconscious.
- **Below 0**, you are Dying. These levels of damage represent real, devastating, life-threatening injuries, but they don't get worse while you lie there. Only more damage moves you closer to death.
- **Reach the bottom** of your negative Levels, and you are dead. Seven Health Levels means dead at -7.

Poise

- **At 0**, you are Flustered. Every Social roll, and anything else that needs you steady, is at Disadvantage until the Scene ends. You can take more damage after you are Flustered.
- **Below 0**, you are Humiliated. These levels represent your standing coming apart in front of the people whose opinion you needed, and it does not quietly repair itself. You cannot take the lead, negotiate, or speak

Health, Sanity and Poise represent one level of damage. As mentioned above, each Damage Die that makes it over a wall deals knocks out one level of damage. It's pretty straightforward.

What we haven't covered is what happens at 0 and below.

for the group, and you defer until your Poise climbs back to 0.

- **Hit the bottom** and your Poise resets to 0 and it costs you a Sanity Level. This level of Sanity damage can't be soaked, but can be prevented by spending a point of Ki.
- Poise damage cannot kill you.

Sanity

- **At 0**, you are Overwhelmed. You pick up a temporary Mental scar effect for as long as it lasts, and every roll is at Disadvantage, though you are still acting under your own power. You can take more damage after you are Overwhelmed.
- **Below 0**, you are Shattered. These levels represent your grip on your own mind giving way. You are panicky and babbling and cannot act on your own, so somebody else has to lead you or drag you. Going below 0 leaves a Mental scar no matter how you recover afterward.
- **Hit the bottom** and you pick up a temporary Mental scar effect and your Sanity resets to 0.
- Sanity damage cannot kill you either.

Going down, and staying down

One attack can never carry you past 0.

However many dice connect, you land exactly at zero. A bear that rolls ten dice at someone with three Levels left doesn't tear them apart. It drops them.

Once you're at 0, any further attack takes one Level. Total. Not one per die - one. A body on the ground absorbs a grizzly's entire turn for a single box. That is why people who go down usually get back up: finishing an unconscious character takes something standing over them, working at it, round after round, while everyone else is still swinging.

So dying here is a thing somebody decides to do to you. Something has to want you dead and be given the time to manage it.

Getting back up. Two things end Dying. Spend a Fate Token and you're back at 1 Health Level, conscious and able to act - and you can spend it while you're out cold, because fate doesn't need you awake. Or somebody stabilizes you - First Aid, a trauma kit, a Gift that says so - and you're at 0: not Dying any more, still unconscious, and healing at the normal rates from there.

Named and unnamed. All of this is for player characters and the NPCs your GM has given a name. An unnamed NPC who hits 0 is out of the fight and out of the story, and whether that's dead or down is the GM's call.

RECOVERY

Recovery takes time. The rules outline three different time frames for recovery.

- **Short Rest:** an hour of genuine downtime, and you only get one of them between full nights.

- **Full Night's Rest:** a full, largely uninterrupted night's sleep.
- **A Month:** the time it takes for Wealth to recover from failed wealth rolls.

Above zero

Short Rest. You heal Health Levels equal to half your Health, rounded up, minimum 1. Poise comes back at half your Presence and Sanity at half your Psyche, both rounded up, minimum 1. Ki comes back equal to your Klotho, minimum 1. One level of Exhausted lifts, unless you are still standing in whatever caused it.

Full Night's Rest. Health, Poise and Sanity all go back to full, and Ki refills completely. Every level of Exhausted clears, with the same exception: a level you took from the cold does not clear while you are still in the cold. Fate Tokens are not part of any of this. You gain one at sunrise whether you slept or not.

Below zero

Short Rest. An hour does not put a body back together. Below 0 Health Levels a Short Rest gives you nothing at all, and you stay Dying until you get a real night. Poise and Sanity work differently, because a reputation and a mind can turn a corner faster than a wound can close. A Short Rest brings either of them back to 1, not to full, and the normal rates start again from there on the next rest. A point of Ki does the same for either one immediately, without waiting for a rest at all.

Full Night's Rest. A full night gets you one Health Level, and only one, however tough you are. At -6 that is six nights before you are back to 0, and only then do the normal rates start again - unless somebody stabilizes you, which puts you at 0 straight away. Poise and Sanity come back to 1, the same as they would on a Short Rest. Nothing down here speeds up with a better night's sleep. Climbing out is meant to cost you time you would rather have spent on something else.

SCARS

Going to 0 leaves a mark. Going below it leaves something that lasts.

At 0, whichever Vital it was leaves a mark that's only for show: a scar, a limp or a changed voice from Health; a nervous habit or a reputation quirk from Poise; a tic, an intrusive thought or a private ritual from Sanity. The Healing and Regeneration Gifts stop the Health one from happening at all.

Below 0, you take a **scar**: one narrow, lasting effect from the lists below. Health leaves a Physical scar, Poise a Social one, Sanity a Mental one. Your GM picks it, or the two of you talk it over and decide.

- **One scar per crossing.** Go below 0, heal back up, go below again, and that's a second scar. Going deeper in one fall doesn't add another, and you can't take the same one twice.
- **A scar isn't a Flaw.** It gives you no points, and a scar getting in your way never earns you a Fate Token.
- **It's permanent** until something heals it.

Healing a scar always counts how far below 0 you went: -1 is one, -7 is seven.

SCAR	BY GIFT	BY ADDER	BY SKILL
Physical	Healing or Regeneration: that many Days	-	Medicine: that many Months
Mental	Restoration: that many Days	Talking Down or Taking the Edge Off: that many Weeks	Psychology: that many Months
Social	-	-	Networking: that many Months

A Skill takes regular work across that time from someone Trained in it - and for Networking, that someone is you. **A scarred reputation can't be treated or healed - it has to be rebuilt.**

Physical scars

SCAR	EFFECT
Bad Knee	Movement Rate -1m. Disadvantage on Athletics to jump.
Stiff Shoulder	Disadvantage on Thrown Weapons and Archery.
Shaky Hand	Disadvantage on Sleight of Hand, and on Firearms past Close.
Ribs That Set Wrong	Your Stamina baseline for holding breath and running flat-out is halved.
Ringed Ear	Disadvantage on Perception by sound.
Clouded Eye	Disadvantage on Perception by sight past Close.
Weak Grip	Disadvantage on Potence contests to hold on: grapples, climbing, a hand on a ledge.
Missing Fingers	Disadvantage on Crafting, Electronics and Security by hand.
Limp	Disadvantage on Acrobatics, and in chases on foot.
Scarred Lungs	Disadvantage on endurance checks in smoke, cold or thin air.
Weather in the Joints	In cold or rain, Disadvantage on Athletics and Acrobatics.
Tender Spot	Ki can't preserve the first Health Level you lose in a Scene.

SCAR	EFFECT
Disfigured	Disadvantage on Disguise. People who've seen you once remember you.
Bad Back	Disadvantage on Athletics to lift, carry or drag.
Slow to Clot	First Aid and Medicine on you are at Disadvantage.
Night Blind	Disadvantage on Perception and Driving in the dark.
Chronic Pain	Your baseline for any sustained exertion is one unit shorter.
Burn Scars	Soak counts 1 lower against fire and heat.
Old Break	A hit that costs 2 or more Health Levels also leaves you Off Balance.
Wheeze	Disadvantage on Stealth when you've moved this round.

Social scars

SCAR	EFFECT
The Story Goes Around	Disadvantage on Intimidation against anyone who's heard what happened.
Known Face	Disadvantage on Disguise and Stealth where it happened.
Stammer	Disadvantage on Public Speaking and Performance in front of an audience.
Sore Spot	A Social attack that brings it up gets 1 extra die.
Burned Bridge	Disadvantage on Networking with one Contact or faction who saw it.
Eyes Down	Disadvantage on Leadership when the person who did it is present.
Tell	Insight to read you is at Advantage.
Gives Ground	Disadvantage on Barter and Bribery.
Rattled	Losing a Poise Level leaves you Distracted.
The Nickname	Ridicule that uses it is at Advantage against you.
Out of Place	Disadvantage on Etiquette at anything formal.
It's on Video	Once a session the GM can say someone in the Scene has seen it. Disadvantage on Persuasion with them.

SCAR	EFFECT
Can't Let It Go	When it's thrown at you in public, Disadvantage on everything else until you answer it.
Nervous Laugh	Disadvantage on Charm and Seduction when it matters.
Quiet Voice	Disadvantage on Intimidation.
Flushes	Disadvantage on Deception about yourself.
Won't Ask	You can't be Helped on Social rolls.
On the Record	Disadvantage on Bureaucracy and Law wherever the record exists.
Stage Freeze	Your first Social roll in front of a crowd each Scene is at Disadvantage.
Touchy Subject	Ki can't preserve Poise against a Social attack that brings it up.

Mental scars

SCAR	EFFECT
The Trigger	One sound, smell or sight leaves you Distracted when it turns up.
Night Terrors	A Full Night's Rest refills Ki only as a Short Rest does, unless somebody keeps watch with you.
Hypervigilant	You can't be Surprised, and you can't take a Short Rest anywhere unsecured.
Phobia	Disadvantage on every roll while the thing is within Close.
Lost Time	A stretch of memory is gone. The GM knows what's in it.
Intrusive Memory	A catastrophic failure also leaves you Distracted.
Checks the Exits	Your first action in each Scene is at Slow.
Flat	Disadvantage on Performance and Charm.
Paranoid	You can't be Helped by anyone you haven't known a Month.
Startle	A sudden loud noise costs you Fast for the round.
Drifts	Once a session the GM can say you drift. Disadvantage on Perception for that Scene.
Insomnia	Miss a Full Night's Rest and you wake

SCAR	EFFECT
	Exhausted.
The Voice	You answer it under your breath. Disadvantage on Stealth.
Survivor's Guilt	While an ally is Dying, you can't spend a Fate Token on yourself.
Freezes	Surprised lasts a round longer.
Tunnel Vision	Under Mental attack, you can't Help or be Helped.
It Knows You	Mental attacks from the thing that did it get 1 extra die.
The Dark	Disadvantage on every roll in darkness without a light.
Fixated	While it's in the Scene, Disadvantage on anything that isn't about it.
Cracks	Disadvantage on Academics, Research and Law in combat.

None of these fit? Your GM can make one. It should come from the moment you were hurt, bite about once a session, and never touch every roll you make.

TIME

HOW TIME WORKS

Time is divided into discrete segments. In order of length, they are a Round, Minute, Hour, Scene, Day, Week, Month, Year, Decade and Century.

Round. About six seconds, and the base unit everything else is measured against: one pass through the turn order, long enough for everyone present to do one thing.

Minute. Ten Rounds, which is exactly sixty seconds and also the span of a fight that goes badly rather than quickly.

Scene. However long the thing you are currently doing takes, from the moment it starts mattering to the moment it stops, and the GM calls the edges.

Day. A full cycle including a night's sleep, which is the shortest band that lets you recover properly and the longest one you can plan inside.

Week. Seven Days, and the span for anything that takes regular work to fix: a habit, a debt, a mind being talked back from somewhere.

Month. Long enough for wounds to close, for people to hear things, and for a reputation to settle into whatever shape it is going to keep.

Year. The length of time for things that change a character rather than a situation: training that takes, debts that come due, the world moving on without asking you.

COMBAT

Combat is both mechanics with a turn order bolted on. Nothing in this section replaces anything you've already read.

If you skipped straight here because you wanted to hit something, go back and read the two mechanics first. I'll wait.

COMBAT ORDER

Roll Initiative once, at the start of the fight: 1d10 plus your Initiative sub-stat, highest first.

You do not re-roll it every round. That order holds for the whole fight.

Then, each round, **everyone declares an Action Bracket** - Fast, Normal, or Slow.

Then it **resolves band by band**. Everyone in Fast goes, then everyone in Normal, then everyone in Slow. Inside a band, your Initiative order decides who goes first.

ACTION BRACKETS

Fast gets one action. You go first, and that's all you do - a move, an attack, one Skill use.

Normal gets two actions. The balanced middle. A move and an attack, usually.

Slow gets one empowered action. You go last, but the action is stronger - you Aim for Advantage, line up a Called Shot, study your target - and you can still take a single step, one meter, before or after it.

Fast trades what you can do for when you do it. Slow trades the other direction - you go last, but the one thing you do, you do properly. Normal doesn't trade anything away, which is why most people spend most of their rounds there.

You can spend **1 Ki per step** to bump the band you declared - Slow to Normal, or Normal to Fast. Two Ki moves two steps. A bumped action keeps everything it was: a Called Shot bumped to Fast is still a Called Shot.

WHAT AN ACTION BUYS YOU

Beyond attacking or moving, these are what you can spend an action on. Anything a Gift or a weapon says about its own action cost overrides this list.

Empowered actions

Empowered actions are what a Slow round buys. You get one of them, plus your one-meter step.

AIM

Advantage on the attack.

CALLED SHOT

You hit something specific: a hand, a strap, the weapon they're pointing at you. No Advantage.

STUDY A TARGET

No roll; the round is the price. Next round, your first attack on it has Advantage, and that includes a Called Shot.

CAREFUL WORK

Advantage on a Skill roll made with your whole attention, and it holds round after round on the same job until something interrupts you.

BRACE

Until your next turn, nothing can Bulldoze you, shove you or knock you down.

BULLDOZE

Charge at least five meters, and no more than twice your Movement Rate, to drive something out of its space. Roll your Potence in dice against its Soak; each one over shoves it back a meter, and you step in behind it. If nothing gets through, you stop beside it.

You can't Aim and take a Called Shot in the same round. You can take two rounds over it: Study a Target, then take the shot with Advantage.

Special actions

Special actions belong to one band.

ATTACK ON THE RUN (FAST ONLY)

A full move and an attack, with a gun or a blade, anywhere along the way. The attack is at Disadvantage.

SNAP TO COVER (FAST ONLY)

A single step into cover beside you, still on your feet.

DIVE FOR COVER (FAST OR NORMAL)

Fast, you move up to your Movement Rate before anyone slower acts, and land Belly Down. Normal, you make a full move first and then dive.

SPRINT (SLOW ONLY)

Five times your Movement Rate, and nothing else.

Everything else

DASH (NORMAL)

Both actions on movement. Up to twice your Movement Rate, nothing else.

RECKLESS

free, just declared. Advantage on your attacks this round, and Advantage on everyone's attacks against you. It is exactly as stupid as it sounds, and every so often it is exactly the right call.

FULL DEFENSE (NORMAL)

You can't attack. Your other action can still move you. Attacks against you are at Disadvantage and your Defense drops by 4, floored at 0.

GRAB

from Melee, an attack, then your Potence in dice against its Soak. Any one over and it's Grabbed.

DISARM

a Called Shot at what they're holding, then Potence against Potence to knock it loose.

HELP

your action goes into someone else's, and their next roll has Advantage.

READY

name a trigger and hold your action for it: when it comes through the door.

DRAW, SWAP, STOW, USE

getting a weapon out, putting one away, or using a simple item takes an action.

RELOAD

depends on the weapon. Magazines, speed-loaders and crossbow cranks take one action. A tube-fed shotgun, loaded shell by shell, takes a full Slow action. A bow pulled from a quiver is free. Each weapon lists its own cost.

MOVEMENT

MAP OR NO MAP

20 Below plays with a map or without one, and the rules are the same either way. Only how you keep track of where everyone stands changes. A table can switch in the same session: a map for the fight in the warehouse, no map for the chase across the rooftops after it.

Theater of the mind has no map. The GM describes the scene, you say what you do, and the picture lives in everyone's head. It still runs on your sheet. The GM keeps rough distances in meters - the dog is about thirty meters off, across the car park - and when you need to know whether you can reach something, you ask how far it is. Close enough is fine. Nobody measures.

Tactical play puts the scene on a map. **One hex is one meter**, so your Movement Rate is simply the number of hexes you can move. Print a map at an inch to the meter and the tokens stay true to scale.

Either way, distance falls into four bands, and the band follows from where you end up.

Melee is contact, out to about one meter - arm's reach. On a map, the next hex. **Close** is one to ten meters: the same room, across a bar, the width of an alley. **Near** is ten to fifty - across a street, the length of a corridor, the far side of a car park. **Far** is anything past fifty meters, rooftop to rooftop.

MOVING IN A ROUND

Your **Movement Rate** is 5 plus your Air, in meters. One move takes you that far. Which band you declare decides how many moves you get.

Fast: one action. Move your Movement Rate, or do something else and don't move. **Normal:** a move and one other action. Or two moves - a **Dash**, twice your Movement Rate. Or two other actions and no move at all. **Slow:** one empowered action and a one-meter step. Or a **Sprint:** five times your Movement Rate, and nothing else.

In a Normal round you can split your move around the other action: move, then shoot; shoot, then move; or move, shoot, and move again, as long as the total stays inside your Movement Rate. A Dash and a Sprint don't split. They're all movement.

A Sprint goes last, because Slow does - unless you pay for it. Bump it with Ki like any Slow action: one Ki and it runs in the Normal band, two and it runs in Fast. It's still a Sprint. It just happens sooner.

LEAVING MELEE

You can always just move away. Nobody gets a free swing at you as you go, and there's no roll to break off. What it costs you is time. Whatever you were fighting hasn't gone anywhere, and if it hasn't acted yet this round, it can follow you and attack - as long as its move reaches you.

So getting clear comes down to **when you go** and **how far you get**. A Fast move goes before anything in the Normal or Slow bands. A long enough move leaves it short. A Sprint gets you furthest, but it goes last unless you bump it, so the thing you're running from bites first.

If something has you **Grabbed**, you're not going anywhere until you escape the hold.

You can move through a friend's space but not an enemy's, and you never stop in a space

someone else is standing in - unless you **Bulldoze** them out of it.

GETTING LOW AND TAKING COVER

Belly Down is getting down on purpose, and it costs you nothing. Flat on the ground, you're a smaller target: **ranged attacks against you are at Disadvantage**. Up close it's the other way round - **your Melee attacks are at Disadvantage** and **Melee attacks against you gain Advantage**. You can still shoot. Standing back up takes an action.

While you're Belly Down you can **Crawl**, at two meters of movement for every one you cover.

Prone is different. Nobody chooses Prone - it's what happens when a blow, a fall, or bad footing puts you on the ground. Prone, you **can't attack** and **every attack against you gains Advantage**, and you can't crawl. Getting yourself together takes an action.

Cover comes in two kinds, and the GM tells you which. Behind **full cover**, anything that needs to see or reach you can't. Behind **partial cover** - a corner, a car door, a low wall - attacks against you are at **Disadvantage**. Belly Down behind partial cover doesn't stack into anything worse, but it does hold up when a shooter takes the time to Aim.

BAD GROUND

Not every meter costs a meter.

Clear ground - a floor, a road, a lawn - costs what it says. **Rough** ground - mud, deep snow, rubble, undergrowth, knee-deep water - costs two meters of movement for every one. **Wild Land** - bog, a collapsed building, a thicket, drifts past your waist - costs three.

You can push through it. Once a turn, when your movement takes you onto bad ground, roll **Athletics at Difficulty 6**. A success crosses Rough as if it were clear, and Wild Land as if it were Rough - never better. A failure pays the full cost. Athletics is Earth by default, but your Descriptors can argue for another Element, the same as any Skill.

Footing is different from ground. Ice, a slick deck, loose scree - walk across it carefully and nothing happens. Dash, Sprint or Bulldoze across it and you roll Athletics at 6, and a failure puts you down Prone.

Tight spaces - a crawlspace, a vent, the gap between two buildings - cost double to

HOW HARD THE CLIMB IS

DIFFICULTY	SURFACE
10	a stepladder, a waist-high wall
9	a ladder
8	a tree with low branches, a chain-link fence
7	a sturdy rope with knots tied in it
6	a rock face with good holds, a drainpipe
5	a plain rope, a brick wall with crumbling mortar
4	a rough stone wall, a rope while carrying someone
3	an overhang, a crumbling cliff
2	a sheer, rain-slicked cliff face
1	smooth concrete, bare ice without tools
0	vertical glass

Rain, wind or darkness make any of it a step or two harder. Nearly Impossible isn't impossible, though. The strongest people in this game can climb glass.

Jumping

A running long jump clears your Air in meters. Standing, it's half that. A high jump gets half as

squeeze through, and while you're squeezed you can't attack, and anything attacking you is at Disadvantage. Crawling ignores Rough ground entirely; you crawl through plowed dirt as easily as grass. Wild Land still costs you its three.

CLIMBING, JUMPING AND SWIMMING

Climbing

Climbing costs two meters for every one you go up. Roll Athletics once a turn at the surface's Difficulty: a success climbs at your full rate, a failure at double cost, and a roll of 20 means you fall.

high as you can jump forward.

JUMPING FURTHER

EXTRA DISTANCE	ATHLETICS DIFFICULTY
+1 m	8
+2 m	6
+3 m	4
+4 m	2
+5 m	0

Fall short and you land at your Air distance - and if that's over the drop, you go down it, unless you land next to an edge. Then you get Athletics at 6 to catch yourself, and climbing out is a climb.

Swimming

Swimming can't be done untrained. If you don't have the Swimming Skill and you end up in deep water, the No-air clock starts right away, unless you've got hold of something that floats.

If you can swim, you swim at your Movement Rate. Staying up is the hard part. In calm water you get your Stamina in Hours for free; in rough water - a current, waves, or swimming with weight - your Stamina in Minutes. After that, roll Water plus Difficulty once an Hour (or a Minute), starting at 8 in calm water and 6 in rough, one step harder every roll. Each failure is a level of Exhausted, and Exhausted 5 means you go under. Cold water piles its own Exhausted on top, which is how a winter river kills a strong swimmer.

Creatures that move differently

Creatures that fly, swim, climb or burrow do it at the rate on their card, with no extra cost and no roll - unless you changed the ground. Bring the building down, flood the room, throw the caltrops: then it pays like anyone else. When

something outclasses you on its own ground, change the ground.

CHASES

A chase is ordinary movement, round after round, with a roll for the route. Everyone declares their movement as usual. Then everyone makes a **Chase roll at Difficulty 6** - Athletics on foot, Driving in a car, Piloting in the air or on the water - and the GM makes it a step or two harder when the route is bad. Being faster doesn't earn you a bonus; the meters already count your speed.

One side succeeds and the other fails: the side that failed hits the fruit stand, and moves at half this round. **Both succeed, or both fail:** everyone moves in full. **A critical success:** you move half again as far.

At a meter or less, you're caught. Get out of sight - around the corner the GM just described - and you roll **Stealth** against your pursuer's Perception. Win, and you've lost them. Lose, and they're back on your trail. When you're the ones chasing, you roll Perception or Tracking against the quarry's Stealth.

Running is exhausting. A Sprint is running flat out: your Stamina in Rounds for free, then a roll of Water plus Difficulty every Round, starting at 6 and getting harder, with a level of Exhausted for each failure. The fast get away, and so do the sneaky. Everyone else needs a plan.

TRAVEL

Over hours and days you stop counting rounds and start counting kilometers. You walk **3 plus a fifth of your Air** kilometers an hour on a road or a trail, and your **travel day is 4 plus your Stamina in hours**. That puts a fragile character at about sixteen kilometers a day and the toughest at forty-five - which, not by accident, is what real people manage. A group goes at its slowest member's pace and stops when its shortest day runs out.

Rough ground halves the day's distance and Wild Land cuts it to a third. Nobody rolls for it; a whole day on bad ground isn't one lucky stride.

Walking past your travel day is a **forced march**. Every extra Hour, roll Water plus Difficulty, starting at 7 and one step harder each Hour, and take a level of Exhausted for every failure. A night's sleep clears it.

Nobody gets lost unless the GM says the country, the weather, or the dark makes it a question. Then it's a Navigation roll - unless you brought a compass and a map.

CONDITIONS AND HAZARDS

CONDITIONS

Eight states you can be put into. Most of them hurt you by taking dice away. Three of them go further.

OFF BALANCE

You rolled a catastrophic failure in combat. You roll everything at Disadvantage until the end of your next turn. It does not stack, it clears on its own, and a Fate Token spent to Shrug Off an Effect clears it early - though it never undoes whatever else went wrong on that roll. The Never Off Balance Boon lets you reroll the failure that caused it: on attack rolls at its first tier, on any roll in combat at its second, and on any roll at all at its third.

DISTRACTED

You lose a Health Level, or get hit by a Kotodama, while resolving a Slow action. Roll Atropos plus Difficulty to hold your concentration. Succeed and the action goes off as declared. Fail and it drops to a Normal action, losing whatever its empowered action gave.

Other things can make you Distracted too - a Gift, a collapsing building, an explosion right next to your head. Same roll. Outside a Slow action, failing means Disadvantage on whatever triggered it instead. The Concentration Boon makes you immune to all of it.

SURPRISED

You didn't see it coming, usually because someone's Stealth beat your Perception. You roll everything at Disadvantage for the rest of that round. It clears when the round ends. The Alertness Boon makes you immune while you're conscious.

FLUSTERED

Your Poise hit 0. You roll all Social rolls at Disadvantage, and anything else where keeping your composure matters, for the rest of the Scene. You can spend an action on a Presence plus Difficulty roll to pull yourself together early.

HUMILIATED

Your Poise went below 0, and this is the one that doesn't just cost you dice. You can't take the lead, you can't negotiate, and nobody is going to let you speak for the group - you defer and you comply. Your body works fine. You'll swing a sword all day. This is social paralysis, not physical. It clears when your Poise climbs back to 0.

Your Poise track runs as far below zero as it does above it - eight Poise means Humiliated all the way down to minus seven. **Hit the bottom of it and something gives.** Your Poise resets to 0, which puts you back to Flustered rather than back on your feet, and you take **a point of Sanity**. No roll, no wall - your Psyche does not defend against this, because this is not something being done to your mind. It is your standing in the room finally coming apart, and taking a piece of you with it. A point of Ki still stops it, the same as it stops anything else.

OVERWHELMED

Your Sanity hit 0. You pick up a temporary Mental scar effect - your GM picks it, or you agree it together - and you roll everything at Disadvantage. You can still act, and you're still yourself. It clears when you're out of whatever did it to you and get a chance to rest, or for 1 Ki, which refills your Sanity on the way out.

SHATTERED

Your Sanity went below 0, and this is the other one that doesn't just cost you dice. You're panicky and babbling and you can't act on your own - somebody has to lead you, or drag you. It clears for 1 Ki or a rest, but either one only brings your Sanity back to 1, not full, and going below 0 leaves a Mental scar however you climb out of it.

EXHAUSTED

The only one that stacks. You take levels of it, one through five, from pushing an effort past what your Stamina covers, or from cold, or from heat.

- **1:** Disadvantage on Physical rolls
- **2:** Disadvantage on everything
- **3:** Your Movement Rate is halved, and you lose Fast actions
- **4:** Every Ki spend costs 1 more
- **5:** On the ground, unconscious, until somebody gets you warm, cool, or rested

A Short Rest clears one level. A full night clears the lot.

COMMON HAZARDS

The world hurts people without anybody swinging anything, and all of it runs on the same machinery: a number of d10, one at a time against your Soak, every die that gets through costing a Health Level. The weapon table is the scale. Fists are 1, a knife is 3, an anti-materiel rifle is 5. A hazard is a number on that same line.

HAZARDS AT A GLANCE

HAZARD	WHAT IT DOES
Falling	1 die per 4 meters, up to 5 dice. Halved into water, deep snow or a hedge
Fire	A burning room: 1 die per round you stay. On fire yourself: 2 dice per round until it's out
Vehicle	1 die per 10 MPH / 16 km/h, no cap

HAZARDS AT A GLANCE (CONTINUED)

HAZARD	WHAT IT DOES
No air	Stamina rounds free, then 1 Health Level per round. Soak doesn't help
Cold and heat	Levels of Exhausted, not Health
Corruption	A track of its own, 0 to 5

FALLING

One die per four meters, up to five. Off a kitchen counter isn't worth rolling. A flight of stairs is about one. Three storeys down a stairwell is three, which is the same as being stabbed. Past twenty meters you are throwing five dice and there is nothing worse to throw. Landing in water, deep snow or a hedge halves it.

FIRE

A burning room is one die at the end of every round you are still in it, and it doesn't stop until you leave. Being on fire yourself is two, and it doesn't stop until you put it out - a Normal action for you, a Fast one for somebody helping.

GETTING HIT BY A VEHICLE

One die per 10 MPH, or per 16 km/h. Clipped in a parking lot is 1. A city street is 3. The highway is 7, and it doesn't stop there - there is no cap. What still holds is the rule that one attack never carries you past 0, so the truck puts you on the ground rather than under it. Anime is full of people who get up from that.

NO AIR

Drowning, smoke, a bag over your head - you have Stamina rounds. After that it is one Health Level per round, and **Soak doesn't help**, because there is nothing to soak. It is the one hazard armour is no use against.

COLD AND HEAT

Cold. This is the one the game is named after, and it doesn't take Health. It takes **Exhausted** levels, and gear is the whole defence. Dressed for it, nothing happens. Underdressed, a level an hour. Wet, or in a wind, or genuinely twenty below, a level every half hour. In cold water, a level a minute. And you cannot clear cold Exhausted while you are still cold - a Short Rest in a snowdrift is not a rest.

Heat. The same ladder from the other end. Working hard in real heat is a level an hour. With no water it is a level an hour whatever you are doing, and nothing clears until you drink. Enclosed, airless and with no shade, a level every half hour.

Exhaustion from cold and heat

CONDITIONS	EXHAUSTED
Dressed for the cold	Nothing happens
Underdressed	1 level per hour
Wet, in a wind, or genuinely twenty below	1 level per half hour
In cold water	1 level per minute
Working hard in real heat	1 level per hour
No water in the heat	1 level per hour, whatever you are doing; nothing clears until you drink

COLD AND HEAT (CONTINUED)

CONDITIONS	EXHAUSTED
Enclosed, airless, no shade	1 level per half hour

Neither one costs you a Health Level. They put you at Exhausted 5, which puts you on the ground, and out there that is the same thing. A blizzard is dangerous to somebody nobody has laid a finger on.

CORRUPTION

Some things get their hooks into you: a presence, an otherworldly thing, a place. It changes you slowly. At first you don't notice it. Eventually, you don't mind. It isn't damage, and it costs no Sanity - it's a track of its own, zero to five, and you only have one.

There is only one thing doing this. What you meet is one of the places it gets through - a lake, a radio, a thing in a basement - and each of those is a **locus**. Get caught by the lake and then by the radio, and it's the same track going up. Whichever locus pushed you up last is yours: that's the one you want to go back to, and that's whose mark you carry. Near any of the others you're Distracted, and you know them for what they are.

Every time you're exposed - you look at it, touch it, breathe it, sleep near it, whatever that source feeds on - it rolls its dice against your Klotho. If any die gets over, you slide one level. Only one, however many got over. A rare few are worse than that, and your GM will know which. Some loci are creatures, and a creature can put its will behind those dice the way you put Ki behind an attack. Nothing else gets through a Klotho of 10.

CORRUPTION - THE FIVE LEVELS

LEVEL	NAME	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW IT CLEARS
1	Tell	A small sign of your locus, and everyone sees it but you.	A day away and it's gone.
2	Pull	You want to go back to your locus. You're Distracted near it, or when something keeps you from it.	Each day away takes a level off, but the wanting lasts a week for every day you spent at Pull or worse.
3	Marked	Your locus's mark, which you may or may not notice, and anyone who touches it risks catching it too.	Only your locus's cure - something rare, and somebody out there knows what.
4	Conduit	You read as unnatural, and reality goes thin around you: Kotodama costs less near you, for everyone.	Only destroying or sealing your locus brings you back from here.

CORRUPTION - THE FIVE LEVELS (CONTINUED)

LEVEL	NAME	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW IT CLEARS
5	Claimed	It has you. If you keep playing, it's steering you now.	The party's Kotodama - six Fate Tokens or more. Whether the character leaves play is up to you and your GM.

Up to Conduit, you can burn a Fate Token per level to claw your way back down, all the way to nothing. Every level you burn counts against the spends you can make in a Scene, because Corruption is meant to be that hard to shake. The pull stays either way.

SKILLS

Earth, Air, Fire, Water and Moira - your Elemental Attributes - are what you are made of. They are the raw materials you have to work with. Your Skills are what you've made with them.

The elements are huge, unknowable forces and concepts, your skills are narrow, practiced things. A skill is the difference between an EMT setting a broken arm with ease and a bystander watching and turning green. Every roll described in the previous chapter assumed you had one of these skills.

EVERY SKILL HAS AN ELEMENT

Every skill naturally stems from one of the Elements interacting with the world through your hands. As such, every skill is inherently linked to a specific element. In game terms, the skill defaults to the associated Element and that Element is used to determine the target number of the roll.

The default element doesn't define what a Skill fundamentally is - it's where the roll starts from. It is the way a skill is normally handled. Stealth defaults to Water because staying unseen is slow, patient work rather than a burst of speed... Most of the time.

CHALLENGING THE DEFAULT

Sometimes you want to take a path less traveled - the ordinary way just isn't the way you want to go.

It is possible to connect a skill with an Element different from the Default. If the GM buys your argument, that's the roll you make. This is

where your Descriptors come into play. These adjectives give you leverage to use a different Element to calculate the Target Number when using a skill.

What's that? Won't everyone just argue their way into using their best Element every single time? They would, if it weren't for your Descriptors. They are chosen once (at creation and each time you add a new point to one of your sub-stats. These challenges are anchored in who your character is - not an improvised argument invented at the table 10-seconds ago.

Player: Ronan wants to lean on the bouncer. Intimidation defaults to Fire, and my Fire is terrible.

GM: Yes. It is. Go on.

Player: One of my Potence Descriptors is *Immovable*. I'm not shouting at him. I'm standing in the doorway, not moving, and he has to decide whether tonight is the night he finds out what that costs.

GM: Makes sense. That'll do it. Roll it on Earth.

Two things about that. The GM has final say, and no is a complete answer.

After that roll is made, the skill "resets" to its default. The next time you use that skill, if you want to use an Element different from the default, you have to argue for it again. Ronan's Immovable descriptor won't help him when he is trying to intimidate someone over the phone.

SKILL TIERS

Your mastery of a skill is reflected in Skill Tiers. Skill Tiers are a crunchy, nuts-and-bolts way to quantify the time and training it takes to become proficient in a Skill. Every skill falls into one of the Tiers outlined below. With the exception of Everyman Skills, all skills start at Untrained.

0 - Untrained: You have no training in this skill. If you aren't trained in a skill, you don't get to add your Element to the Target Number - you roll Difficulty only.

1 - Trained: You are competent with this skill. You are the person people hire to get a job done. You roll your Element+Difficulty.

2 - Adept: You are good at what you do and it shows. You roll your Element+Difficulty, at Advantage.

3 - Expert: You are the guy that the adepts come to for answers. You aren't just good - you are *damn* good. You roll your Element+Difficulty, at Advantage. Additionally, while using this skill, you score a Critical Success when you roll a 2 or a 3.

4 - Master: You have truly mastered this skill. You have spent thousands of hours honing your craft. You might have invented the skill. You roll with all the benefits of an Expert. Additionally, if you roll a Catastrophic Failure (20 on the dice), you can avoid the negative consequences. Immediately roll the dice again. If your second roll succeeds, the Catastrophic Failure is canceled and you simply fail the roll.

EVERYMAN SKILLS

In every setting, there are things that any functional adult can do. These are represented by Everyman Skills. Your GM sets a list of skills that everyone in the campaign has access to automatically.

Every character starts with this short list of Skills at Tier 1 (Trained), for free.

For a present-day game, a list of Everyman Skills might be: Athletics, Bureaucracy, Computer Use, Cooking, Driving, Etiquette, First Aid, Perception, Persuasion and Streetwise. Your GM may have a different idea of what should be on this list, but Perception is always on it. This list also won't work for a medieval high fantasy setting.

THE SKILL LIST

The following list is a starting point for a modern campaign. It isn't exhaustive and isn't trying to be.

If you see a skill that needs to be in the campaign - add it. If a skill seems too broad - split it into two. If you want a skill for your character that isn't on the list, make it. I put the list together to help speed up character creation.

The skills are relatively broad on purpose. Crafting is composed of a wide pool of knowledge and individual sub-skills. The skill should reflect this.

There are 4 skills on this list that are different. They do not change the way you roll - they dictate what you can access. The weapons skills - Melee Weapons, Firearms, Archery, and Thrown Weapons - do not work the same as other skills. Each Tier in these skills grants proficiency with the weapon types listed. The skill is only rolled for maintenance, repair and building weapons.

Every entry lists its default Element in brackets.

ACADEMICS AIR

The library closes at 10 p.m. and you were still there as they were locking up. Someone needs to know this stuff. In most cases, that is going to be you.

General scholarship, history, and literature.

ACROBATICS AIR

Falling is easy. Falling safely is hard. Falling with style is damn near impossible. Yet, you pull it off.

Balance, tumbling, and controlled falls.

ANIMAL HANDLING WATER

Animals don't speak your native language, but they seem to understand what you want from them.

Training, calming, and directing animals.

APPRAISAL MOIRA

The seller twitches when you pick it up. It feels slightly too light and the patina is the weight that gives it away. That, and the way the seller won't quite look at it.

Judging the value and authenticity of goods.

ARCHERY EARTH

Setup... lift... settle... follow-through. The same four steps over and over again until it is reflex. After all, the bowstring does not forgive a flinch.

Which bows you are trained to draw, by Category: a hand crossbow first, then a crossbow, a recurve, a compound, and the warbow last. You do not roll it to shoot - a to-hit is your Element against their Defense, the same for everyone. What this says is which of them you can pick up and use.

Each tier adds to the ones under it.

1 - Trained: Hand crossbow, Crossbow.

2 - Adept: Recurve bow.

3 - Expert: Compound bow.

4 - Master: Warbow. An English longbow, and anything else that asks that much of a back.

Care, repair and building. Waxing a string, fletching your own arrows, tuning a rest or a nock point: no roll. Repair is a roll of this Skill - a delaminated limb, a cracked riser, the prod of a crossbow, a string served badly by somebody else. From **Expert** you can build a bow from a prepared stave and fittings; at **Master**, from a stave you cut and cured yourself.

ATHLETICS EARTH

Humans are capable of amazing feats. Your body will do more than you expected and far less than you hoped for.

Running, jumping, climbing, and lifting under exertion.

BARTER FIRE

Bartering is a game of give and take. Never let them see that you want it. The moment you do, the price stops being negotiable.

Striking favorable trades and deals.

BRIBERY FIRE

Bribery isn't about the money... At least not just about the money. It's about knowing who will take it, how to give it to them and plausible deniability.

Knowing how much, how, and who to pay to get what you want.

BUREAUCRACY WATER

The red tape that is an obstacle to most people is just a finish line for you. Someone, somewhere in this building there is one person who can sign this - you know how to find them and how to get them to sign it.

Navigating institutions, paperwork, permits, and red tape to get things done.

CHARM FIRE

You don't really do anything - you don't have to. You are just that charming. You are easy to be around and by the end of the day, most people like you.

Ingratiation and drawing people in.

COMBAT DRIVING/PILOTING AIR

Driving is easy. Everyone can do it. Almost no one can drive while being showered with glass shards. Driving while being shot at, avoiding impact and using your vehicle as a weapon is hard - but you can do it.

Operating a vehicle under fire or in a chase. This is a separate Skill from ordinary Driving or Piloting; competence in traffic says nothing about competence under fire.

COMPOSITION FIRE

Anyone can write words down. Choosing the right ones, crafting compelling stories, songs or poetry is a different task altogether.

Writing music, poetry, or stories with real craft.

COMPUTER USE AIR

Everyone has a computer in their pocket these days, but very few people know how to really use them with any proficiency. You know how to explore a system, find the setting and how to make the machines work the way they are supposed to.

General computing, software, and programming. This Skill is distinct from Hacking - the same machine, but one of you is asking it politely.

CONCEALMENT MOIRA

You know the best places to stash things, how to disguise an entrance and make a vehicle almost invisible.

Hiding objects, caches, or hideouts from a determined search.

CONTORTION EARTH

Your body is far more flexible than people give you credit for. The ways you can bend your body and twist your joints are downright unnerving to many people.

Fitting through tight spaces and slipping restraints through flexibility.

COOKING EARTH

Anyone can follow a recipe - you stopped needing one years ago.

Preparing food, from the everyday to the exceptional.

COVERT SIGNALS AIR

Two fingers held low against your thigh and everybody behind you stops walking. Nobody said a word, and nobody is going to - that's the whole point. A whole conversation, in a room full of people, and not one of them hears a syllable of it.

Prearranged signals that carry meaning without words - hand signs, chalk marks, whistles, and brevity over the air.

CRAFTING EARTH

Measure twice, cut once. You are good at making things.

Building and repairing goods in a chosen trade. One Skill covers any material or trade - woodworking, metalworking, whatever you practice - because the habits of hand and eye carry across all of them.

CRYPTOGRAPHY AIR

There are two sides to this and you work both. One is making something that stays unreadable to everyone except the person you meant it for. The other is being the uninvited reader on somebody else's message, with nothing to go on but volume, repetition, and time you don't really have.

Creating and breaking codes, ciphers, and encryption.

DECEPTION FIRE

Everybody lies. Most people are dreadful at it, because the moment they're nervous they start adding detail - the dog's name, the make of the car, what the weather was doing that afternoon. You go the other way. Small story, mostly true, delivered like you'd honestly rather be discussing something else.

Lying, bluffing, and fast talk.

DEMOLITIONS EARTH

Anyone can make something explode. Making something explode with the exact force, placement and form to get the job done is a different thing entirely.

Safely handling, placing, and detonating explosives.

DISGUISE WATER

You can make your face somebody else's - hair, skin, the line of a jaw, and the clothes worn the exact way that particular person wears them. Copying the voice and the mannerisms is the easy half. The hard half is being looked at directly by somebody who knows them, and not being seen.

Altering appearance and behaviors to convincingly pass as someone else.

DIVINATION MOIRA

Cards, bones, tea leaves, the dream that won't leave you alone. The method doesn't much matter. What matters is asking a question Fate finds interesting enough to bother answering.

Reading omens, portents, and the shape of what's coming.

DRIVING EARTH

Cars, trucks, a van with a dying clutch, something with tracks on it. If it has wheels and a road underneath, you'll get it where it's going without anybody needing to file a report about it.

Operating ground vehicles in ordinary traffic and terrain.

ELECTRONICS EARTH

Building it is the easy part. Building it so the next person to open the case doesn't curse you by name takes rather more practice. A schematic, a soldering iron, and a great deal of squinting. None of it is fast and none of it is glamorous, and you'd rather be doing it than almost anything else.

Building, repairing, and modifying electronic devices and circuitry.

ENGINEERING AIR

Everything still standing is an argument with gravity that somebody won on paper first. You're one of the people who does the arguing.

Theoretical and design knowledge of structures and systems.

ESCAPOLOGY WATER

Rope, zip ties, cuffs or the trunk of a car. None of it is a trick and none of it is dignified. Four minutes, some skin off your knuckles, and dislocating something on purpose in the dark while you listen for footsteps.

Breaking free of restraints and confined spaces under pressure.

ETIQUETTE FIRE

Every room has rules nobody will say out loud, because saying them out loud would be a breach of the rules. Manners are a password. Get it right and doors open quietly. Get it wrong and nobody tells you which part you got wrong, only that you're no longer being invited.

Navigating social and professional protocol correctly.

FARMING EARTH

Food doesn't come from a shop. It comes from about nine months of somebody paying attention. You know when to plant, when to leave it alone, what's wrong with an animal that's gone off its feed, and how much of the year is spent waiting.

Cultivating crops and managing livestock.

FINANCE AIR

Money doesn't move mysteriously. It moves for reasons, and somebody wrote the reasons down, and you know where they filed them. You can look at a set of accounts and tell which month something went wrong in that building. Usually you can tell who.

Economics, markets, and accounting.

FIREARMS AIR

You learned on one, then another, and every new shape cost you months. They are not interchangeable, whatever the man behind the counter says.

Which firearms you are trained on, by Category: a handgun first, then a shotgun, a submachine gun, a rifle, and the heavy weapons last. You do not roll it to shoot. What it says is which of them you can pick up and use.

Each tier adds to the ones under it.

1 - Trained: Handgun, Shotgun. A compact pistol, a heavy revolver, a derringer, a black powder pistol; a pump shotgun, a sawed-off.

2 - Adept: Submachine gun. A compact SMG.

3 - Expert: Rifle. A hunting rifle, a tactical carbine, a revolver rifle, a muzzleloader.

4 - Master: Heavy. A squad automatic weapon, a grenade launcher, an anti-materiel rifle, a harpoon gun.

FIREARMS (CONTINUED) AIR

Care, repair and building. Cleaning it, clearing a jam, swapping a spring or a firing pin: no roll, that is just owning the thing. A real repair is a roll of this Skill - a cracked frame, a shot-out barrel, a receiver somebody dropped off a roof - at a Difficulty the GM sets from the damage. From **Expert** you can assemble one from parts; at **Master** you can machine what you cannot buy, which is how a weapon with no serial number comes to exist.

FIRST AID WATER

Everybody else in the room is waiting for someone to start. Being trained mostly means being the one who starts. Pressure, airway, warmth, and getting them to the people with the equipment. Four things, done fast, in that order, while somebody screams at you.

Immediate, field-level treatment - stabilizing, bandaging, CPR.

FISHING MOIRA

You tie your own flies, you know which hook suits which mouth, and you can gut and bone one on a flat rock in about ninety seconds.

Catching fish by line, net, or spear.

FORGERY EARTH

Right paper weight, right laminate, and a stamp worn down a little, because a stamp that's been used four thousand times is worn down a little. Nobody checks the seal. Everybody notices crisp. It doesn't have to survive a laboratory. It has to survive eight seconds and a tired man holding it at arm's length under a fluorescent tube.

Producing convincing fake documents, signatures, IDs, and digital records.

GAMING MOIRA

You know the odds cold, down in the bone, from years of it. The man opposite read them off a website last Tuesday and is quietly certain that's the same thing. It's going to be an expensive evening for him.

Skill at games of strategy, chance, and wagering - tabletop, esports, or otherwise.

HACKING AIR

Systems get built by tired people under deadline. Somewhere in this one is the shortcut a man took at two in the morning two years ago, promising himself he'd come back and fix it properly, and he never did. The camera is running firmware from 2013 and the password is still four ones. It took ninety seconds, and not one second of it was clever, and you're a little disappointed about that.

Bypassing digital security - accounts, networks, cameras, and devices.

HOLISTIC MEDICINE WATER

A shelf of brown bottles with handwritten labels, half of them in your grandmother's writing and one of them in a language you don't read. Willow bark is aspirin, honey on a burn genuinely works, and comfrey will do more for a bad sprain than the tube the pharmacy sold you. Three things out of a hundred. Knowing which three is what the years of training went into.

Herbal remedies, folk medicine, and non-clinical healing traditions.

HUNTING MOIRA

Anyone can pull a trigger. Hunting is knowing which slope it beds on, being there before dawn without it knowing, and getting it dressed in the cold before the meat turns.

Tracking, catching, and field-dressing game.

INSIGHT MOIRA

Working out what somebody actually wants and whether what they just told you is true, from four minutes across a table and nothing else.

Reading people, sensing motive and deception - a read that goes past ordinary attention.

INTERROGATION FIRE

He told you a story at ten in the morning and a slightly different one at three. You didn't mention it. You wrote it down and asked him about something else entirely. You aren't trying to make him talk. He'll talk, they always talk. You're working out which of the three hours of talking was true.

Extracting information from an unwilling subject.

INTIMIDATION FIRE

You never have to say the thing out loud to make someone do what you want. They do it because of what they think you'll do if they don't. You stand there looking entirely willing to say it, and let them finish the sentence on their own.

Coercing others through implied or explicit threat.

INTRIGUE MOIRA

Three things are true in every organization ever assembled. One, everybody wants something. Two, nobody says what they want. Three, the person who looks least interested in the conversation is almost always the one it's about.

Scheming, maneuvering, and reading the undercurrents of institutional or political conflict.

INVENTION AIR

A drawer of parts salvaged from things that used to be other things, a notebook nobody else can read, and an idea you've been turning over since Tuesday that you're now fairly sure is going to work. Two in the morning, third attempt, and it does precisely what you said it would do. You're going to be insufferable about this for a week, and you will have earned every minute of it.

Designing and building original devices, not just following existing plans.

INVESTIGATION MOIRA

Perception notices the thing. Research finds the paperwork about the thing. You stand in the room with all of it and work out what actually happened here.

Following clues at a scene and drawing sound conclusions.

LAW AIR

Somebody had this precise argument in 1987 and lost it in a way that turns out to be enormously helpful to you.

Legal codes, procedure, and precedent.

LEADERSHIP FIRE

Eleven people were standing in a corridor not deciding anything. You said three sentences and now they're all doing something, and two of them will later claim it was their idea. People will follow somebody who seems to know where they're going. It helps enormously if you actually do.

Commanding respect and rallying others to act.

LINGUISTICS WATER

Languages aren't lists of words, no matter what the app on your phone has to say on the subject. Each one is a system that agrees with itself, and once you've taken four or five of them apart you already know most of the questions to ask the next one.

Learning, translating, and analyzing languages.

MECHANICS EARTH

It made a noise it doesn't usually make. If you've heard enough of them, that noise has already told you which part, how long you've got, and roughly what it's going to cost.

Repair and maintenance of vehicles and machinery.

MEDICINE WATER

First Aid keeps them alive long enough to reach somebody. You're the somebody. It's a considerably longer appointment.

Surgery, diagnosis, and long-term clinical treatment.

MELEE WEAPONS EARTH

A crowbar, a machete, a fire axe, a sword somebody's grandfather brought home. This says which of them you can pick up without being a menace. It says nothing at all about whether you connect.

Which melee weapons you are trained on, by Category: improvised things and knives first, then one-handed blunt weapons and large blades, then one-handed blades, then polearms and two-handers, and the exotic ones last. You do not roll it to swing. A to-hit is your Element against their Defense and it is the same roll whether you have held a sword before or not. What this says is which ones you can pick up.

Each tier adds to the ones under it.

1 - Trained: Improvised, Knife, One-handed blunt, Large blade. A baseball bat, a metal pipe, a sap, a garrote; a combat knife, a switchblade, a trench knife, a bayonet; a mace, a flail, a tonfa; a machete, a kukri.

2 - Adept: One-handed blade. A short sword, a rapier, a katana, a war axe, a hatchet, a kama, a sai.

3 - Expert: Polearm / two-handed, Two-handed, Two-handed blunt. A battle spear, a glaive, a halberd, a two-handed sword; a sledgehammer; a warhammer.

4 - Master: Exotic (melee). A whip, a chain whip, a nunchaku, a war fan.

Care, repair and building. Keeping your own weapons in working order takes no roll. If you are trained on it you sharpen it, oil it, re-wrap a grip and re-seat a head without being told to. Fixing something actually broken is a roll of this Skill, at a Difficulty the GM sets from the damage - a sprung rivet is not a cracked tang - and your tier already says how that goes. From **Expert** you can build one from prepared stock and fittings; at **Master**, from raw material and the time it takes.

NAVIGATION MOIRA

You couldn't say how you know which way is back. You just haven't been wrong about it yet, and the one time you doubted it you turned out to be right anyway.

Plotting a course and avoiding getting lost, on foot, by vehicle, or otherwise.

NETWORKING FIRE

You don't need to know the answer. You need to know who does, and to have been pleasant to them once, eleven months ago, at something extremely dull. Three hundred people would take your call. Forty would do you a favour. Nine would do you a large one, and you know exactly which nine.

Building and leveraging connections in professional, corporate, or elite circles.

OCCULT MOIRA

Most of it is nonsense. Nine tenths was copied badly by somebody who never once tried it, and then copied again by somebody who couldn't read the first man's handwriting. You've read all of it anyway, because the other tenth is in there somewhere, it is specific, it is dangerous, and telling the two apart is what you're for.

Esoteric lore, ritual, and the world's hidden supernatural undercurrent.

PERCEPTION WATER

Something in here is wrong. You'll have it in about nine seconds - it's the chair, it's four inches off, and somebody was sitting in it recently enough that you can still smell them. Everybody else looked at the room. You looked at the room and saw the one thing in it that had been moved.

Noticing details and spotting hidden things.

PERFORMANCE FIRE

Acting, a violin, a stage, or a bar with twelve people in it. Same Skill. The instrument changes and the work doesn't - hold them, and don't let them notice you're doing it. Three seconds before you go on you're certain this was a mistake and you'd like to go home. Then it's fine. It's been fine every time for eleven years, and it makes no difference at all to the three longest seconds of your life. Then, you do it again.

Acting, music, dance, or oratory before an audience, under one Skill whatever the medium.

PERSUASION FIRE

You aren't lying to him and you aren't leaning on him. You're doing the considerably harder thing, which is finding the version of the truth he can afford to agree with. No trick and no pressure - just the argument, made well, to somebody willing to hear it.

Honest argument and diplomacy.

PILOTING AIR

A four-seat aircraft or a forty-foot boat, same Skill either way. Both are you, a machine with a countable number of moving parts, and a lot of something that holds no opinion at all about whether you get home. And always remember - gravity is a harsh mistress.

Operating aircraft or watercraft, under one Skill whatever the vehicle.

POLITICS FIRE

Nothing gets done because it's right. Things get done because somebody needed a win before the review, and you know whose review falls when. Every agency wants the same three things - a larger budget next year, no headlines this year, and the agency across the road looking worse than they do. Once you know that, very little of what they do stays mysterious.

The workings of governments, agencies, and factions.

PSYCHOLOGY WATER

People are consistent - reliably, mechanically consistent, in ways they'd spot instantly in anybody else and will argue about for an hour when it's them. So the thing they're describing is never the thing, and getting to the thing takes a long time and cannot be hurried. Every attempt to hurry it has cost somebody a year.

Understanding minds, motivations and behavior, including therapy and the long-term treatment of mental trauma.

PUBLIC SPEAKING FIRE

Two hundred people and one of you. They aren't hostile. They're tired, they've been in those chairs since one o'clock, and a good third of them are quietly thinking about the parking lot and whether they'll beat the traffic out. You get ninety seconds, give or take, before you lose them for the evening, and none of those ninety seconds can be spent clearing your throat.

Commanding a room and structuring a spoken argument. This is a separate Skill from Performance - one is argument, the other is spectacle, and being good at one promises nothing about the other.

RELIGION MOIRA

You can tell roughly what a congregation believes from where they put the door, what hangs behind the altar, and what came down forty years ago and was never replaced. You know the calendar, the fasts, who may enter which room, and which of the four holy days actually matters to these people - and that last one isn't written down anywhere, because doctrine and what the pews actually do have never once been quite the same thing.

Theology, doctrine, and religious practice.

RESEARCH WATER

Eleven hours of microfiche and a headache behind one eye, and then a single line in a county record that changes what the entire afternoon was about. The answer was already written down. Somebody just filed it badly, in 1987, under a heading that made complete sense to them at the time.

Finding information through records, libraries, databases, and open sources. This is a separate Skill from Investigation: Investigation reads a scene, Research reads the record.

RIDICULE FIRE

The dozens, trash talk, or a wedding toast that goes eight percent too far. Same craft, different room, same timing. Anybody can be cruel - cruelty is free. Making it land in eleven words, in front of people, and making it the thing he still gets called six months later, is the part you practiced.

Mockery, insult, and the cutting remark. Roasting, trash talk, and the dozens. Distinct from Intimidation, which threatens, and from Performance, which plays to a room rather than at somebody standing in it.

SCIENCE AIR

The universe wrote its rules down somewhere, and you've read enough of them to make a decent guess at the rest. Chemistry, biology, astrophysics - it hardly matters which, because the useful part was never the field. It's knowing what a control group is for, and being unable to stop noticing when there wasn't one.

Broad scientific knowledge. One Skill covers every discipline - chemistry, biology, astrophysics - because a point spent here should buy you a scientist, not a specialist in one footnote.

SECURITY EARTH

A tension wrench, a rake, and a light held in your teeth. A lock is a nothing more than a delay and you know exactly how much time this one buys them - four minutes if it's any good, forty seconds if it went in back in 1994 and nobody has looked at it since.

Bypassing physical locks, safes, and alarm systems.

SEDUCTION FIRE

Everybody's body keeps announcing things without permission. A flush that starts at the collarbone. A laugh that arrives half a second late. A hand that keeps going back to the same glass. You read all of it, and then - this is the part that matters - you answer it. You slow down when she slows down, you let the pause run a beat past comfortable, and you let your own tell show, because nobody has ever fallen for somebody who gave away nothing.

Winning someone over through romantic or physical appeal.

SHADOWING MOIRA

You changed your coat in a doorway on the second block and you've been on the far side of the street ever since. He's looked back twice. Both times you were buying something. Far enough back to be nobody, close enough to still be there when he turns around.

Following someone without being noticed.

SLEIGHT OF HAND AIR

The hand is not faster than the eye. The eye is lazy and goes where it's told. Hands are fast, attention is slow, and the gap between them is a good deal wider than anybody wants to be told. This is what precision looks like when it's somebody else's pocket, or your own sleeve.

Pickpocketing, palming, and planting objects unnoticed.

SMUGGLING WATER

You don't beat the scanner. You give it something dull to look at, you arrive at the shift change, and you make sure the manifest agrees with the weight to the kilogram. The goods were never the problem. The paperwork, the timing, and one bored man at a checkpoint are the problem.

Concealing and moving contraband past scrutiny, including modern screening and customs.

STEALTH WATER

You've been in this room four minutes. Two people have walked through it in that time and neither of them thought to look up. It took you eleven minutes to get where you're sitting, which sounds ridiculous right up until you've heard what a man in a hurry sounds like from the other side of a dark room. Slow is quiet. Everybody learns that the hard way, and usually only once.

Moving unseen and unheard.

STREETWISE MOIRA

The rules here are real. They're specific. And nobody is ever going to tell you a single one of them. But, break one and everybody simply stops talking to you. You can tell which corner is fine and which one isn't from half a block away, and you couldn't explain how if somebody paid you to. Nobody says anything useful to a stranger, and not being a stranger took eight months of buying coffee from the same place and never once asking a question.

Navigating criminal culture, gangs, and underworld contacts.

SURVEILLANCE WATER

You log all of it. The times, the plates, the man who comes on Tuesdays. None of it means anything until one entry doesn't fit, and then every bit of it means something. And the camera goes where nobody looks, which is never where the view is best - you take the worse angle every time, because a good angle that gets found is no angle at all.

Observing a target or location without being detected, and spotting when somebody is doing it to you - physical stakeouts and technical monitoring both.

SURVIVAL EARTH

It was never going to be the bear. It's wet socks, a turned ankle, and one night colder than you planned for. Shelter first, then water, then fire, and food a long way behind all of them - everybody gets that order wrong, and they all get it wrong in the same direction, off looking for something to eat on the first afternoon. The wilderness isn't trying to kill you. It simply doesn't care, and that turns out to be considerably worse.

Foraging, shelter, water, and enduring somewhere that offers no help.

SWIMMING EARTH

Swimming down is a separate discipline from swimming across. You know how deep you can go, how long you have at the bottom, and exactly how slowly you have to come back up. Across the top of it, down into it, or straight at a current that would rather you didn't - same water, three different arguments, and you're at home in all three.

Moving efficiently and enduring in open water.

SYSTEMS OPERATION WATER

Sonar, reactor telemetry, a plant control room, the sensor suite on something flying. Same discipline every time - somebody built an instrument to describe a thing nobody can see, and you can hear what it's saying. A wall of readouts that means nothing at all to anybody else, and something very specific to you.

Operating and interpreting complex consoles, sensors, and industrial or vehicle control systems.

THROWN WEAPONS EARTH

A knife leaves your hand turning and it goes on turning whether that suits you or not. Training is knowing how many turns it's made by the time it gets there, which means knowing your distances cold, which means having thrown the same blade a few thousand times. Distance, spin, and one moment to let go. Get any of the three wrong and you've thrown away a perfectly good knife and armed somebody who didn't have one.

Which thrown weapons you are trained on, by Category: a balanced blade first, then a thrown axe, a shafted weapon, a returning one, and the sling last, because the sling takes years. You do not roll it to throw.

Each tier adds to the ones under it.

1 - Trained: Balanced blade, Thrown axe. A throwing knife; a hand axe.

2 - Adept: Shafted. A javelin.

3 - Expert: Returning. A boomerang.

4 - Master: Sling.

Care, repair and building. Keeping an edge, checking a haft, re-weighting a knife that has started to fly wrong: no roll. Repair is a roll of this Skill - a split haft, a bent blade, a sling gone brittle. From **Expert** you can make them from prepared stock; at **Master**, from raw material, matched to your own hand and the way you actually throw.

TRACKING MOIRA

The ground keeps a record of everything that crosses it, for a while, and you can read most of it before the weather takes it back. A deer, a man, or a vehicle that left the road two days ago - it reads the same either way. Weight, direction, and how recently. Four of them came through here, one carrying something heavy, and they stopped longer than they meant to. All of it is in the dirt if you slow down enough to look.

Following physical trails.

BOONS

A Boon is a small, permanent piece of good luck. Not a power - a fact about you that happens to help.

Gifts are the loud part of a character. Boons are the quiet part, and the quiet part decides more scenes than you'd think. Being impossible to surprise will save your life more often than being able to throw fire, because getting caught out is how most people die and most fires aren't necessary.

You buy them at creation out of the Boons pool, and afterward with XP. Each one has a flat cost, and those costs sort into four tiers - **Trivial** at 1, **Lesser** at 3, **Greater** at 5, **Legendary** at 7. A handful come in tiers of their own, where the higher tier already includes everything the lower ones gave you - buy the one you want, not all three.

None of this is required. I've seen perfectly good characters with no Boons at all - those points just went somewhere else.

HOW BOONS WORK

A Boon is a grab bag item. Skills are the things you practiced and Gifts are the things that shouldn't be possible - a Boon is neither of those, which is exactly why the category exists.

You either have a Boon or you don't. There's no 1-10 scale, no dots, no ranks. If you want something that climbs by level, what you actually want is a Resource, and those get their own chapter.

Eighteen entries bend that rule, and I'd rather flag each one where it sits in the list than make you memorize them here. Most offer two, three or four tiers, and buying a higher tier already

includes everything the lower ones gave you - so buy the one you want, not all of them.

Special Movement is the odd one out. It isn't tiered at all, but you can buy it more than once, once for each way of moving.

A Boon almost never hands you a bonus on a roll. It's usually a rule exception, an option you didn't have before, or a standing fact about your body or your reputation. If you came here looking for +2 to something, you're in the wrong chapter.

Flaws are the mirror image of all this - mostly non-numeric, and they pay you points instead of charging them. The difference is that every Flaw comes in Levels, 1 to 5.

THE BOON LIST

ALERTNESS 3, LESSER

You are never not paying attention. While everyone else is asking, "What was that?" You are already turning to face the threat. You pay attention to everything... to the point of being called "paranoid" more than once.

Immune to being Surprised while conscious, unless under a mind-altering effect that would specifically allow it.

ALTERNATE IDENTITY 5, GREATER

You have a second life. There's an address that receives your mail. There are neighbors who could describe you to a sketch artist without a second thought. It all stands up to scrutiny because it is all real. It's a lot of work, but worth it for the benefits it grants.

A fully realized second identity - name, history, and papers that hold up under real scrutiny - keeping your real self insulated from what it does.

ALWAYS CONNECTED 3, 5, OR 7

You are the one who never says, "I don't have any bars!" There is always a signal and you are connected to it. While the rest of them are wandering around with their phones in the air, you've already sent the file.

Bought as one of three tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one).

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): your mobile/portable computing devices are always online under normal conditions - no dead zones, no dropped signal, no service gaps. Supernatural interference, deliberate technological jamming, or genuinely extreme circumstances (miles underground, fully off-grid) can still block it, GM's call, but ordinary everyday conditions never do.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): the same connection, but it's not tied to any device - a cybernetic implant of your own, granting the same access even fully divested of every belonging and piece of gear you own.

Tier 3 (7, Legendary): the same connection as Tier 2, but through some means beyond ordinary technology (a lingering enchantment, a telepathic relay, quantum entanglement, whatever fits the character) - unbreakable so long as you remain on this plane of existence, immune even to the exceptions Tier 1 allowed.

AMBIDEXTROUS 3, 5, OR 7

Most people have a dominant hand. For you, whichever hand is free is the dominant one.

Bought as one of three tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one).

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): ignore the Disadvantage normally imposed for performing a task with your off-hand.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): your hands work independently - perform one task with each hand in the same round, instead of one task overall.

Tier 3 (7, Legendary): once per turn, spend 1 Ki to make one additional attack with your off-hand, at no penalty.

ANIMAL RAPPORT 1, TRIVIAL

Dogs cross the street to greet you. The cat that no one gets to pet sits in your lap. Your friends describe you as a "Disney Princess," and they aren't wrong. You can't communicate with them and you can't tell them what to do. Animals just trust you on sight.

Animals read you as safe and trustworthy on sight, calmer and friendlier around you than they'd otherwise be - no communication, just instinct.

COMMON SENSE 7, LEGENDARY

Most people don't realize they did something stupid until it's too late. The little voice in the back of your head says, "I wouldn't do that. It's a bad idea." And you listen. Most of the time. When you do something stupid, you can't say nobody warned you.

The GM will give you a heads-up before you commit to an obviously terrible decision.

COMPACT FRAME 3, LESSER

When other people have to squeeze into a tight space, you just walk on through. Vents, the space behind the cabinet, the crowd other people have to muscle their way through are non-issues for you. It works the other way, too - you can easily disappear in a crowd.

Fit through spaces, gaps, and crowds an ordinary body couldn't, and blend into a packed room without trying.

CONCENTRATION 5, GREATER

Once you start something, you will finish it. You studied for finals in a bar during a GWAR concert and aced them. Gunfire, explosions, a demolition crew tearing the building down around you - none of it is a distraction.

Immune to being Distracted, regardless of source (damage, Kotodama, Gifts, environmental hazards) - a Slow action always resolves as declared.

DANGER SENSE 5, GREATER

It's quiet... Too quiet. Something is wrong. You don't know what it is, you just know. Something warns you when you are in danger.

May ask the GM at any reasonable moment whether there's danger nearby; the GM must give a truthful (if vague, gut-feeling-level) answer. Additionally, roll **2d10 for Initiative and keep the higher die** (instead of the normal single 1d10), then add your Initiative sub-stat as usual.

DISPLACED ECHOES 3 OR 5

Mockingbirds, magpies and you. You hear a car alarm, a chainsaw, a snippet of a song and can imitate it perfectly. It's not an impression, but you mimic the sound precisely.

Bought as one of two tiers (the higher includes the lower's benefit - no need to buy both).

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): perfectly imitate any voice or sound you've heard - undetectable unless a listener has a specific reason to doubt it, in which case they may roll Insight + Difficulty (GM sets Difficulty by how good their reason for suspicion is) to see through it.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): additionally, throw your voice to make it seem to originate from any point in your line of sight.

DISTINCTIVE FEATURES 1, 3, 5, OR 7

There is something about you that is visibly different. You might have something non-human in the family tree or you might have Bette Davis eyes. Or a tail that helps you balance, gills, fur, markings that can't be mistaken for a birthmark. They are unusual, but useful.

Bought as one of four tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one). None are purely cosmetic - they have real effects.

Choose a feature: **Tail** (real balance and grip - another hand for holding on, not for fine work), **Gills** (breathe water indefinitely, and air as normal), **Fur** (ignore cold that has everybody else reaching for a coat), **Pouch** (a few small items carried hands-free and out of sight), or **Coloration** (markings nobody would mistake for human, and blending into one matching environment you name). Anything else that size works too, if you and the GM can agree what it does.

Tier 1 (1, Trivial): one feature.

Tier 2 (3, Lesser): a second.

DISTINCTIVE FEATURES (CONTINUED) 1, 3, 5, OR 7

Tier 3 (5, Greater): a third.

Tier 4 (7, Legendary): a fourth.

DOUBLE-JOINTED 3, LESSER

You saw a man fold himself into an acrylic box on The Gong Show and decided you wanted to do the same thing. Now, if you can get your head through it, the rest of you will follow.

For Escapology rolls, treat your Skill Training Tier as one tier higher than your actual tier, with a minimum of Trained - even an Untrained character rolls Escapology as if Trained. Trained rolls as if Adept, Adept as if Expert, Expert as if Master. (Master stays Master.)

DUELIST 3, 5, OR 7

You picked a weapon and learned everything about it. It is no longer a tool - it is a part of you. The guy across from you has trained. You have specialized.

An attack is a straight Attribute-against-Defense roll with no Skill in it, which means no Training Tier ever reaches one. This is that ladder, bought instead of trained. Each tier includes the ones below it.

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): name one weapon Category from the weapon Skills - Knife, Handgun, Large blade, whatever you actually carry. Attack rolls made with it are at Advantage - the same shape as Adept.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): with that weapon, a critical hit lands on a 2 or a 3 - the same shape as Expert.

Tier 3 (7, Legendary): name a second Category, which gains both. Held alongside Never Off Balance, which is the Master tier for the same roll, that completes the ladder.

EIDETIC MEMORY 5 OR 7

Everyone else's memories fade and slowly rearrange themselves as time passes. Yours do not. You don't remember things, you access the files. The page is there in front of you. The license plate is on the car at the stoplight in your mind.

Bought as one of two tiers (the higher includes the lower's benefit - no need to buy both).

Tier 1 (5, Greater): perfect recall of anything you've actually experienced and attended to - things you saw, read, or heard.

Tier 2 (7, Legendary): perfect recall of literally anything you've ever perceived, attended to or not - a page glimpsed once, background chatter, something in peripheral vision.

ENCHANTING VOICE 5, GREATER

You could read the phone book and people would lean in to listen. The velvet tones of your voice rival the Sirens or Orpheus. Something in your voice makes people decide you are worth listening to. You can't switch it off.

Anyone who hears you speak has their initial reaction/disposition nudged a step more favorably. Additionally, choose one voice-dependent Skill (Charm, Deception, Performance, Persuasion, Public Speaking, or Seduction) at creation: treat your Skill Training Tier as one tier higher than your actual tier for that Skill, with a minimum of Trained (same shape as Double-Jointed's Escapology bump).

ENCYCLOPEDIC KNOWLEDGE 3, LESSER

You read something about this once. It was in a psychology journal. "Why did I read it? It seemed interesting." You devour information and it sticks with you. It doesn't matter where the information came from, you are almost always right.

When you want to know something relevant about a topic - history, science, esoteric trivia, nearly anything - roll **Air + Difficulty** directly (GM sets Difficulty by how obscure the fact is; no Skill or Training Tier involved). Success - the GM tells you the relevant fact, though you can't say where or how you learned it. Failure - nothing surfaces.

EXTRA LIMBS 1, 3, 5, OR 7

Most humans have two arms and two legs. Some have less, which brings the average down. You are trying to bring the average back up. You have more limbs than a "normal" human. Whether it is more arms, legs, tentacles, they are yours. They work and your body has never been confused about their function. Complex tasks are easier, but finding a suit that fits is hard.

Bought as one of four tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one). You have more limbs than an ordinary person - extra arms, tentacles, or something else the body has simply grown in, each one just as functional as your original set.

Tier 1 (1, Trivial): one extra limb, usable for simple parallel tasks (hold, brace, steady something) alongside whatever you're already doing.

Tier 2 (3, Lesser): two extra limbs - you can hold or ready an additional item at all times (a second weapon, a shield, a tool), always available without needing to draw it.

Tier 3 (5, Greater): three extra limbs - they can actively assist a task you're already attempting, granting Advantage on any roll where an extra hand or two would help (Escapology, forcing/breaking something, climbing).

Tier 4 (7, Legendary): four or more extra limbs, full independent use - perform up to two simple parallel tasks per round instead of one, and gain Advantage on any physical task benefiting from more hands, including grappling or restraining an opponent.

EYE FOR THE OPENING 5, GREATER

You don't hit harder than anyone else. You don't have to. You see the opportunity - when their guard dips, they are shifting their weight and are vulnerable or when their attention flickers to something behind you - and you seize that moment.

Your critical range on attack rolls widens - a roll of **2 or 3** is a critical hit, not just a 2. An attack uses no Skill, so no Training Tier can widen it for you; this is the only thing that does. Applies to Physical, Social and Mental attacks alike.

EYE FOR THE STRANGE 5, GREATER

No one noticed, but when you walk into the room, you feel it. Something isn't natural and you can spot it - the shadows are too deep, there is a cold spot following a conversation. You can sense the supernatural.

When something supernatural is happening around you, roll **Moira + Difficulty** directly (GM sets Difficulty by how subtle/hidden it is; no Skill or Training Tier involved). Success - the GM tells you something supernatural is present and gives you a relevant detail. Failure - you still feel something resonating in the threads of fate, leaving you uneasy with no concrete information.

FAMILIAR 1, 3, 5, OR 7

You have someone... or something that has chosen you. A black cat followed you home. A book started talking to you one day. A spirit attached itself to you and never explained why. Whatever it is, it is competent, loyal and willing to go places you can't.

Bought as one of four tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one). Not necessarily magical, not necessarily built by you, just yours.

Choose what it is. What it is decides which Skills it can take:

Bound spirit - something that was never quite alive, tied to you by an arrangement neither of you brings up. It goes where you can't and notices what you wouldn't. *Divination, Insight, Occult, Perception, Religion, Shadowing, Surveillance.*

Animated servant - a made thing that runs on something and keeps running whether or not anybody is watching. Tireless, literal, and stronger than it looks. *Athletics, Crafting, Electronics, Mechanics, Security, Systems Operation.*

Talking object - a book, a ring, a radio that picks up more than it should. It doesn't move on its own, so it gets carried, and it is usually the best-read thing in the room. *Academics, Appraisal, Cryptography, Law, Linguistics, Occult, Research, Science.*

Capable person - somebody who works for you, follows you, or has decided you need looking after. *Any Skill a person could learn.*

Tier 1 (1, Trivial): Trained in one Skill from its list. Reliably useful for everyday work, not built for danger.

Tier 2 (3, Lesser): Expert in that Skill, plus Trained in two more from its list. Can act for you unsupervised on simple tasks.

FAMILIAR (CONTINUED) 1, 3, 5, OR 7

Tier 3 (5, Greater): Master in its specialty, and able to hold its own when things turn dangerous - a butler who is also a bodyguard, luggage that can flatten an attacker, a spirit with real teeth.

Tier 4 (7, Legendary): a legend in its own right, recognised or feared independently of you. Effectively unkillable in any permanent sense - destroyed, it finds its way back, rebuilt, reformed or returned.

FEIGN DEATH 3 OR 5

Your body is a biological machine and you have learned to shut the whole machine down... temporarily. You appear dead in every way that matters.

Bought as one of two tiers (the higher includes the lower's benefit - no need to buy both).

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): convincingly fool onlookers - and a casual medical check - into believing you're dead or unconscious, on your own choice.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): dead to all means of detection, including rigorous or technological examination - full voluntary control over your own vital signs and biofeedback, deep enough to fool sophisticated medical equipment.

HIGHER PURPOSE 7, LEGENDARY

You have been chosen for a specific purpose. By what? You don't know. It might be fate, a debt, an elder god. Whatever it is - it has a vested interest in seeing that your story ends after you achieve this goal. When you go, it will mean something.

Once per major story arc, you cannot be permanently killed or written out of the story by anything short of a dramatically appropriate death - you're meant for something greater, and the universe isn't done with you yet.

INNATE COMPASS 1 OR 3

You don't get lost. Ever. North is that way. It's just a fact you have access to, the same way you know which way is up. You always know roughly where you are, even without a map. That doesn't stop people from handing you the map, though.

Bought as one of two tiers (the higher includes the lower's benefit - no need to buy both).

Tier 1 (1, Trivial): always know true north and roughly what time it is, no matter where you are.

Tier 2 (3, Lesser): additionally, for any place you've been before, you always know the direction and rough distance to it.

IRON GRIP 3, LESSER

Your hand is a vise. If you have a grip on it - it stays in your hand.

Immune to being disarmed against your will - a weapon or item stays in your hand until you choose to let go.

IRON STOMACH 1, TRIVIAL

Gas station sushi. The leftovers with no clear date on them. Water out of something that isn't a tap. Whatever it is, you imbibe it, and then you are fine. Anyone who shared it with you - not so much.

Eat or drink almost anything without illness.

IRON WILL 3, 5, OR 7

Your mind is your own, and the door only opens from the inside. People who try to read you come away with nothing - no tells, no tics, no flicker behind the eyes to work with. People who try to push you find out that pushing was the only thing they brought.

Bought as one of three tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one).

IRON WILL (CONTINUED) 3, 5, OR 7

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): immune to being read via Insight - an attempt to read your emotions, tells, or intentions through Insight automatically fails.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): additionally, any attempt to read or rewrite your mind - by Skill, Gift or anything else - is made at Disadvantage, and unlocks **Assert Your Will** as a Fate Trigger - spend 1 Fate Token to flatly negate an attempt to intimidate or dominate you, no roll.

Tier 3 (7, Legendary): additionally, full passive immunity to domination, possession, mind control, memory alteration, and any attempt to read you whatsoever - no roll, no cost, automatic. You can still be deceived, but never puppeted, rewritten or read.

JACK OF ALL TRADES 5 OR 7

And a master of none. Being a jack of all trades is often better than mastery of a couple skills. You've picked up things here and there. None of it is remarkable, but you know how to do a little of everything and that matters more often.

Bought as one of two tiers (the higher includes the lower's benefit - no need to buy both).

Tier 1 (5, Greater): your baseline in every Skill is Trained, including ones you've never trained in or even heard named before - but your ceiling in any Skill is capped at Trained, permanently, even if you spend points to raise it further. Any of your 15-point Skills Pool left unspent because of that cap is simply unspent - it doesn't convert into points for Attributes, Resources, or anything else.

Tier 2 (7, Legendary): the Tier 1 cap is lifted - Skills you specifically invest in can still climb past Trained toward Adept, Expert, or Master as normal.

LIE DETECTOR 3, 5, OR 7

It's never the words. Anyone can rehearse a story until it reads as true. It's the half-second hesitation, the glance away, the detail that is a little too on the nose. Everybody tells you when they are lying - you just know how to listen to what they are really saying.

Bought as one of three tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one).

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): for Insight rolls made specifically to catch someone in a lie, treat your Skill Training Tier as one tier higher than your actual tier, with a minimum of Trained (same shape as Double-Jointed's Escapology bump).

Tier 2 (5, Greater): additionally, gain Advantage on that same Insight roll, stacking with the Tier 1 bump - even a careful evasion or partial truth doesn't slip past easily.

Tier 3 (7, Legendary): additionally, a direct, deliberate lie told straight to your face registers automatically, no roll needed - though you still won't know the truth, only that you weren't told it.

LIGHT SLEEPER 1, 3, OR 5

You have never slept through anything in your life. Most nights, it's a curse. You wake up before the sound is gone. You are awake and ready to go.

Bought as one of three tiers (each includes the lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one).

Tier 1 (1, Trivial): wake instantly at the slightest disturbance.

Tier 2 (3, Lesser): additionally, you're never automatically Surprised while asleep - roll Perception even while asleep to notice a threat, same as if you were awake.

LIGHT SLEEPER (CONTINUED) 1, 3, OR 5

Tier 3 (5, Greater): additionally, waking from a disturbance doesn't cost you your position in the round - you act on your normal Initiative immediately rather than losing the first exchange getting your bearings.

LIGHTNING CALCULATOR 1, TRIVIAL

You don't do the math. You don't have to - you just know the answer. The odds, how much fuel remains, the required angle to land the shot - the numbers are there. You are moving while everyone else is reaching for the calculator app on their phone.

Instant, effortless mental processing of complex calculations - arithmetic, odds and statistics, trajectories, logistics, or any other math-driven estimate - done in your head, accurately, that would normally take pen, paper, or a calculator.

NATURAL LINGUIST 1, 3, 5, OR 7

Some people have a knack for mathematics. Others have an ear for music. You have an innate understanding of languages. Within a few minutes of exposure to a language, you begin to understand it - where the verbs belong, which sounds are doing the heavy lifting, the patterns unique to the language. Give it a day, and you can survive.

Bought as one of four tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one).

Tier 1 (1, Trivial): when first hearing an unfamiliar language, you can often piece together rough meaning and grammar patterns from listening alone (GM's call how much you catch).

Tier 2 (3, Lesser): learn a new human language to fluency after a single day of real exposure or study.

Tier 3 (5, Greater): learn a new human language to fluency after mere minutes of interaction.

Tier 4 (7, Legendary): learn *any* language, including non-human or otherwise exotic communication systems - the time required scales with how alien it is (a terrestrial animal's calls might take a day; a species that communicates via color-shifting skin patches might take weeks).

NEVER OFF BALANCE 3, 5, OR 7

You've fallen (or been knocked down) enough times to have an opinion about it. You lose your footing and you are already recovering.

Bought as one of three tiers, each including the one below it. On a catastrophic failure, roll again. If the second roll succeeds, the catastrophic failure is downgraded to an ordinary miss or failure - it never becomes a success, and if the second roll also fails the catastrophic failure stands.

NEVER OFF BALANCE (CONTINUED) 3, 5, OR 7

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): attack rolls. The same shape as Master, for the one roll no Training Tier reaches.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): every roll in combat.

Tier 3 (7, Legendary): every roll.

QUICK STUDY 1, TRIVIAL

One quick read through is usually all it takes. People don't like it when you pick something up over an afternoon that they spent the last five years mastering.

Pick up new information or a demonstrated technique unusually fast, and read or skim at exceptional speed - GM's call on how much time it actually saves.

RESTFUL TRANCE 3, LESSER

Three hours of meditation and you feel like a million bucks. You don't dream, toss and turn, or drift off to sleep - you turn your brain off and flip it back on just as easily. No one who sees it thinks it looks restful, but they don't know what they are missing.

A Full Night's Rest only requires **3 hours** of actual sleep to grant its full benefit. A Short Rest only requires **15 minutes** instead of the normal hour, though the normal one-per-Full-Night's-Rest cap still applies.

SPECIAL MOVEMENT (3 (LESSER), MAY BE PURCHASED MULTIPLE TIMES)

You move in a way most people can't - crawling up a wall, walking over snow without a trace, swinging on grappling hooks. Whatever the method, physics filed an objection and no one listened.

Choose a specific, narrow locomotion trick that shouldn't work but does: **Water-Walking** (cross any liquid surface as easily as solid ground), **Wall-Crawling** (climb any surface, including ceilings, as easily and securely as flat ground), **Tunneling** (dig through earth, sand, or similarly soft material at your normal Movement Rate), or **Untrackable** (leave no scent, footprint, or trail; mundane tracking, and most supernatural tracking, simply fails to find a path). May be bought more than once; each purchase must choose a different mode.

SPECIAL WEAPONS 3, 5, OR 7

You have one specific piece of hardware that nobody should be walking around with, and you know exactly how it works. Where it came from is your business. Whether the paperwork exists is nobody's business. It is yours, it is the only one you get, and it does something a normal weapon cannot.

Access to a single named weapon system, chosen when you take this and defined with the GM - including which Element rolls it, if anything about it is rolled at all. Bought as one of three tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one).

The lists below are examples, not a menu to choose from. If the thing you want is not on them, that is rather the point of the Boon - bring it to the GM and settle between you what it does.

SPECIAL WEAPONS (CONTINUED) 3, 5, OR 7

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): unusual rather than restricted, and the only route to the Exotic (ranged) Category - no weapon Skill reaches it. A blowgun, a flare gun or a net launcher, all three already statted in Equipment; a speargun or a dart pistol would sit here too. Nobody is going to arrest you for carrying one, and nobody else at the table knows how to use it either.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): hardware that exists and is illegal for you to be holding. A flamethrower, a shoulder-launched rocket, a mortar, a vehicle-mounted minigun, a riot water cannon. Owning it is a crime most places you will carry it, and that is part of what you are paying for.

Tier 3 (7, Legendary): something that should not exist at all. A prototype railgun, a directed-energy rifle, a blade that remembers everyone it has killed, a rifle built for one specific target and inert against anybody else. What it is and what it does is settled with the GM.

STEADFAST PRESENCE 3, 5, OR 7

Fear doesn't seem to be able to get a grip on you. You don't hide it well - you just don't really get scared and people can tell. When things go wrong, everyone in the room turns to you. Your stoicism in the face of adversity steadies those around you.

Bought as one of three tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one).

Tier 1 (3, Lesser): immune to fear - any attempt to frighten or intimidate you automatically fails.

Tier 2 (5, Greater): additionally, allies within your Movement Rate are inspired by your presence, gaining Advantage on any roll made to resist fear or intimidation.

Tier 3 (7, Legendary): additionally, allies within that same range share your full immunity to fear - any attempt to frighten or intimidate them automatically fails too.

TRAINED BY A MASTER 1, 3, 5, OR 7

Somebody who was genuinely the best taught you, and they didn't waste time on the flashy parts. They taught you what to do when it goes wrong. Years later, at the moment it goes wrong, you hear their voice and your hands are already doing it.

Bought as one of four tiers (each includes every lower tier's benefit - no need to buy more than one). Each tier named below grants one additional Skill you can name (up to 4 total) *and* one additional use per session (up to 4 total). At the moment of failure, freely choose which named Skill the use applies to - uses aren't locked to a specific Skill in advance, and can all be spent on a single Skill in the same session if you want.

Tier 1 (1, Trivial): 1 named Skill, 1 use per session.

TRAINED BY A MASTER (CONTINUED) 1, 3, 5, OR 7

Tier 2 (3, Lesser): 2 named Skills, 2 uses per session.

Tier 3 (5, Greater): 3 named Skills, 3 uses per session.

Tier 4 (7, Legendary): 4 named Skills, 4 uses per session. A spent use treats a failure on the chosen Skill as a success instead.

UNSHAKEABLE ALIBI 3, LESSER

You always have a story - a time, a place, a reason and enough inane details that nobody wants to hear them. It's not a lie - you were really there.

Always have a plausible, verifiable-sounding cover story ready on short notice - GM's call on how far it holds up under real scrutiny.

UNSTOPPABLE 7, LEGENDARY

What should leave you unconscious and bleeding on the floor, simply doesn't. You can still die, you are just conscious for it.

Being reduced to 0 Health Levels doesn't render you unconscious - you keep going into negative Health Levels, down to the same -(Health Levels) death threshold everyone eventually hits, instead of blacking out at 0. While in that negative range: (1) you're extremely hurt but conscious - you can talk, move, and act at rest with no restriction; (2) any exertion - combat, strenuous effort, or moving quickly - costs **1 Ki** per instance.

WEATHERED 3, LESSER

You never understood why people are constantly worried about the weather. You simply don't make it an issue. Heat that melts the dog, cold that drives people inside, hurricane force winds - none of it stops you. The cold never bothered you, anyway

Shrug off extreme heat, cold, thin air, and harsh weather that would meaningfully slow or endanger an ordinary person, and hold your breath far longer than an ordinary person can.

RESOURCES

Resources are what you have, who you know, and what picks up when you call.

A character isn't just a list of things they can do. They have a bank balance, or they don't. They've got somewhere to sleep that nobody else knows about, or they're on a friend's couch. They can get a lawyer at two in the morning, or they can't. None of that is a Skill and none of it is a Gift, and all of it decides what's on the table when things go sideways.

Resources are rated in Levels. You buy them out of the Resources pool at creation and raise them later with XP, at a flat rate per Level. A higher Level isn't a different Resource - it's the same one, reaching further.

WHAT A RESOURCE IS

A Resource is something you draw on or lean on - money, contacts, a reputation, somewhere to go to ground. It's never a bonus on a roll. Every Resource is rated **1-5**, and each level is a defined step up in what you can reach, not a bigger number to add to something.

Levels cost a flat **1 point** each out of the Resources pool at creation, so a Resource at Level 3 costs you 3 points. Once play begins, each new level costs a flat **3 XP**.

PUSHING A RESOURCE

Only six Resources can be pushed: Contacts, Debts Owed, Media Contact, Occult Library, System Access, Wealth. Those six have a reach that can be stretched - somebody can be asked for more than they owe, a library can be searched harder, money can be found. Every

other Resource is a standing fact. A Safehouse Network is stocked or it isn't, and there is nothing to roll about it: its Level table says what you have and that is what you have.

Each Resource's Level table below defines what's available for free, no roll required. When you want to draw on a Resource for something past that free scope, roll a **Resource Check: 2d10** against **Resource Level + (10 - Resource Index)**, roll-under. Critical results apply as normal (a roll of 2 is always a success, a roll of 20 is always a failure, regardless of the target number). No Skill is involved - a flat roll against the Resource itself, the same shape as the Gift Check.

Resource Index is a flat **1-6** rating for how far beyond a Resource's ordinary reach the request goes - its own scale, not the general Difficulty Chart. It inverts the same way Defense does: a *lower* Resource Index is easier (Resource Index 1 adds **9** to the target), a *higher* one is harder (Resource Index 6 adds only **4**, the minimum any Resource Check can add).

Success: you get what you were after, at no further cost.

Failure: you still get what you were after - the ask goes through either way - but the Resource's Level drops by **1**, representing it stretched thin: savings drained, favors called in, goodwill spent.

Critical failure: the same, except the Level drops by **2**.

The drops are cumulative. A reduced Resource uses its lower Level for everything, including any further Resource Check made while it's still reduced. At **Level 0** it is spent - nothing can be drawn on it at all, free scope or roll - until the start of the next **Month**, when every Resource returns to its full Level.

Why it works like this. The roll isn't asking whether you're rich. It's asking what you can put your hands on right now. Wealth is liquid assets, not net worth - the money actually available this week, rather than the sum of everything you own.

Which is why the Level drops instead of the ask failing. In college you could buy the pizza, and then you were done buying things for a while. As an adult a decent used car is still well within reach, and it will still flatten you for a month. Neither of those is a failure. You got the pizza. You got the car. You just can't do it again yet.

That's the whole model, and it applies to every Resource, not only money. The ask goes through. What it costs you is your ability to make the next one.

Reaching beyond your means: a Resource Index up to **2 higher** than the Resource's current effective Level can be attempted - anything further out of reach can't be attempted at all. Reaching that far always gets you what you were after, but drops the Resource's Level to **0** for a Month (not just 1) regardless of whether the roll succeeded or failed - **unless the roll is a critical success**, which resolves the attempt as an ordinary free success with no cost at all.

Resource Index 6 is always treated as reaching 2 levels beyond the Resource's current Level, no matter how high that Level actually is - and it's the one case a critical success can't save: a

Resource Index 6 attempt always drops the Resource to 0 for a Month, full stop, even on a critical success.

WEALTH AT CHARACTER CREATION

Buying gear (see **Weapons & Equipment**) at character creation uses a dedicated procedure, not the general **Pushing a Resource** rule above.

A character's **creation-Wealth** starts at **2**, unless they spent Resources Pool points on Wealth, in which case their purchased Level is used instead. The **Destitute** Flaw overrides both: a Destitute character's creation-Wealth is **0**, and they cannot spend points on Wealth at all during character creation - the Flaw has to be bought off first. This applies only to creation; XP raises Wealth normally once play begins.

Every item carries a **Wealth rating**. Shopping happens in three steps, in this order.

1. TAKE YOUR PACKAGES

One **Everyman Gear Package** from every Level up to and including your creation-Wealth - one from each Level, not several from the top. Free, no roll.

2. TAKE YOUR FREE ITEMS

Money stops being a decision long before it stops mattering. What a character can simply have depends on how far the item sits below them:

- **Two or more Levels below your creation-Wealth:** free, and as many as you can reasonably carry and justify. A Wealth 5 character does not count flashlights.
- **At your creation-Wealth, or one Level below it:** free, up to a number of items equal to your creation-Wealth. A Wealth 3 character takes three of them.
- **Above your creation-Wealth:** never free. It is not a roll either - see step 3. Taking one empties the pool.

A Wealth 3 character therefore walks away with everything they want at Wealth 1, any three items at Wealth 2 or 3, and a decision to make about anything above that. A Wealth 0 character gets a Level 0 package and nothing else free.

3. ROLL FOR THE REST

Two things are left: another item from the band you have already spent your free picks on, and anything sitting above your creation-Wealth. They are not the same purchase.

At creation-Wealth or one Level below, past the free allowance - a Wealth Check. Roll **2d10** against **creation-Wealth + 10**, roll-under, standard critical results apply.

- **Success:** the item is free.
- **Failure:** you still get the item, and creation-Wealth drops by **1**.
- **Critical failure:** the same, except creation-Wealth drops by **2**.

Above your creation-Wealth - no roll. The item can be had, and having it costs everything: creation-Wealth drops straight to **0**. Reach that far and you walk away with your Starting Packages, your free items, and that one thing.

The ask always goes through. What it costs is the ability to make the next one.

At creation-Wealth 0 the rolling stops, but the free items don't. Both free bands are measured against the Level you actually bought, not against whatever is left of the pool - so spending yourself down to nothing still leaves you anything two or more Levels below your Wealth, as many as you can carry and justify, along with any of your free allowance you hadn't used yet.

THE BLACK MARKET IS NOT PART OF THIS

Nothing on **The Black Market** is ever free. The steps above do not apply to it: every purchase there is a transaction whatever it costs, and it is gated by **Black Market Access** as well as by Wealth. Nobody hands you a jammer because you are rich.

AFTERWARDS

Creation-Wealth carries across every purchase in this shopping pass. **This pool is temporary bookkeeping only:** it has no effect on the character's actual Wealth Resource once play begins, which stays at whatever Level was actually purchased. Once creation ends this procedure stops applying entirely - every purchase from then on uses the general **Pushing a Resource** rule above, unaffected by anything that happened while shopping.

THE RESOURCES

BASE

Somewhere that is yours. A door you control, a lock you picked out, and nobody's name on the lease that you didn't want there. It might be a room over a garage or a whole floor nobody else visits. Either way, you can shut the door and breathe.

How developed, defended, or well-equipped the headquarters/safehouse is.

BASE (CONTINUED)

- 1 A dedicated, secure space of your own - a real hideout, workshop, or safehouse beyond an ordinary home; basic, but defensible
- 2 A proper base with solid amenities and dependable security
- 3 Well-equipped, with real security and specialized rooms
- 4 Fortified and staffed, with serious defenses and advanced equipment
- 5 A near-impenetrable, fully self-sufficient stronghold

BLACK MARKET ACCESS

There is a version of every store that doesn't ask, doesn't record and doesn't remember you came in. A guy with a van. A back room behind a laundromat. A number you text one word to. You know where those are.

How deep into illegal or off-the-books trade the connections reach.

- 1 A single fence or dealer for common contraband
- 2 A working relationship with a local black-market network - weapons, drugs, stolen goods
- 3 Real standing with a regional network, access to rarer or more dangerous goods
- 4 Deep pull into a national or international smuggling network, most anything can be found for a price
- 5 A name in the black market itself - you don't just buy from the network, you're a fixture in it, able to source almost anything that exists

CONTACTS

You don't know the answer. You know four people, and one of them does. A cop who owes you. A nurse who works nights. Somebody's cousin at the airport. It isn't what you know - it's who picks up when you call.

How large, capable, or well-placed the network is.

- 1 One reliable contact for small favors or info
- 2 A handful of contacts spanning a couple of fields
- 3 A broad network spanning most of a city
- 4 An extensive network with regional reach, including a few influential names
- 5 A vast network reaching into any relevant field or region, including powerful people

CORPORATE BACKING

Something enormous and entirely legal has decided you are useful. It moves slowly, it moves in writing, and once it moves it is very hard to stop. There is a budget code with your name on it and a lawyer who already knows who you are.

How much a legitimate business entity can move, fund, or cover.

- 1 A small business willing to carry you on the books, light cover and minor funding
- 2 A real company with legitimate revenue, able to fund modest operations and provide solid cover
- 3 A mid-size company with real assets, capable of funding serious operations and absorbing real scrutiny
- 4 A major regional company, resources and cover to match, capable of weathering real investigation

CORPORATE BACKING (CONTINUED)

5 A multinational corporation's backing, effectively bottomless resources and cover strong enough to survive nearly anything

DEBTS OWED

People owe you. Not favors, exactly - the other kind. The kind nobody gets out of by saying they're busy. You don't bring it up often. You have never needed to. They remember.

How much real leverage is owed, in favors people can't easily refuse.

- 1 One person who owes you a real, acknowledged favor
- 2 A small handful of people who owe you, each for something genuinely significant
- 3 A broader circle of real debts, enough to call in meaningful help when it matters
- 4 Debts owed by people with real capability or standing of their own, favors that can move real weight
- 5 A web of serious debts reaching people of real power, the kind of leverage that can bend outcomes that matter

FAME

People know your face. The room changes when you walk into it, and not always in the direction you would like. Strangers are friendly, or they aren't, and either way they decided something about you before you opened your mouth.

How widely recognized the character is, and how strongly people react to it.

- 1 Known within a small local circle
- 2 Recognized across a city or subculture
- 3 Known regionally or nationally
- 4 Broadly famous - recognized by strangers regularly
- 5 World-renowned, a household name

FOLLOWERS

You have people who will actually go when you say go. Not fans. Not friends who would think about it and get back to you. People who turn up with a van at four in the morning and ask what it's for later.

How many, how skilled, or how loyal the group is.

- 1 A single loyal follower or apprentice
- 2 A small handful of modestly capable followers
- 3 A coordinated, reasonably capable crew
- 4 A sizable, well-organized group with real capability
- 5 A substantial, highly capable and loyal organization

FRINGE BENEFIT

A card, a title, a laminated badge, a line on a form. Most people don't know that door is a door. You have the thing that opens it, and nobody at the desk is going to argue with you about it.

FRINGE BENEFIT (CONTINUED)

The reach/exclusivity of the license, membership, clearance, or legal right.

- 1 A basic hobbyist license/membership
- 2 A recognized professional credential (licensed trade, press pass)
- 3 Restricted-access clearance - into secured facilities, government-adjacent circles
- 4 High-level clearance - classified access, executive-level standing
- 5 Near-total access - opens virtually any door in its domain

GUILD STANDING

Inside one trade, your name means something specific. You don't have to be in the room for it to mean it. People who have never met you know where you rank and behave accordingly.

How much rank and pull the character holds within a specific trade or professional body.

- 1 A dues-paying member in reasonably good standing
- 2 A recognized, respected member, able to call in modest favors
- 3 A senior member with real influence over local guild decisions
- 4 A leadership figure, influence reaching the guild's regional or national body
- 5 A defining figure within the guild itself, decisions of real consequence run through you

INFORMANT NETWORK

A lot of people see a lot of small things. Doormen, dishwashers, the guy running the newsstand, the kid who is always outside. Not one of them knows anything important. All of them tell you what they saw.

How wide and reliable the web of low-level eyes and ears is.

- 1 A couple of regular tipsters in one neighborhood
- 2 A working network across a city - cabbies, bartenders, doormen - who pass along what they see
- 3 A broad network spanning a whole city's worth of ordinary people, reliable and reasonably fast
- 4 A network with regional reach, fast enough to catch developing situations as they happen
- 5 An extensive network reaching anywhere relevant, near-real-time awareness of anything worth knowing

LEGAL COUNSEL

Somebody whose entire job is standing between you and the consequences, and who is very good at it. They answer at two in the morning. They don't ask what you did. They ask what you said, and to whom.

How capable and well-connected the lawyer or legal team is.

- 1 A single competent lawyer, reliable for everyday trouble
- 2 A small firm that can handle real charges and knows which favors to call in
- 3 A firm with real courtroom pull and connections into the local justice system
- 4 A firm capable of making serious charges quietly disappear, with reach into regional courts and agencies

LEGAL COUNSEL (CONTINUED)

5 Legal firepower capable of making almost anything short of the worst crimes vanish, nationally

MEDIA CONTACT

A story runs, or it doesn't. Somebody decides which, and you know them well enough to call. What ends up in the paper is not the same thing as what happened, and you have a hand in the difference.

How much a story can be shaped, planted, or killed before it runs.

1 One sympathetic local journalist willing to hear you out

2 A standing relationship with a local outlet - can get a story placed or softened

3 Real pull with a regional news network - can plant, spike, or reframe a story reliably

4 Influence reaching national media - a story dies or runs the way you want it to, most of the time

5 Command of the narrative at a national or international level - what the world believes happened is substantially up to you

MEDICAL ACCESS

Care that happens quietly and competently, with nobody filling out the form asking how this occurred. A clinic that keeps odd hours. A surgeon who owes somebody. You get stitched up and you go home.

How much discreet, high-quality medical care can be called on.

1 A single sympathetic nurse or paramedic willing to patch you up off the books

2 A private doctor who treats you (and a few others) no questions asked

3 A small discreet clinic with real equipment, staffed by people who won't talk

4 A private hospital wing or trauma team on standby, capable of handling serious, unusual injuries

5 A world-class covert medical operation, capable of handling anything short of death itself, anywhere you can reach it

OCCULT LIBRARY

Shelves of things most people would find unbearably dull and a few people would burn the building down to reach. Some of it is photocopied. Some of it should never have been photocopied. You know where every piece of it is.

How comprehensive, rare, or dangerous the collection of esoteric material is.

1 A modest personal collection - well-thumbed books on folklore and the occult, covering common knowledge

2 A solid working library, with enough breadth to research most common supernatural phenomena and a few genuine rarities

3 An extensive collection, including forbidden or suppressed texts - enough to dig into obscure or actively dangerous topics

OCCULT LIBRARY (CONTINUED)

4 A renowned archive sought after by scholars and occultists alike, holding material found nowhere else publicly

5 A legendary collection - texts thought lost or mythical; knowledge dangerous enough that possessing it alone draws attention

SAFEHOUSE NETWORK

Somewhere to go that isn't home, in more than one direction, already stocked. Cash, a change of clothes, a phone nobody has the number for. You have never needed all of them at once. You keep them all anyway.

How many scattered bolt-holes are maintained, and how well hidden each is.

Every site has power, running water, a way in and out, and basic supplies: food, bedding, a change of clothes, a first aid kit. None of them has anything beyond that. Whatever you need past keeping a person fed, dry and out of sight is whatever you carried in with you. A property that comes properly outfitted is an item, bought like any other.

1 One bolt-hole beyond your Base. Somewhere to lie up for a night that nothing on paper connects to you

2 A small handful across a city, none of them connected to each other or to you

3 A network spanning a region, each site far enough off the road that nobody arrives by accident

4 A network reaching into neighboring regions, a few of them hidden well enough to survive a real search

5 A network at national scale, any site of which can disappear you completely, indefinitely

SANCTUARY STANDING

There is one patch of ground where nothing touches you, and everybody standing on it knows why. Get through that door and whatever is chasing you has to stop and think it over.

How protected the character is within one specific safe territory.

1 A single establishment where you're recognized and safe from casual trouble

2 A small protected zone - a block, a building complex - where real trouble is unwelcome

3 A genuine sanctuary territory, actively enforced, real consequences for violating it

4 A significant, well-known sanctuary, respected and enforced across multiple factions

5 A sanctuary recognized and honored practically everywhere relevant, violating it carries consequences almost no one is willing to risk

SIGNATURE POSSESSION

One object. Yours specifically, known to be yours, and worth something to somebody other than you. A car, a watch, an instrument, a gun with a history. People recognize it before they recognize you.

How significant the one prized item owned actually is.

1 A well-made, quality item - reliable, a cut above ordinary

2 An item with a real history or reputation of its own, recognized by those who know to look

3 A genuinely rare or exceptional item, sought after by serious collectors or rivals

4 An item of real renown, recognized on sight by anyone versed in its field

SIGNATURE POSSESSION (CONTINUED)

5 A legendary item, known even to people who've never seen it - and often coveted because of it

SPIRITUAL STANDING

Within one faith, your word carries weight that has nothing to do with what you can prove. People listen because of where you stand, not because of the argument you made. That cuts both ways and you know it.

How much weight the character's name carries within a specific religious or spiritual community.

1 A respected member of a local congregation or circle

2 A trusted figure within a wider spiritual community, sought out for guidance

3 Real authority within the community - your word carries weight in real decisions

4 A recognized leader or elder, influence reaching related communities elsewhere

5 A figure of real spiritual significance, recognized and deferred to across the faith or tradition broadly

SYSTEM ACCESS

Doors that aren't doors, opened with credentials that are genuinely yours. You aren't breaking in. You are logging in, and the log says you were supposed to be there.

How deep and wide the character's reach into digital systems and networks already is.

1 Access to public records and consumer-level databases and systems

2 Real internal access into a specific organization's systems - a company, a local agency

3 Broad access spanning multiple systems and networks, reaching into mid-level corporate or government databases

4 Deep access into high-security systems - classified government or corporate networks, real backdoors

5 Near-total digital reach - access into almost any system that exists, the kind of reach that alarms anyone who learns of it

TERRITORY

Actual ground that answers to you. Not owned - owned is a different thing, and much easier. Nobody deals on this block, drinks in this bar or parks on this street without it getting back to you.

How much real ground answers to the character specifically.

1 A single block or building genuinely under your influence

2 A modest neighborhood where your word carries real weight

3 A significant district, actively held and defended

4 A substantial stretch of a city, real infrastructure and people answering to you

TERRITORY (CONTINUED)

5 Territory on the scale of a city or region, genuinely yours in every practical sense

UNDERWORLD REPUTATION

In the parts of town with no signage, people have heard of you, and they have heard something specific. You never have to introduce yourself. You do occasionally have to correct the story.

How known, trusted, or feared the character is within criminal and hidden-world circles.

1 A name a few low-level players recognize and treat with mild caution

2 Known within a specific city's criminal scene as someone not worth crossing

3 Respected or feared across a city's underworld broadly, name carries real weight in negotiations

4 Known regionally among serious players - crime bosses, cartels, syndicates - as someone to reckon with

5 A legend in the underworld nationally or beyond, invoked as a cautionary tale or a name that opens (or closes) any door

VEHICLE

It gets you there, and people notice which one it is. That's the trade. Everybody remembers the car, which is wonderful right up until somebody is describing it to a police sketch artist.

How distinctive, capable, or valuable the vehicle is.

1 Reliable but unremarkable

2 One standout feature - notably fast, armored, or distinctive

3 Significantly customized, high-performance

4 Rare and exceptional - armored, military-grade, or famous

5 One-of-a-kind, legendary in capability or reputation

WEALTH

Money you can actually reach, which is a different thing from money you technically have. Net worth is a number on paper. This is what's in the account on a Tuesday, and it's the only one that matters when you need something today.

How much disposable financial resource is available to draw on.

1 Financially comfortable - bills, rent, and daily needs covered without stress, plus modest savings and room for the occasional splurge

2 Well-off - real disposable income, enough saved to absorb an emergency without real strain

3 Wealthy; owns property outright, can make major purchases freely

4 Very wealthy; can finance a major undertaking outright

5 A fortune large enough to move markets or bankrupt entire operations

GIFTS

A Gift is the thing your character can do that other people can't.

Magic, psionics, a mutation, a blessing, a piece of hardware bolted to your spine - 20 Below doesn't care which, because that's the setting's job and the setting is yours. What the system cares about is that a Gift is **specific and narrow**. Not "fire magic." A named capability with five defined levels, that does one thing at increasing magnitude.

That narrowness is deliberate, and it's the main thing keeping Gifts from eating the game. A broad Gift answers every problem and turns the rest of your sheet into decoration. A narrow one is a tool you have to be clever about bringing to bear, which is the version worth playing.

FIVE LEVELS

Every Gift has exactly **5 levels**, rated 1-5.

Levels are a ladder and you climb it in order - you hold Level 2 before you can buy Level 3. **A Gift's Level is its magnitude:** how big, how strong, how far. Each level says what you can do at that size, building on the one below. All five are written down when the Gift is made, so you know from the start what you're working toward.

POINTS

At character creation, each Gift Level costs a flat **3 points** from the Gifts pool - a Gift bought to Level 3 costs 9 points, to Level 5, 15 points.

Adders come in two tiers, **Lesser (3 points)** and **Greater (6 points)**, paid once to unlock the

option permanently; the Ki cost of actually using it each time is separate and paid per the Gift's own text. Every Gift should offer at least 3 Adders.

Limiters are a permanent, creation-time restriction chosen for one specific Gift. Each Limiter taken drops the cost of every Level of that Gift by 1 point. Stack as many different Limiters on one Gift as you like, but no combination ever drops a Level below 1 point.

Limiters make Levels cost different amounts on different Gifts, so the 21-point pool won't always come out even. Whatever you can't spend converts to Discretionary points at 2:1. Nothing is lost for failing to divide neatly.

RESOLUTION

Gifts don't add a stat. Using one reaches for tools the game already has.

The roll. When a Gift needs one, it borrows a roll you already know - weapon damage, the Presence or Psyche attack shape, or a plain **Attribute + Difficulty** check. No Gift invents its own.

The Ki cost. A flat spend, no roll, written into the level that charges it. The same kind of thing as Ki Infusion, or bumping your Bracket.

The Gift Check. 2d10 under your **current Ki**, roll low, the same shape as any core roll. Succeed and it's free. Fail and it costs you 1 Ki until you refill. It reads current Ki rather than your maximum, which is why Gifts are dependable while you're fresh and start letting you down once the day has worn you thin.

None of the three is automatic. Each Gift, and each level of it, says which it uses, if any.

ATTACK DICE

A Gift that attacks rolls **its Level plus half the sub-stat that powers it**, rounded down. The sub-stat is the one Ki Infusion already uses, so there is never a second question about which stat a Gift runs on: **Ferocity** for dice against Soak, **Presence** against Presence, **Psyche** against Psyche.

This is why a Gift is worth its points. A weapon rolls what it rolls forever - the heaviest ordinary weapon in the book is 5 dice and always will be. A Gift at Level 1 with a middling sub-stat rolls fewer dice than something you could buy, and a Gift you have actually invested in leaves every weapon behind. The points buy the curve, not the number.

Dice built by a device or rolled by something you raised - a Gadgeteer gadget, a Necromancy thrall - are the exception, and stay on the ordinary scale. Those dice come from the thing, not from you.

THE GIFT LIST

Every entry defines all five levels up front. A Gift's Level is its magnitude - not a different power wearing the same name.

ALTERNATE FORM

Your body was the first draft. You decided to design a second one. Bones slide over one another. Muscle and skin ripple with a mind of their own. Shifting between the two takes a moment. The first time was awful - itchy, painful... and the sound. Now, you can do it while holding a conversation.

Transforming is a Slow action and triggers a Gift Check - success free, failure costs 1 Ki, the transformation happens either way. The form lasts until voluntarily dropped, no ongoing cost to maintain.

The alternate form is built once, at creation, spending a points pool (below) on the build menu below. The pool scales with Gift Level, so a character can revisit and add to the form's build as they gain Levels.

ADDDERS

- **Partial Shift** (Lesser, 3 pts): shift a single body part (hands to claws, eyes, wings) without a full transformation - no action cost, no Gift Check - but only one build-menu option's benefit applies at a time, not the whole form.
- **Extended Reserve** (Greater, 6 pts): the build-menu pool at every Level is permanently +3 points bigger.
- **Second Form** (Greater, 6 pts): build a second alternate form at creation, chosen independently, with its own full pool for your Level. Switching still triggers the Gift Check each time.
- **Snap Change** (Lesser, 3 pts): transforming is a Fast action instead of a Slow one. The Gift Check still applies.
- **Shed Skin** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when a hit would cost you a Health Level while transformed, you drop back to your normal form instead and ignore that Health Level. You can't transform again until the Scene ends.

ALTERNATE FORM (CONTINUED)

- **Terrifying Visage** (Lesser, 3 pts): the first time per Scene you transform in sight of enemies, roll your Level plus half your Presence against the Presence of every enemy within Close; a connecting die leaves that enemy Frightened until the end of their next turn.
- **Final Stage** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene while transformed, spend 2 Ki: every sub-stat boost in your build counts twice until the Scene ends. When the Scene ends you revert and are Exhausted until your next Short Rest.
- **Mending Shift** (Lesser, 3 pts): transforming or reverting ends any Bleeding or Envenomed condition on you, as the body rebuilds itself.

LIMITERS

- **Slow to Invoke**: transforming takes a full Minute instead of a Slow action.
- **Involuntary Trigger**: the form activates automatically under a specific stress condition (mortal danger, strong emotion, GM's call at creation) and can't be suppressed once triggered.
- **Fixed Duration**: the form can't be voluntarily dropped early. It lasts a flat Scene, then reverts on its own.
- **Painful Change**: every transformation, in or out, leaves you Staggered until the end of your next turn.
- **Beast Mind**: while transformed you can't speak, and you're at Disadvantage on every Mental roll.
- **Keyed Trigger**: you can only transform while holding one specific item chosen at creation (a mask, a charm, a card). Lose it and you can't transform until it's back in your hand.
- **Carried Weakness**: choose one weakness at creation (fire, silver, cold iron, loud noise). While transformed, attacks that use it against you roll at Advantage.

ALTERNATE FORM - POOL BY LEVEL

LEVEL	POOL
1	2 points
2	5 points
3	9 points
4	13 points
5	18 points

ALTERNATE FORM - BUILD MENU

OPTION	COST	EFFECT
Sub-stat boost	1 pt	+2 to one physical sub-stat (Soak, Ferocity, Stamina, Potence, or Initiative) while transformed.
Attribute boost	2 pts/point	+1 to one Attribute (Earth, Air, Fire, Water, or Moira) while transformed, up to your own normal maximum.
Environmental adaptation	1 pt	Breathe underwater, see in total darkness, ignore extreme temperatures, or similar.
Borrow a Gift Level	3 pts/Level	Gain one Level of an existing Gift you don't otherwise hold while transformed, GM-approved for fit - same per-Level price as the Gifts pool .
Borrow a Boon	1/3/5/7 pts	Gain a Boon you don't otherwise hold while transformed, at that Boon's own Trivial/Lesser/Greater/Legendary price.

ANIMAL FRIENDSHIP

Animals sense you are a kindred spirit. Your presence doesn't trigger their instincts. A panicky horse is soothed by your touch. The angry canine sitting behind the "Beware of Dog" sign wags his tail happily when you approach. Prey, predator, wild, or domesticated - they all trust you. They understand you and what you are trying to say to them and will often act on your behalf when you ask.

2 - Range extends to Near. You may now direct the animal to perform one simple task within its natural capabilities (lead you somewhere, retrieve a small object, stand guard, fetch help) in addition to calming or understanding it. Still a Normal action, no Ki. Additionally, you gain a lasting Animal Companion, free with this Level -

no Ki or point cost - an ordinary creature of your choice, chosen at creation, that stays by your side simply because it likes you. Not summoned or magically bound; it can leave if truly mistreated or endangered, but under normal circumstances it travels and fights alongside you.

ADDERS

- **Beast Steed** (Lesser, 3 pts): your Animal Companion can carry you as a mount. While mounted, your Movement Rate matches the Companion's own.
- **Speak for the Wild** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, ask an animal what it's seen or sensed recently - a real memory read, not just its current instinct-level state.

ANIMAL FRIENDSHIP (CONTINUED)

- **Swarm Companion** (Lesser, 3 pts): your Animal Companion is a swarm of small creatures (rats, birds, insects) acting as one, not a single creature. Same stats and progression as an ordinary Companion, but immune to attacks that require a single physical target, and takes double dice from any attack that hits an area. Stacks with Second Companion.
- **Second Companion** (Greater, 6 pts): gain a second Animal Companion, built and advanced identically to the first.
- **Borrowed Senses** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki as a Normal action to see and hear through your Animal Companion, or one animal you've calmed, for the rest of the Scene while it stays within Far. Your own body is Distracted while you do.
- **Hunting Pair** (Lesser, 3 pts): your attacks against a target your Animal Companion is in Melee with are at Advantage. Can't be taken with **No Companion**.
- **Last Guard** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, when a hit would land on you, your Animal Companion within Close throws itself in the way and takes the hit instead. Can't be taken with **No Companion**.
- **Beast Fusion** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend 2 Ki as a Slow action to merge with your Animal Companion until the Scene ends: you gain all its sub-stat bonuses from Levels 3-5 on top of your own, and it can't act separately. Requires Level 3. Can't be taken with **No Companion**.
- **Call of the Wild** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend 2 Ki: every animal within a long walk hears you and arrives within a few rounds, a group you can direct as at Level 3, even where none were in sight. Requires Level 3.

LIMITERS

- **Single Species:** the Gift only works on one chosen species, not animals in general.
- **No Companion:** you never gain the free Animal Companion at Level 2. Like every Limiter, this is permanent - it defines what the Gift is, and no amount of XP removes it. Can't be taken with **Beast Steed**, **Swarm Companion** or **Second Companion**.
- **Vocal Component:** using the Gift requires speaking or making an audible animal call. Doesn't work if you're silenced, gagged, or otherwise unable to vocalize.
- **Shared Wounds:** whenever your Animal Companion loses a Health Level, you lose 1 Poise and are Distracted until the end of your next turn. Can't be taken with **No Companion**.
- **Owed Tribute:** every task you direct an animal to do (Level 2+) must be paid for with food or a comfort it wants. Unpaid, your next roll with any animal is at Disadvantage until you settle it.
- **Scent of the Wild:** you carry the wild on you: Disadvantage on Social rolls with people while your Animal Companion or any animal you're directing is in sight.

1 - Roll **Moire + Difficulty** to calm an agitated animal or exchange simple, instinct-level understanding with it (hunger, fear, the direction of danger) - one ordinary animal at a time, within Close range. Is a Normal action. No Ki, no Gift Check.

ANIMAL FRIENDSHIP (CONTINUED)

2 - Range extends to **Near**. You may now direct the animal to perform one simple task within its natural capabilities (lead you somewhere, retrieve a small object, stand guard, fetch help) in addition to calming or understanding it. Still a Normal action, no Ki. Additionally, you gain a lasting **Animal Companion**, free with this Level - no Ki or point cost - an ordinary creature of your choice, chosen at creation, that stays by your side simply because it likes you. Not summoned or magically bound; it can leave if truly mistreated or endangered, but under normal circumstances it travels and fights alongside you.

3 - Range extends to **Far**. You may now affect a small group of animals simultaneously (a pack, a flock, a swarm) rather than just one - calming, understanding, or directing all of them at once costs **1 Ki**. Your Animal Companion's bond deepens automatically, free with this Level: it gains **+2** to one relevant sub-stat of your choice (Soak, Ferocity, Stamina, Potence, or Initiative).

4 - The affected group scales up to a full herd, swarm, or pack of any size. Your influence now extends to dangerous or exotic wildlife, not just ordinary animals - even apex predators respond to you. Group-effect Ki cost rises to **2**. Your Animal Companion gains a second **+2** to a different sub-stat, automatically, free with this Level (stacking with Level 3's bonus).

5 - Your connection extends even to legendary or mythic beasts - dragons, cryptids, spirits wearing animal shape, whatever the setting allows (GM's call on fit). Group-effect Ki cost drops back to **1**. Your Animal Companion gains a third **+2** to a sub-stat of your choice, plus one minor Boon-equivalent trait fitting the bond (GM-approved) - both automatic, free with this Level.

BATTLE SENSE

Everyone telegraphs every move. Most people just don't know Morse code. You are able to read the subtle tells that reveal what your opponent will do - a sharp intake of breath, a subtle shift in stance, an involuntary glance where they will strike. It's not precognition and it's no use outside of a fight, but you see it coming before they know they are going to do it.

Reading an opponent costs **1 Ki**, declared on your turn - it takes no action. You hold **one read at a time**, and naming somebody new drops the one you had.

1 - Spend **1 Ki** and name one opponent you can see. Every attack you make against them is at **Advantage** for the rest of the round.

2 - The read now lasts **the rest of the fight** rather than the round. Same 1 Ki, same one-at-a-time limit.

3 - Against a read opponent, your **critical hits land on a 2 or a 3** - the same shape as **Expert**, for the roll no Training Tier reaches.

4 - A read opponent **cannot gain Advantage against you**, from any source. You are already where they were going.

5 - Once per fight, take **one extra Fast action**, at any point you choose. It is Fast and it stays Fast - Ki cannot bump it to Normal or Slow, and it cannot be spent on a Slow action's called shot.

ADDS

- **Cold Read** (Lesser, 3 pts): +1 Ki per use. Establish a read by watching someone fight *somebody else*, without attacking them yourself.
- **Second Read** (Greater, 6 pts): hold **two** reads at once instead of one.
- **Shared Read** (Greater, 6 pts): +1 Ki per use. One ally you can speak to gains your Advantage against the read opponent for one round.

BATTLE SENSE (CONTINUED)

- **Counter Stance** (Greater, 6 pts): once per round, when a read opponent attacks you and no die connects, spend 1 Ki to make one Fast attack against them at once, even outside your turn.
- **Find the Gap** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, one attack against a read opponent ignores 2 of their Soak.
- **Already Gone** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, when a read opponent attacks you, spend 1 Ki to put that attack at Disadvantage.
- **Blind Reading** (Lesser, 3 pts): you read by sound, breath and the shift of weight. Being Blinded, darkness or smoke doesn't drop your read, and you don't suffer Disadvantage against your read opponent for not seeing them. Can't be taken with **Eyes Only**.
- **Read the Room** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend 2 Ki: every opponent you can see counts as read until the end of the round.
- **Open Book** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki as a Normal action to tell a read opponent exactly what they're about to do. Roll your Level plus half your Presence against their Presence; a connecting die leaves them Flustered until the end of their next turn.

LIMITERS

- **Eyes Only**: you must be able to see them clearly. Darkness, smoke or heavy cover drops the read until you can see them again.
- **Rattled**: losing a **Health Level** drops your current read. Re-establishing it costs Ki again.
- **Costly Sense**: every Ki cost of this Gift is 1 higher, at every Level.
- **Tunnel Vision**: while you hold a read, attacks against you from anyone other than your read opponent are at Advantage.
- **Learn by Taking**: you can only read an opponent who has already attacked you this fight. Can't be taken with **Cold Read**.

- **Aftershock**: at the end of any fight in which you held a read, you're Distracted until your next Short Rest.
- **Human Tells**: reads only work on creatures with a human-like body. Animals, machines, the dead, swarms and anything without breath or a face can't be read.

BERSERKER

Some people go quiet when they are hurt. You go loud. Pain doesn't register as a warning - it registers as permission. The more of you is broken, the more dangerous you become, right up until there's nothing left to break.

ADDDERS

- **Feeds on Pain** (Lesser, 3 pts): Fury's bonus dice also apply to Melee grapples and contested Potence rolls, not just attacks.
- **Undying Focus** (Lesser, 3 pts): Level 4's Social exemption extends to Mental rolls too - Fury no longer imposes Disadvantage on anything.
- **Not Yet** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when you lose your last Health Level, you keep fighting until the end of the next round before you fall. Your Fury bonus sits at its cap for that round.
- **Red Mist** (Lesser, 3 pts): while any Fury bonus is active, you can't be Frightened or Flustered.
- **Wrath Unbound** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend 2 Ki: until the Scene ends, count 2 more missing Health Levels than you have for Fury, even from full health.
- **Blood Scent** (Lesser, 3 pts): while any Fury bonus is active, you know the direction of every Bleeding creature within Far, and your attacks against Bleeding targets are at Advantage.

BERSERKER (CONTINUED)

- **Contagious Rage** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend 1 Ki to grant one ally within Close range half your current Fury bonus (round down) as bonus dice on their own next Physical attack.
- **Overflowing** (Greater, 6 pts): Last Stand can be triggered a second time per Scene, though the second use costs 1 Ki.

LIMITERS

- **No Off Switch:** Fury's Disadvantage never goes away, even at Level 4+ - it always applies to Social and Mental rolls both.
- **Reckless Momentum:** while any Fury bonus is active, you can't voluntarily retreat or disengage from a fight you're already in.
- **Crash:** when your Fury bonus drops back to 0 (healed past the missing-HL threshold, or the Scene ends), you're at Disadvantage on all rolls until your next Short Rest.
- **Friend or Foe:** while any Fury bonus is active, if no enemy is in Melee with you at the start of your turn, you must move toward the nearest creature and attack it, ally or not.
- **Burning Blood:** while your Fury bonus is at its cap, you lose 1 Poise per round.
- **Deaf to Reason:** while any Fury bonus is active, you can only attack, move or Grab - no Skills, items or other Gifts.

1 - Rising Fury: while you have at least 1 Health Level missing, add bonus dice to your Physical attacks equal to half your missing Health Levels (round down), capped at **1**. While any Fury bonus is active, you're at Disadvantage on Social and Mental rolls - nothing gets through but the fight in front of you.

2 - Fury's cap rises to **2**.

3 - Fury's bonus now also applies to your Soak - the same fury that sharpens your strikes also numbs what would otherwise put you down.

4 - Fury's cap rises to **3**. The Level 1 Disadvantage no longer applies to Social rolls - a raging fury reads as pure menace, not incoherence - just Mental rolls now.

5 - Fury's cap rises to **6**. Once per Scene, as a free action, trigger **Last Stand:** your Fury bonus locks at its maximum for the rest of the Scene, regardless of your actual missing Health Levels.

CLAIRVOYANCE

You can perceive distant places, objects or people without being physically present. You focus your senses beyond the bounds of your body - observing what lies elsewhere as though you were standing there. Your body stays behind, unoccupied while your animating force goes sightseeing.

ADDERS

- **Split Focus** (Lesser, 3 pts): divide the vision between two locations at once, each getting a proportionally weaker (GM-adjudicated) picture, instead of one full-strength vision.
- **Anchor Point** (Lesser, 3 pts): designate a person or object beforehand. You may reflexively snap your vision to it once per Scene, even mid-action, without spending the normal Slow action to project.
- **Tandem Sight** (Greater, 6 pts): bring one other willing person along for the ride - they share what you see and hear for the vision's duration, no separate roll needed.
- **Speak Through** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to let one short sentence in your voice be heard at the place you're viewing.
- **Quick Glance** (Lesser, 3 pts): project as a Normal action instead of a Slow one, but the vision lasts only until the end of the round.

CLAIRVOYANCE (CONTINUED)

- **Spirit Sight** (Lesser, 3 pts): your projected sight shows spirits, invisible things and active Gift effects at the place you're viewing, as if they stood in plain view.
- **Overwatch** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki as a Slow action to hang a thin thread of your sight above your own position for the rest of the Scene while you keep acting normally. You can't be Surprised, and within Near no one can hide from your sight behind cover or around corners.

LIMITERS

- **Vulnerable While Projecting:** your body is left slumped and unaware of its surroundings while your sight is elsewhere - no passive Perception, Disadvantage on any roll to notice danger to your physical body.
- **Tethered Sight:** the Gift only works on a fixed set of pre-tuned static locations - one slot per Level held in this Gift. Retargeting an existing slot to a new location requires spending a full evening or rest period retuning your sight to it. Level 4-5's follow-a-person and unknown-location capabilities never apply, since every use has to land on one of your tuned slots.
- **One-Way Mirror:** anyone at the destination with a supernatural sense for it can always tell they're being watched, no roll required.
- **Bleeding Eyes:** after each vision ends, you're at Disadvantage on every sight-based roll for the rest of the Scene.
- **Still Waters:** projecting needs a still focus (a bowl of water, a mirror, a flame) and calm. You can't project during a fight or while anyone hostile is within Near. Can't be taken with **Anchor Point**, **Quick Glance** or **Overwatch**.
- **Symbolic Sight:** visions come as symbols. Writing, faces and numbers never come through clearly - the GM describes what you see as a metaphor, not a photograph.

1 - Roll **Moire + Difficulty** (harder the less familiar the place) to project your sight to somewhere you've personally been before. Is a Slow action, sight only - no sound - lasting a few minutes or until broken.

2 - The vision now includes sound as well as sight. You can also target a place you've only seen in detail (a photo, a vivid description) rather than having to have physically been there yourself.

3 - Spend **1 Ki** to extend the vision's duration significantly, or to target a place you've never seen or visited at all, so long as you're actively searching for it with a clear intent ("show me where the stolen car went").

4 - Your sight can now follow a specific person you've met, tracking their general location even if you don't know exactly where they are - the vision moves with them rather than staying fixed to one place.

5 - You can project into a completely unknown, undescribed location by intent alone - answering an unknown ("where is the artifact hidden?") rather than needing any prior anchor. Ki cost from Level 3 drops to **0**.

CONJURED ARMORY

Somewhere, just the other side of the world, your weapon waits for the moment you call it forth. With a flicker of thought, it slips through the gaps in reality and into your grasp, ready for battle. You don't own the weapon so much as call a mystical DoorDash to deliver one.

Chosen once, at creation: your **signature weapon**, any single item from the catalog in Weapons & Equipment.

A conjured weapon's Damage is its listed rating **plus this Gift's Level**, with no ceiling - the weapon table's cap of 5 binds what a smith can forge, not what you call out of the air. A Damage 4 hatchet conjured at Level 3 deals **7**.

CONJURED ARMORY (CONTINUED)

Expendables. Anything used up when it is used - a grenade, a charge, a rocket - can be conjured **once per Scene**. After that, **1 Ki** conjures it again. A weapon that comes back is not expendable: a thrown blade called home at Level 3 can be thrown all day.

ADDDERS

- **Bonded Blade** (Lesser, 3 pts): your signature weapon carries a permanent edge no other conjured weapon does - its Damage is always **+1** higher than any other weapon you conjure, from Level 3 on, forged specifically for your hand.
- **Armory of Anything** (Lesser, 3 pts): your conjured weapons can include improvised or exotic options beyond the standard catalog (a chainsaw, a fire axe, a katana pulled from pure aesthetic) - GM's call on stats, using the closest catalog equivalent.
- **Twin Draw** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, conjure a second weapon alongside your first at no extra cost, usable for a second attack within the same Normal action bracket.
- **Blade Rain** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend 2 Ki as a Slow action to conjure a storm of weapons: make one attack with your conjured weapon against every enemy within Near you can see.
- **Soulblade** (Greater, 6 pts): your signature weapon may cut the spirit instead of the flesh: choose on each attack to roll against Psyche instead of Soak. Armor does nothing against it.
- **Elemental Edge** (Lesser, 3 pts): choose Bleeding or Envenomed at creation. Once per Scene, a hit with a conjured weapon leaves the target with that condition.
- **Parry Blade** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per round, when you're attacked in Melee, spend 1 Ki to conjure a blade into the blow's path: that attack is at Disadvantage.

- **Blade Anchor** (Lesser, 3 pts): after throwing a conjured weapon (Level 3+), spend a Fast action to pull yourself to where it landed, up to Near, before calling it back. Requires Level 3.

LIMITERS

- **Slow Return:** dismissing a weapon isn't instant - it takes a full Fast action to banish it.
- **Blood Price:** every summon costs you 1 Poise - the weapon is fed before it answers.
- **Soul-Bound:** your weapons are part of you: whenever one is disarmed, broken or knocked away, you're Staggered until the end of your next turn.
- **Spoken Name:** every summon means calling the weapon's name aloud. Silenced, gagged or unable to speak, you can't summon.
- **Signature Only:** you only ever conjure your signature weapon - Level 2's any-weapon clause never applies. Can't be taken with **Armory of Anything**.
- **Borrowed, Not Owned:** a conjured weapon vanishes if it ever leaves your grip involuntarily (disarmed, knocked away) - you must re-summon rather than immediately recall it.
- **Visible Conjuring:** summoning is never subtle - it's always an obvious flash or effect visible to everyone nearby, no way to conceal that you're using a Gift.

1 - Summon your signature weapon into your hand as a **Fast action**, no Ki cost. It arrives with its listed range. Dismissing it is free and instant. It never runs dry - ammo, if any, is never actually a concern, though you're free to roleplay reloading.

2 - You may now conjure **any** weapon from the full catalog, not just your signature - reselect freely each time you summon.

CONJURED ARMORY (CONTINUED)

3 - You can throw the conjured weapon. The throw is an attack like any other; calling it back to your hand afterwards is a **free action** on your turn, from any distance. A weapon you let go of on purpose does not vanish the way one knocked from your grip does.

4 - Summoning becomes a **free action** - no action cost at all, folding seamlessly into any attack. You're never caught without a weapon in hand.

5 - Once per Scene, spend **1 Ki** to conjure a weapon so precise it ignores **3** points of the target's Soak for that single attack.

COPYCAT

If you watch someone closely enough, you can hold the thread of what makes them exceptional. A skill, a talent, even the odd power behind their superhuman feats are no mystery to you. You don't become them, you just lean on their abilities - carrying their echo with you for a time.

This Gift always costs Ki, at every Level. There is no mastery discount to free.

ADDERS

- **Retained Impression** (Lesser, 3 pts): once you've mimicked a specific person's capability, watching them again re-triggers it at half Ki cost (rounded up) for the rest of that session.
- **Group Study** (Lesser, 3 pts): you may watch multiple targets in the same scene and hold a separate mimicked capability from each, rather than one overwriting the last.
- **Perfect Copy** (Greater, 6 pts): a mimicked Gift capability comes with any Adders the original had unlocked, not just its bare Level effect.
- **Mirror Return** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when a Gift is used against you, spend 2 Ki after it resolves to throw the same capability straight back at its user as a free action, at the highest Level your own Copycat Level lets you mimic.
- **Touch Copy** (Lesser, 3 pts): you can borrow by skin contact (a Grab counts) instead of watching - copying something the target hasn't shown you yet.
- **Stored Page** (Greater, 6 pts): keep one mimicked capability on file permanently. Calling it up again costs its normal Ki but needs no watching and no roll. Replacing the stored one takes a full rest.

COPYCAT (CONTINUED)

- **Explained to Me** (Lesser, 3 pts): if the target has explained their power to you, or you've been hit by it, your roll to borrow it is at Advantage.
- **Lend the Echo** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki and touch an ally to hand them a capability you're holding for the rest of the Scene. You lose it while they have it.

LIMITERS

- **One at a Time:** you can only hold a single mimicked capability at once, at any Level - Level 5's "all three at once" clause never applies.
- **Live Feed Only:** the target must still be within your sight when you activate a mimicked capability, not just at the moment you first watched it.
- **Echo, Not Original:** a mimicked Gift capability never benefits from your own Moira, Ki totals, or other bonuses beyond what the roll itself requires - it runs at the exact numbers you watched, even if worse than your own stats would produce.
- **Foreign Strain:** each time you use a mimicked Gift capability, you lose 1 Poise - your body wasn't built for it.
- **Twice Seen:** watching once isn't enough: you must see the Skill, Boon or Gift used twice in the same Scene before you can borrow it.
- **Living Source:** a borrowed capability ends the moment its original owner is unconscious or dead.
- **Identity Bleed:** at the end of any Day you spent holding a mimicked capability, lose 1 Sanity as their habits and voice creep into yours.

1 - Watch a target use a Skill, then spend **1 Ki** and roll **Moira + Difficulty** to borrow it: for the rest of the scene, use that Skill yourself, treated as Trained even with no training of your own (or your own tier, if already higher).

2 - You can also mimic a Boon after watching its effect happen once, gaining that Boon's benefit for the rest of the scene. Same cost.

3 - You can mimic a Gift after watching it used, copying its Level 1 capability for the rest of the scene. Ki cost rises to **2**.

4 - A mimicked Gift capability can go as high as its Level 3, and any mimicry (Skill, Boon, or Gift) now lasts a full **Day** instead of just a Scene.

5 - Mimic a Gift capability up to its full Level 5, or hold a Skill, a Boon, and a Gift capability all mimicked at once, for a full Day.

CYBERNETICS

The line between flesh and hardware is blurred. Steel strengthens bones, nerves are replaced by fiber-optic cables, nano-circuitry extends the senses beyond what biology can perceive. You are augmented. These augmentations are not powers you call upon but machines integrated into you - engineered to function as if you were born with them.

Unlike a shapeshifting Gift, there's no transformation to trigger - your augmentations are always active. No action, no Gift Check, no Ki cost just to have them running.

The build is set once at creation, spending a points pool (below) on the build menu. The pool scales with Gift Level, so a character can revisit and expand their augmentations as they gain Levels.

ADDERS

- **Overclock Surge** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to push one installed augmentation to double effect for a single action.

CYBERNETICS (CONTINUED)

- **Backup Power Cell** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, ignore an effect that would otherwise disable your augmentations.
- **Full Conversion** (Greater, 6 pts): the build-menu pool at every Level is permanently +3 points bigger.
- **Reconfigurable** (Greater, 6 pts): with an hour of focused work, swap your build-menu loadout for a different selection of equal or lesser total cost.
- **Governor Override** (Greater, 6 pts): Once per Scene, spend 2 Ki as a Fast action to cut your safety governors for the rest of the Scene: every Subdermal Plating, Armored Plating, Myomer Fiber and Linear Frame bonus you have is doubled. When the Scene ends you take 1 Health Level and are Exhausted.
- **Rocket Fist** (Lesser, 3 pts): Spend 1 Ki to launch a cybernetic hand on its cable and make an unarmed or Integrated Weapon attack against a target at Near range. The hand reels back in before your next turn.
- **Sacrificial Part** (Lesser, 3 pts): Once per Scene, when an attack would take Health Levels from you, a piece of hardware takes the hit instead: ignore that attack's damage, and one build-menu option of your choice goes offline until you spend an hour repairing it.
- **Battle Configuration** (Greater, 6 pts): Build a second loadout at creation, with its own full pool for your Level. As a Normal action, fold one away and deploy the other - only one is ever active, and the second counts as Visible Hardware whether or not you took that Limiter.
- **Onboard AI** (Greater, 6 pts): Your hardware has a voice and a personality of its own. Once per round it takes one Fast action using only your installed augmentations (fire the Chem Injector, run a scan, key the Comms Array) without costing you an action, and it keeps doing so while you are unconscious.

- **Threat Response Loop** (Lesser, 3 pts): Your targeting suite never sleeps: you can't be Surprised, and once per Scene you may take your turn first in a round regardless of Initiative.
- **Hidden Arsenal** (Lesser, 3 pts): The first time in a Scene you attack with an Integrated Weapon or Integrated Heavy Weapon, a target who didn't know it was there is Surprised against that attack.
- **Cortex Vault** (Greater, 6 pts): Your brain lives in an armored case. When you would die, your body is wrecked but you survive in the case - helpless, but able to hear, speak through a Comms Array, and be installed in a new body after a week of downtime. The Vault can't save you again until that week is done.

LIMITERS

- **Vulnerable to EMP:** electromagnetic effects, a Technokinesis-style intrusion, or a dedicated anti-tech weapon disable your augmentations for the rest of the Scene on a hit.
- **Visible Hardware:** your augmentations are visible, not concealable under normal clothing - no passing as unaugmented.
- **Maintenance Dependent:** without downtime and access to tools between sessions, GM's call whether an augmentation glitches out for the session.
- **Chrome Distance:** Too much of you is machine. Disadvantage on any roll to comfort, charm or earn the trust of someone who isn't augmented, and animals won't settle near you.
- **Heat Venting:** Your frame overheats. After a round in which you use Reflex Booster, Overclock Surge or an Integrated Weapon, none of them work the next round while you vent.

CYBERNETICS (CONTINUED)

- **Kill Switch:** Someone else still owns your hardware - a maker, a company, a military. Once per session the GM may have them shut your augmentations off for a Scene, and they expect favours to keep it switched on.
- **Short Circuit:** Water shorts you out. Once soaked through - submerged, hosed down, caught in a downpour - you have Disadvantage on every physical roll until you dry off, and you can never install Artificial Gills.
- **Rejection Dose:** Your body fights the hardware. You need an immunosuppressant dose per day; miss one and you are Exhausted until you get it, and Toxin Binders never helps with it.

CYBERNETICS - POOL BY LEVEL

LEVEL	POOL
1	2 points
2	5 points
3	9 points
4	13 points
5	18 points

CYBERNETICS - BUILD MENU

A few options are bigger versions of a cheaper one - Myomer Fiber and Linear Frame, Subdermal Plating and Armored Plating, Sensory Suite and Multi-Optic Cluster, Chemical and Molecular Analyzer. Take one or the other; the larger replaces the smaller rather than stacking with it.

OPTION	COST	EFFECT
Subdermal Plating	1 pt	+2 Soak, always on.
Myomer Fiber	1 pt	+2 to one physical sub-stat (Ferocity, Potence, Initiative, or Stamina).
Sensory Suite	1 pt	One sense-based upgrade: see in total darkness, zoom/magnify at will, or filter out deafening/blinding effects.
Integrated Toolkit	1 pt	A multitool, lockpick set, or scanner built into a limb - can't be disarmed or confiscated in a pat-down.

CYBERNETICS - BUILD MENU (CONTINUED)

OPTION	COST	EFFECT
Integrated Storage Compartment	1 pt	A concealed cavity in a limb or torso, holding a handful of small items - invisible to a pat-down or metal detector.
Video/Audio Recorder	1 pt	Continuously record everything you see and hear, and replay it later - clean, reliable evidence.
Comms Array	1 pt	Short-range encrypted radio link to other augmented allies or compatible tech, immune to ordinary jamming.
Navigation Suite	1 pt	Perfect sense of direction and position, plus a stored map of anywhere you've personally been.
Biometric Lock	1 pt	Your augmentations (and anything in an Integrated Storage Compartment) only function for you - stolen or severed parts are inert junk to anyone else.
Universal Interface Port	1 pt	A hardline jack that connects to any standard port or socket, no compatible cable or adapter needed.
Climbing Servos	1 pt	Retractable claws or grip pads in hands and feet - climb sheer surfaces at your normal Movement Rate, no roll for an ordinary climb.
Silent Movement Dampeners	1 pt	Your augmented limbs make no mechanical noise - no Stealth penalty from servo whine or joint clicks.
Thermal Regulation	1 pt	Ignore extreme heat or cold - no Disadvantage from environmental temperature.
Vehicle Link	1 pt	Pilot or drive by direct neural link - Advantage on any roll to control a compatible vehicle.
Signal Scanner	1 pt	Spot active transmitters, bugs, taps, and cameras nearby - the room tells you who's listening.
Voice Stress Analyzer	1 pt	Advantage on any roll to tell whether someone is lying to your face.
Chemical Analyzer	1 pt	Taste or smell a sample and know what it is - drugs, poisons, accelerants, blood.
Sealed Respirator	1 pt	Filtered lungs and a sealed airway - immune to gas and airborne agents, and you can go without air for several minutes.
Toxin Binders	1 pt	Advantage against poison, disease, and drugs, including the ones you'd rather enjoy.
Stun Knuckles	1 pt	Your unarmed strikes can deal their damage to Poise instead of Health Levels - put someone down without killing them.
Gyro Stabilizer	1 pt	Advantage on any roll to keep your feet - against being knocked Prone, shoved, or left Off Balance.

CYBERNETICS - BUILD MENU (CONTINUED)

OPTION	COST	EFFECT
Mag Clamps	1 pt	Magnetic soles and palms - walk on metal walls and ceilings at your normal Movement Rate, and nothing moves you off a metal floor while you're clamped.
Smoke Vent	1 pt	Once per Scene, flood Close range around you with thick smoke - sight through it is blocked until the end of the next round.
Dazzler Eyes	2 pts	Once per Scene, as a Fast action, flash one target at Close range who is looking at you - they are Blinded until the end of their next turn. Flash-filtering eyes ignore it.
Adrenal Pump	2 pts	Once per Scene, as a Fast action, flood your system and shake off Frightened, Exhausted or Staggered.
Thermoptic Masking	2 pts	Your body holds ambient temperature and damps its own signal - invisible to thermal sight, motion sensors and signal scanners.
Enhanced Antibodies	1 pt	You heal one step faster than normal on any rest.
Artificial Gills	1 pt	Breathe water indefinitely.
Radiation Shielding	1 pt	Immune to radiation, and Advantage against any environmental hazard that works on flesh rather than force.
Bio-Comp Monitor	1 pt	Constant readout of your own condition - you know exactly how hurt, poisoned, or drugged you are, and a Comms Array broadcasts it if you go down.
Laser Rangefinder	1 pt	Exact distance to anything you can see. Advantage on attacks at Far range and on any indirect or thrown shot.
Fiber-Optic Probe	1 pt	A camera on a flexible lead that deploys from a fingertip - see under doors, around corners, into locks.
Synthskin Overlay	1 pt	Your hardware reads as flesh to the eye, the hand, and a casual scan. Cancels the Visible Hardware Limiter if both are taken.
Voice Modulator	1 pt	Reproduce any voice you've recorded, pitch yourself unrecognizable, or speak subvocally into a Comms Array.
Loudspeaker	1 pt	Drive your voice to a painful volume. Advantage to command, warn, or scatter a crowd at Near range or further.
Language Translator	1 pt	Real-time translation of any language you've heard enough of to sample - understood, and spoken back.
Fashionware Suite	1 pt	Light tattoos, fiber hair, a subdermal watch - change your look on demand. Advantage to be remembered, or to be forgotten.
Chem Injector	1 pt	An internal reservoir holding one dose of a drug of your choosing. Administered by thought, and nothing to find in a search.
Garrote Wire	1 pt	A spool of monofilament from a fingertip. A weapon, a cutting tool, and a tripline, depending on the evening.

CYBERNETICS - BUILD MENU (CONTINUED)

OPTION	COST	EFFECT
Reinforced Chassis	2 pts	+1 to Carrying Capacity and Break Threshold, stacking with Potence's own.
Subroutine Uplink	2 pts	Passive short-range wireless link to nearby active electronics - grants Technokinesis Level 1's passive awareness, without needing that Gift.
Data Vault	2 pts	Onboard encrypted memory - perfect recall of anything you've scanned or recorded, immune to remote hacking without direct physical access.
Onboard Computer	2 pts	Instant calculation, translation, and lookup - treat any Knowledge-Skill roll needing reference material as if you had a research library on hand.
Holographic Projector	2 pts	Project a small hologram at Close range - a decoy, a visual aid, a disguise overlay.
Grapple Line	2 pts	A retractable cable launcher built into an arm - anchor and pull yourself to a point within Near range, or yank a target or object toward you.
Nanite Medkit	2 pts	A self-contained injector loaded with one dose of field-medicine nanites - once per Scene, stabilize yourself or an adjacent ally from dying, no roll.
Smartlink	2 pts	A weapon interface - add one bonus die to attacks with any firearm wired to you. Someone else firing it gets nothing.
Pain Editor	2 pts	Wound Disadvantage from missing Health Levels doesn't apply to you, and torture, agony effects, and pain-based intimidation simply don't land.
Motion Sensor	2 pts	Detect anything moving within Near range, through darkness, smoke, or a single wall.
Multi-Optic Cluster	2 pts	Every Sensory Suite upgrade at once, in one eye - darkness, magnification, filtering, and thermal. Replaces Sensory Suite.
Molecular Analyzer	2 pts	Forensic-grade analysis - material composition, residues, age, what a thing was before it was this. Replaces Chemical Analyzer.
Cyber-Disguise	2 pts	Reshape your face and build over a few minutes to pass as a specific other person you've studied. Not an illusion - it's machinery moving bone.
Jump Servos	2 pts	Leap to anywhere within Near range from standing, and take no damage from a fall you chose.
Nano-Repair System	2 pts	An internal repair swarm - recover 1 Health Level once per Scene, no roll and no action.
Quick-Change Mount	2 pts	Swap a hand for another limb-mounted option costing 2 points or less in seconds rather than an hour.
Integrated Weapon	3 pts	A retractable blade, dart launcher, or similar built into a limb - counts as a Light weapon that can never be disarmed or left behind.

CYBERNETICS - BUILD MENU (CONTINUED)

OPTION	COST	EFFECT
Reflex Booster	3 pts	Spend 1 Ki to take one extra Fast action. Once per round, no limit per Scene.
Chipware Socket	3 pts	A skill-chip slot. With a chip on hand, treat any one Skill as Trained for the Scene - swap chips freely between Scenes.
Linear Frame	3 pts	An internal load frame - +4 to one physical sub-stat rather than Myomer Fiber's +2, but the bulk is not concealable. Replaces Myomer Fiber.
Armored Plating	3 pts	+4 Soak rather than Subdermal Plating's +2, but it is plainly armor and cannot be concealed. Replaces Subdermal Plating.
Chameleon Skin	3 pts	Hold still and your skin matches what's behind you - Advantage on Stealth while stationary, lost the moment you move.
Cybersnake	3 pts	A segmented limb that deploys from your torso - reaches Close range, grapples, and gets into places a hand won't.
Internal Power Plant	3 pts	A sealed generator instead of cells. Your augmentations never run down and never need servicing, cancelling the Maintenance Dependent Limiter if both are taken.
Integrated Heavy Weapon	4 pts	A forearm-mounted ranged weapon - counts as a Medium weapon, never disarmed, and impossible to explain at a checkpoint.

DEADZONE

Some people radiate power. Around you, that aura dims and flickers. The closer you are to them, the harder it is to fuel their abilities. Gifts fizzle, supernatural forces fray and the impossible remains stubbornly out of reach.

ADDERS

- **Lingering Dampener** (Lesser, 3 pts): the single-target tax/shutdown (Levels 1-3) persists for a full Day instead of just the rest of the scene.
- **Ki Bleed** (Lesser, 3 pts): when your field (Level 4+) is active, spend 1 Ki to siphon 1 Ki directly from a target inside it into your own pool.
- **Anchor the Field** (Greater, 6 pts): your field (Level 4+) stays up after you leave it or fall unconscious, persisting until the scene ends or you choose to drop it.

- **Null Touch** (Lesser, 3 pts): a Melee attack of yours that connects applies Level 1's tax to the target with no extra action or Ki.
- **See Through** (Lesser, 3 pts): illusions, invisibility and disguises made by Gifts don't work on you within Close - you see the person under them.
- **Sealing Mark** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 2 Ki and touch a target: name one of their Gifts. They can't use it at all for a full Day. Requires Level 3.
- **Dead Circuit** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to shut down one Gift-built or Gift-powered device within range (a gadget, a cybernetic part, a drone, a conjured weapon) for the rest of the Scene.
- **Null Body** (Greater, 6 pts): Gift attacks against you are at Disadvantage. Helpful Gift effects from allies (healing, shields, buffs) also fail on you.

DEADZONE (CONTINUED)

- **Sense the Spark** (Lesser, 3 pts): you can feel who within Near holds a Gift, and roughly how strong it is (low, middling or high Level).

LIMITERS

- **Indiscriminate**: your field (Level 4+) can't be tuned to exclude allies - it suppresses everyone inside, including yourself and your own Gift uses.
- **Warning Shimmer**: the air visibly distorts around you whenever this Gift is active at any Level - it can never be used covertly.
- **Costs You Too**: every Ki spend for this Gift is doubled, rounded up (so Level 1's single-target tax costs 2 Ki instead of 1), at every Level, with no exceptions.
- **Touch Only**: your single-target effects only work at Melee range, whatever your Level. The field (Level 4+) is unchanged.
- **Always On**: at every Level, anyone within Close of you (you, allies and enemies) pays Level 1's tax on every Gift use, and you can't switch it off.
- **Slow Unravel**: shutting down an active effect or stopping a Gift (Level 2) takes a Slow action instead of happening with the Ki spend alone.
- **Hollow**: you can never hold any other Gift. Deadzone is all you have.

1 - Touch or **Close** range, single target. Spend **1 Ki**, no roll: for the rest of the scene, that target's Gift uses cost double Ki, rounded up (a normally-free use instead costs 1 Ki).

2 - Range extends to **Near**. You may instead spend 1 Ki to directly prevent a Gift from activating in the first place, or shut down one specific active supernatural effect already in place, no roll, either way ending it outright.

3 - Range extends to **Far**. You can affect a second target at the same time, for a second 1 Ki spend.

4 - Spend **2 Ki** and roll **Moire + Difficulty** to instead raise a true field around yourself out to **Close** range, affecting everyone inside rather than picking individual targets, lasting the rest of the scene. Failure still spends the Ki; the field doesn't form.

5 - The field radius extends to **Near**, and upgrades from a tax to an outright block: Gifts simply can't be used inside it. Ki cost for the single-target effects (Levels 1-3) drops to **0**.

DOMINATION

You don't persuade people - you decide for them. Everyone has a voice in their head that tells them what to do - you can just make it yours. Meet their eyes, speak with intent, flex your will and a suggestion becomes a command.

As with any Mental attack, additional Ki Infusion (1 Ki per die) can push individual dice further by adding your own Psyche, per the usual rule.

ADDDERS

- **Blind Command** (Lesser, 3 pts): issue a command over a phone call, recording, or any medium carrying your voice and intent, not just direct eye contact.
- **Puppet Strings** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 2 Ki on top of the normal cost: a connecting die hands you the target's whole next turn - you choose its actions, attacks on its own allies included. The self-harm safeguard still applies below Level 5. Requires Level 3.
- **Mass Command** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki per extra target to issue one command to everyone you can meet eyes with within Near. Roll once and check the dice against each target's Psyche separately.
- **Eyes of the Master** (Lesser, 3 pts): you always know the direction and rough distance to anyone currently carrying out a command of yours.

DOMINATION (CONTINUED)

- **Iron Crown** (Lesser, 3 pts): your will is hard to take: rolls to control, command or read your mind are at Disadvantage against you.
- **False Memory of Consent** (Lesser, 3 pts): the target has no memory of being commanded - the compliance feels, to them, like it was their own idea.
- **Standing Order** (Greater, 6 pts): a delayed/triggered command (Level 3+) can be reset and reused against the same target without needing to re-establish eye contact and pay the Ki cost again, so long as the original condition hasn't yet fired.

LIMITERS

- **One Word, Always:** commands never advance past Level 1's single-word simplicity, regardless of Gift Level bought - Level 2's sentence/complexity upgrade never applies.
- **Fragile Hold:** any command that would cause the target visible distress or conflict with their core values ends immediately and can't be reattempted against them for a full Day.
- **Marked Predator:** anyone who succeeds a Psyche roll against you afterward instinctively recognizes you as a Domination user on sight, permanently, whether or not they were ever a target.
- **Spoken Aloud:** commands must be spoken and heard. A target who can't hear you ignores them, and everyone nearby hears exactly what you ordered.
- **Backlash:** when no die connects, you lose 1 Sanity - the refusal bounces back into your own head.
- **One Command per Scene:** each person can only be commanded once per Scene, successful or not.
- **They Always Know:** every target remembers being commanded afterward, and knows it was you. Can't be taken with **False Memory of Consent**.

1 - Requires eye contact. Spend **1 Ki** and roll **1 + half your Psyche** dice per-die against the target's Psyche wall - a connecting die lets you issue a single-word command ("stop," "sleep," "drop it") that they obey for one action or moment. Commands resulting in self-harm or serious injury automatically fail.

2 - Dice rise to **2 + half your Psyche**. Commands can now be full sentences rather than a single word, and can be complex - multi-step instructions, conditional logic, or nuanced requests - not just simple directives.

3 - Dice rise to **3 + half your Psyche**. You may implant a delayed/triggered command - it stays dormant until a specific condition you set occurs, then executes automatically.

4 - Dice rise to **4 + half your Psyche**. Repeated exposure builds suggestibility: each successful use of this Gift on the same person grants **Advantage** on your next attempt against them, cumulative and lasting until they're free of your influence for an extended stretch (GM's call).

5 - Dice rise to **5 + half your Psyche**. The self-harm/serious-injury safeguard no longer applies - commands can now be harmful, even lethal.

DRONE SWARM

Even when there is no one around, you are not alone. You have a swarm of small machines that follow your every command. Each one is built for a different purpose - combat, defense, healing, transport and more. They move with just a thought. They are your hands, guns, eyes and anything else you can imagine.

DRONE SWARM (CONTINUED)

Drone Chassis (every deployed drone, regardless of type): **Soak** 1 · **Defense** 5 · **Health Levels** 2 · **Movement Rate** matches your own · **Output Rating** 2, rising with your Gift Level. No Skills or Gifts of its own. Acts immediately after you in the turn order, taking a Fast or Normal action each round (never Slow).

Drone Types (chosen per drone, reconfigurable per the Level 1 rule):

1. **Combat**: mounted weapon. Attack dice equal to its Output Rating, capped at **5** so a drone never outguns the heaviest ordinary weapon a person can carry, resolved per-die vs. the target's Soak, Presence, or Psyche as fits the attack. The **Jack In** bonus ignores that cap - it is the only thing that does, and it costs you your body to use.
2. **Healing**: as its action, touch a willing target within Melee range and restore Health Levels equal to half its Output Rating, round up.
3. **Shielding**: as its action, project a barrier over one ally within Melee range, granting them Soak equal to its Output Rating until the start of your next turn (stacks with their own Soak).
4. **Remote Operation**: as its action, route one roll through the drone instead of acting in person - make a Skill check or device interaction as if you were standing where it is, using your own stats.
5. **Surveillance**: while active, automatically know the number and rough position of hostile creatures within Near range, no roll - everyone on your side gains Advantage on Perception rolls to spot ambushes there.
6. **Jamming**: as its action, target one enemy within Near range; they suffer Disadvantage on their next roll involving a device, sensor, or remote link.
7. **Decoy**: as its action, the drone mimics your own signature closely enough that an attacker targeting you may target it instead, GM's call on plausibility.

8. **Transport**: as its action, carry one willing Melee-range ally (or a load of gear) up to its own Movement Rate.

9. **Repair**: as its action, touch damaged equipment, armor, or a vehicle and restore its Health Levels equal to half its Output Rating, round up - objects only, not living creatures.

ADDDERS

- **Redundant Systems** (Lesser, 3 pts): drones' Health Levels rise by 1 each, at every Level.
- **Rapid Redeploy** (Lesser, 3 pts): when a drone is destroyed, spend 1 Ki to deploy a replacement immediately as a Fast action.
- **Swarm Tactics** (Greater, 6 pts): while jacked into one drone, every other deployed drone's Output Rating also gains the +2 Jack-In bonus, coordinated off the same sync. Those borrowed points are still subject to the Combat drone's damage cap - only the drone you are actually jacked into ignores it.
- **Internal Dock** (Greater, 6 pts): your drones house inside your body when not deployed. Nothing shows on a search, nothing comes off you when you are disarmed, and nobody can tell you have them until you use them. Deploying costs a **Fast** action instead of a Slow one, and a docked drone repairs **1 Health Level per hour**.
- **Emergency Eject** (Greater, 6 pts): if your jacked-in drone is destroyed, spend 1 Ki to disengage cleanly instead of the normal disorientation (Disadvantage on your next roll).
- **Combination Protocol** (Greater, 6 pts): As a Normal action, lock every deployed drone together into one large drone: Soak 2, Health Levels equal to the parts' current Health Levels +2, and once per round it may use one type ability of any drone that went into it at your Output Rating +1 (the Combat cap of 5 still applies unless you Jack In). Separating is a Normal action, with damage split as evenly as possible.

DRONE SWARM (CONTINUED)

- **Crossfire** (Lesser, 3 pts): When two or more Combat drones attack the same target in one round, that target is Off Balance until the start of its next turn - there is no angle left to cover.
- **Remote Feeds** (Lesser, 3 pts): See and hear through any deployed drone without Jacking In. Switching feeds is a Fast action, and your body stays yours, though you have Disadvantage on your own Perception while watching another feed.
- **Payload** (Lesser, 3 pts): Spend 1 Ki as a Fast action to detonate one drone: it rolls its Output Rating in dice (capped at 5) against the Soak of everything within Melee range of it, then it is destroyed.
- **Intercept Protocol** (Lesser, 3 pts): Once per round, when an ally within Melee range of one of your drones is attacked, the drone throws itself in the way and the attack resolves against the drone instead.
- **Hot-Swap Firmware** (Greater, 6 pts): Reconfigure a deployed drone into a different type with a Slow action and 1 Ki, instead of 2 hours of work.
- **Hive Autonomy** (Greater, 6 pts): Give each drone a standing order when you deploy it - conditions and sequences included - and it carries it out with no further commands, including while you are jacked in elsewhere or unconscious. Can't be taken with **Manual Control** or **One at a Time**.

LIMITERS

- **Short Leash**: drones (and Jack In) stop functioning beyond Close range of you.
- **One at a Time**: while jacked into one drone, every other deployed drone freezes in place until you disengage.
- **Fragile Fleet**: drones' Health Levels are permanently 1 lower at every Level, minimum 1.
- **Exposed While Jacked**: Level 5's "still take Fast actions" benefit never applies - your

body stays fully defenseless the whole time, at every Level.

- **Line of Signal**: Your drones need a clear signal. Any drone you can't see - behind a wall, through thick smoke, around a corner - freezes in place until you can see it again, and you can't Jack In to it.
- **Feedback**: Every drone is wired into your nerves. When one is destroyed, lose 1 Ki; if you were jacked into it, you also take 1 Health Level.
- **Narrow Fabrication**: You can only build three of the nine drone types, chosen at creation. Reconfiguring only ever moves between those three.
- **Manual Control**: Your drones act only on rounds in which you spend a Fast action giving orders - skip it and every drone holds still.
- **Loud Swarm**: Your drones are loud, bright and ugly. While any is deployed you have Disadvantage on Stealth, and bystanders who see them panic or call for help.

1 - Deploy Drones: spend 1 Ki as a Slow action to deploy up to **2** drones from your gear, each built as one of nine types (below), chosen when constructed. Reconfiguring a drone into a different type takes **2 hours** of dedicated work outside of combat - the drone count never changes, just what each one is. Drones last until destroyed or recalled. **Jack In**: as a Normal action, sync fully with one deployed drone, adding **+2** to its Output Rating for as long as you stay jacked in - but your own body goes still and undefended (no actions, can't notice threats) until you disengage (a Fast action) or the drone is destroyed.

2 - Deploy up to **3** drones. Output Rating rises to **3**.

3 - Deploy up to **4** drones. Output Rating rises to **4**.

DRONE SWARM (CONTINUED)

4 - Deploy up to **5** drones. Output Rating rises to **5**. **Overwatch:** when a drone is destroyed, spend 1 Ki to have it use its type ability one last time, at its current Output Rating, before it goes down.

5 - Output Rating rises to **6**, and your body is no longer fully defenseless while jacked in - it can still take Fast actions (moving, ducking for cover), just not perceive normally. Once per Scene, spend **2 Ki per Combat-type drone firing for Full Barrage:** every Combat-type drone you command fires at once, all their dice pooled into a single attack against one target. Each drone's dice are capped individually first, then pooled; the pool itself has no ceiling.

DUPLICATION

One of you is just a start. You can split yourself into copies. The copies have your face, your skills, and your memories up to the moment of the split. They are all you. It gets weird, but at least you all have the same taste in movies, right?

This Gift always costs Ki, at every Level. There is no mastery discount to free. You can dismiss any or all of your clones instantly, at will, no action required.

ADDDERS

- **Tougher Copies** (Lesser, 3 pts): your clones' Health Levels rise from 1 to 2.
- **Delayed Pop** (Lesser, 3 pts): when a clone would pop, spend 1 Ki to instead let it survive at 0 Health Levels for one more action before vanishing.
- **Combined Strike** (Greater, 6 pts): two or more clones (or you and a clone) attacking the same target in the same round add their dice pools together into a single attack roll, instead of resolving separately.
- **Hollow Copies** (Lesser, 3 pts): for 1 Ki, create two hollow copies instead of one clone; together they count as a single clone against your cap. A hollow copy can't attack, carry or touch anything and pops on any contact, but looks and sounds exactly like you.
- **Body Swap** (Lesser, 3 pts): as a Fast action, swap places with any clone you can currently direct. No Ki.
- **Shared Eyes** (Lesser, 3 pts): you perceive through one clone of your choice in real time, not only when it ends; switching which clone is a Fast action.
- **Shell Game** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki as a Fast action while at least one clone is within Close range of you; until you attack or take a Slow action, attacks against you are at Disadvantage from anyone who didn't see the shuffle from Melee range.

DUPLICATION (CONTINUED)

- **Substitution** (Greater, 6 pts): once per round, when an attack would connect with you, spend 1 Ki to swap places with a clone within Close range; the attack strikes the clone instead and it pops.
- **Clone Burst** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki when a clone pops or you dismiss it: it bursts, rolling your Duplication Level + half your Ferocity against the Soak of everyone at Melee range with it.

LIMITERS

- **Shared Pain**: whenever a clone pops, you take 1 unsoakable Health Level and are at Disadvantage on your next roll.
- **Slow Split**: creating a clone is a Slow action instead of instantaneous, at every Level.
- **One Mind**: clones can't act independently - every clone takes the exact same action you do, on your turn, mirrored rather than directed separately.
- **Severed Reach**: you must physically touch a clone to reabsorb it early and gain its memories - the Gift's normal instant, no-action remote dismissal doesn't apply.
- **Memory Flood**: whenever two or more clones end in the same round, the returning memories hit at once and you are Distracted until the end of your next turn.
- **Divided Strength**: while one or more clones exist, you and every clone roll 1 fewer die on every attack.
- **Anchor Body**: the moment you lose a Health Level, every clone you have pops at once. Can't be taken with **Shared Pain**.

1 - Spend **1 Ki** to create one duplicate of yourself: identical in appearance and Skills, but with only **1 Health Level**, popping instantly on any connecting hit. It acts immediately after you in the turn order, taking a Fast or Normal action each round (never Slow), and must stay within your line of sight. Lasts up to a Minute or until it pops. When it pops, or the duration ends, you instantly know everything it experienced.

2 - Duration extends to a **Scene**.

3 - You can maintain **2** clones at once, for a second **1 Ki**. Clones can use your Boons and Skills fully, as if they were you.

4 - You can maintain **3** clones at once, and they're no longer bound by line of sight, so long as you know roughly where they are. Clones can spend your Ki to use your Gifts too, drawing from the same pool you have.

5 - You can maintain **5** clones at once, with no range limit at all.

ELEMENTAL AURA

You can surround yourself with a mantle of power. It wraps you in a cloak of energy, protecting you and lashing out at any threat that dares touch you. You choose whether it burns, freezes, distorts, radiates, crackles or defies description - within its reach, the world itself begins to obey the nature of your power.

"Element" is a broad catch-all, not limited to the four classical elements - fire, ice, lightning, steam, darkness, radiation, cosmic energy, void, magnetism, or whatever else fits what you actually are. Chosen once, at creation.

Activating the aura is a Slow action. **Maintaining it requires a Gift Check every turn it stays active - failure costs 1 Ki, at any Level.** At Level 5, a turn spent lashing out with the aura (below) skips the maintenance check entirely, since spending Ki to attack already covers the cost.

ELEMENTAL AURA (CONTINUED)

ADDDERS

- **Environmental Surge** (Lesser, 3 pts): +1 Ki. For one round, the Level 4 environmental effect pushes out one Range Band further than normal.
- **Elemental Weapon** (Lesser, 3 pts): imbue a held weapon with your aura's element - it deals your current contact damage type alongside its own, no extra Ki cost.
- **Elemental Burst** (Greater, 6 pts): +1 Ki, once per activation. Pulse the aura outward - everyone within your current trigger range (whatever Melee/Close/Near your Level currently reaches) takes your contact damage simultaneously, not just someone who happens to touch or strike you.
- **Quick Kindle** (Lesser, 3 pts): activating the aura is a Fast action instead of Slow.
- **Banked Embers** (Lesser, 3 pts): you may hold the aura inward: invisible and dealing no contact damage, but still removing dice from attacks of your element. Flaring it to full is a Fast action. Can't be taken with **Visible Aura**.
- **Searing Hold** (Lesser, 3 pts): while you are Grabbed or grabbing someone, they take your contact damage at the start of every one of your turns, no attack needed.
- **Flashpoint** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you lose a Health Level while the aura is up, it flares: your next contact damage this Scene rolls 2 extra dice, no Ki.
- **Shelter in the Storm** (Greater, 6 pts): one ally at Melee range with you also has incoming attacks of your element reduced by your aura, exactly as yours are.
- **Drink the Element** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when your aura removes every die of an incoming elemental attack (Level 4+), spend 1 Ki to regain 1 Health Level. Requires Level 4.

LIMITERS

- **Vulnerable Opposite**: you take double dice from attacks of one specific opposing element (GM-set to fit your chosen element, e.g. a fire aura leaves you vulnerable to ice).
- **Visible Aura**: the aura is always visibly active whenever raised - it can never be raised discreetly or concealed.
- **Exhausting Maintenance**: the Gift Check's failure cost rises to 2 Ki instead of 1, at every Level.
- **Backburn**: whenever the aura deals damage, roll 1 die against your own Soak as well - the element doesn't spare you.
- **Temper Leak**: whenever you lose a Health Level, the aura raises itself (no action, maintenance still due) and can't be dropped before the end of your next turn; raised this way, it strikes allies who touch you as readily as foes.
- **Fed by the Source**: the aura can only be raised while a real source of your element is within Near range (a flame, a storm, a live cable); losing the source drops it at the end of the round.

1 - Before an incoming attack of your chosen element resolves, remove one quarter of its dice (rounded down), then resolve the rest normally against your Soak. Anyone who touches you takes **1 + half your Ferocity** vs their Soak.

2 - Remove half of an incoming elemental attack's dice (rounded down) before it resolves. Contact damage rises to **2 + half your Ferocity**.

3 - Remove three quarters of an incoming elemental attack's dice (rounded down). The trigger widens from requiring actual touch to anyone striking you at Melee range - damage rises to **3 + half your Ferocity**.

ELEMENTAL AURA (CONTINUED)

4 - Full immunity - all dice from an incoming attack of your chosen element are removed before it resolves; nothing gets through. Contact/Melee damage rises to **4 + half your Ferocity**. The aura's presence extends to Close range: anyone nearby (not just attacking you) suffers a minor environmental effect fitting the element, GM-adjudicated to theme.

5 - Immunity persists. Damage rises to **5 + half your Ferocity**. The aura can be projected as an attack: spend **1 Ki** to strike a target at Near range without contact, same per-die-vs-Soak resolution - doing so on a turn skips that turn's maintenance Gift Check.

ELEMENTAL MANIPULATION

The elements answer your call - fire dances, gravity warps, shadows writhe, electricity crackles - all obeying your will. You don't command an element in a single, practiced way. You are an improvisational artist, finding new ways to alter the world with your will when the need arises.

Your domain - fire, darkness, gravity, time, the weather, the temperature of a room, even what people perceive as real - is chosen once, at creation.

This Gift never deals direct damage, at any Level.

ADDDERS

- **Layered Effect** (Lesser, 3 pts): create two Level 1-scope effects with a single roll and action instead of one.
- **Domain Echo** (Lesser, 3 pts): an effect you create leaves a passive lingering trace after it ends (residual heat, faint darkness, static in the air) lasting a Scene - detectable by anyone investigating, no mechanical effect of its own.
- **Anchor the Domain** (Greater, 6 pts): the Level 5 merge lasts a full Scene instead of one Round, still once per Scene.
- **Domain Sense** (Lesser, 3 pts): while a zone of yours is up, you know where everyone inside it is and can't be Surprised by anything within it.
- **Precision Working** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki when you aim a Level 1 effect at one creature (darkness over only their eyes, frost locking one knee); on a success they are Blinded, Deafened, Off Balance or Prone (your choice, fitting the domain) until the end of their next turn.
- **Snap Shaping** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per round you may make the Level 1 roll as a Fast action, at Disadvantage.

ELEMENTAL MANIPULATION (CONTINUED)

- **Living Construct** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to shape a person-sized construct of your domain that lasts a Scene, acts right after you and takes one Fast or Normal action per round - carrying, blocking a doorway, holding someone Grabbed. It deals no damage and collapses on any connecting hit.
- **Second Domain** (Greater, 6 pts): choose a second domain when you buy this; every Level of the Gift works with both, and one effect may blend them (steam from fire and water, a storm of shadow).

LIMITERS

- **Single Sense Domain:** your effects only ever manifest through one sense at a time (sight-only, sound-only, etc.) - Level 1's "full sensory picture" never applies.
- **Elemental Purity:** you can only manipulate a literal instance of your element already present in the scene (no darkness in broad daylight, no fire without an existing spark) - GM's call on availability.
- **Costly Merge:** the Level 5 merge always costs 1 Ki to trigger, never free.
- **Conducted:** every effect needs both hands free and broad, visible gestures; while Grabbed or holding anything, the Gift doesn't work.
- **Weather of the Heart:** whenever you become Frightened or Flustered or lose a Health Level, your domain lashes out unbidden - the GM creates one Level 1 effect of their choice around you.
- **Held by Will:** your zones and ongoing effects end the moment you're Distracted or lose a Health Level (Level 4 permanent effects excepted).
- **Slow Hands:** the Level 1 roll is a Slow action instead of Normal. Can't be taken with **Snap Shaping**.

1 - Roll **Moire + Difficulty** to shape an effect within your domain that touches a full sensory picture (not just one sense) or physically moves/reshapes something person-sized (a body's worth of matter, a room's worth of shadow, a sound that isn't really there, the temperature of a room). No Range Band limit, works anywhere you can perceive or clearly reach with it. Is a Normal action. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - You can now blanket an area instead of a single target or point. Spend **1 Ki** to create a zone (spreading true darkness, a field of magnetic interference, a sudden downpour, a shared false vision everyone inside perceives the same way) that imposes Disadvantage on anyone inside acting against you, lasting up to a Scene.

3 - The area effect scales to something building-sized or block-sized (a full weather shift over a neighborhood, a false skyline that fools anyone looking). Ki cost rises to **2**. You can also physically move or reshape something correspondingly large within your domain with no roll, so long as it's plausible for the element.

4 - Any effect you create (the area zone, a moved or reshaped object, a false sensory scene) can be made **permanent** instead of temporary, for an extra **1 Ki** spent when you create it.

5 - Once per Scene, you can briefly merge with your own domain (a body of living shadow, a drifting cloud of embers, a knot of pure magnetism) for a Round, immune to Physical damage while merged, though you still can't deal damage yourself. Ki cost for the Level 2 area effect drops to **0**.

ENHANCED SPEED

You move faster than most people can comprehend. Nerves fire faster and muscle moves you more rapidly than a human frame should be capable of. Thought and action compress into fractions of a second. The world seems to pause when you decide to act.

The extra action this Gift grants can never be a Slow action, at any Level - moving this fast isn't conducive to the precision a Slow action demands.

The Disadvantage imposed on attackers (Levels 4-5) doesn't apply if the attacker has Enhanced Speed at the same Level - matched speed cancels the edge; only someone slower than you gets caught flat-footed by it.

ADDDERS

- **Redirected Momentum** (Lesser, 3 pts): +1 Ki, on an extra-action turn. Instead of (or alongside) attacking, shove or reposition a target you interact with by half your Movement Rate.
- **Blink Step** (Lesser, 3 pts): on a turn you spend Ki for the extra action, you may also move your full Movement Rate as a free action, not counted against your normal movement.
- **Afterimage** (Greater, 6 pts): +1 Ki, once per round, on an extra-action turn. When an attack against you would connect, treat it as striking an afterimage instead - the hit is negated entirely.
- **Slow-Motion Eye** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki before defending against a ranged or thrown attack to defend with Advantage - you watch it come in slow motion.
- **Running Start** (Lesser, 3 pts): on a Ki-spend turn, an attack made at the end of a move of at least one Range Band knocks the target Off Balance if any die connects.
- **Blur Work** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to finish a non-combat task that would take up to a

Minute (searching a room, packing a bag, reading a file) in a single Round.

- **Rescue Sweep** (Lesser, 3 pts): on a Ki-spend turn, you may carry one ally or bystander along with your movement, no penalty, and set them down anywhere on your path.
- **Unleashed** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, declare you've stopped holding back: for the rest of the Scene the extra-action spend may be used one more time per round than your Level allows. When the Scene ends you are Exhausted.

LIMITERS

- **Winded**: after the third extra-action Ki spend in a single Scene, you're at Disadvantage on all rolls until you get a short rest.
- **Loud and Fast**: using the extra-action spend, at any Level, is always audible and visible to anyone nearby - no stealth use of this Gift.
- **Straight Line Only**: the extra action's movement can only be used to move in a straight line - no sharp turns or complex maneuvering on a Ki-spend turn.
- **Can't Stop on a Dime**: on a Ki-spend turn you must use your full multiplied Movement Rate; if walls, crowds or the scene prevent it, you're Off Balance at the end of the turn.
- **Ravenous**: after any Scene in which you used the extra-action spend, you must eat a large meal before your next rest, or you start your next Scene Exhausted.
- **Paper Frame**: on a turn you use the extra-action spend, the first hit that connects with you costs 1 extra Health Level.

1 - At the beginning of combat, you may take one Fast or Normal action before anyone else acts - before even the Fast Action Bracket resolves. If more than one character has this Gift, they act among themselves in Initiative order, but all still act before the normal turn order begins.

ENHANCED SPEED (CONTINUED)

2 - Once per round, you may spend **1 Ki** to take an additional Fast action, resolved immediately after your normal action for that round - it doesn't change your Action Bracket or Initiative position, just adds a second action on top. For the rest of that turn after spending the Ki, your **Movement Rate** is **x1.5**.

3 - The extra action from Level 2 can now be a Fast **or Normal** action, still 1 Ki, still once per round. Roll Initiative as 2d10 and keep the higher die. The post-Ki-spend Movement Rate multiplier rises to **x2** for the rest of that turn.

4 - The extra-action spend can now be used **up to twice per round** (still 1 Ki per use). On any turn where you've spent Ki this way, attacks made against you that turn are at **Disadvantage** - you're moving too fast to track cleanly. The post-Ki-spend Movement Rate multiplier rises to **x3** for the rest of that turn.

5 - The extra-action spend can now be used **up to three times per round** (still 1 Ki per use, still Fast or Normal only). Attacks made against you are at Disadvantage on any turn you spend Ki this way. The post-Ki-spend Movement Rate multiplier rises to **x5** for the rest of that turn.

ENTHRALL

When you enter a room, everyone feels it - eyes fall on you, attention settles and it becomes difficult to care about anything else. You might inspire fascination, awe or dread. You don't command anyone to do anything, you are simply the most compelling person in the room.

As with any Social attack, additional Ki Infusion (1 Ki per die) can push individual dice further by adding your own Presence, per the usual rule.

ADDDERS

- **Voice and Image** (Lesser, 3 pts): works through a live phone call or video feed - the target doesn't need to be in the same physical space, but it has to be real-time.
- **Recorded Echo** (Greater, 6 pts): the effect also works through a pre-recorded message - a video, a voicemail, a broadcast - landing on the target without you present or even active at the time it lands.
- **Undeniable** (Greater, 6 pts): at Level 4+, a connecting die also grants you Advantage on your very next direct Social roll against that same target this Scene, stacking with the passive lock.
- **Dread Made Flesh** (Lesser, 3 pts): a target locked in dread is Frightened of you while within Close range of you.
- **Rapture** (Lesser, 3 pts): a target locked in fascination is Distracted whenever it acts against anyone other than you.
- **Rallying Awe** (Lesser, 3 pts): allies you've locked in awe can't be Frightened while they can see you.
- **Dim the Light** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki as a Fast action to turn your presence inside out for a Scene: you draw no attention, and gain Advantage on rolls to blend into a crowd or go unnoticed.

ENTHRALL (CONTINUED)

- **Command the Room** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, as a Slow action, everyone currently locked onto you stops and watches you for 1 Round, taking no actions unless attacked.

LIMITERS

- **Must Be Seen:** the target has to actually see you, not just hear you - kills any voice-only or audio-only use.
- **Single Target Only:** the Level 2+ multi-target/crowd expansion never applies, regardless of Level bought - always resolves against one target.
- **Fades Fast:** the lock still lasts the full Scene, but only while you actively concentrate on maintaining it - losing focus (Distracted, taking an unrelated Slow action, or similar) ends it immediately instead of it lingering passively.
- **Feel It First:** you can only project an emotion you honestly feel; while you're Frightened or Flustered the Gift won't activate at all.
- **They Remember:** everyone you affect knows afterward that something was done to them; once the Scene ends you're at Disadvantage on Social rolls against anyone you've locked.
- **Devotees:** people you lock don't let go: once per session the GM brings one back at the worst possible moment, wanting your attention.

1 - Requires the target to perceive you. Spend **1 Ki**; make the standard to-hit roll (**Fire** vs. their **Social Defense**). On success, roll **1 + half your Presence** dice per-die against their Presence wall - a connecting die locks their attention onto you for the scene: awe, dread, or fascination, your choice. No specific action compelled, just overwhelming presence.

2 - Dice rise to **2 + half your Presence**. Effect now reaches everyone perceiving you within Close range - each target gets their own to-hit roll and, on success, their own dice vs. their Presence wall.

3 - Dice rise to **3 + half your Presence**. You may split the effect's flavor by target in the same use - dread for hostiles, awe or magnetism for allies/bystanders.

4 - **No to-hit roll required anymore** - your presence is overwhelming enough that it simply rolls **4 + half your Presence** dice per-die against the target's Presence wall directly. Repeated exposure builds a hold: each successful use on the same person grants **Advantage** on your next attempt against them, cumulative, lasting until they're away from you for an extended stretch (GM's call).

5 - Dice rise to **5 + half your Presence**, still no to-hit roll needed. Range extends to everyone perceiving you within Near, and a natural 10 on any die (not just a connect) causes the target to freeze or flee outright for a Round, unable to act against you at all.

FLIGHT

Gravity is a mere suggestion for you. You can fly somehow. Whether you manipulate gravity, grow wings, or ride the currents of the aetheric wind, you are no longer tethered to the ground.

ADDDERS

- **Passenger Overload** (Lesser, 3 pts): 1 Ki. Carry more than one person while flying (Level 4+ only).
- **Dive Bomb** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to slam into a target from the air - Potence dice vs. their Soak, Close range only.

FLIGHT (CONTINUED)

- **Sonic Boom** (Greater, 6 pts): 1 Ki. Everyone at Close range along your flight path takes 2d10 vs Soak and is knocked Prone if any die connects. Usable any time you move at flying speed, no cap on uses beyond the Ki cost itself.
- **Sky Perch** (Lesser, 3 pts): on a turn you hover without moving, your ranged attacks against grounded targets have Advantage.
- **Last-Instant Catch** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per round, spend 1 Ki to move your full flying Movement Rate outside your turn to catch a falling or thrown person or object.
- **Downdraft** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki as a Normal action while airborne: everyone at Close range below you is Off Balance, and smoke, gas or loose debris there is blown clear.
- **Barrel Roll** (Greater, 6 pts): when you pay the Level 3 juke, its Advantage applies to every attack against you until your next turn, not just the one.
- **Lend the Sky** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to grant one ally within Close range your Level 1 flight for a Scene.

LIMITERS

- **Vulnerable Silhouette**: you're always visible against the sky while flying, no concealment possible - Disadvantage on any Stealth roll made while airborne.
- **Fair Weather Flier**: you can't fly in severe weather (storms, high wind, heavy turbulence) - GM's call on what qualifies.
- **Grounded Recovery**: if reduced to 0 Health Levels or knocked unconscious while flying, you fall and take normal fall damage - no automatic soft landing.
- **Clipped Wings**: your flight comes from wings or a rig; a Called Shot that costs you a Health Level on your back or arms grounds you until a Short Rest.

- **Low Ceiling**: you can never rise higher than a single-story roof; Level 2's hover out of Melee reach never applies.
- **Heavy Wings**: staying aloft isn't free: every round airborne after the first requires a Gift Check.
- **Needs a Launch**: taking off is a Slow action unless you drop from a height or run a full move first.

1 - You can hover in place or fly at your normal ground Movement Rate. Taking off or landing is a Fast action; staying aloft is free once airborne. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - Movement Rate while flying doubles. You can hover just out of Melee range of anything that can't also fly or reach that high, forcing grounded attackers to close the distance some other way.

3 - Movement Rate while flying triples. Spend **1 Ki**, when an attack targets you in the air, to juke through open air for **Advantage** on your defense.

4 - Movement Rate while flying rises to **x5**, fast enough to close or open a full Range Band as part of a single move. You can carry one other person while flying with no penalty. Ki cost from Level 3 stays at 1.

5 - You break the sound barrier. Within a scene, you can cross from Far to Melee range (or the reverse) in a single move, no Range Band restriction. Ki cost for the evasive dodge from Level 3 drops to **0**.

FORCEFIELD

You can focus your will into a barrier that stands as a bulwark between you and the world. It may manifest as a shimmering bubble, an invisible wall of force or a solid shield. Whatever form it takes, it exists for one purpose - to stop whatever the world throws at it.

Chosen once, at creation: your Forcefield's **Form**.

FORCEFIELD (CONTINUED)

1. **Wielded Shield** - held in one hand, front arc only, matching a real ballistic shield's own limits. Hardness and Health Levels are always **+1** above the numbers below. Covers only yourself - never projects onto an ally, at any Level.
2. **Bubble Barrier** - no hands required. Instead of a single target, it covers **everyone** within its current range, including you - starting at Melee (Level 1), extending to Close (Level 3) and Near (Level 4), same range numbers as below just read as a radius. Hardness and Health Levels are always **-2** below the numbers listed.
3. **Personal Barrier** - exactly as below: full Hardness and Health Levels, covers all four Zones, a single target (yourself, or one ally within range once Level 3+).

The barrier occupies the same Zone(s) as any worn armor and follows the normal rule that **armor doesn't stack within a Zone** - raising it over a Zone that's already covered by real armor replaces that armor's protection for as long as the barrier holds, it doesn't add to it.

Maintaining the barrier requires a Gift Check every turn it stays up - failure costs 1 Ki, at any Level.

ADDDERS

- **Reinforced Barrier** (Lesser, 3 pts): the barrier's Health Levels rise by 1, at every Level.
- **Instant Raise** (Lesser, 3 pts): activating the barrier is a Fast action instead of Normal.
- **Shared Burden** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when someone the barrier covers would lose a Health Level to a hit it didn't stop, spend 1 Ki to redirect that loss to the barrier's own Health Levels instead.
- **Wide Guard** (Greater, 6 pts): Personal Barrier can cover up to two allies simultaneously once you reach Level 3, each

tracked separately (no effect on Wielded Shield or Bubble Barrier).

- **Stepping Panes** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to set small barrier platforms in the air for a Scene; you and allies can climb and stand on them anywhere within Near range.
- **Ward Line** (Lesser, 3 pts): lay a faint barrier across a doorway, path or window for a Scene; it stops nothing, but you know the instant anything crosses it.
- **Standing Wall** (Greater, 6 pts): raise the barrier as a flat wall anywhere within Close range instead of on a body; it blocks passage and attacks across it, with the same Hardness and Health Levels.
- **Rebound** (Greater, 6 pts): when the barrier's Hardness stops every die of an attack, spend 1 Ki to throw it back: roll your Forcefield Level + half your Ferocity against the attacker's Soak.
- **Barrier Cage** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to raise the barrier around one foe at Close range instead: they can't leave it or attack out of it until its Health Levels are broken from either side.
- **Fortification** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 2 Ki to lock down the place you are standing in for a Scene. Every door, window, vent and other way in or out is sealed by the barrier, each one with the barrier's Hardness and Health Levels, tracked separately. Walls, floor and ceiling use your barrier's Hardness in place of their own if it is higher. Nothing passes a sealed opening, and attacks can't be made through one, until its Health Levels are broken; you know the instant one is struck. The lockdown covers a room at Levels 1-2, a floor of a building at Level 3, and a whole building at Level 4 and up. It lasts until the Scene ends, you leave, or you drop it as a Fast action. The Gift Check to keep the barrier up still applies each turn. Requires Level 2.

FORCEFIELD (CONTINUED)

LIMITERS

- **One at a Time:** Personal Barrier can never be raised for yourself and an ally simultaneously - projecting it onto someone else means going without it yourself.
- **Slow to Reform:** once depleted, the barrier can't be raised again until a Short Rest, regardless of Level.
- **Visible Shimmer:** the barrier is always visibly active whenever raised, a faint shimmer anyone can notice - no way to conceal that it's up.
- **Exhausting Maintenance:** the Gift Check's failure cost rises to 2 Ki instead of 1, at every Level.
- **Cracks Run Deep:** when the barrier loses its last Health Level, you lose 1 Health Level too.
- **Planted:** you can't move from where you stand while the barrier is up.
- **Sealed In:** the barrier gets in your way too. While it covers you, any attack you or anyone else inside it makes against a target outside the barrier is at Disadvantage. Attacks between people inside the barrier are made normally.

1 - As a **Normal action**, no Ki cost, raise the barrier: **Hardness 3, Health Levels 2** (before your Form's modifier), resolved with the exact same two-stage mechanic as **worn armor** - it covers **all four** Zones at once. Lasts until depleted or dismissed (a Fast action to drop early).

2 - Hardness rises to **4**, Health Levels rise to **3**.

3 - Hardness rises to **5**, Health Levels rise to **4**. Personal Barrier may now be raised over one ally within Melee range instead of yourself; Bubble Barrier's radius extends to Close.

4 - Hardness rises to **6**, Health Levels rise to **5**. Personal Barrier's ally range extends to Close; Bubble Barrier's radius extends to Near.

5 - Hardness rises to **7**, Health Levels rise to **6**.

Once per Scene, spend **1 Ki** to instantly restore a depleted barrier to full Health Levels, re-raising it as a Fast action.

GADGETEER

Tinfoil, bubble gum, baling wire, a pile of junk and a workbench are all you need to make something useful. Parts that should never be in the same space work together flawlessly in your hands. Circuits are built without schematics and impossible configurations emerge from the chaos in your backpack. It may look like the innards of a VCR taped to a tennis racket, but that ionizing radiation detector works exactly as intended.

ADDERS

- **Stockpile** (Lesser, 3 pts): during downtime, pre-build up to 2 gadgets ahead of time to carry with you, ready to use later without spending build time in the moment.
- **Salvage Loop** (Lesser, 3 pts): when a gadget you built breaks or is destroyed, gain Advantage on your next Gadgeteer roll.
- **Overclock** (Greater, 6 pts): spend an extra 1 Ki when building a gadget to push it one function or damage/defense tier beyond what your Level normally allows. That gadget breaks after a single use, win or lose.
- **Trusty Contraption** (Lesser, 3 pts): one named gadget of yours never exhausts its purpose; if it breaks, repairing it is a Fast action, no roll.
- **Field Repair** (Lesser, 3 pts): roll Air + Difficulty as a Normal action to get a broken device, vehicle or piece of armor working again for the rest of the Scene.
- **Booby Trap** (Lesser, 3 pts): a combat gadget may be set as a trap; it triggers on the first person to come within Melee range of it, who is Surprised against it.

GADGETEER (CONTINUED)

- **Tech Talk** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend a Normal action explaining how your gadget works, out loud, to everyone present; its next use gains Advantage.
- **Kitbash** (Greater, 6 pts): as a Normal action, merge two of your working gadgets into one, keeping every function of both even beyond your Level's function cap.

LIMITERS

- **Finite Supply**: you need physical scrap or parts on hand to build anything - this Gift doesn't work with empty hands in a bare room.
- **One and Done**: only one Gadgeteer-built device can be functional at a time - building a new one instantly disables the previous one.
- **Loud Construction**: building a gadget, at any Level, is never quiet - always audible or visibly obvious, no stealthy use.
- **Prototype Jitters**: every use of a combat gadget needs a Gift Check; on a failure the gadget breaks after this use, instead of costing Ki.
- **Only You Understand It**: no one else can use your gadgets - in anyone else's hands they do nothing.
- **Kaboom**: when one of your gadgets breaks, it goes off: roll 2 dice against the Soak of whoever holds it (usually you).

1 - Given scrap and roughly an hour of focused work, roll **Air + Difficulty** (GM sets Difficulty by how complex the gadget is) to build one simple, single-function gadget - a lockpick set, a basic signal jammer, a simple sensor, a makeshift flashlight upgrade. It works reliably until broken or its narrow purpose is exhausted. A gadget may carry a minor combat function (a shock prod dealing **1d10**, a shim granting **+1** Soak); those cost **1 Ki** to build, pure-utility ones are free.

2 - Build time drops to just a few minutes regardless of complexity. Gadgets can now have **two** functions instead of one, and a combat function rises to **3d10** damage or **+3** to a defensive stat.

3 - You can now build a gadget on the fly, mid-combat, as a single Fast or Normal action, improvising from whatever's on hand. Gadgets can have up to **three** functions. Combat-relevant gadgets scale up - **2d10** damage, or **+2** to a defensive stat. Ki cost for combat-capable gadgets rises to **2**.

4 - Building a gadget is now only a **Fast** action. Gadgets can have up to **four** functions. Combat-relevant gadgets scale to **4d10** damage or **+4** to a defensive stat. Ki cost for combat-capable gadgets rises to **3**.

5 - Combat-relevant gadgets scale to **5d10** damage or **+5** to a defensive stat. Gadgets can have up to **five** functions. Ki cost drops back to **2** for combat-capable gadgets. Additionally, once per session, you can build one extraordinary one-off device capable of a dramatic, GM-approved effect beyond the normal function cap - a signature invention.

GRACE PERIOD

You cannot run away from the consequences of your actions, but you can make them wait in line. You can make the universe hold back for a brief while - taking a moment to take a deep breath before the tidal wave of action and reaction crashes over you. You still hurt. The trap still goes off. The disaster still arrives... you just get to decide when.

This Gift always costs Ki, at every Level. There is no mastery discount to free.

ADDERS

- **Shared Reprieve** (Lesser, 3 pts): the same Ki spend delays a second, separate consequence at the same time, not just one.

GRACE PERIOD (CONTINUED)

- **Preemptive Ward** (Lesser, 3 pts): use this Gift before a consequence has even happened. If the thing you're warding against occurs within the next Round, it's automatically caught and delayed, no reaction timing needed.
- **Partial Release** (Greater, 6 pts): when a delayed consequence finally lands, spend 1 extra Ki (paid at the original delay) to reduce its severity by one step (GM's call) instead of it landing at full force.
- **Appointed Hour** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you delay a consequence, you may name the exact moment within the duration when it lands (when you're across the bridge, when the guard walks under it).
- **Sense of the Hour** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, spend 1 Ki when you would be Surprised; you aren't - you felt the consequence queuing up.
- **Hold That Thought** (Lesser, 3 pts): any condition (Staggered, Frightened, Envenomed, Exhausted and the like) counts as a minor consequence, so Level 1's 1 Ki can hold it off for 1 Round.
- **Redirected Reckoning** (Greater, 6 pts): when a delayed consequence lands, spend 1 Ki to have it land on something else in its path instead - an object, or a foe now standing where you were.
- **Not Now** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend 3 Ki: every Health Level you would lose for the rest of the Scene is held back, and they all land together when the Scene ends.

LIMITERS

- **Debt Comes Due**: when a delayed consequence finally lands, it lands harder, worsened by one step (GM's call) rather than landing as originally sized.
- **Self Only**: you can only ever delay consequences affecting yourself, never someone else.

- **No Renewal**: Level 5's renewal clause never applies. The Month-long delay always lapses for good at the end of its duration.
- **Spoken Stay**: you must name the consequence aloud to delay it; while gagged, silenced or otherwise unable to speak, the Gift doesn't work.
- **One Debt at a Time**: you can hold only one delayed consequence at once; delaying a new one releases the old immediately. Can't be taken with **Shared Reprieve**.
- **Unmoored**: every use leaves you out of step with time: you're Off Balance until the end of your next turn.

1 - Spend **1 Ki** to delay a minor consequence already in motion by **1 Round**, just long enough to react. No roll.

2 - Delay a real, meaningful consequence (an injury's onset, a trap already sprung) for up to a **Minute**. Ki cost rises to **2**.

3 - Delay something looming over the whole scene (a curse taking hold, a countdown to disaster) for the rest of the **Scene**. Ki cost rises to **3**.

4 - Delay something major and lasting (an injury that should be crippling, a deadline with real stakes) for a full **Day**. Ki cost rises to **4**.

5 - Hold off almost anything for up to a **Month**, so long as you renew the effect with another 1 Ki before it lapses. Ki cost for the initial delay rises to **5**.

HEALING

With a touch, you remind the body of what it is. Sickness fades and wounds close under your hands. Even fatal illnesses and afflictions that should linger are healed by your attention.

HEALING (CONTINUED)

This Gift always costs Ki, at every Level. There is no mastery discount to free.

Additionally, given dedicated care each Day, you can heal away a Physical scar entirely, on someone else, in **Days equal to how far below 0 their Health went**. Healing never touches a Mental or Social scar.

ADDERS

- **Second Hands** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend a second 1 Ki to heal a second target in the same Round, bypassing the normal once-per-Round cap.
- **Lingering Mend** (Lesser, 3 pts): a Health Level you restore gains a one-time buffer: the next hit that would take it away is negated instead.
- **Preventive Dose** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to grant a target Advantage against contracting poison or disease for the rest of the scene, used before exposure rather than after.
- **Triage Touch** (Lesser, 3 pts): as a Fast action, touch a target to learn exactly how many Health Levels they've lost and every poison, disease, curse or condition on them, hidden ones included. No Ki.
- **Soothing Hands** (Lesser, 3 pts): the same touch and 1 Ki can instead clear Frightened or Flustered from the target, calming the mind as well as the body.
- **Borrowed Vigor** (Lesser, 3 pts): a willing target may pay any Ki cost of this Gift from their own Ki instead of yours.
- **Mending Circle** (Greater, 6 pts): as a Slow action, spend 3 Ki to restore 1 Health Level to every willing ally within Close range (Near at Level 3+). It counts as your use for the Round.
- **Pulled Back** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when a target within your healing range takes a hit, spend 2 Ki as a reaction,

outside your turn, to heal them at once, even if you've already healed this Round.

- **Undoing Touch** (Greater, 6 pts): run the Gift backward: spend 1 Ki and make an unarmed Melee attack that rolls your Level plus half your Ferocity in dice against Soak, reopening old wounds.

LIMITERS

- **Cost to Self**: healing another person costs you 1 unsoakable Health Level of your own per use, in addition to the Ki cost.
- **Willing Only**: you can never heal an unconscious or unwilling target. Level 1's "willing or unconscious" narrows to willing only.
- **Slow Hands**: every use of this Gift is a Slow action, at every Level.
- **Can't Heal Yourself**: this Gift never works on you, at any Level.
- **Patient Pays**: every use of this Gift leaves its target Exhausted until the end of the Scene; the body pays for its own repair.
- **Laying On of Hands**: every use needs bare-skin touch, at every Level. Level 3's range extension to Close never applies.
- **Must Understand the Wound**: any cure (poison, disease, curse or condition, not a restored Health Level) needs a successful Gift Check on top of its Ki cost. On a failure the cure doesn't take and the Ki is spent anyway.
- **Healer's Fatigue**: the third time you use this Gift in a Scene, and every use after, you become Exhausted until you rest.

1 - Touch a willing or unconscious target and spend **1 Ki** to instantly restore 1 Health Level. Usable once per Round. No Gift Check.

2 - The same touch and Ki spend can instead cure a mundane poison, disease, or negative physical condition, so long as it isn't already permanent.

HEALING (CONTINUED)

3 - Restores **2 Health Levels** per use instead of 1. Touch is no longer required, range extends to **Close**.

4 - Reaches supernatural-origin poisons, curses, and conditions too, not just mundane ones. Ki cost for a supernatural cure rises to **2**.

5 - Given a full **Day** of dedicated care and **3 Ki**, you can heal even normally-permanent harm on someone else: a lost limb, lasting disfigurement.

HEIGHTENED SENSES

Eyes like a hawk. Nose like a bloodhound. Ears like a bat. Your senses are more finely tuned than most. You hear distant sounds clearly. Darkness no longer hides things from you. The world is full of information that most people cannot perceive and you take it all in.

Which sense (or senses) sharpen, and how, is chosen once, at creation - enhanced hearing, night vision, telescopic sight, microscopic focus, or something else that fits the concept.

ADDERS

- **Cross-Sense Bleed** (Lesser, 3 pts): a second sense of your choice, different from your primary one, also gains Level 1's penalty-stripping benefit.
- **Danger Instinct** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, if your enhanced sense would detect something dangerous while you're not actively paying attention, you get a reflexive warning and Advantage on Initiative for that encounter.
- **Piercing Focus** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to pierce a barrier or concealment one tier beyond what your current Level would normally reach, for a single use.
- **Tell the Lie** (Lesser, 3 pts): Advantage on rolls to tell whether someone within Close range is lying or afraid, read off a racing heartbeat, the scent of sweat or a flicker in the eyes, whichever fits your sense.
- **Blind Fighter** (Lesser, 3 pts): if your chosen sense isn't sight, being Blinded doesn't give you Disadvantage against targets within Close range that your sense can pick up.
- **Signature Imprint** (Lesser, 3 pts): sense a person for a full Round and you know them again by that sense alone; disguise, darkness, a changed voice or a new face don't fool you.

HEIGHTENED SENSES (CONTINUED)

- **Shared Senses** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki and touch an ally; for the rest of the Scene, they gain your Level 1 benefit with your chosen sense.
- **Bullet Time** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Round, when an attack you can sense coming targets you, spend 1 Ki to impose Disadvantage on it.

LIMITERS

- **Overload:** using your sense in an overwhelming environment (a loud crowd, bright lights, thick smells) forces a Moira + Difficulty roll or you're Disadvantaged for a Round.
- **Single Direction:** your enhanced sense only covers a narrow cone, not all-around awareness. GM adjudicates facing.
- **Draining Focus:** obstacle-piercing always costs 1 Ki. Level 4's free upgrade never applies.
- **Dulled Elsewhere:** everything else fades while one sense runs hot: Disadvantage on any Perception roll that doesn't use your chosen sense.
- **Glass Nerves:** any effect that would leave you Blinded or Deafened (whichever matches your sense) lasts 1 Round longer, and you have Disadvantage resisting it.
- **Trance Focus:** piercing an obstacle (Level 3+) needs stillness: you're Distracted for as long as you keep it up.

1 - Perception rolls that rely on your chosen sense ignore ordinary environmental penalties tied to it - darkness for night vision, distance for telescopic sight, background noise for hearing, and so on. No roll of its own needed; it just strips the penalty layer whenever it would apply. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - Gain **Advantage** on all Perception rolls using your chosen sense. Its effective range extends significantly - perceive things at **Far** range that would normally require being much closer.

3 - Your sense gains microscopic-level detail at no extra cost - spot a single fingerprint across a room, hear a heartbeat, notice trace chemical residue by scent. Additionally, spend **1 Ki** to pierce an obstacle that would normally block your sense entirely - see through fog or a thin wall, hear through a door, etc.

4 - The obstacle-piercing from Level 3 no longer costs Ki, and now works through thicker, more substantial barriers - solid walls, multiple rooms away. Additionally, you're immune to being **Surprised** by any threat your enhanced sense would have detected.

5 - Your chosen sense becomes constant, passive awareness within **Far** range - you don't need to actively look or listen; relevant details and threats simply register automatically. Additionally, it can pierce even magical concealment or supernatural stealth, not just mundane obstacles (GM's call on edge cases specifically countering your exact sense).

IMMOVABLE

What happens when an irresistible force meets an immovable object? When you finally meet an irresistible force, you will let the rest of the world know. You stand against impossible forces. Attempts to move you aside feel like trying to shoulder a mountain aside. Once you plant your feet - it becomes a matter of overcoming your will.

ADDERS

- **Rooted Strike** (Lesser, 3 pts): when a forcing attempt against you fails, spend 1 Ki to counter-shove the attacker by half your Movement Rate.

IMMOVABLE (CONTINUED)

- **Planted** (Lesser, 3 pts): while you haven't moved this Round, you can't be made Off Balance or knocked Prone.
- **Living Wall** (Lesser, 3 pts): standing in a doorway, corridor or gap, you block it outright: no one can slip past or around you without first moving you.
- **Dead Weight** (Lesser, 3 pts): no one can drag or carry you against your will, and anyone you've Grabbed can't pull free by moving you; they have to break your hold.
- **Stored Impact** (Greater, 6 pts): when you resist a forcing attempt, spend 1 Ki to store the blow. Once before the Scene ends, release it: your next Potence roll or melee attack is at Advantage and a hit knocks the target Prone.
- **Unmoved Mind** (Greater, 6 pts): your footing reaches your will: Advantage against any effect that would make you move or flee against your will, including Frightened, commands and compulsions.
- **Grounding Field** (Lesser, 3 pts): as a Fast action, spend 1 Ki to extend your current Level's resistance to one touched ally for the rest of the Round.
- **Unbreakable Line** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when an ally within Melee range would be forcibly moved, spend 1 Ki to intercept the effect. It targets you instead, resolved against your own resistance.

LIMITERS

- **Flat Feet:** after you resist a forcing attempt with this Gift, your Movement Rate is halved for the next 2 Rounds.
- **One Failure, Done:** if you're ever successfully moved despite this Gift, all its benefits stop for the rest of the Scene.
- **No Bracing:** this Gift's benefits don't apply if you're Surprised or otherwise unaware of the attempt against you.
- **Feet on the Ground:** this Gift only works while you stand on solid ground: not mid-

jump, climbing, swimming, on ice or while Prone.

- **Stone in Water:** you can't swim. In deep water you sink and must walk out along the bottom, holding your breath.
- **Never Step Back:** a vow: you can never move away from an enemy who is in Melee with you. You may hold or advance, never retreat.
- **Bearing the Load:** after you resist a supernatural forcing attempt, you're Exhausted until the end of the Scene.

1 - Gain **Advantage** on any roll to resist being pushed, tripped, knocked back, or thrown - including a Potence-based forcing attempt against you. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - Full immunity against ordinary human-strength attempts to move you - anyone trying must clearly exceed normal human capability (GM's call) to have any chance at all.

3 - Spend **1 Ki**, when targeted by a supernatural or exceptional force effect (a boosted Potence attempt, a Gift, etc.), to gain **Advantage** on resisting it too.

4 - The Ki-gated Advantage from Level 3 becomes free - always active against supernatural attempts, no Ki cost.

5 - Full immunity to being forcibly moved by anything at all, mundane or supernatural, short of your own choice to move.

INSUBSTANTIALITY

Solid matter isn't really that solid, is it? It's mostly empty space. You can slip out of phase with the material world and pass through solid matter. Walls, doors and other barriers are no obstacle to you. While you are out of phase, the world passes through you just as easily.

While phased, you're also undetectable by ordinary senses, sight, sound, and touch alike, not just untouchable.

INSUBSTANTIALITY (CONTINUED)

ADDERS

- **Extended Phase** (Lesser, 3 pts): the duration at Levels 1-2 doubles (2 Rounds / 2 Minutes).
- **Solid Strike** (Lesser, 3 pts): while phased at Level 4+, spend 1 Ki to briefly re-solidify one limb for a single Physical attack, then re-phase immediately after.
- **Phase Walk** (Greater, 6 pts): pass through moving obstacles (a crowd, a struggling grapple, a closing door) as freely as static ones, not just stationary barriers.
- **Slip the Hold** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you're Grabbed, spend 1 Ki as a reaction to phase free, at any Level.
- **Sink and Hide** (Lesser, 3 pts): while phased you can stop inside a wall, floor or other solid matter and stay hidden there for as long as the phase lasts.
- **Ghost Drop** (Lesser, 3 pts): phase through a floor to drop to the level below, and take no damage from any fall you started by phasing.
- **Phantom Disarm** (Lesser, 3 pts): touch a held weapon or object and spend 1 Ki: it phases, drops through its holder's grip and lands at their feet.
- **Hand Inside** (Greater, 6 pts): while any part of you is phased (Level 3+), spend 1 Ki to reach through armor: your next unarmed attack this Round ignores all Soak and Hardness from worn armor. Requires Level 3.

LIMITERS

- **Slow Fade**: phasing takes a full Round to take effect instead of a Fast action, at every Level except Level 5's reactive dodge.
- **Held Breath**: you can't breathe while phased. After 3 Rounds phased, lose 1 Health Level per Round until you solidify.
- **Naked Passage**: your clothes and gear don't phase with you. Anything worn or held

drops, or stays behind on the near side of the wall.

- **Phase-Struck**: Gifts and supernatural attacks ignore your phasing entirely, and hit you at Advantage while you're phased.
- **Unanchored**: while fully phased you sink: you must spend a Fast action per Round to stay on your feet, or drop through the floor to the level below.
- **Residual Static**: while phased, you're still visible as a faint shimmer or outline. You're never undetectable.
- **No Passengers**: Level 5's extend-to-another-person clause never applies.

1 - Spend **1 Ki** and a Fast action to phase for **1 Round** - pass through a thin barrier (a door, a thin wall). You can't attack or be attacked while phased, and it ends automatically once you're through.

2 - Phasing now lasts up to **1 Minute** (about 10 Rounds), letting you move through multiple thin obstacles in sequence. Still can't attack while phased.

3 - You can now phase through thicker, more substantial barriers - solid stone, concrete - and phase only part of your body instead of the whole thing. While phased, the phased part is immune to Physical damage - attacks pass through it the same way you pass through walls.

4 - Phasing can be maintained for a full **Scene** (toggled on/off at will) instead of just a Minute. You may now attack while phased, though only as a Mental or Social attack - your body still can't physically connect with anything solid.

5 - You may extend the effect to one other person you're touching, phasing them along with you. You can also phase instantly as a reaction to dodge an incoming attack. Ki cost drops to **0**.

INVISIBILITY

Hide and seek world champion five years running. Only, you weren't really hiding. Light passes around or through you. Eventually you can hide scent and sound. There is simply nothing to find unless someone knows exactly where and how to look.

ADDERS

- **Shared Veil** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to extend Level 3+'s sound/scent masking to one other touched person alongside you.
- **Peripheral Blur** (Lesser, 3 pts): even when detected by touch, tech, or a broken effect, anyone who detects you is at Disadvantage on any roll to precisely locate or target you.
- **Deep Cover** (Lesser, 3 pts): so long as you stay in one place and take no action, the effect's duration extends to a full Scene instead of capping at 1 Minute.
- **Ghost Step** (Greater, 6 pts): while invisible, you leave no physical trace at all, no footprints, no disturbed dust, no broken cobwebs, foiling even mundane tracking methods.
- **Out of Nowhere** (Lesser, 3 pts): your first attack from invisibility per Scene leaves its target Surprised.
- **Afterimage** (Greater, 6 pts): when you turn invisible, spend 1 extra Ki to leave a visible double where you stood. It keeps up your last action for 1 Round and draws any attacks aimed at you.
- **Unseen Aura** (Lesser, 3 pts): while invisible, Gifts and supernatural senses trying to find you roll at Disadvantage.

LIMITERS

- **Fragile Veil**: any physical contact, being touched or bumping into someone, breaks the invisibility instantly, at every Level.
- **Silence Required**: the Gift doesn't work if you're already speaking or making noise the moment you activate it.

- **Startled Reveal**: if something sudden and dangerous happens while you're invisible, roll Moira + Difficulty or the effect breaks involuntarily.
- **Blind While Unseen**: light passes through your eyes too: you're Blinded for as long as you're invisible.
- **Gear Shows**: clothes and held items stay visible. To be truly unseen you go naked and empty-handed.
- **Rain Reveals**: rain, snow, smoke, dust or thrown powder outline you: in any of them, anyone looking can see where you are.

1 - Spend **1 Ki** and a Fast action to turn invisible to sight only, so long as you remain stationary - moving or taking any action breaks the effect immediately. Touch, sound, scent, and technology can still detect you. Lasts up to 1 Minute or until broken.

2 - You may move while invisible without breaking the effect. Still breaks the instant you take a hostile action (attacking, etc.).

3 - Invisibility now extends beyond sight to sound and scent as well - undetectable to ordinary senses while active. Technological sensors (cameras, motion detectors) still pick you up.

4 - You may now take a hostile action without breaking the invisibility. Additionally, spend **1 Ki** to also fool technological detection for that action.

5 - You can activate this Gift even under direct, active observation - someone already looking right at you doesn't stop it from taking hold, though doing so costs an additional **1 Ki** on top of the base cost (2 Ki total when used this way).

JUMPING

You don't run to the edge and jump. You just jump. A single push can clear rooftops, ravines, and anything else standing between you and where you want to be. With enough power, the landing itself becomes a weapon, turning the force of your descent into a devastating impact.

ADDERS

- **Wall Launch** (Lesser, 3 pts): use a vertical surface mid-jump to kick off and redirect, adding a second full jump distance to the same move, no Ki cost.
- **Silent Landing** (Lesser, 3 pts): land without sound or visible impact, no dust, no thud, no telltale sign you came down here.
- **Shockwave Leap** (Greater, 6 pts): the landing-impact attack (Level 4+) becomes a Near-range area effect instead of Close, for an extra 1 Ki on top of its normal cost.
- **Air Step** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to kick off the empty air once mid-jump, adding a second jump with no surface needed.
- **Pinpoint Landing** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you make a Level 4+ landing impact, you can fold it into the one target you land on instead of everyone within Close: it's at Advantage and a hit knocks them Prone. Requires Level 4.
- **Pounce** (Lesser, 3 pts): when a jump ends in Melee with an enemy, spend 1 Ki: they're Off Balance and your first attack against them this Round is at Advantage.
- **Catch and Carry** (Lesser, 3 pts): carry one person or an equal load through any jump at full distance, and once per Round, jump to catch a falling person within your jump range as a reaction.
- **Hang Time** (Lesser, 3 pts): hover at the top of a jump until the end of the Round; a ranged attack made from there is at Advantage.
- **Evasive Bound** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Round, when an attack targets you, spend 1

Ki as a reaction to leap up to your Movement Rate away: the attack is made at Disadvantage.

LIMITERS

- **Committed Arc**: once a jump begins, you can't abort or land early. You cover the full distance you committed to.
- **Self-Inflicted Impact**: the landing-impact attack (Level 4+) also hits you for half the dice rolled.
- **No Redirect**: Level 2's mid-air trajectory adjustment never applies.
- **Run-Up**: every jump needs a run-up of at least your Movement Rate. From a standing start you jump like anyone else.
- **Hard Landings**: any landing from a jump longer than 2x your Movement Rate leaves you Off Balance until your next turn.
- **Sky Target**: while you're airborne, ranged attacks against you are at Advantage.

1 - From a standing start, jump forward up to **2x** your Movement Rate, or straight up up to **1x** your Movement Rate. Is a Fast action. No fall damage from a landing height within what you could jump. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - Forward jumps extend to **3x** Movement Rate, vertical to **1.5x**. You can adjust your trajectory once, mid-air, changing direction after the jump's already started.

3 - Forward jumps extend to **4x** Movement Rate, vertical to **2x**. Spend **1 Ki** to chain a second jump immediately on landing, covering that much distance again in the same move.

4 - Forward jumps extend to **6x** Movement Rate, vertical to **3x**. Landing from a jump can be turned into an attack: spend **1 Ki**, everyone within Close range of your landing point takes your Potence dice vs. their Soak. Chaining a jump (Level 3) no longer costs Ki.

JUMPING (CONTINUED)

5 - Forward jumps extend to **10x** Movement Rate, vertical to **5x**. Ki cost for the landing-impact attack from Level 4 drops to **0**.

MARKED FOR THE HUNT

After you mark your target, the hunt runs itself. A part of your consciousness and awareness stays fixated on them no matter where they go. Hiding becomes more difficult. Escape is no longer a certainty. Every encounter with your quarry is a step towards the inevitable end.

ADDDERS

- **Shared Mark** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to extend the mark's tracking and Advantage benefits to one touched ally.
- **Lingering Scent** (Lesser, 3 pts): if the mark lapses at Levels 1-3, rough-direction awareness persists for one additional Scene before it fully fades.
- **First Blood** (Greater, 6 pts): the first successful hit against a marked target each encounter deals one extra damage die.
- **Blood Token** (Lesser, 3 pts): you can mark someone you can't see while holding a piece of them: hair, blood, or something they've worn for a Day or more.
- **Chosen Prey** (Lesser, 3 pts): pick one kind of quarry at creation (a species, a faction, a kind of creature). Marking one of them costs no Ki.
- **Dread of the Hunted** (Lesser, 3 pts): your quarry knows they're marked. When they start their turn within Near of you, they roll Moira + Difficulty or are Frightened of you until their next turn.
- **No Escape** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Round, when your marked target moves away from you, spend 1 Ki as a reaction to move up to your Movement Rate after them, outside your turn.

LIMITERS

- **One Target Only**: you can only ever have one active mark at a time. Marking a new target instantly releases the old one.

MARKED FOR THE HUNT (CONTINUED)

- **Visible Focus:** your intense focus on the marked target is obvious to onlookers. Disadvantage on Stealth or Deception rolls made against anyone aware you have a mark active.
- **Personal Vendetta:** you can only mark someone who's wronged you or someone you care about, GM's call, not an arbitrary target.
- **Mark on a Hit:** you can only mark a target by touching them or landing a hit, never on sight alone. Can't be taken with **Blood Token**.
- **Mirror Mark:** the mark runs both ways: your quarry always knows your rough direction too.
- **Obsession:** while your quarry is in the Scene, you're at Disadvantage on any roll not aimed at them.
- **Waking Watch:** the mark only holds while you're awake. Sleep or unconsciousness ends it, Level 4's permanence included.

1 - Spend **1 Ki** to mark a target you can currently see. For as long as the mark lasts (a Scene, renewable), you always know their rough direction and gain **Advantage** on any roll made to track or locate them specifically.

2 - Gain **Advantage** on any roll made directly against your marked target: an attack, a contested Skill use, anything aimed at them specifically.

3 - Your marked target's attempts to hide, disguise themselves, or evade you specifically are at **Disadvantage**. You also gain Advantage to avoid being Surprised by them.

4 - The mark no longer needs renewing: it holds until the target is dealt with or you choose to release it, not just for a Scene.

5 - Spend **1 Ki** to pinpoint your marked target's exact location right now, regardless of concealment, Stealth, Invisibility, or other means of hiding (short of a Gift specifically built to counter this, GM's call).

MARTIAL ARTIST

The cliché is that your hands are deadly weapons. Sometimes, clichés are true. Years of training and study have turned every punch and kick into deadly blows. Training has taught you to read your opponent and anticipate their attack before it lands. You know when to strike, when to yield and when to obstruct for maximum effectiveness.

ADDERS

- **Iron Body** (Lesser, 3 pts): while Guard is active, its Soak bonus also applies against harm that would normally bypass Soak entirely (fire, falls, GM's call).
- **Flowing Counter** (Greater, 6 pts): if an attack misses you while Guard is active, spend 1 Ki for an immediate free unarmed attack against that attacker, no action cost.
- **Weaponized Body** (Lesser, 3 pts): your unarmed strikes count as wielding a weapon for any Skill, Boon, or Gift that specifically requires one.
- **Sealing Strike** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 2 Ki on a successful unarmed hit: the target can't use a Gift or spend Ki until the end of their next turn.
- **Through the Armor** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki on an unarmed attack: it ignores the Soak and Hardness added by worn armor, striking the body behind it. Can't be taken with **Marked Hands**.
- **Deflecting Palm** (Lesser, 3 pts): while Guard is active, thrown weapons and arrows are at Disadvantage against you; you slap them aside.
- **Holding Back** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, reveal your real skill: the first unarmed attack after you do is at Advantage and leaves the target Surprised.
- **Stone Splitter** (Lesser, 3 pts): your unarmed strikes break things: roll at Advantage against any object's Hardness.

MARTIAL ARTIST (CONTINUED)

- **Light Feet** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to run up a wall or across water for your full Movement Rate this Round.

LIMITERS

- **Marked Hands:** your unarmed Damage bonus doesn't apply against a target wearing modern ballistic/plate armor - GM's call on what qualifies.
- **All In:** while Guard is active, you can't take any action besides moving up to half your Movement Rate - no partial commitment.
- **Telegraphed:** an opponent who's seen you fight before gets Advantage on their first attack roll against you each combat, recognizing your stance on sight.
- **Empty Hands:** every benefit of this Gift is lost while you hold anything in either hand, shield and torch included.
- **Named Techniques:** every Ki spend on this Gift is a technique you shout aloud: it breaks Stealth, and it never catches a target Surprised.
- **Honor Code:** a vow: you can't use this Gift against a target who is Prone, Surprised or fleeing. Can't be taken with **Holding Back**.
- **Broken Focus:** while you're Frightened, Flustered or Distracted, you can't use Guard and your unarmed Damage drops back to 1.

1 - Your unarmed strikes deal **2** Damage (up from the baseline 1), resolved with the same per-die-vs-Soak mechanic as a weapon. No Ki, no Gift Check. You also gain **Guard**: as your action, forgo attacking to brace instead, gaining **+2** Soak until the start of your next turn.

2 - Unarmed Damage rises to **3**, matching a Knife or Handgun. Guard's bonus rises to **+3**.

3 - Unarmed Damage rises to **4**, matching a Sword or Rifle. Guard's bonus rises to **+4**. Spend **1 Ki** on a successful unarmed hit to stagger the target, imposing Disadvantage on their next roll before the end of their next turn.

4 - Guard can now be held as a **Fast action**, usable reactively - even outside your own turn, once per round - instead of only on your own turn.

5 - Unarmed Damage rises to **5**, matching a Two-handed sword or Heavy weapon - your bare hands hit as hard as anything on the weapon table. Guard's bonus rises to **+5**. The stagger effect (Level 3) no longer costs Ki.

MEMORY MANIPULATION

Memories are stories that your mind whispers to itself. You've learned how to step in and rewrite the script. You can edit what is remembered - removing things remembered and adding events that never happened. These altered memories feel as real as the original.

ADDDERS

- **Selective Erasure** (Lesser, 3 pts): erase one specific detail from a broader memory instead of the whole thing - they keep the encounter, just not your face in it.
- **False Trail** (Lesser, 3 pts): an implanted memory (Level 2+) can point the target toward a specific false belief or action you choose, not just a generic replacement.
- **Group Edit** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 additional Ki to affect up to 3 targets simultaneously with the same edit, instead of resolving them one at a time.
- **Mind Fog** (Lesser, 3 pts): an edit leaves the target Distracted until the end of their next turn, lost between what was and what they now remember.

MEMORY MANIPULATION (CONTINUED)

- **Remembrance** (Lesser, 3 pts): the same roll can restore a memory that was erased or altered, including one changed by another Gift.
- **Gifted Memory** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki and touch a willing target to give them one of your own memories. They keep it as if they'd lived it: sights, words, a route, a face, but no skill.
- **Buried Deep** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to bury one of your own memories. Telepathy, interrogation and other Gifts can't reach it until you choose to dig it back up.
- **Sleeper Trigger** (Greater, 6 pts): an implanted memory (Level 2+) can stay dormant until a trigger you set - a phrase, a place, a face - then surfaces all at once as though just recalled. Requires Level 2.
- **Forgotten Craft** (Greater, 6 pts): a connecting die can make the target forget how to use one Skill until the end of the Scene; they roll it as Untrained.
- **Taking the Edge Off** (Lesser, 3 pts): with one session each Week, rework the memory behind a Mental scar until it stops biting, in **Weeks equal to how far below 0 their Sanity went**. They keep the memory; it only stops hurting. Works on you as well as on someone else. Requires Level 3.

LIMITERS

- **Recent Only:** you can never affect memories older than a Day, regardless of Level - Level 3's upgrade to older memories never applies.
- **Leaves a Seam:** an edited memory always has a small, detectable inconsistency a thorough investigation (or another telepath) can find.
- **One Edit, Once:** you can never target the same person's memory twice - the first edit is permanent and final.

- **Eye to Eye:** the target must be able to see your eyes. A Blinded target, or one looking away, can't be edited.
- **Living It:** you relive every memory you erase or rewrite: after an edit you're Distracted until the end of your next turn, and a violent or traumatic memory costs you 1 Sanity.
- **Dreams Return:** an edit only holds for a Week. After that the true memory resurfaces in the target's dreams and comes back, unless you edit it again. Can't be taken with **One Edit, Once**.
- **Spoken Script:** you must narrate the edit aloud to the target as you make it; there's no doing it quietly.

1 - Requires touch. Spend **1 Ki**; make the standard to-hit roll (**Air** vs. their **Mental Defense**). On success, roll **1 + half your Psyche** dice per-die against their Psyche wall - a connecting die erases one specific, recent memory (something from the last few minutes: a name overheard, a face seen, this exact encounter).

2 - Dice rise to **2 + half your Psyche**. You may implant a simple false memory in place of the erased one, instead of leaving a blank.

3 - Dice rise to **3 + half your Psyche**. Range extends to **Close**, touch no longer required. You can now target older, more significant memories, not just recent ones.

4 - **No to-hit roll required anymore** - it simply rolls **4 + half your Psyche** dice per-die against the target's Psyche wall directly.

5 - Dice rise to **5 + half your Psyche**, still no to-hit roll. Once per Scene, an edit also scrubs any physical evidence of your involvement from the target's immediate perception - footage glitches, notes stop making sense to them, whatever would otherwise contradict the new memory.

NECROMANCY

Death isn't the end of the story. In your hands, it is the beginning for some. You have learned to reach across the veil and bring the dead back to do your bidding. The dead rise as things of bone, spirit or rotting flesh. They are obedient, but utterly removed from who they once were.

Chosen once, at creation, purely cosmetic: the form your raised dead take (bone constructs, wrapped corpses, spectral soldiers, whatever fits the way you do this).

ADDDERS

- **Grave Whisper** (Lesser, 3 pts): touch a corpse and roll Moira + Difficulty to ask it one question about its own death, answered as a faint, disjointed impression, not real testimony.
- **Borrowed Hands** (Greater, 6 pts): Once per Scene, spend 1 Ki as a Fast action to let one soul from your roster ride in your body instead of rising: until the end of the Scene you use one of their Skills at their Tier in place of your own. Your eyes and voice change while they ride. Requires **Roll Call**.
- **Reaper's Harvest** (Lesser, 3 pts): Once per round, when a creature dies within Near range of you, raise it as a thrall on the spot as a Fast action, no Ki. It counts toward your thrall limit.
- **Soul Cleave** (Greater, 6 pts): Necrotic Touch can cut the soul instead of the flesh: roll your Level + half your Psyche against the target's Psyche instead of Soak. Each connecting die still heals you.
- **Lay to Rest** (Lesser, 3 pts): As a Normal action, roll Moira + Difficulty to send one raised dead, ghost or spirit within Near range back to the Fray, the GM setting Difficulty by its strength. Another necromancer's thralls count.
- **Soul Sight** (Lesser, 3 pts): You see souls. At a glance you know whether someone within Near range is alive, dead, raised, possessed

or Gifted, and roughly how many Health Levels they have left.

- **Standing Call** (Lesser, 3 pts): One soul from your roster can stay with you between Scenes as a ghost only you can see and hear. It can't act or touch anything, but it talks, remembers, and scouts up to Near range from you. Requires **Roll Call**.
- **Phylactery** (Greater, 6 pts): Your soul is hidden in a vessel you made. When you would die, you instead return at 1 Health Level next Scene, within reach of the vessel, and the vessel is spent. Making a new one takes a week of downtime, and if an enemy finds and breaks it first, you get nothing.
- **Reinforced Bones** (Lesser, 3 pts): your thralls' Health Levels rise by 1 each, at every Level.
- **Smart Thralls** (Lesser, 3 pts): your thralls understand commands at roughly the level a well-trained dog does - a short sequence, a simple condition, one target picked out of a group. They still have no judgement and no initiative, and do nothing you did not tell them to do.
- **Bone Armory** (Greater, 6 pts): your thralls rise already armed, bone drawn out into blades, spurs or hooked talons. Each thrall's Attack rises by **1 die** at every Level.

NECROMANCY (CONTINUED)

- **Skilled Thralls** (Greater, 6 pts): when you Raise the Dead you may raise **Greater Thralls** instead - **half your usual number, rounded up**. Decided each time you summon, not fixed at creation. Each has Soak **2**, Defense 5, Health Levels **3**, your Movement Rate, and a **Command Rating** equal to your **Gift Level + 1**, used as its Attribute on any roll it makes. Each holds one Skill of your choice at **Tier 2 (Trained)**, rising to **Tier 3 (Adept)** at Gift Level 3 and **Tier 4 (Expert)** at Gift Level 5, and can carry and use one weapon or tool, rolling that weapon's Damage rating in place of its natural attack, up to a maximum of **one die more than a thrall's Attack at your current Level**. They are no smarter than any other thrall. One mode applies per summoning: an ordinary batch, Greater Thralls, or - with Risen Gifted - a single Gifted Thrall.
- **Risen Gifted** (Greater, 6 pts): you may raise **one** Gifted Thrall in place of your whole batch, decided each time you summon. It must come from the remains of someone who actually held a Gift in life - the GM decides what you have to work with. Soak 2, Defense 5, Health Levels 4, your Movement Rate, Attack as a normal thrall. It carries **one** of that person's Gifts, operating at a Level equal to **half your Necromancy Level, rounded up**. It has no Ki of its own: every Ki cost the Gift incurs comes out of **your** pool, and any roll the Gift calls for uses **your** Attributes and Skills. It is no smarter than any other thrall - it will use the Gift on the thing you point it at and in no other way, and a Gift needing judgement, conversation or a plan (GM's call) does not function through it.
- **Hungry Grave** (Greater, 6 pts): whenever a thrall you command is destroyed, spend 1 Ki to raise a replacement immediately as a Fast action, instead of waiting for your next Slow action.

- **Bonecrafter** (Greater, 6 pts): as a Normal action, meld every thrall you currently command into a single, larger creature - a bone giant, a mass of fused corpses, whatever form you choose. Its Health Levels equal the sum of the merged thralls' current Health Levels **+3**; its Attack still uses the same dice rating an individual thrall has at your current Gift Level (Soak and Defense unchanged). It counts as one creature taking one action in the turn order, replacing every merged thrall until it's destroyed - raise a fresh batch of thralls normally afterward.
- **Shared Suffering** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when you would drop to 0 Health Levels, spend 2 Ki to instead sacrifice every thrall you currently command and stay at 1 Health Level.
- **Roll Call** (Greater, 6 pts): when you Raise the Dead, you may instead call **one specific soul** out of the Fray: a named person on your roster. **Roll Call can be bought more than once**, and each purchase adds one soul to the roster. They rise in your Form as a Greater Thrall (Soak 2, Defense 5, Health Levels 3, your Movement Rate, Command Rating = your Gift Level + 1) and keep **every Skill they had in life**, rolled at their Command Rating. They remember, they talk, and they are loyal, but they **never act unless you prompt them**: one prompt per round, Fast or Normal actions only. They can't go more than **Near range** from you. If destroyed, they go back to the Fray, and you can call them again next Scene.

LIMITERS

- **Brittle Legion**: your thralls' Health Levels are permanently 1 lower at every Level, minimum 1.
- **One at a Time**: Necrotic Touch and commanding thralls can't be used in the same round - using one locks out the other until your next turn.

NECROMANCY (CONTINUED)

- **Grave-Bound:** your thralls can never move more than Close range from you - stray past that and they collapse instantly.
- **No Whispers:** Necrotic Touch's healing never applies - it still deals damage, but grants you nothing back.
- **Lone Servant:** you never command more than one thrall at a time. Raise the Dead raises one, whatever your Level.
- **Blood Price:** Raise the Dead costs 1 Health Level as well as the Ki - the dead rise on your own life.
- **Fresh Dead Only:** You can only raise remains that died within the last day - no old bones, no graveyards, no week-old battlefields.
- **Hallowed Ground:** Salt, consecrated ground and sunlight break your hold: thralls can't cross a line of salt or enter hallowed ground, and in direct sunlight every thrall and Roll Call soul has Disadvantage on every roll.
- **Mark of the Grave:** Death shows on you - cold skin, a grave smell, animals shying away. Disadvantage on any roll to win over the living who get close enough to notice, and anyone who knows the signs knows what you are.

1 - Raise the Dead: spend 1 Ki as a Slow action to raise up to **2** skeletal thralls from nearby remains. Each has Soak 1, Defense 5, Health Levels 2, your own Movement Rate, and a natural-weapon Attack of 1d10 (resolved per-die vs. Soak, same mechanic as any weapon). They act immediately after you in the turn order, taking a Fast or Normal action each round (never Slow), and have no Skills or Gifts of their own. They understand commands of one or two words - *guard, kill him, follow* - and nothing more complex; anything needing a condition, a sequence, or a judgement call is beyond them. They last until destroyed or dismissed. **Necrotic Touch:** as a Normal action, make a Physical attack (Attribute vs. Defense, as usual) dealing **1 + half your Ferocity** vs. Soak - each connecting die heals you 1 Health Level (never past your maximum), drawing their vitality straight into your own.

2 - Raise up to **3** thralls at once. Necrotic Touch's dice rise to **2 + half your Ferocity**.

3 - Raise up to **4** thralls at once, and each one's Attack rises to **2d10**. Necrotic Touch's dice rise to **3 + half your Ferocity**.

4 - Raise up to **5** thralls at once. Necrotic Touch's dice rise to **4 + half your Ferocity**. **Wither:** spend 1 Ki on a successful Necrotic Touch hit to also impose Disadvantage on the target's next roll, their strength visibly sapped.

5 - Necrotic Touch's dice rise to **5 + half your Ferocity**. Once per Scene, spend **2 Ki** to unleash **Legion's Toll:** every thrall you currently command instantly unravels into a burst of necrotic force, each one making one last Attack roll against everyone within Melee range of it, then all are destroyed.

OATHBINDER

A deal is a deal. Your word is as good as a bond. In fact - it is a bond. Something in the exchange gives the oath serious weight. People break their word constantly, but they find that they can't really do that with you.

ADDDERS

- **Written Word** (Lesser, 3 pts): an oath signed binds as well as one spoken - a contract, a ledger entry, a name on a line.
- **Witness** (Lesser, 3 pts): bind an oath sworn between two other people, with you as the witness rather than a party to it.
- **Blood Price** (Greater, 6 pts): breaking a bound oath costs the oathbreaker **1 Sanity level**, on top of everything else.
- **Binding Vow** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to swear a vow on yourself aloud, naming one foe and one restriction that will cost you this Scene (no weapons, no retreat, no Ki Infusion). While you keep it, every roll you make against that foe is at Advantage. Break it and you suffer the oathbreaker's penalty of your own Level.
- **Kept Faith** (Lesser, 3 pts): anyone acting to fulfil an oath you bound, you included, has Advantage on the roll that directly fulfils it, once per Scene per oath.
- **Forfeit Clause** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you bind an oath, name a simple forfeit (hand over an item they carry, leave the area, tell the truth about one thing). Whoever breaks the oath pays it as their very next action.
- **Brand of the Forsworn** (Lesser, 3 pts): anyone who breaks an oath you bound carries a mark any onlooker can sense is wrong; they're at Disadvantage on every Social roll to be trusted until they make amends (GM's call on what counts).
- **Oathbreaker's Due** (Greater, 6 pts): anyone who breaks an oath you bound is Frightened of you for the rest of the Day and cannot willingly move closer to you.

LIMITERS

- **Freely Given**: an oath only binds if the person swearing genuinely means it at the time. Coerced or tricked oaths don't take.
- **Named Terms**: the terms have to be specific and spoken aloud. A vague promise binds nothing.
- **Cuts Both Ways**: any oath you swear binds you exactly as hard as it binds them.
- **Honest Tongue**: you can never knowingly speak a falsehood. If you do, the Gift stops working entirely until you have slept.
- **One Bond at a Time**: you can hold only one bound oath at a time. Binding a new one releases the old, whoever it bound.
- **Broken Faith**: when any oath you bound is broken, you share the oathbreaker's Disadvantage on your next roll and cannot bind a new oath for the rest of the Day.
- **Something in Return**: an oath only binds if both sides give something in the swearing. A one-sided promise, with nothing offered back, binds nothing.

1 - A promise made to you in earnest sticks. Anyone who breaks one is at **Disadvantage on their next roll**, shaken by having done it. No Ki, no Gift Check - it simply happens.

2 - You can bind an oath deliberately. The terms are stated aloud, both parties agree, and you spend **1 Ki**. When the sworn party tries to act against it, they roll **Atropos + Difficulty** to go through with it; failure means they cannot bring themselves to act against it for the rest of the Scene.

3 - You know the moment a bound oath is broken, and roughly where the oathbreaker is. Their roll to act against a bound oath is now made at **Disadvantage**.

4 - A single oath can bind more than one person - everyone who assents to the terms is bound by them. The swearing no longer has to happen face to face; a voice down a phone line binds as well as one across a table.

OATHBINDER (CONTINUED)

5 - A bound oath is, for all practical purposes, unbreakable. Any attempt to act against it **automatically fails**, no roll needed.

ONSLAUGHT

You have one answer in every situation - hit it. Whether that means attacking with a fist, a blade, a claw or something stranger is up to you. The shape of the attack is irrelevant. What matters is the force behind it and delivering it over and over again until whatever stands in your way stops standing.

Your one way of hurting people at arm's length is chosen at creation, and described however you like. The rules don't read the description.

You are choosing a picture, not a mechanic.

The description is yours and it changes nothing. A forearm blade, a fist and a dagger all roll the same dice against the same wall. Pick whichever one you would rather say out loud when it lands.

What the rules read is always the same.

A Physical attack at Melee range. The to-hit is a straight Attribute-vs-Defense roll using whichever Element fits how you are going about it, the same as swinging a bat. The dice resolve one at a time against **Soak**, and a connecting die costs a **Health Level**. Every swing costs **1 Ki**, and there is never a Gift Check. What the Levels buy is dice, Level plus half your Ferocity, and that is the whole Gift.

This is not a Signature Move. A Move is built: you pick an attack source and a wall and they don't have to match, which is how a scream ends up breaking composure. Onslaught picks nothing. It is the plain version, for a character whose answer to a problem at arm's length is to hit it until it stops. If you want the strange version, build a Move.

Unarmed fighting lives here. None of the weapon Skills covers fists and feet - there is no Category for them, and nothing to be trained on - so a character who fights with their hands is describing Onslaught, whatever else it could have been.

ONSLAUGHT (CONTINUED)

ADDERS

- **Follow Through** (Lesser, 3 pts): when an attack drops a target to 0, attack a second target in Melee range immediately, no action cost.
- **Off the Wrong Foot** (Lesser, 3 pts): one extra die against a target who hasn't acted yet this combat.
- **Nothing Held Back** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to add your Potence to every die of a single attack, not just the ones Ki Infusion buys.
- **Sweep** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki on top of the attack's own cost to swing at **every** target in Melee range with the full pool, each resolved against their own Soak.
- **Heavy Hands** (Lesser, 3 pts): when two or more dice of a single attack connect, the target is Off Balance.
- **Closing Rush** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki on top of the attack's cost to attack a target at Close range, crossing into Melee as part of the same action.
- **Building Barrage** (Greater, 6 pts): every consecutive round you attack the same target with this Gift adds 1 die, up to +2. The count resets if you attack anyone else, take any other action, or they leave Melee range.
- **Everything on One Blow** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend 2 or more Ki on top of the attack's cost: the attack gains 1 die per Ki spent this way. When it resolves you are Exhausted.

LIMITERS

- **Wind-Up**: attacking with it is always a Normal action, never a Fast one, whatever else would otherwise allow it.
- **Takes a Toll**: once you are below half your Health Levels, each use costs 1 unsoakable Health Level.
- **Only in Anger**: unusable in any round you haven't already been attacked in, or in a

fight you started.

- **Nothing Else in Hand**: usable only while your hands hold nothing else - no shield, torch, gun or ally's hand.
- **Bruised Knuckles**: every attack also rolls 1 die against your own Soak; a connecting die costs you a Health Level.
- **Tunnel Vision**: once you attack a target with this Gift, you cannot attack anyone else with it until that target drops or leaves Melee range.
- **Loud Blows**: every swing is heard out to Far range, and you never gain anything from a target being Surprised - they see it coming.

1 - Spend 1 Ki to attack anything in **Melee** range for **1 + half your Ferocity** dice, resolved per-die against Soak like any weapon. No Gift Check, at this or any Level.

2 - **2 + half your Ferocity** dice.

3 - **3 + half your Ferocity** dice.

4 - **4 + half your Ferocity** dice.

5 - **5 + half your Ferocity** dice.

PERIPHERAL

You don't disappear. You don't need to. People just overlook you. Eyes pass over you and attention just drifts away. Time spent with you quickly becomes clouded and difficult to remember, as if you were nothing more than a dream.

ADDERS

- **Fading Trail** (Lesser, 3 pts): physical evidence you leave behind (footprints, fingerprints, a dropped item) is similarly overlooked or dismissed, not just your presence itself.
- **Group Obscurity** (Greater, 6 pts): Level 4's touch-extension covers everyone in a chain of physical contact at once, not just one other person.

PERIPHERAL (CONTINUED)

- **Blind Spot** (Lesser, 3 pts): while the effect is active, your first attack against someone who hasn't noticed you treats them as Surprised. The effect then ends for that person.
- **Misdirection** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki: the attention that slides off you lands on one person or object you choose within Near range, and anyone who fails to notice you this round is Distracted by it.
- **Slip Away** (Lesser, 3 pts): Level 2's forgetting takes one round instead of a few minutes, and a chase against you ends the moment you break the pursuer's line of sight.
- **Ghost in the Crowd** (Greater, 6 pts): in a fight, anyone who wasn't focused on you when the effect began can't choose you as a target until you attack them or they beat Perception + Difficulty as a Normal action.

LIMITERS

- **Breaks on Contact:** any direct physical interaction (a touch, a handshake, being bumped into) instantly ends the effect for that Scene.
- **No Recordings:** the effect doesn't fool cameras, recordings, or other non-living observation - only living memory and attention.
- **Loud Undoes It:** raising your voice, running, or otherwise drawing deliberate attention immediately breaks the effect.
- **Gifted See True:** anyone who holds a Gift of their own ignores the effect completely.
- **Hollow Voice:** while the effect is active you cannot make Social rolls - your words slide off people with the rest of you.
- **Can't Turn It Off:** once activated, the effect runs the whole Scene. Allies must beat Perception + Difficulty to find you, aid you or notice you're hurt.
- **Always On:** the effect never stops. There is nothing to activate and no Gift Check to make; it is simply how people see you,

including when you'd rather be seen. Can't be taken with **Can't Turn It Off**.

- **No Targeting:** the effect works on everyone who can see you, friend and stranger alike - you can't choose who it touches, and you can't leave anyone out.

1 - Activating is a Fast action and triggers a **Gift Check** - success free, failure costs 1 Ki, the effect happens either way. **You decide who it works on: anyone, everyone, or everyone but the people you name. You can change your mind as a Fast action.** For the rest of the Scene, anyone it's working on who isn't already actively focused on you must beat a **Perception + Difficulty** roll to notice what you're doing, and even on a success, they're at **Disadvantage** recalling details about you afterward.

2 - Anyone who briefly loses sight of you (you leave a room, turn a corner, get lost in a crowd) forgets they saw you at all within a few minutes, unless something jogs their memory.

3 - The effect now holds even mid-conversation - if you go quiet or step back, people naturally lose their conversational thread about you and move on, without it feeling unnatural to them.

4 - You may extend the effect to one other person you're touching, bringing them into your own obscurity for as long as contact holds.

5 - Once per Scene, spend **1 Ki** to retroactively erase yourself from the last few minutes of everyone present's memory - as far as they can recall, you were never part of what just happened.

POSSESSION

Why keep your mind anchored in your meat suit when you can wear someone else's? You can force your way into another person's mind. When you do, it pushes their mind aside and you take the pilot seat. Their body is yours for the duration while your body lies empty, waiting for you to return.

This Gift always costs Ki, at every Level - there is no mastery discount to free.

As with any Mental attack, additional Ki Infusion (1 Ki per die) can push individual dice further by adding your own Psyche, per the usual rule.

ADDDERS

- **Anchor Line** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you possess a target, spend 1 additional Ki to sense if your original body enters danger for the duration of that possession, letting you snap back to it instantly as a reaction.
- **Distant Hop** (Lesser, 3 pts): Level 5's instant target-switching only requires line of sight, not direct eye contact.
- **Mechanical Take** (Greater, 6 pts): this Gift also works on constructs and machines, not just living bodies.
- **Silent Passenger** (Lesser, 3 pts): instead of taking control, ride inside a host you've won: you share their senses and they don't know you're there. Take the wheel at any time as a Fast action, no new roll.
- **Empty Vessel** (Lesser, 3 pts): possess a sleeping or unconscious target with no roll; you still pay the Ki.
- **Clean Exit** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you leave a host, they remember nothing of the time you held them and are Distracted until the end of their next turn.
- **Last Leap** (Greater, 6 pts): when your own body would drop to 0 Health Levels, spend 1 Ki as a reaction to throw your mind at anyone in Close range as a normal possession attempt. If it fails, you fall as normal.

- **Carried Gifts** (Greater, 6 pts): your own Gifts (other than Possession) work through a host's body, paying Ki from your own pool and rolling your own sub-stats.

LIMITERS

- **Fragile Grip**: if the host resists at any point during possession (GM's call, under duress or extreme willpower), you're expelled back to your own body immediately, unless you spend 1 Ki to hold on.
- **Echo Sickness**: after returning from a possession lasting longer than a Scene, you're at Disadvantage on all rolls for the rest of that day.
- **One-Way Door**: returning to your own body isn't automatic. You must win another Psyche roll against the host to leave, same as entering.
- **Borrowed Wounds**: when you leave a host, every Health Level it lost while you held it costs you 1 Health Level too.
- **Only the Open Door**: works only on a target who is willing, unconscious or Frightened. Can't be taken with **Empty Vessel**.
- **Wrong Eyes**: a host's eyes and voice change while you hold it. Anyone who knows the host sees it's wrong, and your Social rolls against them through the host are at Disadvantage.
- **Thinning Thread**: every Scene you stay in one host after the first costs 1 Ki; if you can't pay, you snap back to your own body.

1 - Requires touch. Spend **1 Ki** and roll **1 + half your Psyche** dice per-die against the target's Psyche wall - a connecting die lets you possess their body for the rest of the scene. Your own body goes limp and undefended while you're away.

2 - Dice rise to **2 + half your Psyche**. Touch is no longer required - possession can be attempted at **Close range**.

POSSESSION (CONTINUED)

3 - Dice rise to **3 + half your Psyche**. Range extends to **Near**. Possession duration becomes indefinite - lasting until you choose to return or are forcibly expelled, not capped at a scene.

4 - Dice rise to **4 + half your Psyche**. Range extends to **Far**. While possessing, you gain full access to the host's Skills, Boons, and other Gifts, using their body's full capability as your own.

5 - Dice rise to **5 + half your Psyche**. You may possess a new target instantly, snapping from one host directly into another without returning to your own body first, so long as you can make eye contact with the new target.

PRECOGNITION

The future doesn't arrive at the same time for everyone. For you - it leaks through in flashes and snippets, sudden clarity and a moment you haven't experienced yet. You can see what is coming and read the warnings of what is yet to happen.

ADDDERS

- **Shared Vision** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, share a passive flash with an ally in Melee range. They receive the warning too.
- **Second Impression** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, reroll a failed active-foresight roll (Level 2+).
- **Guided Hand** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki so the Advantage from a foreseen attack (Level 3+) also applies to your next attack against that same attacker, not just your defense.
- **Never Blindsided** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you would be Surprised, spend 1 Ki: you aren't, and neither is one ally within Close range you shout to.
- **Step Aside** (Lesser, 3 pts): Level 3's Ki spend can guard one ally in Melee range instead of you - they gain the Advantage on their defense.
- **Prophetic Dream** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Day, after a night's sleep, the GM gives you one flash about the coming Day, and you may roll Moira + Difficulty to ask one question about it.
- **Branching Path** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, after any roll of yours resolves, spend 1 Ki: it was only a vision. Reroll it and take the new result.

LIMITERS

- **Uncertain Visions**: every flash, passive or active, is vague and symbolic, never literal. The GM always delivers it as an interpretable image, not plain information.
- **Draining Sight**: after any active use (Level 2+), you're at Disadvantage on your next roll.

PRECOGNITION (CONTINUED)

- **Fewer Flashes:** Level 5's always-on passive upgrade never applies. Passive flashes stay GM's-call only regardless of Level bought.
- **Trance Sight:** active foresight (Level 2+) needs closed eyes and stillness: you are Blinded and Distracted until the end of your next turn.
- **Only My Own Fate:** flashes and foresight only ever concern what happens to you. You never see an ally's fate unless you're in it with them. Can't be taken with **Step Aside** or **Shared Vision**.
- **Despair's Weight:** when a flash shows harm coming to you or an ally, you are Frightened until the end of your next turn.

1 - Passive and involuntary - at a dramatically appropriate moment (GM's call), you receive a brief precognitive flash: a warning, a fragment of the near future. No roll, no action, purely a narrative tool the GM wields on your behalf.

2 - Once per scene, you may actively reach for a flash: roll **Moire + Difficulty** to get a vague impression of the likely outcome of a specific decision or action you're considering.

3 - Spend **1 Ki**, when you've foreseen an attack coming, to gain **Advantage** on your defense against it - foreknowledge translated into a real combat edge.

4 - Active foresight (Level 2) sharpens from a vague impression into a clearer vision, and can now reach further out - not just the immediate next moment, but a meaningful stretch of near future.

5 - Passive flashes (Level 1) can now surface any time danger is coming, not just when the GM chooses to grant one - you're rarely blindsided anymore. Ki cost from Level 3 drops to **0**.

PROTOCOL

You didn't write the social contract, but you can enforce it. You establish the rules and those around you follow them. Those under your sway follow the rules because breaking them just feels wrong. They may even come to resent those who refuse to follow them.

Ki Infusion still applies on top, same as any Social attack.

ADDERS

- **Silent Imposition** (Lesser, 3 pts): the target has no memory of being bound - the rule feels like their own personal code, not something imposed on them.
- **Lasting Decree** (Greater, 6 pts): a rule set persists indefinitely once imposed, not capped at Scene/Day - it holds until you release it or the target manages to break free (GM's call on the threshold).
- **House Rules** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 2 Ki as a Slow action to declare one rule over a room or an area up to Near across. Everyone inside, and anyone who enters later this Scene, is rolled against separately. It doesn't count against your target limit, but holds one rule only and only inside the area.
- **Penalty Clause** (Lesser, 3 pts): breaking one of your rules also leaves the breaker Flustered.
- **Enforcer's Edge** (Lesser, 3 pts): your rolls against someone who broke one of your rules this round or last are at Advantage.
- **Fair Terms** (Lesser, 3 pts): if you bind yourself to the same rule as the target, the to-hit roll (Levels 1-3) is at Advantage. Can't be taken with **Reciprocal Bond**.
- **Amendment** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki as a Fast action to swap one rule on a bound target for a new one, no new roll.

PROTOCOL (CONTINUED)

- **Zealous Enforcement** (Greater, 6 pts): bound targets don't just want the rule followed - they actively intervene, verbally or physically, to stop anyone else from breaking it.

LIMITERS

- **Spoken Aloud Only**: the rule has to be declared out loud in the target's presence - no silent or written imposition.
- **Fragile Authority**: the first time a bound target successfully breaks a rule, even at the Disadvantage cost, the whole binding shatters immediately for them - no wearing it down over repeated attempts.
- **Reciprocal Bond**: while any binding is active, you're also bound by the same rule yourself - you set the standard, you have to live by it too.
- **Undermined by Contradiction**: if you personally break a rule you've currently imposed on someone else, every active binding you're holding shatters at once.
- **Reasonable Rules**: a rule must be one the target could plausibly keep. 'Don't fight back' against someone attacking them, or 'don't leave' in a burning building, binds nothing.
- **Badge of Office**: you need a visible sign of authority - a badge, gavel, uniform or seal - in hand or worn. Without it, the Gift doesn't work.

1 - Requires the target to perceive you. Spend **1 Ki**; make the standard to-hit roll (**Fire** vs. their **Social Defense**). On success, roll **1 + half your Presence** dice per-die against their Presence wall - a connecting die binds them to one simple rule of conduct you declare ("don't raise your voice," "don't lie to me," "don't draw a weapon") for the rest of the Scene. Breaking the rule costs them **Disadvantage** on the roll that breaks it.

2 - Dice rise to **2 + half your Presence**. You may declare up to two rules at once on the same target.

3 - Dice rise to **3 + half your Presence**. You may bind up to **two targets** at once, each resolved individually against their own Presence wall and their own rule set.

4 - **No to-hit roll required anymore** - it simply rolls **4 + half your Presence** dice per-die against each target's Presence wall directly. Up to **three targets** at once, each able to hold up to **three rules**.

5 - Dice rise to **5 + half your Presence**, still no to-hit roll needed. Up to **five targets** at once. Duration extends to a full Day instead of just the Scene.

PSYCHOKINESIS / TELEKINESIS

You don't need your hands to lift, throw, pin or crush anything within reach of your will. Things move because you will them to. With enough force, even another person can be moved simply because you want them to.

ADDDERS

- **Gentle Touch** (Lesser, 3 pts): grip and manipulate liquids, gases, or loose particulate matter (sand, water, smoke) as a cohesive mass, something solid-object telekinesis normally can't do.
- **Multi-Throw** (Lesser, 3 pts): the thrown-object attack (Level 3+) can hit a second target in the same Round at no additional Ki cost.
- **Crushing Grip** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to crush a gripped object or limb directly, Potence dice vs. Soak, no throw required, usable each round while the grip is maintained.
- **Deflection** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki as a reaction when a thrown or fired attack targets you or an ally in Close range: Advantage on that defense.

PSYCHOKINESIS / TELEKINESIS (CONTINUED)

- **Featherfall** (Lesser, 3 pts): grip your own body to slow a fall: no fall damage from any height, and you may hover in place until the end of your next turn.
- **Push** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki as a Normal action to shove one person in Close range: contest your Potence against theirs; if you win, they're Prone.
- **Return to Sender** (Greater, 6 pts): Level 3+: when a thrown or fired projectile misses you, spend 1 Ki to hurl it back at its source as your thrown-object attack, as a reaction. Requires Level 3.
- **Debris Storm** (Greater, 6 pts): Level 3+: where there's loose debris (rubble, gravel, broken glass - GM's call), spend 2 Ki as a Normal action to hurl it: roll your Potence dice against every target in a Close-sized area within range, each against its own Soak. Requires Level 3.

LIMITERS

- **Line of Sight Only:** you must maintain unbroken line of sight to whatever you're gripping. The effect ends instantly if that's blocked.
- **Guiding Hand:** you must point or gesture at what you grip. While Grabbed, or with both hands full or bound, the Gift doesn't work.
- **Pounding Head:** after your second use in a Scene, each further use leaves you Distracted until the end of your next turn.
- **Objects Only:** you can never grip, move or crush a living being. Level 4's person grip never applies. Can't be taken with **Push**.
- **Temper Surge:** when you lose a Health Level, anything you're gripping is flung in a random direction (GM's call).
- **One at a Time:** Level 4's multi-object grip never applies. You're limited to one object or person at a time, regardless of Level.
- **Backlash:** if a contested Potence attempt against a person fails, you're at

Disadvantage on all rolls for your next turn.

1 - Spend **1 Ki** to apply your Potence rating (both the flat carry/break give and the contested forcing dice pool) to an object within **Close** range, no touch required. Initiating is a Normal action; holding or moving something across subsequent rounds takes a Fast action each round to maintain concentration.

2 - Range extends to **Near**. You can also perform simple fine manipulation at range (turn a key, flip a switch, thread a needle) with no roll.

3 - Range extends to **Far**. You can hurl an object you're gripping at a target as an attack: roll your Potence dice per-die vs. the target's Soak, same shape as a thrown weapon. Ki cost stays **1**.

4 - You can grip and move several objects at once (up to a handful), or grip a person directly to restrain or reposition them (contested against their Potence or Soak, GM's call). Ki cost rises to **2**.

5 - Maintaining a telekinetic grip no longer requires concentration once per Scene, and the mass you can grip doubles beyond your normal Potence carrying capacity. Ki cost from Level 1 drops to **0**.

PSYCHOMETRY

Objects have a memory. A sword remembers who used it. A ring recalls the years it spent on the C.E.O.'s finger. Touch something and fragments of its history rush into your mind. Faces, emotions, places, and events are all imprinted within mundane items. You do not get to choose which parts.

Direct touch is required at every Level - there is no remote version of this Gift.

ADDERS

PSYCHOMETRY (CONTINUED)

- **Lingering Impression** (Lesser, 3 pts): after reading an object, you retain a faint sense of it for a Day, letting you recognize it or its owner again on a later touch without a fresh roll.
- **Emotional Resonance** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, ask specifically about the emotional state of whoever last handled the object, getting a clear answer even at Level 1's flash tier.
- **Chain Reading** (Greater, 6 pts): read a second object that was in contact with the first at the time of the event in question, extending the vision to include it, for the same Ki cost.
- **Walls Remember** (Lesser, 3 pts): touch a wall, floor or doorframe to read the place itself: questions can be about anything that happened in that room.
- **Last Hand's Trail** (Lesser, 3 pts): after a reading, spend 1 Ki: you know the rough direction of the object's last handler for the rest of the Scene.
- **Weapon's Memory** (Lesser, 3 pts): when a weapon in Melee range misses you or you Grab it, spend 1 Ki to read its habits: your defense against that weapon is at Advantage for the rest of the Scene.
- **Imprint** (Lesser, 3 pts): leave a memory in an object on purpose - a message, a face, a warning. The next person to touch it sees it as a flash, Gift or not.
- **Flesh Remembers** (Greater, 6 pts): read a person by touch: roll your Level + half your Psyche per-die against their Psyche wall. A connecting die lets you ask one question about where their body has been or what it has done in the last Day.
- **Replay** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki: a detailed vision plays out as a faint replay around the object, seen by everyone present.

LIMITERS

- **Painful Echo**: a detailed vision always costs 1 unsoakable Health Level, even after the Ki

cost drops to 0 at Level 5.

- **One Touch Only**: you can only ever read an object once. A second reading of the same object yields nothing new.
- **Overwhelmed by Violence**: if the object's history includes a violent death or severe trauma, roll Moira + Difficulty or be Disadvantaged for the rest of the Scene.
- **Bare to the World**: you can't choose not to read. The first time per Scene you touch something with a violent or grieving history, you are Distracted until the end of your next turn and the GM picks what you see.
- **Lost in the Echo**: each question takes a full minute of trance; while in it you count as Surprised against any attack.
- **Last Owner Only**: you only ever reach the history of the object's most recent owner. Level 2's reach further back never applies.

1 - Touch an object and roll **Moira + Difficulty**.

Ask 1 question about its most significant recent history - the answer comes as a vague impression, a flash of emotion or sense-memory. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - Ask up to 2 questions. Answers now come as a clearer scene rather than a flash, and can reach further back into the object's history, not just its most recent moments.

3 - Ask up to 3 questions. Spend 1 Ki per question to push that answer into a detailed, near-immersive vision instead of a scene - faces, words, real specifics.

4 - Ask up to 4 questions. Detailed visions (Level 3) can now identify specific people and approximate dates, and reach centuries back if the object is old enough to hold it.

5 - Ask up to 5 questions. A touch can now reconstruct a brief sequence of the object's major moments rather than one isolated scene. Ki cost for a detailed vision drops to 0.

REGENERATION

You get knocked down, but you get up again. And again. And again. Your body refuses to be broken. Wounds close while you watch and injuries that should leave you permanently broken are only temporary setbacks. Given enough time - damage that should be irreversible will heal.

Additionally, given rest each Day, you can heal away a Physical scar entirely, on yourself only, in **Days equal to how far below 0 your Health went**. Regeneration never touches a Mental or Social scar.

ADDDERS

- **Battlefield Mend** (Lesser, 3 pts): the combat heal (Level 3+) can trigger reflexively the first time you'd drop to 0 Health Levels in a Scene, stabilizing you instantly.
- **Deep Reserves** (Lesser, 3 pts): the combat heal's per-Round use cap increases by one at every Level (2/Round at Level 3, 3/Round at Level 4, etc.).
- **Overheal Buffer** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, using the combat heal while already at full Health Levels instead grants a temporary bonus Health Level that lasts until the Scene ends.
- **Rapid Mend** (Greater, 6 pts): the Level 5 permanent-harm recovery only needs a full Scene of dedicated rest instead of a full Day.
- **Sealed Wounds** (Lesser, 3 pts): you can't be made Bleeding; any Bleeding on you ends at the start of your turn.
- **Second Wind** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, when you use the combat heal (Level 3+), also shake off Exhausted or Staggered. Requires Level 3.
- **Adaptive Flesh** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, after one source (a named weapon, a specific Gift, fire) costs you a Health Level, name it: for the rest of the Scene, attacks from that source against you are at Disadvantage.

- **Mending Mind** (Greater, 6 pts): the combat heal (Level 3+) may restore 1 Poise instead of 1 Health Level, and once per Scene 1 Sanity level instead. Requires Level 3.

LIMITERS

- **Feed the Fire**: passive recovery requires actually eating a substantial meal during the rest period. It doesn't work on an empty stomach.
- **No Instant Fix**: the Ki-gated combat heal (Level 3+) never applies. Passive recovery rates are the only way this Gift heals, at any Level.
- **Fragile Restoration**: a Health Level recovered by the combat heal (Level 3+) can be lost again by any single hit, even one that would normally deal no damage past Soak.
- **Bane**: choose one source at creation (fire, silver, acid, blessed weapons). Health Levels it takes never regenerate - not passively, not with Ki - and heal only at the normal rate.
- **Burning Through**: after the third combat heal in a Scene, you're Exhausted.
- **Borrowed Flesh**: at the end of any Scene you used the combat heal, you lose again half the Health Levels it restored, rounded down.

1 - While resting (not fighting or exerting), recover 1 Health Level per **Scene** of rest.

2 - Passive recovery rate improves to 1 Health Level per **Minute** of rest.

3 - Spend **1 Ki** to instantly recover 1 Health Level at any time, even mid-combat - usable once per **Round**.

4 - Passive recovery improves further to 1 Health Level per **Round** of dedicated rest (near-instant between exchanges). The Ki-spend combat heal from Level 3 can now be used twice per Round.

REGENERATION (CONTINUED)

5 - Given a full **Day** of rest, you can recover from even normally-permanent harm - a lost limb, lasting disfigurement. Ki cost for the combat heal drops to **0**.

RESTORATION

Minds break the way bodies do, and some of them can be set. You reach the part of a person that stopped holding together - the panic, the lost hours, the thing they can't stop seeing - and you put it back where it goes. It doesn't make them forget. It makes them able to carry it.

This Gift always costs Ki, at every Level. There is no mastery discount to free.

Additionally, given dedicated time each Day, you can heal away a Mental scar entirely, on yourself or someone else, in **Days equal to how far below 0 their Sanity went**. Restoration never touches a Physical or Social scar.

ADDERS

- **Read the Damage** (Lesser, 3 pts): as a Fast action, touch a target to learn their current Sanity and Poise, every Mental scar they carry, and anything working on their mind, hidden things included. No Ki.
- **Lingering Calm** (Lesser, 3 pts): a Level you restore gains a one-time buffer: the next Mental hit that would take it away is negated instead.
- **Borrowed Calm** (Lesser, 3 pts): a willing target may pay any Ki cost of this Gift from their own Ki instead of yours.
- **Quiet Room** (Greater, 6 pts): as a Slow action, spend 3 Ki to restore 1 Sanity to every willing ally within Close range (Near at Level 3+). It counts as your use for the Round.
- **Caught Before the Fall** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when a target within your range loses Sanity, spend 2 Ki as a reaction, outside your turn, to restore it at once, even if you've already used this Gift this Round.
- **Unravel** (Greater, 6 pts): run the Gift backward: spend 1 Ki and make a Mental attack that rolls your Level plus half your Psyche in dice against Psyche, pulling at the seams you'd otherwise mend.

RESTORATION (CONTINUED)

LIMITERS

- **Cost to Self:** restoring another person costs you 1 Sanity of your own per use, in addition to the Ki cost.
- **Willing Only:** you can never restore an unwilling or Shattered target. Level 1's "willing or Shattered" narrows to willing only.
- **Talk It Through:** every use of this Gift is a Slow action, at every Level, and the target has to be able to hear you.
- **Can't Heal Yourself:** this Gift never works on you, at any Level.
- **Must Know Them:** you can only restore someone you've shared at least one full Scene with before.
- **Carry It Home:** after each use you're Distracted until the end of your next turn, holding what you took from them.

1 - Touch a willing or Shattered target and spend **1 Ki** to instantly restore 1 Sanity Level. Usable once per Round. No Gift Check.

2 - The same touch and Ki spend can instead restore 1 Poise, or clear Overwhelmed or Distracted.

3 - Restores **2 Levels** per use instead of 1. Touch is no longer required, range extends to **Close**.

4 - Reaches what was done to a mind on purpose: the same use can end domination, possession or enthrallment, or restore a memory erased or rewritten by a Gift. Ki cost for these rises to **2**. Corruption is beyond it - it's its own thing.

5 - Given a full **Day** of dedicated care and **3 Ki**, you can restore what a mind has lost for good: memories taken by injury, illness or age, a self worn away.

SALVO

When you absolutely, positively have to deal damage at range, this is how you do it. You send something across the intervening space - a bullet, a shard of ice, an energy blast or something that has no physical presence at all - and it hurts. A lot. You decide what the attack is, how it looks and how it reaches its target.

What crosses the gap is chosen at creation, and described however you like. The rules don't read the description.

You are choosing a picture, not a mechanic.

What you throw, fire, project or simply will across the room is yours to describe and changes nothing. It is the same dice against the same wall either way.

What the rules read is always the same. One target, a Physical attack out to **Far** range, at every Level. The to-hit is a straight Attribute-vs-Defense roll with whichever Element fits the approach. The dice resolve one at a time against **Soak** and a connecting die costs a **Health Level**. Every shot costs **1 Ki**, and there is never a Gift Check. What the Levels buy is dice, Level plus half your Ferocity, and that is the whole Gift.

This is not a Signature Move. A Move is built to be strange. Salvo is the one you take when you want to shoot something.

ADDS

- **Through and Through** (Lesser, 3 pts): on a hit, one connecting die also connects against a second target directly behind the first.
- **Scatter** (Greater, 6 pts): spend **1 Ki** on top of the attack's own cost to split its dice between any two targets in range, each resolved against their own Soak. The pool is divided, not doubled.

SALVO (CONTINUED)

- **No Warning** (Lesser, 3 pts): whatever crosses the gap can't be perceived until it lands. A target who hasn't already spotted you can't tell where the attack came from.
- **Held Breath** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to lose it as a **Fast action** without giving up the rest of your Normal action.
- **Charged Shot** (Lesser, 3 pts): lose the shot as a Slow action instead of a Normal one to roll 2 extra dice; you are Off Balance until the start of your next turn.
- **Pinning Fire** (Lesser, 3 pts): instead of rolling damage, spend 1 Ki and make the to-hit roll as usual; on a hit the target is Distracted and at Disadvantage on attacks until the end of their next turn.
- **Curving Shot** (Lesser, 3 pts): the shot bends around cover and corners: you can target anyone within Far range whose position you know, even without a clear line to them. Can't be taken with **Line of Sight Only**.
- **Delayed Fuse** (Greater, 6 pts): on a hit, you may hold the dice instead of resolving them; detonate them as a Fast action any time later in the Scene, resolving against the target and everyone in Melee range of them.
- **Everything Into It** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, spend all your remaining Ki (at least 3) to add that many dice to one shot; afterward you are Exhausted until the end of the Scene.
- **Meet It Mid-Air** (Lesser, 3 pts): when a ranged attack targets you or an ally within Near range, spend 1 Ki and give up your next Fast action to fire into it: the attacker rolls to hit at Disadvantage.

LIMITERS

- **Line of Sight Only**: nothing through smoke, darkness, or anything else that breaks a clear view, whatever your other senses would allow.
- **Tell-Tale**: every use leaves an obvious trace pointing back at you. Anyone looking knows

who did it.

- **Winds Down**: after the third use in a Scene, every further use costs 1 more Ki - 2 Ki per shot for the rest of the Scene.
- **Charge Time**: every shot is a Slow action, at every Level. Can't be taken with **Charged Shot**.
- **Recoil**: every shot leaves you Off Balance until the start of your next turn.
- **Burned Channel**: every shot after the second in a Scene also costs 1 unsoakable Health Level, the hands or eyes it leaves through scorching.
- **Falls Off**: at Far range the shot rolls 2 fewer dice.
- **Called Aloud**: you must shout the attack's name and have a free hand to fire; no shot while Grabbed, gagged or bound, and every shot gives away your position.

1 - Spend **1 Ki** to attack one target out to **Far** range for **1 + half your Ferocity** dice, resolved per-die against Soak like any weapon. No Gift Check, at this or any Level.

2 - **2 + half your Ferocity** dice.

3 - **3 + half your Ferocity** dice.

4 - **4 + half your Ferocity** dice.

5 - **5 + half your Ferocity** dice.

SANCTUARY

You can put a person out of reach. Not behind a wall - anyone could still swing at them - but past the point where anyone wants to. Hands falter, aim drifts, the shot goes wide. At its height, a place you ward becomes somewhere violence has to pay to start.

This Gift always costs Ki, at every Level.

ADDERS

SANCTUARY (CONTINUED)

- **Guarded Mind** (Lesser, 3 pts): the ward covers Mental attacks as well as Physical ones. Social attacks are never covered - words are rarely counted as violence.
- **Turned Aside** (Lesser, 3 pts): an attacker who fails the roll is also Distracted until the end of their next turn.
- **Tripwire** (Lesser, 3 pts): you know, wherever you are, the moment one of your wards is broken or tested, and by whom.
- **Hallowed Ground** (Greater, 6 pts): a Level 4+ ward stays for a Week, whether you're there or not. Requires Level 4.
- **No Second Try** (Greater, 6 pts): an attacker who fails the roll can't try against that warded person again this Scene.

LIMITERS

- **Vow of Peace**: while any ward of yours stands, you can't attack anyone, anywhere.
- **Others Only**: you can never ward yourself.
- **Fragile Peace**: a ward ends the first time anyone inside it loses a Health Level, from any source.
- **Consecrated**: warding a place (Level 4+) takes a full Hour of preparation there first.
- **Must Stay**: a place ward ends the moment you leave it, at every Level, including Level 5.

1 - Touch a willing target, yourself included, and spend **1 Ki** as a Slow action to ward them until the end of the Scene. Anyone who tries to make a Physical attack on them must first roll **Air + Difficulty 5**. On a failure the attack goes to another target of the attacker's choice, or is lost. The ward doesn't stop harm that isn't aimed at them - a blast, a fire, a falling roof. It ends at once if the warded person attacks anyone.

2 - Range extends to **Close**, touch no longer required. The roll to attack drops to **Air + Difficulty 4**.

3 - Ward up to **3 people** with the same Slow action and **1 Ki** each. The roll drops to **Air + Difficulty 3**. A warded person who attacks ends only their own ward.

4 - **Ward a place**: the space you're in, out to Close, for **3 Ki**. Everyone inside is warded while they stay inside, at **Air + Difficulty 2**. It lasts until the end of the Scene or until you leave it.

5 - The warded place becomes a true sanctuary, out to **Near**, until the next sunrise. There's no roll: anyone who wants to start violence inside it spends **1 Ki** first, once, and then fights as normal. Someone with no Ki can't start it at all. Anyone already attacked inside can answer without paying.

SHAPESHIFT

Your body is not fixed in form. Your skin, bone, muscle, and voice ripple and flow into new configurations. You can become almost anything you can imagine. You can wear another person's face, slip into the form of an animal like changing your clothes, or even become an inanimate object.

ADDERS

- **Instant Revert** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, revert to your true form as a Fast action instead of a Slow one, with no Gift Check.
- **Partial Aspect** (Lesser, 3 pts): as a Fast action with no Gift Check, change a single feature without a full disguise: gills to breathe water, eyes that see in darkness, grip pads to climb sheer surfaces at your Movement Rate.
- **Quick Change** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, if you break line of sight with everyone watching for even a moment, transform as a Fast action with no Gift Check.

SHAPESHIFT (CONTINUED)

- **Shed Skin** (Lesser, 3 pts): when Grabbed, spend 1 Ki to slough your outer layer and slip free, leaving a limp husk in their hands; you are no longer Grabbed.
- **Boneless** (Lesser, 3 pts): your body folds like cloth: squeeze through any gap your head fits through at half your Movement Rate, in any form.
- **Weaponized Flesh** (Greater, 6 pts): as a Fast action, grow blades, spikes or claws; while they last your unarmed attacks roll your Level plus half your Ferocity against Soak. The weapons are plainly inhuman and end any disguise.
- **Borrowed Motion** (Greater, 6 pts): when you mimic a specific animal (Level 3+), you gain its way of moving - swimming, climbing, burrowing, or flight at no more than your normal Movement Rate. Requires Level 3.
- **Full Spectrum Mimicry** (Lesser, 3 pts): mimicry (Level 2+) extends to scent and body heat too, fooling animal senses and thermal imaging, not just sight and sound.
- **Living Disguise** (Greater, 6 pts): while mimicking a specific person, you also gain a working instinctive sense of how they'd act or react, enough to improvise their mannerisms convincingly under pressure.

LIMITERS

- **Size Locked**: the mimicked form must stay within roughly your own mass ($\pm 25\%$). No shifting into something much larger or smaller.
- **Slow Return**: reverting to your true form always takes the same Slow action and Gift Check as transforming, at every Level.
- **Betraying Detail**: one small, GM-chosen detail of your true self always persists through the disguise (a birthmark, a habit, a scent), a fixed tell you don't get to choose.
- **Wrenching Change**: every transformation, in either direction, leaves you Off Balance

until the end of your next turn, visibly writhing as bone resets.

- **Losing Yourself**: every Scene you end in a form other than your own costs 1 Sanity, the borrowed shape crowding out who you were.
- **Bare Change**: clothes and carried gear never change with you; to pass as someone you need their clothes, and a shift in public leaves you standing in the wrong ones.
- **Piece of Them**: to mimic a specific individual (Level 3+) you need a piece of them - hair, blood, a nail - and the mimicry ends when the Scene does.

1 - Is a Slow action and triggers a [Gift Check](#) - success free, failure costs 1 Ki, the transformation happens either way. Transform into a generic member of a broad category you've seen examples of (a dog, a police officer, a teenage boy) - not a specific individual. Appearance only, no voice. Undetectable unless an observer has specific reason to doubt it, in which case they may roll Insight + Difficulty to see through it.

2 - Mimicry now includes voice as well as appearance.

3 - You may now mimic a specific individual - a particular person or animal you've seen in real detail - or a specific inanimate object, instead of just a generic category.

4 - You no longer need to have seen the specific target in person - a detailed photo or description is enough. You also pick up minor functional traits where it makes sense - their exact fingerprint or biometric signature (fooling biometric scanners).

5 - The mimicry becomes undetectable even under close technical scrutiny, and lasts indefinitely until you choose to change back - no more Gift Check required to maintain it.

SIGNATURE MOVE

Every seasoned fighter, mystic or gifted soul eventually develops something that is theirs - a technique, a maneuver, a flourish nobody taught them and nobody else does quite the same way. It has a name, whether or not you are the one who named it.

You can have more than one. Signature Move is bought per Move: each one is its own purchase, with its own Levels at the usual 3 points apiece, and each one gets a **name**. Two Moves at Level 3 cost 18 points, the same as any other 18 points of Gift. Nothing stops you carrying three except the size of the pool.

Each Move is defined once, at creation: whether it is primarily an **attack** or a **non-damaging effect**. If it's an attack, you make two separate choices - and they don't have to match.

The attack source. **Ferocity**, **Presence** or **Psyche** - the sub-stat that powers the Move. This is what you add to a die when you spend Ki to infuse it, and it's the part that says what the Move is about you: raw aggression, sheer force of personality, or a mind that pushes.

The wall it resolves against. **Soak**, **Presence** or **Psyche** - what the dice are rolled against, one at a time, and what decides the cost. A die through Soak costs a Health Level. Through Presence, a Poise. Through Psyche, a Sanity.

Most Moves pair the obvious way. They don't have to, and the interesting ones don't.

A **Presence** Move resolved against **Soak** is a beam of pure personal force that knocks people down - you aren't talking anyone into anything, you're bringing enough of yourself to bear that it lands like a hit. A **Ferocity** Move against **Presence** is a scream that breaks composure instead of bone. A **Psyche** Move against **Soak** is a stare that stops a heart.

The wall you pick also picks your to-hit target, because there are three Defenses and each answers one kind of attack. A Move resolving

against Soak rolls against Physical Defense, one against Presence rolls against Social Defense, one against Psyche rolls against Mental Defense. What stays yours either way is the Element - picked by how you're going about it, the same as any other attack. And it never changes what a connecting die costs - the wall decides that, always. Flavor the Move however you like; the wall is what the rules read.

ADDERS

- **Extended Range** (Lesser, 3 pts): +1 Ki per use. The Move reaches one Range Band further than its current Level would normally allow.
- **Piercing Edge** (Lesser, 3 pts): the Move ignores a flat 2 points of the target's chosen wall before resolving.
- **Area of Effect** (Greater, 6 pts): +1 Ki per use. The Move affects everyone within its range/area rather than a single target - exact shape and extent defined when the Move is built, GM-approved.
- **Kiai** (Lesser, 3 pts): shout the Move's name as you use it for Advantage on its to-hit roll; everyone within Near range hears exactly where you are.
- **Counter Form** (Greater, 6 pts): once per round, when a Melee attack misses you, spend 1 Ki to use the Move against that attacker at once, as a free action.
- **Second Form** (Greater, 6 pts): the Move gets a second form, defined at creation with a different wall or a non-damaging effect; choose which form to use per use. Same Level, same Ki.
- **Thousandfold Practice** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, after you have already used the Move this Scene, the next use costs no Ki.

SIGNATURE MOVE (CONTINUED)

- **Combination Technique** (Lesser, 3 pts): when an ally has attacked the same target earlier this round, the Move gains Advantage on its to-hit roll and its secondary effect lands even if only one die connects.
- **Last Stand Awakening** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, while you are on your last Health Level, use the Move as if it were one Level higher (dice, range and secondary effect; Ki cost as your real Level).

LIMITERS

- **Telegraphed**: the Move requires an obvious, visible windup, a stance, a gesture, something a watching enemy learns to recognize. Anyone who's seen it before gains Advantage on defending against it again.
- **One and Done**: the Move can only be used once per Scene, regardless of Level.
- **Costly Signature**: the Move's Ki cost is always 1 higher than its Level would normally require, at every Level, including Level 1 (which costs 1 Ki instead of 0).
- **Rooted Stance**: you can't use the Move on a turn in which you have moved.
- **Bound to the Blade**: the Move only works through one specific weapon or object; without it in hand, you have no Move.
- **Backlash**: every use costs you 1 point from the track its source hits: a Health Level for Ferocity, a Poise for Presence, a Sanity for Psyche.
- **Open After**: after using the Move, attacks against you have Advantage until the start of your next turn.
- **Needs a Reason**: you can only use the Move once you or an ally in sight has lost a Health Level this Scene.

1 - If an attack: deals **1 + half your attack sub-stat** vs the target's chosen wall. If non-damaging: produces one small, clearly-bounded effect (GM approval on scope). Using it is a Fast action. No Ki cost, no Gift Check.

2 - Damage rises to **2 + half your attack sub-stat** (if an attack); the non-damaging effect's scope widens (still GM-approved, but a real step up from Level 1). Using the Move now costs **1 Ki**, in addition to the Fast action - that Ki spend is what bakes in one minor secondary effect layered onto the base Move (a small knockback, a brief off-balance status, a minor debuff).

3 - Damage rises to **3 + half your attack sub-stat**. Range extends from Melee to **Close** (Levels 1-2 were Melee-only). The secondary effect from Level 2 upgrades to a moderate tier (a real knockdown, a genuine debuff, a short status lock, rather than just "brief"). Still 1 Ki per use.

4 - Damage rises to **4 + half your attack sub-stat**. Range extends to **Near**. The secondary effect upgrades to a major tier (a real status condition, a significant forced reposition, a debuff with teeth). Ki cost rises to **2** per use.

5 - Damage rises to **5 + half your attack sub-stat**. Range extends to **Far**. The secondary effect reaches its full, signature-defining scope (GM-approved - a finishing blow, a reality-bending flourish, whatever fits the Move you built). Ki cost rises to **3** per use.

SIZE CHANGE

Humans tend to exist on a specific scale. For you - that scale is just a recommendation. You can grow to enormous size, shrink to minuscule proportions, or stretch parts of yourself beyond normal limits. Size is just a tool for you.

SIZE CHANGE (CONTINUED)

ADDDERS

- **Partial Shift** (Lesser, 3 pts): grow or shrink just one part of your body, a hand, a foot, instead of the whole thing, for precision work without the full-body swing.
- **Momentum Slam** (Lesser, 3 pts): while enlarged, spend 1 Ki on a successful hit to add your current Soak bonus, halved (round down), as extra damage dice on that attack.
- **Proportional Gear** (Greater, 6 pts): carried objects and worn equipment resize along with you automatically, staying usable at any size instead of being left behind or crushed.
- **Surprise Scale** (Lesser, 3 pts): if you change size as part of an attack while unnoticed (shrunk out of sight, or simply underestimated), the target counts as Surprised against that attack.
- **Stomp** (Lesser, 3 pts): while enlarged, spend 1 Ki to make one Physical attack against everyone in Melee range; a hit knocks the target Prone instead of dealing damage.
- **Giant's Grip** (Greater, 6 pts): while enlarged, a Melee hit may leave the target Grabbed in your hand instead of dealing damage; they are at Disadvantage on every roll to break free.
- **Rubber Body** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki when a blunt Physical attack hits you to stretch with it and ignore one connecting die.
- **Dense Form** (Lesser, 3 pts): mass stays when you shrink: while shrunk you keep your full weight and can't be forcibly repositioned, and your unarmed hits lose nothing to size. Can't be taken with **Scale Penalty**.
- **Colossus Stride** (Lesser, 3 pts): while enlarged, your Movement Rate doubles and rubble, fences and crowds don't slow you.

LIMITERS

- **Slow Growth**: activating this Gift is always a Slow action, at every Level.
- **Fixed Direction**: chosen once at creation, you can only ever grow or only ever shrink, never both.
- **Unscaled Gear**: your clothing and equipment never resize with you. Growing bursts your clothes; shrinking leaves you swimming in them, at Disadvantage on any roll requiring properly fitted gear until you adjust.
- **Scale Penalty**: while enlarged, attacks against you have Advantage and nothing smaller than a building hides you; while shrunk, your Physical attacks roll half their dice, rounded down.
- **Stuck Size**: returning to normal size takes a Slow action and a Gift Check; on a failure you stay changed until the end of the Scene.
- **Crash Afterward**: at the end of any Scene in which you changed size at Level 3+, you are Exhausted.

1 - Each use, choose one: grow or shrink your whole body by roughly half again your normal height in either direction, or stretch a single limb to extend your reach out to Close range instead of Melee. Is a Fast action. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - The size swing doubles - grow or shrink up to double your normal height in either direction, or stretch your reach out to Near range. Still just a Fast action, no Ki, no Gift Check.

3 - The size swing triples, or reach extends to Far. Activating now costs **1 Ki**. While enlarged, gain **+2 Soak**; while shrunk, attacks made against you are at **Disadvantage** - you're a much harder target to land a hit on.

SIZE CHANGE (CONTINUED)

4 - While enlarged, Soak rises to **+4** and you gain **+2 Ferocity** - sheer mass hits harder. While shrunk, attacks against you remain at Disadvantage, and you gain **Advantage** on Stealth-related rolls - small enough to go unnoticed in the right circumstances. Ki cost rises to **2**.

5 - While enlarged, Soak rises to **+6** and Ferocity to **+4** - titanic scale, capable of breaking through walls and toppling structures underfoot (GM-adjudicated environmental interaction). While shrunk, you become undetectable to anything not specifically searching for you at that scale - full immunity to being noticed by chance alone. Ki cost rises to **3**.

SUPER-STRENGTH

You can produce force far beyond what your muscles should be able to produce. You can punch, lift and throw with improbable strength, harnessing raw physical power to ignore the normal limits of flesh, bone and leverage.

ADDERS

- **Rending Grip** (Lesser, 3 pts): the boosted attack (Level 3+) also disarms or crushes whatever the target is holding, on a hit.
- **Seismic Slam** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to slam the ground, a shockwave dealing Potence dice vs. Soak to everyone at Close range along it.
- **Unstoppable Force** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki when you land a hit. If enough dice connect to drop the target past 0 Health Levels in one blow, let it carry all the way through instead of stopping them at exactly 0.
- **Air Pressure Punch** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to strike the air itself: an unarmed Physical attack out to Near range, which can take the Level 3 boosted die.
- **Anything's a Weapon** (Lesser, 3 pts): swing or throw anything within your Carrying Capacity - a lamppost, a car door - as a weapon, thrown out to Near range; it breaks on the hit.
- **Iron Frame** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki when a Physical attack hits you to add your current Potence bonus to your Soak against that attack.
- **Stored Impact** (Greater, 6 pts): every Health Level you lose to a Physical attack this Scene is banked; your next boosted attack adds one die per banked Level (up to your Gift Level) and empties the bank.
- **Past the Limit** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, double your Potence bonus for one action; afterward you take 2 unsoakable Health Levels as your own body gives way.

SUPER-STRENGTH (CONTINUED)

LIMITERS

- **Uncontrolled Force:** the boosted attack (Level 3+) always destroys any inanimate object it strikes alongside the target. You can't pull the blow.
- **Torn Muscle:** every use of the boosted attack costs you 1 unsoakable Health Level - the strain of unleashing that much force.
- **Loud and Obvious:** your strength is never subtle. Even the passive Level 1+ bonus is visibly inhuman, no way to hide it.
- **Bottomless Appetite:** after any Scene in which you used the boosted attack, you must eat a huge meal within the hour or be Exhausted until you do.
- **Heavy Hands:** your strength never switches off: Disadvantage on any delicate manual task, and fragile things you handle under stress break.
- **Anger Engine:** the boosted attack (Level 3+) only works once you have lost a Health Level or Poise this Scene, or seen an ally lose one.
- **Short Burst:** the Level 2+ contested bonus and the boosted attack only work for 3 rounds per Scene, counted from their first use.

1 - Treat your Potence as **2 higher** for Carrying Capacity and Break Threshold only. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - The bonus also applies to the contested dice pool - roll as if your Potence were 2 higher when forcing, breaking, or moving something actively resisting.

3 - Spend **1 Ki** on a successful Physical attack to add your Potence to that attack die, on top of Ferocity - the boosted die becomes **d10 + Ferocity + Potence** vs. Soak, for the same 1 Ki spend Ki Infusion already costs.

4 - The Potence bonus from Levels 1-2 rises to **4**. The boosted attack (Level 3) can also send the target flying, a forced reposition one Range Band, on top of the damage.

5 - The Potence bonus rises to **6**. Once per Scene, unleash a GM-approved capstone feat sized to the moment: overturning a vehicle, collapsing a wall, holding a structure up long enough for others to escape. Ki cost for the boosted attack drops to **0**.

SWARM

You cease to be a single entity, scattering into a living cloud of many constituent living things. Each of them is bound to the others - moving with a single mind. Cracks become doorways and barriers become nothing more than inconvenience.

What you come apart into - a cloud of insects, a flock of bats, a swirl of micro-drones, something else - is chosen at creation.

The double-damage vulnerability to area attacks while swarmed never goes away, at any Level.

ADDERS

- **Distraction Cloud** (Lesser, 3 pts): while swarmed, spend 1 Ki to impose Disadvantage on all attacks a single target within your spread range makes for the rest of the Round, your components harassing them from every angle.
- **Instant Regroup** (Lesser, 3 pts): reforming is always a free action instead of whatever action cost your Level normally requires.
- **Split Focus** (Greater, 6 pts): while spread (Level 3+), attack two separate points independently instead of one uniform area, each resolved separately, same Ki cost.
- **Left Behind** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you reform, leave one component on a target or in a room; for the rest of the Scene you know where it is and hear what it hears.

SWARM (CONTINUED)

- **Devouring Cloud** (Greater, 6 pts): while swarmed, spend 1 Ki per round to engulf one target in Melee range: make a Physical attack, and on a hit they are Blinded and Distracted until you leave them.
- **Crawling Armor** (Lesser, 3 pts): in your true form, spend 1 Ki to cover yourself in a layer of your components for the Scene: the first single-target Physical attack per round against you loses one die.
- **One Survives** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, if you would drop to 0 Health Levels while swarmed, spend all your remaining Ki (at least 1) to scatter instead: you leave the Scene and reform, on your last Health Level, at the start of the next one.
- **Everything Comes Along** (Lesser, 3 pts): your clothes and anything you carry break down into the swarm with you and reform with you.
- **Hollow Shape** (Lesser, 3 pts): while spread (Level 3+), spend 1 Ki to hold a convincing silhouette of yourself somewhere in your spread; the first attack this round aimed at you strikes the decoy instead. Requires Level 3.

LIMITERS

- **Fragile Focus**: if a physical barrier interrupts your swarm mid-flow (a door slams shut, a window closes), you reform prematurely on the spot, ending the effect early.
- **Weather Locked**: strong wind, rain, or similar conditions impose Disadvantage on all actions while swarmed.
- **Always Costly**: the spread/attack Ki cost never drops to 0. Level 5's mastery discount doesn't apply.
- **Scattered Mind**: while spread (Level 3+) you are Distracted.
- **Hungry Swarm**: after a Scene swarmed, your swarm must feed - a Slow action with something to feed on - before you break

apart again; until then every use costs 1 extra Ki.

- **Repulsive**: anyone who sees you swarm recoils: social rolls against them are at Disadvantage for the rest of the Scene.
- **Fire Bane**: fire (or one other element fixed at creation) always counts as an area attack against you while swarmed, even from a single-target source, and deals double dice.

1 - Spend **1 Ki**; is a Slow action to break apart into your swarm form (a cloud of bugs, bats, drones, whatever fits). While swarmed, immune to single-target Physical attacks (they connect with mostly empty space), but any attack that hits an area instead deals double dice. You can flow through any gap large enough for a single one of your components (a crack under a door, a vent). Lasts up to a Minute. Reforming is a Normal action.

2 - Duration extends to a **Scene**. Breaking apart is now a Normal action.

3 - Breaking apart is now a Fast action. While swarmed, spend **1 Ki** to spread out across **Close** range instead of staying roughly person-shaped, letting you watch or listen from many points at once, or make a single Physical attack (per-die vs. Soak) against everyone in that range simultaneously.

4 - Spread range extends to **Near**.

5 - Spread range extends to **Far**. Ki cost for spreading out and attacking (Level 3) drops to **0**.

TECHNOKINESIS

Machines speak their own language, and you are fluent in it. Electronics respond to you like you are one of their own - acting as an extension of your own hands. You can sense, access, alter and eventually command technology in ways that defy understanding.

TECHNOKINESIS (CONTINUED)

ADDDERS

- **Lingering Foothold** (Lesser, 3 pts): once you've connected to a device or system, retain a passive backdoor indefinitely, reconnecting instantly with no roll or Ki, until the device is reset, reformatted, or physically disconnected.
- **Ghost in Every Machine** (Lesser, 3 pts): Level 1's passive awareness extends to Near range, and you also immediately sense which devices nearby are actively working against you, recording, transmitting, or armed, without needing to connect to any of them.
- **Overload Surge** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to fry a connected device instead of controlling it, disabling it outright and dealing a jolt of feedback (1d10 vs Soak) to anyone in direct contact with it.
- **Voice in the Wires** (Lesser, 3 pts): speak or show images through any speaker or screen you are connected to.
- **Borrowed Eyes** (Lesser, 3 pts): while connected to a camera or microphone, perceive through it as if you stood there; it counts as your line of sight for other Gifts.
- **Sleeper Command** (Lesser, 3 pts): leave one standing order in a connected device - 'when that door opens, cut the lights' - that runs on its own later in the Scene.
- **Skim** (Lesser, 3 pts): as a Fast action, pull everything a connected device holds into your head; finding anything specific in it takes the usual Air + Difficulty.
- **Blackout Pulse** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 2 Ki: every powered device within Close range shuts down until someone restarts it (a Slow action for anyone).
- **Into the Flesh** (Greater, 6 pts): your Gift reaches implants, cybernetic limbs and drones: spend 1 Ki and roll Air vs. the owner's Mental Defense; on a success one implant

or drone stops working until the end of their next turn.

LIMITERS

- **Networked Only**: this Gift only works on devices already networked or powered on. Standalone, offline, or unpowered electronics are invisible to it.
- **Visible Interference**: connecting to a device causes visible interference nearby, flickering screens, dimming lights, tipping off anyone paying attention.
- **Slow Handshake**: every connection, at every Level, takes a full Round to establish instead of its normal action cost.
- **Wired In**: you must touch the device, or something physically wired to it, at every Level; the range from Level 3+ only extends across a connected network.
- **Feedback Burn**: when a device you are connected to is destroyed or someone forces you out, you lose 1 Sanity.
- **Static Mind**: while you hold any connection open, you are Distracted.
- **Hostile Static**: machines you use by hand hate you: Disadvantage on any roll using a device the ordinary way.

1 - Active electronics within Close range register at the edge of your awareness: a phone buzzing in a pocket, a camera panning, a server humming behind a wall. No roll, no Ki.

2 - Touch a simple device (a lock, a lightswitch, a basic terminal) and roll **Air + Difficulty** to make it answer to you directly, no cable, no login. Costs a Normal action.

3 - Range extends to **Close**, no touch required. Spend **1 Ki** to reach a straightforward device or system (a camera, a door, a simple network) from a distance.

4 - Range extends to **Near**. A complex networked system stops being a wall of code and becomes a space you can navigate and rewrite in real time. Ki cost rises to **2**.

TECHNOKINESIS (CONTINUED)

5 - Range extends to **Far**. An entire building's systems, a fleet of devices, a whole network: scale stops being a limit, all of it yours to command at once. Ki cost from Level 3 drops to **0**.

TELEPATHY/EMPATHY

Other people's minds are an open book to you. You can hear thoughts they haven't spoken, read the emotions below their expressions, and eventually establish a direct connection between minds. Intuition eventually becomes access to another person's inner world.

ADDDERS

- **Emotional Broadcast** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, project a simple emotion (fear, calm, doubt) into a target's mind as a Mental attack, even before Level 4's two-way link exists.
- **Group Mind** (Lesser, 3 pts): once a two-way link is established with someone (Level 4+), bridge one additional willing party into the same shared link.
- **Shared Senses** (Lesser, 3 pts): through a two-way link (Level 4+), see and hear what the other person sees and hears. Requires Level 4.
- **Quiet Mind** (Lesser, 3 pts): other readers and mental attackers roll at Disadvantage to get into your head, and you always know when someone tries.
- **Crowd Read** (Lesser, 3 pts): read the mood of a whole crowd with one roll, and learn which person in it feels something different from the rest.
- **Hear the Lie** (Lesser, 3 pts): when someone within your range lies aloud, make a Gift Check (no Ki); on a success you know it was a lie.
- **Empathic Anchor** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene per ally, spend 1 Ki to restore 1 Poise or 1 Sanity to someone you are linked to, or end their Frightened or Flustered.
- **Thought Before Deed** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki: against one target whose surface thoughts you have read this Scene, you have Advantage on defense rolls until the end of the round.

TELEPATHY/EMPATHY (CONTINUED)

- **Talking Down** (Lesser, 3 pts): through a two-way link (Level 4+), with dedicated time each Week, heal away a Mental scar, on yourself or someone you're linked to, in **Weeks equal to how far below 0 their Sanity went**. Requires Level 4.
- **Memory Lockpick** (Greater, 6 pts): spend an extra 1 Ki on a forced read (Level 3+) to target one specific memory or fact instead of a general surface impression, yielding a precise answer instead of a vague sensation.

LIMITERS

- **One Mind at a Time**: you can only maintain one link or active read at a time, even at Level 5. A new link severs the previous one automatically.
- **Echoes Linger**: a faint psychic echo lingers after any read or link. Other telepaths or psychics can detect that you were there.
- **Vulnerable Link**: while actively linked (Level 4+), you're at Disadvantage against any Mental attack targeting you. The open channel cuts both ways.
- **Eye Contact**: every read and link, at every Level, needs eye contact to start.
- **Always On**: you can't shut it off: with a dozen or more minds within Close range you are Distracted.
- **Feel It Too**: when a forced read connects, you lose 1 Poise; when someone linked to you loses a Health Level, you lose 1 Poise.
- **Known Reader**: anyone who knows what you can do is uneasy around you: social rolls against them are at Disadvantage.

1 - Against a target actively resisting, spend **1 Ki** to force the read as a genuine **Mental attack - 1 + half your Psyche** dice per-die against their Psyche wall, breaching to their surface thoughts on a connecting die. Otherwise, roll **Air + Difficulty** to read someone's general emotional state - fear, anger, deception, attraction, whatever's closest to the surface - requires them to be within Close range and perceivable to you. Success reveals the surface emotion; no specific thoughts, just the feeling underneath. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - Range extends to **Near**. The forced read rises to **2 + half your Psyche** dice. You can now read surface, unguarded thoughts as well as emotions - still resolved as Air + Difficulty; a target actively resisting simply raises the Difficulty (GM's call), not yet a contested roll.

3 - Range extends to **Far**. The forced read rises to **3 + half your Psyche** dice.

4 - The forced read strengthens to **4 + half your Psyche**. You can now project your own thoughts into a target's mind as well as read theirs - a genuine two-way telepathic link. For a willing or aware participant, this works at **Line of Sight** (as far as you can see them, not bound by the normal Range Bands). Forcing a read on an unwilling target (the Level 1 Mental attack) is capped at **Near**. Forced reads can now dig into deeper memories and guarded secrets, not just surface thoughts. Ki cost for forced reads stays **1**.

5 - The forced read rises to **5 + half your Psyche** dice, and its range extends back out to **Far**. Additionally, once you've established a genuine two-way link with someone (even briefly), you retain a limited telepathic connection to them indefinitely afterward - no range limit at all, a permanent bond once formed. Ki cost for forced reads drops to **0**.

TELEPORT / DIMENSIONAL PORTAL

The distance between spaces doesn't matter to you. You simply stop being at point A and start existing at point B. Walls, distance and even the boundaries between worlds become irrelevant as you flicker across space or rip open a gate through it.

ADDERS

- **Extended Portal** (Lesser, 3 pts): the portal (Level 4+) lasts a full Scene instead of a Minute.
- **Blind Jump Recovery** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, if a blink would land you somewhere dangerous, you may instantly abort and land back at your starting point instead, no Ki cost.
- **Swap** (Lesser, 3 pts): blink into the place of a willing person or an object within sight, sending it to where you stood.
- **Anchor Mark** (Lesser, 3 pts): leave a mark on a place, an object or a willing person; you can blink to it at any distance, without sight, as long as it exists. One mark at a time.
- **Folded Pocket** (Lesser, 3 pts): keep up to a backpack's worth of things in folded space and draw one out as a Fast action.
- **Blink Strike** (Lesser, 3 pts): a Melee attack made right after a blink in the same turn has Advantage on its to-hit roll.
- **Return to Sender** (Greater, 6 pts): at Level 4+, when a ranged attack targets you or an ally within Near range, spend 1 Ki to catch it in a pinhole portal: it resolves instead against another target within Near range of you, using the attacker's roll. Requires Level 4.
- **Through the Fold** (Greater, 6 pts): spend 1 Ki to strike through a hand-sized rift: one Melee weapon attack reaches any target you can see, as if they stood next to you.
- **Extra Passenger** (Greater, 6 pts): bring up to three touched people along instead of just one, at Level 4+.

LIMITERS

- **Echo Behind**: a visible or audible trace always marks both where you left and where you arrived. There's no silent option.
- **Recoil**: after teleporting, you're at Disadvantage on all rolls for the next Minute.
- **One-Way Portal Only**: Level 4's portal never allows two-way travel. It opens once for you to step through, then closes immediately.
- **Rough Arrival**: every blink triggers a Gift Check; on a failure you arrive Off Balance and lose 1 Health Level.
- **Cooldown**: no more than one blink per round, and never in two rounds in a row.
- **Open Wake**: for 1 round after you blink, anyone who saw you go can step through after you.
- **Nothing Heavy**: you can take only what you wear and carry in one hand; anything heavier, and anyone you would bring along, stays behind. Can't be taken with **Extra Passenger**.
- **Marked Ground Only**: from Level 2 on, blinks without sight need a sign you placed at the destination with your own hand. Can't be taken with **Anchor Mark**.

1 - Blink instantly to anywhere within line of sight, no matter the distance. Is a Fast action, and costs **1 Ki**. No Gift Check.

2 - You can also blink to a place you've personally visited before, even without current line of sight, so long as you can clearly picture it.

3 - Blinking now works for a place you've only seen in vivid detail (a photo, a thorough description) rather than requiring you to have been there yourself. Doing so requires a **Gift Check**: failure still moves you, but you land somewhere within sight of the intended spot instead of precisely on it.

TELEPORT / DIMENSIONAL PORTAL (CONTINUED)

4 - You can bring one other person along, if you're touching them, at no extra cost. Instead of blinking, you may tear a portal: a stable rift lasting up to a Minute, letting others step through it in both directions. Opening a portal is a Slow action and triggers a Gift Check.

5 - The portal can connect to a different plane of existence entirely, not just another point in your own world, so long as you have some way of pointing it there: an object, a description, a name, GM's call on fit. Ki cost for the Level 3 detail-only blink drops to 0.

THREADSPACE

Just outside ordinary space is a place that belongs to you and you alone: a space you have carved into the Fray. It starts as a pocket you can stow a couple of things in. Eventually it's a private refuge, shaped and furnished however you choose, and at its height a way home from anywhere.

How it works.

- **It's an actual place.** It's carved out of the Fray and sealed: nothing from the Fray gets in, and nothing inside wanders out, though an anomaly may be able to breach it. Inside, everything works normally. There's air, light is whatever you furnish it with (the fold and the closet are dark), time passes as it does outside, and every rule works the way it does anywhere.
- **It's reached from ordinary space only.** No fold or door opens from inside a Threadspace, yours or anyone's.
- **The fold** (Levels 1-2) opens anywhere within arm's reach - beside you, behind your back, under the table - and nobody sees it unless they're watching your hands.
- **The door** (Level 3+) is a person-sized opening standing in the air within arm's reach, and anyone who sees it knows it's unnatural. Only you can open it. While it stands open, anyone can step through, and everything crosses - sight, sound, bullets, Gifts. It's a doorway.
Every time you open it, make a Gift Check: success costs nothing, failure costs 1 Ki, and the door opens either way.
- **You come out where you went in.** From inside, the way out is the door or fold you came in by. A door you open later, from outside, opens where you are then.
- **Your time inside is limited,** by Level. When it's up, the Threadspace puts you out where you came in, along with everyone with you.

THREADSPACE (CONTINUED)

- **When you can't hold it.** If you're knocked unconscious, the door stays shut, and anyone inside waits for you to wake or for their time to run out. At your death the space comes apart, puts everyone and everything inside out where you are, and is gone.

A prepared door is a real door, frame or arch at a place you know intimately: somewhere you've spent a Month of your life, or less if the GM agrees it matters enough. Preparing it takes a full Day of dedicated work there and 3 Ki. You can have one at a time, and preparing another unmakes the first. It stays prepared until it's destroyed, and then the way home is gone.

ADDDERS

- **Reflexive Retrieval** (Lesser, 3 pts): retrieving a stashed handheld item (Level 1 scope) is a reflexive action once per Round, not costing your Fast action.
- **Expanded Fold** (Lesser, 3 pts): storage capacity at every Level increases well beyond its normal scale, room for bulky or oversized items (a vehicle, furniture in bulk) that wouldn't otherwise fit.
- **Physical Link** (Greater, 6 pts): bind the opening itself to a physical object big enough to actually climb through (a trunk, a door, a large bag), permanently, no Ki cost. Anyone who opens it can step through into your Threadspace, or pull items from it, the same way you can.
- **Swallowing Fold** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, when a thrown or fired object (an arrow, a knife, a grenade) would hit you, spend 1 Ki to fold it away and the attack misses. On a later Round, release it as a Fast action at a target in Near, rolling the object's own damage.
- **Quartermaster** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you retrieve a stashed item, you can place it straight into the hand of a willing ally within Close instead of your own.

- **Emergency Door** (Greater, 6 pts): requires Level 3. Once per Scene, as a Fast action, open your door behind a willing ally within Close and pull them inside, out of harm until you let them out. Triggers a Gift Check. Requires Level 3.
- **Oubliette** (Greater, 6 pts): requires Level 3. Spend 2 Ki to shove a Grabbed foe through your door into a bare antechamber and shut it. They stay there until you open the door again or the Scene ends, and come out wherever the door next opens. Requires Level 3.
- **Home Ground** (Lesser, 3 pts): anyone inside your Threadspace without your invitation is Distracted for as long as they stay, and you always know where they are inside it.
- **Stillwater Room** (Greater, 6 pts): requires Level 3. Nothing stored in your Threadspace spoils, rusts or ages, and once per Day a Scene of rest inside counts as a Full Night's Rest. Requires Level 3.

LIMITERS

- **Slow Threading:** opening the fold or door always takes a full Round instead of a Fast action, at every Level.
- **Visible Seam:** opening the fold or door always tears a glowing seam in the air that anyone within Near sees. You can never stash or retrieve covertly, and anyone who saw it knows exactly where you hide things.
- **Spills on Collapse:** whenever you're knocked unconscious or drop to 0 Ki, the fold bursts open and everything stored at the Level 1-2 scale falls out at your feet.
- **Chosen Threshold:** at creation, choose a kind of surface (a shadow, a mirror, a doorframe, running water). You can only open the fold or door on or through that surface; none within reach, no access.

THREADSPACE (CONTINUED)

- **Guided Guests:** guests (Level 4+) can never navigate the Threadspace unassisted. They must be led by you at all times or risk getting lost.
- **Fragile Weave:** if the Threadspace is ever breached by an anomaly (GM's call, rare), everything currently stored inside is at risk of being lost or expelled.

1 - Stash or retrieve a handful of small objects (anything that fits in two hands) through the fold. A Fast action. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - The fold grows to a closet's worth of space. You can store considerably more, and duck inside yourself to hide for up to **5 Minutes**.

3 - The fold becomes a genuine room behind its own door, big enough to live in and furnish however you like. Up to **an Hour** inside.

4 - The room expands into a full dwelling of your own design, as many rooms as you want, furnished and stocked however you like, and you can bring others through the door as guests. Up to **a Day** inside.

5 - You can hold two doors into the same Threadspace open at once, linking those two real points for as long as both stay open: in through one, out the other. Within one Scene the second door opens where you are, like any door. Beyond that, at any distance, it can only open on your **prepared door**. Up to **a Week** inside, and opening a door no longer needs a Gift Check.

TRANSMUTATION

Matter is just an arrangement of atoms. You can break it apart and build it into something else. Shaping stone into walls, scrap into weapons or raw materials into something functional are all child's play. You can't create mass from nothing - nothing is created or destroyed - just rearranged according to your will.

Chosen once, at creation: how you perform the ritual that triggers this Gift, tracing a circle, speaking a precise chant, or simply focusing in silence. The mechanics stay the same regardless of flavor.

This Gift always costs Ki, at every Level. There is no mastery discount to free. This Gift cannot create or restore living matter, and cannot resurrect the dead: equivalent exchange has never once made that trade work.

ADDERS

- **Ritual Shortcut** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, perform the ritual one action-band faster than your Level normally allows, at no extra Ki cost.
- **Precise Recall** (Lesser, 3 pts): revert an object you've personally transmuted back to its original form, at the same Ki cost as the original transformation, so long as nothing has altered it further since.
- **Mass Bank** (Greater, 6 pts): break something down without immediately rebuilding it, banking the freed mass for a later transmutation, up to your current Level's mass cap.
- **Earthen Lance** (Greater, 6 pts): requires Level 2. Slam the ritual into the ground or a wall and force a spike, fist or blade of it out at one target within Close, rolling your attack dice (Level + half Ferocity) against Soak. Costs your Level's normal Ki. Requires Level 2.

TRANSMUTATION (CONTINUED)

- **Unmaking Touch** (Greater, 6 pts): as a Melee attack, spend your Level's normal Ki to transmute a foe's held weapon or worn armor: roll your attack dice against its Hardness, and if any die gets through, the item is ruined until repaired.
- **Prepared Circle** (Lesser, 3 pts): perform the ritual ahead of time on a surface without triggering it. Later, from within Near, trigger it as a Fast action, paying the Ki then. One prepared circle at a time; it fades at the end of the Day.
- **Structural Read** (Lesser, 3 pts): touch an object to know its composition, hidden compartments and weakest point at once. Your next attack against that object's Hardness has Advantage.
- **Pay in Flesh** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you lack the Ki, pay any part of a transmutation's Ki cost with Health Levels instead, 1 Health Level per Ki.
- **Conductor** (Lesser, 3 pts): while touching a continuous body of material (a floor, a wall, a hull), you can transmute any point of it within Close, not just what's under your hands.

LIMITERS

- **Irreversible Exchange**: once transmuted, an object can never be reverted to its original form, by this Gift or any other means. Equivalent exchange only runs one way.
- **Loud Working**: the ritual is never silent or discreet, always visibly or audibly obvious, at every Level.
- **Single Material**: at creation, choose one material family (earth and stone, metal, wood and plant fiber, water and ice). You can only transmute within it; Level 3 composition changes stay inside the family.
- **Rebound**: if the Moira + Difficulty roll fails, the working backlashes through you: lose 1 Health Level as well as the Ki.

- **Understood Forms Only**: you can only make something you've personally studied or taken apart an example of. No improvising a mechanism or tool you've never handled.
- **Unstable Work**: everything you transmute slumps back to its original form at the end of the Scene. Cannot be taken with Irreversible Exchange. Can't be taken with Irreversible Exchange.
- **Fixed Ritual Component**: your chosen ritual flavor requires a specific physical condition (a clear space to draw a circle, the ability to speak a chant, genuine silence to focus). The Gift simply fails if that condition is denied.

1 - Touch a quantity of raw or simple material (up to roughly what you could carry) and spend **1 Ki**, then roll **Moira + Difficulty** to break it down and reconstruct it into a different simple object of equivalent mass and similar composition (loose stone into a crude wall, wood into a simple tool). Performing the ritual is a Slow action; the transmutation itself is instant once triggered.

2 - The output can now be meaningfully more complex than the input (raw ore into a working blade, rubble into a fitted brick wall), still equivalent mass. The ritual is now only a Normal action. Ki cost rises to **2**.

3 - You can change a material's basic composition, not just its shape (wood into iron, sand into glass). Affected mass roughly doubles. Ki cost rises to **3**. A **Gift Check** applies on especially large or precise jobs, GM's call.

4 - The ritual is now only a Fast action. Affected mass roughly doubles again. Ki cost rises to **4**.

TRANSMUTATION (CONTINUED)

5 - Affected mass reaches building scale, and you can transmute functioning mechanisms, not just static shapes (a working weapon, a piece of armor, a simple machine), so long as the raw material and mass are sufficient. Ki cost rises to **5**.

UNBURDENED

You know what your body is supposed to need, but you decided to tell it no. Heat, cold, thirst, hunger, exhaustion, pain and even the need to breathe are just signals that you can turn off. You can keep going long after an ordinary person would have collapsed. Survival limits are now little more than an inconvenience.

ADDERS

- **Painless** (Lesser, 3 pts): Advantage on any roll to resist the penalty effects of pain or injury, not immunity to the damage itself, just the body's distraction from it.
- **Deep Reserve** (Lesser, 3 pts): when you do eat, drink, or sleep, a single session banks enough reserve to cover a stretch twice as long as your current Level would otherwise grant.
- **Instant Reset** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Day, instantly clear any accumulated deprivation effects with a moment's focus, no need to actually eat, drink, or sleep to recover from them.
- **Refuse Exhaustion** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to ignore the Exhausted condition until the end of the Scene. When the Scene ends, it lands on you as normal.
- **Share the Burden** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to extend your current breath-holding and deprivation benefits to one ally within Close for a Scene, so long as they stay within Close of you.
- **Deathlike Stillness** (Lesser, 3 pts): as a Normal action, stop your breath and heartbeat. Short of supernatural senses, anyone examining you finds a corpse, while you stay aware of everything around you. It ends when you move.
- **Tireless Pursuit** (Lesser, 3 pts): you never tire from running. In a chase or on a forced march you can hold a Sprint for as long as the chase lasts, and you have Advantage on rolls to keep pace.

UNBURDENED (CONTINUED)

- **Starve the Body** (Greater, 6 pts): once per Scene, burn the body's reserves: recover 2 Ki at once. At the end of the Scene you're Exhausted, and you need food, water and sleep now regardless of your Level until you properly eat and rest.
- **Breathless Stance** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki and hold your breath: until you next speak, breathe or the Scene ends, you have Advantage to resist being knocked Off Balance, Staggered or Grabbed.

LIMITERS

- **Sudden Reckoning**: when this Gift's duration finally runs out, all the deprivation you'd normally have felt gradually hits at once: Disadvantage on everything until you properly rest, eat, and drink.
- **Conscious Effort**: the passive benefits (Levels 1-2) require active concentration. They stop working while unconscious or surprised.
- **No Comfort**: not needing food, sleep, or rest doesn't mean you don't crave them. Disadvantage on any Social roll requiring you to convincingly pass as an ordinary person eating, sleeping, or resting normally.
- **Unfelt Wounds**: you don't feel injury. The GM tracks your Health Levels and warns you only when you're down to your last one, and you don't notice Bleeding or Envenomed until someone points it out or the Scene ends.
- **Hibernation**: when you finally do rest, you sleep a full Day and can't be woken by anything short of taking damage.
- **Locked Ki**: Ki you spend on this Gift or its Adders doesn't refill until you've properly eaten, drunk and slept.

1 - Hold your breath for a **Minute**. Hunger, thirst, and sleep needs stretch to roughly a **Day** between requirements instead of daily. No roll, no Ki, passive.

2 - Hold your breath for a full **Scene**. Hunger, thirst, and sleep needs stretch to roughly a **Month**.

3 - Spend **1 Ki** to stop needing air, food, water, or sleep entirely for a full **Day**: underwater, in a sealed room, in smoke too thick to breathe, wide awake through what should be an exhausting stretch.

4 - The Level 3 immunity extends to extreme conditions too (vacuum-adjacent cold, crushing pressure, lethal air), and now lasts a full **Month** instead of a Day.

5 - Air, food, water, sleep, and extreme temperature all stop being requirements, permanently, no Ki needed, no Level 3 spend required anymore.

UNDYING VIGOR

Poison, disease, the passing of time... Your body refuses to succumb to these things. You can be killed. You can be broken, bleed and die - but you won't die from natural causes. Sickness, age and decay will not be what ends you.

Purging a poison or disease (Level 3+) always costs Ki. There is no mastery discount to free.

ADDERS

- **Cleansing Touch** (Lesser, 3 pts): spend 1 Ki to purge a poison or disease from a touched ally instead of only yourself.
- **Preemptive Ward** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Day, grant yourself Advantage against a specific known poison, disease, or aging effect before you're ever exposed to it.
- **Halted Decay** (Greater, 6 pts): once per year of in-game time, subtly reverse a few years of accumulated aging, on top of the Level 4+ stopped-aging benefit.

UNDYING VIGOR (CONTINUED)

- **Venom Keeper** (Lesser, 3 pts): requires Level 3. When you purge a poison, you can hold it in your blood instead. Your next weapon or unarmed hit that deals a Health Level before the Scene ends leaves that target Envenomed. Requires Level 3.
- **Poison Eater** (Lesser, 3 pts): once per Scene, when you resist or purge a poison or disease, recover 1 Ki.
- **Plague Sense** (Lesser, 3 pts): you sense poison and disease within Close: a tainted cup, a sick crowd, a coated blade. No roll; you know it's there, not what it is.
- **Clotting Blood** (Lesser, 3 pts): Bleeding ends on you at the end of each of your Rounds.
- **Deathless Flesh** (Greater, 6 pts): Advantage to resist curses, rot and life-draining effects that wear you down over time rather than strike you.

LIMITERS

- **Slow Purge**: your immunity isn't instantaneous, at any Level. A poison or disease still runs its full course, symptoms included, for up to a Day before your body fights it off. The Level 3+ Ki purge still works, but only shortens that Day down to a Minute rather than clearing it outright.
- **Vulnerable Youth**: your immunity to aging (Level 4+) doesn't protect against magical or supernatural rapid-aging effects specifically, only the natural passage of time.
- **Silent Carrier**: you're personally immune, but you can still carry and unknowingly transmit disease to others without ever showing symptoms yourself.
- **Fever Purge**: every purge is violent: after you use the Level 3+ purge, you're Exhausted for the rest of the Scene.
- **Specific Bane**: at creation, choose one substance (silver, a certain herb, blessed water). Your immunities never apply to it,

and exposure leaves you Envenomed with Disadvantage to resist.

- **Rejects Remedy**: your body fights off outside help too. Medicine and first-aid rolls to treat you have Disadvantage.
- **Brittle**: your body resists slow death but not violence: Disadvantage on rolls to resist Bleeding and Staggered.

1 - **Advantage** on any roll to resist poison.

Immune outright to ordinary disease. No Ki, no Gift Check.

2 - Advantage extends to serious, dangerous poisons and illnesses too, not just minor ones.

3 - Spend 1 Ki to purge an active poison or disease from your system outright, on command, no roll needed.

4 - You stop aging entirely, natural or accelerated. Immunity to poison and disease upgrades from Advantage to outright, even against exotic toxins and genuine plagues.

5 - Full immunity to poison, disease, and aging of any origin, natural or supernatural. You can still be killed, violence, injury, and the like still work, you simply can't be worn down or aged to death.

FLAWS

A Flaw is you promising the table that your character will make things harder for themselves, and the system promising to pay you for it.

This is the part of 20 Below that most needs saying out loud: the game gets better when things go wrong, and it's built to reward you for letting them. A Flaw isn't a penalty you swallowed for points. It's a hook you handed the GM, and every time they pull it, you get paid.

Flaws are chosen at creation and hand points back to spend elsewhere. Taking one means it's going to come up, and it'll cost you something real when it does. If a Flaw never once inconveniences you, it wasn't a Flaw - it was a discount, and somebody at the table should say so.

Flaws are Boons in a mirror - the complications, quirks and bad hands you pick on purpose.

Every Flaw is Leveled, 1 to 5, the same way Resources are, and the Level is the price. Take Amnesia at 3 and you get 3 points back; at 5, you get 5. Nothing here is bought flat.

They're rarely a number. A Flaw is usually a complication or a restriction rather than a minus-something on a roll. The few that do carry numbers say so themselves.

You take them at creation, and only at creation. This is a bargain you strike while you're building, not one you can come back for.

A Flaw that never bites is worth nothing. If it doesn't actually make life harder, it isn't a Flaw and it doesn't pay - the one-eyed character with no depth perception problem and no trouble it has ever caused them, which is a

common enough trope, doesn't collect for Impaired Senses on the strength of an eyepatch.

THE FLAWS

AMNESIA

There is a hole where a piece of your life used to be. You know it's there the way you know a tooth is gone - you keep checking. Sometimes something surfaces. A smell, a name, a room you have never been in. Then it's gone again.

Part of your past is missing.

- 1 A single traumatic event is missing - one specific memory gone, everything else intact.
- 2 A cluster of related memories is missing - the days or weeks around a specific incident, or one relationship entirely forgotten.
- 3 A significant span of time is missing - months or years, not just one moment. Name, identity, and abilities are intact, but real gaps exist in personal history and relationships.
- 4 Most personal history is gone - only fragments remain. Still knows their own name and can act normally, but life before a certain point belongs to a stranger.
- 5 Forgotten their entire identity - may not know what Skills or Boons/Gifts they have.

ANTAGONIST

Somebody out there is thinking about you right now, and they are not wishing you well. They know your name. They know where you eat lunch. You made an impression on exactly the wrong person, and they are patient.

Someone or something is set against you - a rival, an enemy, a hunter who doesn't give up.

ANTAGONIST (CONTINUED)

- 1 A minor rival - someone who competes with or needles you personally. Low capability, mostly a nuisance.
- 2 A capable individual enemy, or a small hostile group/local authority keeping an eye on you.
- 3 A well-resourced enemy or organized hostile group actively working against you.
- 4 A powerful, dangerous enemy or organization with real reach, actively hunting you.
- 5 A nemesis-tier antagonist - extremely powerful, far-reaching, and personally invested in your downfall. Relentlessly hunts you as a top-priority target.

ANXIETY

Your brain runs a threat assessment every waking second and it never files a clean report. The stove. The email. The look somebody gave you four years ago. You know most of it isn't real. Knowing has never once made it stop.

Anxiety that doesn't need a reason and doesn't switch off.

- 1 A specific, narrow fear or recurring nightmare - unsettling, but rarely interferes with function.
- 2 A phobia that actively triggers avoidance or hesitation when confronted with its source.
- 3 Generalized anxiety - chronic worry and disrupted sleep color everyday decisions, not just one trigger.
- 4 Panic attacks - sudden, incapacitating episodes of panic under stress, not just avoidance.
- 5 A pervasive anxiety disorder - constant hypervigilance, frequent panic attacks, and deeply entrenched avoidance that fundamentally limits day-to-day life.

BERSERK

There is a switch, and you are not the one who flips it. Once it's thrown you are a passenger - swinging until there is nothing standing and nobody left to swing at. Afterward, other people tell you what you did.

Once you're going, you don't stop until it's over.

Each level's effect is cumulative - it keeps every lower level's restriction and adds its own.

- 1 Once triggered by real danger, cannot voluntarily disengage from the current fight - must keep engaging until an enemy is defeated or flees.
- 2 Level 1, plus: while triggered, cannot declare a Slow Action Bracket - full aggression only, no called shots or concentration.
- 3 Levels 1-2, plus: must always act against the nearest hostile target - no picking tactically who to engage.
- 4 Levels 1-3, plus: the trigger doesn't end just because the original threat is gone - any new hostile that appears keeps the fight going.
- 5 Levels 1-4, plus: keeps fighting even when badly hurt - won't retreat or stop to protect themselves, only stopping when physically unable to continue (unconscious, restrained, or no hostiles remain).

CODE OF CONDUCT

You have a line. You drew it yourself, nobody else is obligated to respect it, and that is exactly why it counts. It has cost you money, opportunities and at least one friendship. You would draw it again tomorrow.

A rule you set yourself and won't break, even when breaking it would help.

CODE OF CONDUCT (CONTINUED)

1 A minor, low-stakes personal restriction - inconvenient, rarely costly. Strict vegetarian/vegan; never tells even a white lie; always pays a debt the moment it's owed; won't enter a home uninvited.

2 A real behavioral rule that occasionally costs something. Never draws a weapon first; refuses payment for helping someone in genuine need; never abandons a task once started, however small; always keeps a promise made to a friend.

3 A binding code that actively shapes major decisions. Once I draw my blade, it must taste blood; any promise made must be kept regardless of personal cost; a formal challenge, once accepted, can't be walked away from; a secret entrusted to them is kept even under real pressure.

4 A severe restriction that limits options in dangerous or critical moments. Refuses to harm anyone significantly weaker than themselves; an enemy must always be given a chance to surrender before a killing blow; cannot break a vow even to save their own life.

5 An absolute, life-defining restriction. I cannot kill anything, no matter the cost; a vow that cannot be broken under any circumstance, even to save the people they love; can never refuse a genuine request for help, regardless of personal danger.

DEPENDENT

Somebody needs you. A kid, a sibling, an old friend who never got their feet under them - whoever it is, they can't do this without you, and they don't get a vote in what you've gotten yourself into. Every plan has to include them.

Someone relies on you, and has to be protected or provided for.

1 A dependent who mostly manages on their own - checks in occasionally, needs a little financial or emotional support now and then.

2 A dependent who needs regular, real support - time, money, or care on a recurring basis, though not helpless.

3 A dependent who can't protect themselves and needs real intervention when trouble finds them - a young child, an elderly parent, someone seriously ill.

4 A dependent who is a frequent liability - regularly endangered by your own life (enemies, work, reputation), requiring real risk to protect.

5 A dependent who is entirely helpless without you and a prime target - enemies know exactly who to threaten to get to you.

DESTITUTE

Money is something that happens to other people. You know which places let you sit for hours over one coffee, which shelter has the fewest rules, and exactly how far what's in your pocket will stretch. You are very good at arithmetic you never wanted to learn.

You have no money - anywhere from a bad patch to nothing at all.

Each level's effect is cumulative - it keeps every lower level's complication and adds its own.

DESTITUTE (CONTINUED)

1 A rough patch. Creation-Wealth is **0** instead of the default 2 for gear shopping at creation, and no Resources Pool or Discretionary points may be spent on Wealth while this Flaw is held - buy it off first - see Everyman Gear Packages for what's still available at Level 0. Doesn't follow you past creation; whatever put you here (a lost job, a bad breakup, a bad month) is already turning around.

2 Chronically tight. As Level 1, and it doesn't go away - living paycheck to paycheck, or with no paycheck at all, is an ongoing fact of your life, however your Resources ended up built.

3 Real precarity. As Level 2, and something concrete is currently unstable - unreliable housing, an unreliable income source, or a debt actively being chased.

4 Genuinely impoverished. As Level 3, and it's visible enough that people react to it on sight - shapes first impressions the same way Notable Appearance or Notoriety do, just for money instead of looks or reputation.

5 Nothing left. As Level 4, and there's no safety net at all - no one to call for a loan, no fallback plan, and whatever put you here is bad enough to be a real, ongoing story hook (GM's call on specifics).

DIRECTIONLESS

North is a rumor. Everyone else seems to have a map running somewhere behind their eyes and you never got issued one. You have been lost inside a building you work in. "It's two blocks that way" means nothing to you.

You get lost. Reliably.

1 A mildly unreliable sense of direction - occasionally turns around even in familiar places, rarely costs more than a moment.

2 A poor sense of direction - regularly gets turned around in unfamiliar areas, needs to double-check directions rather than trust instinct.

3 Actively bad - gets lost even in semi-familiar places without a map, guide, or other aid to follow.

4 Severe - cannot reliably navigate even short, familiar routes without external aid; easily disoriented under any pressure or unfamiliar layout.

5 No functional sense of direction whatsoever - completely dependent on others or tools to get anywhere; could get lost in their own home under stress or darkness.

FRAGILE

Other people get a bruise. You get a hairline fracture. Whatever everybody else's body does to absorb a hit, yours never learned. You break easily, you heal slowly, and you have built your whole life around knowing both.

The body works against you.

1 Mildly delicate - bruises easily, tires a bit faster than average, but functions fine day to day.

2 Noticeably weaker - real physical exertion (lifting, running long distances) is harder, minor injuries take a bit longer to heal.

FRAGILE (CONTINUED)

3 Frail - the body struggles under real exertion or stress; a condition flares up under pressure; recovery from harm is markedly slow.

4 Seriously compromised - sustained exertion risks real harm; even routine physical demands can trigger a flare-up or setback; wounds that would be minor for others become serious.

5 The body is failing - barely able to sustain ordinary physical demands without real risk; any injury is dangerous and slow to heal; a single hard fight could be life-threatening regardless of what actually connects.

GUN-SHY

The moment it kicks off, there is a gap. Everyone else is already moving and you are still catching up to the fact that this is happening. It isn't cowardice - you get there. You just get there late, and late is expensive.

When violence starts, you falter.

Each level's effect is cumulative - it keeps every lower level's penalty and adds its own.

1 First round of combat, act last within your declared Action Bracket, regardless of Initiative.

2 Level 1, plus: for the first round, Fast actions are treated as Normal and Normal actions are treated as Slow - Slow actions can't be taken that round at all.

3 Levels 1-2, plus: unless 1 Ki is spent, they don't act at all in the first round of combat.

4 Levels 1-3, plus: while in combat, they act at Disadvantage.

5 Levels 1-4, plus: the Ki-to-act requirement from Level 3 applies every round, not just the first - without spending Ki each round, they're frozen entirely; when they do act, it's at Disadvantage throughout.

ILLITERATE

The letters are right there and they don't come together. You have built an entire life around not needing them to - you memorize, you ask, you get somebody else to check the form. It works right up until someone hands you something and waits.

You can't read, to one degree or another.

1 Illiterate only in the local language/script - fully literate (possibly exceptionally so) in their own.

2 Illiterate in every language/script they're likely to encounter while traveling, though still fully literate at home - the gap is broader than just "here."

3 Only semi-literate even in their native language on top of that - basic reading/writing is possible, but real fluency isn't there anywhere.

4 Functionally illiterate everywhere, including their own native language - cannot meaningfully read or write at all.

5 No concept of written language whatsoever - doesn't register that symbols represent language in the first place.

IMPAIRED SENSES

One channel is down. You have rerouted around it well enough that people forget, and you let them. It stays forgotten until somebody speaks up from your bad side, or the thing you needed to notice was over there.

One of your senses is dulled, or gone.

IMPAIRED SENSES (CONTINUED)

A reminder of the general rule above: if the impairment doesn't actually impair you - no depth-perception penalty, no missed cues, nothing a compensating sense or trained-around habit doesn't fully cover - it isn't worth points. This Flaw is the most obvious anime-trope case for that rule (the one-eyed swordsman who fights exactly as well as anyone with two eyes).

- 1 A minor gap in one sense - reduced but functional (mild nearsightedness beyond normal correction, slight hearing loss in one ear, a dulled sense of smell). Real but manageable.
- 2 A significant impairment in one sense - noticeably worse than normal, actively affects tasks that rely on it, but not total loss (poor low-light vision, muffled hearing, no sense of smell at all).
- 3 Total loss of one sense - fully blind in one eye, fully deaf in one ear, or a complete loss like smell/taste. Other senses compensate, but real gaps remain.
- 4 Total loss of a primary sense - fully blind or fully deaf, relying entirely on other senses and/or tools/training to compensate.
- 5 Total loss of multiple primary senses - both blind and deaf, or similarly extreme. Complete reliance on remaining senses and outside support.

INCANTATIONS

It doesn't work if you can't say it. Something out there is listening for the specific words and it is not interested in what you meant. A hand over your mouth is enough to stop you. So is a room where being heard would be a disaster.

A Gift of yours only works if you can say a specific phrase out loud.

A Gift only answers to a spoken word - distinct from a Gift's own Limiters like Animal Friendship's Vocal Component: this is a full character-creation Flaw, its points added to the general Flaws total like any other, chosen against one or more Gifts you already have.

- 1 One specific Gift requires speaking a short trigger phrase aloud to activate - audible to anyone nearby, and it simply doesn't work if you're unable to speak (silenced, gagged, underwater, and the like).
- 2 The phrase grows more specific - a full sentence, verse, or exact wording - long and distinct enough that garbling or rushing it fails the activation outright.
- 3 Two or more Gifts each require their own spoken incantation to activate.
- 4 Every Gift you have requires its own spoken incantation - none of your capability works if you can't speak clearly.
- 5 As Level 4, and the incantation must be spoken clean, with no other exertion that Round - sprinting, grappling, or taking a hit while attempting one fails it outright, forcing you to start over next round.

ITEM OF POWER

What you can do isn't entirely in you. Some of it lives in an object - a ring, a coat, a beat-up guitar case - and objects get lost, stolen, confiscated and left in somebody else's car.

ITEM OF POWER (CONTINUED)

A Gift of yours lives, at least partly, in something you carry rather than in you.

Your capability isn't fully your own - it lives, at least in part, in something you carry. Distinct from a Gift's own Limiters (which discount that specific Gift's point cost): this is a full character-creation Flaw, its points added to the general Flaws total like any other, chosen against one or more Gifts you already have.

1 One specific Gift only works while you're in possession of a particular item - well-secured or hard to casually separate from you (a tattoo, an implant, something bonded to you), but losing it locks out that one Gift entirely until it's recovered.

2 As Level 1, but the item is a real, ordinary object - a ring, a blade, a pendant - that can be stolen, confiscated, or lost in a struggle like any other possession.

3 Two or more Gifts are bound to the same item instead of just one - losing it locks out everything tied to it at once.

4 Every Gift you have depends on retaining the item - lose it, and you're left with nothing but your ordinary Skills, Boons, and Attributes until it's recovered.

5 As Level 4, and the item itself is something genuinely easy to take, damage, or lose - not secured, not bonded, not hard to separate from you at all. Anyone who thinks to try has a real shot at disarming you completely.

LAME

The distance hasn't changed. What it costs you has. Stairs are a decision. "It's not far" is something other people say. You get where you are going - you just get there later, and you pay for it that night.

An old injury or condition took some of your mobility and kept it.

1 A minor limp or stiffness - noticeable, doesn't slow them down in any real way.

2 Reduced mobility that costs something under exertion - slower over distance, real effort on stairs or rough terrain.

3 A significant mobility loss - needs a cane, brace, or similar aid for anything beyond short, easy movement.

4 Severe impairment - mobility is a constant limiting factor; sustained or fast movement is difficult even with aids.

5 Effectively immobile without significant support - a wheelchair or equivalent, or unable to move under their own power at all in a fight or chase.

NOTABLE APPEARANCE

People remember you. Every time, whether that's useful or not. The witness description is never vague and the bartender never has to ask twice. You have never once been "some guy" and you never will be.

Something about how you look draws stares and reactions.

1 A minor, easily-overlooked trait - noticed only on close attention, rarely commented on.

2 A distinctive feature that people notice and occasionally remark on, but doesn't follow them.

NOTABLE APPEARANCE (CONTINUED)

3 A memorable appearance that people recognize and remember on sight - recall and gossip travel with them.

4 A striking appearance that draws stares and comment everywhere, actively makes blending in impossible.

5 An unmistakable, singular appearance - described in wanted posters and rumors alike; anyone who's heard of them would recognize them on sight.

NOTORIETY

Your name gets to the room before you do, and it has already said something you would rather it hadn't. Some of what they heard is true. The rest has been improved in the retelling, and nobody is interested in your correction.

How widely, and how badly, you're known.

1 Known within a small local circle - a minor local bad reputation, occasional suspicion.

2 A known troublemaker within a community or subculture.

3 Regionally known for something bad - distrust follows them beyond their home turf.

4 Widely infamous - recognized and reviled by strangers regularly.

5 A notorious name nationwide or worldwide, actively shunned or targeted on reputation alone.

OVERCONFIDENT

You have been right enough times to stop checking. That worked out beautifully, right up until the day it didn't, and you are not convinced that day counts. You will take the odds. You always take the odds.

You underestimate danger, or overestimate yourself, and you do it consistently.

1 Occasionally shrugs off a real warning - rarely costs anything, mostly just talk.

2 Regularly takes on tasks slightly beyond them without checking first - real but recoverable setbacks.

3 You habitually dismiss genuine danger and sound advice, and it costs you, and sometimes your allies, real setbacks.

4 Reliably walks into situations that are clearly beyond them, refusing help or backup even when it's obviously needed.

5 Cannot recognize danger as danger until it's already too late - repeatedly puts themselves and others at serious risk through sheer refusal to see their own limits.

PARIAH

There is a category people drop you into on sight and nothing you do gets you out of it. Being polite doesn't. Being useful doesn't. Being right definitely doesn't. You stopped waiting for the room to come around a long time ago.

People hold a specific prejudice against you. Name it with your GM.

What I have in mind is the kind this setting invented: visibly not human, known to carry a Gift, marked by something that happened and never explained. The ordinary human bigotries exist in this world too, because it is our world - but they are not what this Flaw is for.

PARIAH (CONTINUED)

- 1 A minor prejudice - occasional dirty looks, mild social friction, rarely any material consequence.
- 2 Real but limited discrimination - some doors are harder to open (served last, passed over for a room), but nothing blocks basic life.
- 3 Active, meaningful discrimination - regularly denied service, employment, or fair treatment; public spaces mean dealing with real hostility.
- 4 Systemic hostility - the prejudice has institutional teeth: denied legal protection, actively targeted by local authority, barred from whole industries or areas.
- 5 Widespread, violent hostility - openly hunted, attacked, or persecuted for what they are; public life is dangerous.

RELIANCE

There is something you need, and the needing keeps its own schedule. It doesn't care what else is happening. It doesn't negotiate, it doesn't wait for a good moment, and it always collects.

Something you need - a compulsion, a substance, or a condition that has to be managed.

- 1 A minor compulsion or mild reaction - inconvenient, rarely costly. A nervous habit like nail-biting; a mild seasonal allergy; a harmless lucky ritual before anything risky.
- 2 A real pull or trigger that occasionally costs something. A gambling habit that drains resources; an allergy requiring real caution (shellfish, bee stings); a compulsive need for background noise or routine that disrupts focus when broken.
- 3 A genuine dependency that shapes daily life. Regular substance use requiring a fix on a schedule; a chronic condition needing daily management (insulin, medication); hoarding or obsessive behavior that actively strains relationships.
- 4 A severe dependency with real danger if unmet. Hard addiction with physical withdrawal symptoms; a severe, life-threatening allergy on exposure; a compulsion strong enough to override better judgment in the moment.
- 5 A life-controlling dependency. An addiction that incapacitates without regular access; a condition requiring constant, uninterrupted support to survive; a compulsion so absolute it defines every decision you make.

RITUAL REQUIRED

It answers. It just doesn't answer immediately. There is a procedure - words, motions, something burned, something owed - and it takes as long as it takes. Nobody has ever kicked in a door at a convenient moment.

A Gift doesn't answer the instant it's reached for - it has to be called, coaxed, or earned each time.

Your power doesn't answer the instant you reach for it - it has to be called, coaxed, or earned each time. Distinct from a Gift's own Limiters: this is a full character-creation Flaw, its points added to the general Flaws total like any other, chosen against one or more Gifts you already have.

- 1 One specific Gift requires a short ritual - roughly a minute of chanting, gestures, or preparation - before its first use each Scene. Once performed, that Gift stays primed and usable normally for the rest of the Scene.
- 2 The same Gift now requires that ritual before every single use, not just once per Scene - each activation costs the full minute of setup again.
- 3 The ritual itself grows heavier - roughly ten minutes, real focus required. Anything that would normally cause Distracted interrupts it outright, forcing you to start over.
- 4 Every Gift you have requires the Level 3 ritual before its first use each Scene, not just one - priming your full capability takes real, dedicated time.
- 5 Every Gift requires the full ritual before every single use, with no priming grace at all - full setup, every time, for everything you can do.

SECRET

One fact. That is all it is. One fact, and an entire life built carefully around it staying where it is. You have gotten good at steering a conversation. You have gotten better at leaving the room.

Something you badly don't want getting out.

- 1 An embarrassing detail - mildly damaging to reputation if it got out, nothing more.
- 2 A real secret - exposure would cost you something genuine: a relationship, a job, a bit of standing.
- 3 A serious secret - exposure would cause real, lasting damage to your life, or the lives of people you care about.
- 4 A dangerous secret - exposure invites real threats: legal jeopardy, violence, or being hunted by someone with the power to act on it.
- 5 A world-shaking secret - exposure would be catastrophic, reshaping your life entirely, or endangering far more than just you.

SHAKEN CONFIDENCE

It happened once, in front of people who mattered, and some part of you never quite stood back up. Everyone else forgot about it years ago. You did not. You feel it in the room every time something similar starts.

One specific humiliation took your footing in a room, and you never got it back.

One specific, defining humiliation left a real mark - not on the body, on the nerve. A natural fit for the genuine Flaw a below-zero Poise scar can impose, though it can also just be taken directly at creation like any other Flaw.

- 1 A specific type of social situation (public speaking, a rivalry, one particular person) triggers a flicker of doubt - costs a beat, nothing more.

SHAKEN CONFIDENCE (CONTINUED)

2 Real hesitation in that situation - a genuine, recoverable setback if pushed through anyway.

3 Active avoidance of that situation where possible; forced into it, performs at a real disadvantage.

4 The doubt bleeds into adjacent situations, not just the original trigger - a broader loss of confidence.

5 A pervasive, crippling lack of social self-assurance - even routine interactions carry real hesitation, not just the original trigger.

SHORT FUSE

The distance between the provocation and your response is a lot shorter than most people's. You are not proud of it. You have apologized for it. And the next time somebody says the wrong thing, you will be halfway through the response before you notice you started.

You anger fast, and everybody can tell.

1 Snaps at minor annoyances - sharp words, nothing lasting.

2 Loses composure under real provocation - says or does something they regret, with real (if recoverable) social cost.

3 Hard to talk down once provoked - regularly escalates situations that a calmer head could have defused.

4 A serious liability under pressure - provocation reliably leads to real damage: burned bridges, real consequences, sometimes violence.

5 You can't reliably control yourself once triggered - provocation regularly leads to serious harm, to relationships or to people, with real consequences you can't walk back.

SOFT-HEARTED

You know what the smart move is. Everybody does. You have simply never been able to make yourself do it - not to somebody already down, already scared, already smaller than you. It has cost you, and you would do it the same way again.

You struggle to act against the vulnerable, even when it costs you.

1 Hesitates for a moment before acting against someone clearly weaker or in distress - costs a beat, nothing more.

2 Actively looks for a way to avoid harming the vulnerable, even if it costs real effort or a worse outcome elsewhere.

3 Will take a genuine risk or loss rather than harm someone vulnerable - a real, recurring cost.

4 Cannot bring themselves to act against the vulnerable even when the stakes are severe - will let an opportunity or advantage slip away rather than cross that line.

5 Will actively endanger themselves or the mission to protect or spare someone vulnerable, every time, no exceptions.

SPEECH IMPEDIMENT

The thought is clear. It is fast, it is complete, and it is exactly right. Getting it out of your mouth is the part that isn't. You have watched people decide what you were going to say and then answer that instead.

A stutter, an accent, something that gets between you and being understood.

1 A mild, noticeable quirk (a stutter under stress, a thick accent) - rarely actually hampers being understood.

2 A real impediment that occasionally causes miscommunication or draws unwanted attention.

SPEECH IMPEDIMENT (CONTINUED)

3 A significant impediment - regularly slows or garbles speech enough that real effort is needed to be understood.

4 A severe impediment - verbal communication is unreliable; often misunderstood or unable to get a full thought out under pressure.

5 Effectively unable to communicate verbally in any reliable way - must rely on writing, gestures, or another person to speak for them.

FATE

Fate is the part of the system that admits the dice aren't the whole story.

Everything so far has been about what your character can do. This is about the thumb you get to put on the scale - where it comes from, and what it costs. Three things live here: your **Nature**, which is who your character fundamentally is and how they earn Fate Tokens; the **Tokens** themselves, and what you spend them on; and **Ki**, the pool that fuels everything supernatural you own.

Nature is the one people underestimate. It isn't a personality label for the top of the sheet - it's the trigger that pays you. Play to it and the system hands you resources. Play against it and you get nothing, which is its own answer about whether you picked the right one.

A parallel resource layered on top of the core roll - playing into vulnerability, flaws, and bad luck funds a currency spent later.

NATURE

Every character has a **Nature** - a short archetype capturing a core drive or way of engaging with the world, written on the character sheet. Playing to your Nature at a dramatically appropriate moment grants a Fate Token.

The list of starter Natures, and the guide to writing your own, are in **Creating a Character**, because that is where you pick one.

FATE GAIN

Nature - playing to your Nature at a fitting moment (see above).

Voluntary Disadvantage - a player may choose to take Disadvantage on a roll in exchange for a Fate Token.

Flaws - every character has Flaws. When the GM or the player invokes a Flaw in a scene, the invoking side's choice grants the player a Fate Token.

Daily Regeneration - characters regain **1 Fate Token** at sunrise, every day.

Lucky Number - whenever one of your own core rolls comes up exactly equal to your Klotho, you gain **1 Fate Token**, automatically.

Milestone Award - when the party overcomes a significant challenge (a session's climactic fight, defeating a notable threat, a decisive turning point in the story), the GM awards **1 Fate Token to every PC**, roughly once per session - rarer than that and it stops feeling like a beat worth marking; more often and it stops feeling like a milestone.

GM Discretion - the GM can directly award a Fate Token for good roleplay or a clever idea, independent of the other triggers above.

No double-dipping: a single scene beat pays out **at most one Fate Token**, even if it could honestly be described as both playing to your Nature and invoking a Flaw (or any other two triggers above) at once - e.g. a Soft-Hearted character with a Caregiver Nature stopping to help someone vulnerable. Pick whichever source fits best and pay out once.

HOLDING FATE TOKENS

A character can hold at most **([Stamina score] x 3) + 1** Fate Tokens at once. A Token earned while already at that cap is lost rather than banked - including the daily regeneration and Milestone awards.

Both Fate Token limits come from Stamina, and they are deliberately the same stat at two scales: **(Stamina x 3) + 1 is how many you can hold; Stamina + 1 is how many counted spends you can make in a single Scene.**

Banking across a quiet stretch of play is possible, but it tops out quickly, and it tops out sooner for the character who could least afford to spend them anyway.

A character with **Stamina 0 holds 1 Fate Token at most**, and can spend it. The +1 on both caps is there so that nobody is shut out of Fate entirely: the Token that arrives at sunrise always has somewhere to go.

FATE TRIGGERS

Fate Tokens are spent on Kotodama, or on any of the following, each a flat **1 Fate Token**. None of these flat triggers count against Stamina's per-Scene cap; only what you're holding limits them.

Overcome a Flaw - one of your Flaws doesn't apply for the rest of the current scene.

Automatic Success - a single roll succeeds outright, no dice involved. Fate Tokens are rare enough that this stays a flat cost regardless of the Difficulty being bypassed.

Shrug Off an Effect - ignore a negative status or condition (Off Balance, Distracted, Surprised,

Flustered, Overwhelmed, Exhausted, or similar) for a moment.

Refill Ki - your Ki pool refills completely, right there in the moment, no need to wait for a rest.

Get Back Up - spent while Dying, it puts you at **1 Health Level**, conscious and able to act. You can spend it while unconscious.

Characters with Iron Will may also spend 1 Fate Token to **Assert Your Will** - declare "my will is my own" and flatly negate an attempt to intimidate or dominate you, no roll. A micro-Kotodama: same shape as the main mechanic, but flat-costed and scoped narrowly to defending your own mind.

KI (THE POOL)

Fate Tokens are the resource players earn and spend; Ki is the pool that powers everything superhuman a character does. Ki is deliberately common: **Ki = your strongest Element + 8**, which puts every character between **13 and 18** regardless of how they built the rest of the sheet. Whatever a character is *most* is what channels their Ki - the frail specialist draws on as much as the bruiser.

Ordinary people have 1 Ki. Anyone without a Gift - the ordinary NPC, the bystander, the child - has a single point, and it's there for one moment past what they should be able to manage: the grandmother who lifts the car off a child, the runner who finds one more mile.

Ki has three jobs, all of them direct spends - no roll, no check, and none of them interact with Stamina's per-Scene cap:

1 point from Ki preserves one Vital Level - Health, Poise or Sanity - that would otherwise be lost to a die that got through the wall. At or below 0, 1 Ki instead restores Poise or Sanity to 1, without waiting for a rest. 1 Ki per step to move up one Action Bracket (Slow → Normal, or Normal → Fast; 2 Ki moves two steps at once). 1 Ki per die to boost an attack die - see Ki Infusion, covering all three attack types (Physical/Ferocity, Social/Presence, Mental/Psyche).

Most Gifts also cost Ki to use, called out per Gift and per Level, and some of them additionally call for a Gift Check rolled against current Ki.

Refill: a Short Rest restores **Klotho** Ki (minimum 1); a Full Night's Rest restores Ki fully. These are the big damn heroes, after all - Ki isn't meant to be a slow trickle back.

STAMINA'S JOB

Action Brackets themselves (Fast/Normal/Slow) cost nothing to declare - that's just normal combat flow, not something Stamina governs. Instead, Stamina does three things:

Hard cap on how many Fate Tokens a character can hold. At most **[Stamina score] x 3) + 1** at once - see Holding Fate Tokens. **Hard cap on counted spends per Scene.** A character can make **at most [Stamina score] + 1 counted spends per Scene** - the Time Band a combat encounter is contained within - regardless of how many Fate Tokens they actually have banked. It counts spends, not Tokens: a 7-Token Kotodama is one spend.

Counted: a Kotodama of any size; your share of a pooled Kotodama, one spend for each character who puts in, including a Claimed rescue; and burning off Corruption, one spend per level burned. **Not counted:** every flat Fate

Trigger - Overcome a Flaw, Automatic Success, Shrug Off an Effect, Refill Ki, Get Back Up, and Assert Your Will. **General**

endurance/exhaustion-resistance gauge.

Stamina sets a free baseline duration for any single sustained exertion (holding breath, forced marching, sustained labor, running flat-out) - Stamina Rounds, Minutes, Hours, or whatever Time Band unit fits the activity, GM's call. Past that baseline, roll **Water + Difficulty** once per additional unit of time, with Difficulty dropping by 1 each successive check. Failure imposes one level of **Exhausted**.

Exhausted is cumulative, each level stacking on top of the last:

A Short Rest drops one level of Exhausted; a Full Night's Rest clears it entirely, mirroring Health Level Recovery's own split. Exertion is one source; cold and heat are the other, and a level taken from an environment cannot be cleared while the character is still in it.

- 1 - Disadvantage on Physical rolls.
- 2 - Disadvantage on all rolls.
- 3 - Movement Rate halved, and no Fast actions.
- 4 - Every Ki spend costs 1 more.
- 5 - Unconscious, until somebody gets you warm, cool, or rested.

KOTODAMA

言霊 (kotodama, "word spirit") - spending Fate Tokens to assert a fact into the fiction directly, rather than touching a die roll. A player states a fact about the world, spends Fate Tokens to back the claim, and the fiction bends to make it true.

WHY IT COSTS WHAT IT COSTS

The world is the way it is because everyone agrees it is.

That isn't a metaphor and it isn't philosophy. It's the load-bearing fact of this game.

There were monsters once. Not "people told stories about monsters" - there were monsters, in the woods, and everyone knew it. You didn't go past the treeline after dark because of what was out there, and what was out there was out there because nobody alive doubted it. The agreement was total, so the monsters were real.

Then we stopped believing. Not all at once and not on purpose - we lit the streets, we mapped the woods, we explained the noises one at a time. As the agreement thinned out, so did the monsters. There's nothing in the woods now. We checked. We checked so thoroughly and so publicly that the checking itself became the thing everyone agreed on, and the woods emptied out to match.

Reality is a vote nobody knew they were casting.

Here's the part that should worry you. It still works. If you could convince most of the human race that there's an island off the west coast of America, and that the island has unicorns on it, then the island is there. Not that people would believe in it - it would be on the charts. Ships would have wrecked on it. It would have a history and a name, and somebody's grandmother would have been born there. The world would rearrange itself around the agreement and hand you back a version where the island had always been, because that's what the world does.

You can't convince most of the human race of anything. That's fine. You don't have to.

Your character is a fulcrum. That's what the Gifted *are* - the few whose will presses on reality directly, instead of going the long way around through persuading seven billion people. Everyone else gets a vote. You get to lean on the scale. Kotodama is you leaning.

So that's the cost curve, and it's why the prices climb the way they do. You aren't paying for the size of the effect. You're paying for how much agreement you've to overrule. A small claim slips through because the consensus was never firm on whether that door latched. A large one has to displace something a great many people are certain about, and their certainty is load-bearing.

Which is why the biggest claims can't be made alone. One person's will against the reality of the masses only reaches so far.

A claim's total Fate Token cost is the **sum of independent components**, not one flat lookup on a single scale. Multiple players may **pool** their Fate Tokens together for a total no single character could afford alone. Each character who puts in uses one of their own counted spends.

Four components: Magnitude, Range, Plausibility, and an optional **Duration** surcharge.

MAGNITUDE - SOLO RANGE (1-4 TOKENS)

Four tiers, one person acting alone, each step more exhausting than the last.

1 - Minor coincidence - The flashlight was already in your pack; there's just enough battery left to get the engine started; the key is under the mat; the door didn't latch; your phone happens to have signal here

2 - Meaningful, deliberate change - A hidden door that might not have been there before; the stolen motorcycle is just around the corner; the perfect tool was left by the side of the road; the security camera was already pointed the other way; a witness remembers seeing something useful

3 - Decisive, unmistakable feat - A structure collapses or appears exactly where it's needed; a patrol's morale breaks all at once; a faction's loyalty visibly flips in the moment; the crowd's fear turns to anger, aimed at exactly the right target; the bridge holds together just long enough

4 - Solo ceiling - An NPC's true nature or history is revealed to everyone present at once; a building that should be collapsing suddenly isn't; a faction's allegiance flips for good, not just the moment; a locked-down facility's systems glitch out all at once; an entire crowd's memory of what just happened is uncertain afterward

MAGNITUDE - POOLED RANGE (5+ TOKENS)

Everything above is what one person's will manages on its own. Past that, the consensus pushes back harder than any single character can push.

Five and up always takes more than one of you. It also works differently from the tiers above it - you don't read the price off a list. Tell the GM what you're claiming, and they will tell you what it costs. At this scale the size of the

change sets the number, and no table is going to anticipate what your table just decided to rewrite.

5 - Past any one person - A district keeps its power through a night it had no business surviving; an organization's records of you are wrong in every copy at once; the storm breaks over the whole valley exactly when it's needed; everyone who died in one specific event is found alive; a standing order changes and nobody can name who gave it

6+ - Universe-altering - The dead of a war aren't dead, and never were; a language nobody has spoken in three hundred years is the one everyone grew up speaking; a continent that was on no map has always been there; a law of physics has an exception, and always did

At six and beyond you've stopped changing what happened. You're changing what was always true - and everyone alive remembers it that way, because their agreement is what you rewrote.

RANGE - HOW FAR IT HAS TO HOLD

How far the change has to hold, which is another way of asking how many people's agreement it has to survive.

Everything within your own reach is free. Magnitude is already paying for a claim about the world right where you're standing, and charging twice for the same thing would price ordinary play out of existence. The bands below all cost nothing.

Past that, you're reaching into places whose agreement you're not standing in the middle of, and it costs. There's no table for it yet - tell the GM how far you need the claim to hold and they will price it, the same way they price Magnitude 5 and up.

Free - Self / on your person - The flashlight in *your* pack

Free - Touch / arm's reach - The door didn't latch; the key's under the mat

Free - Immediate vicinity / line of sight - The stolen motorcycle just around the corner; a hidden door across the room

Free - The space you're in - The whole room, vehicle, or block you're standing in - still bound to your own location

Priced by the GM - Anywhere you're not - Another district, another city, a place you've only heard of

PLAUSIBILITY

How hard the claim is to explain away afterward, independent of how big it is. A claim nobody can rationalize forces people to notice the override, and a consensus that notices is a consensus that resists.

Whisper, +0 - Entirely within the range of normal luck - a witness wouldn't think twice - The door happened to not latch. The consensus never had an opinion on this one, so there's nothing to overrule and nothing to pay.

Murmur, +1 - Technically still possible, a notable stroke of luck a skeptic would talk themselves out of suspecting - Every camera on this block happened to be pointed the wrong way. The agreement bends. It doesn't break.

Shout, +3 - Flatly breaks what anyone present believes is possible - no rationalizing it away, and it's remembered - A locked vault door swings open with no one touching it.

Three, not two, because a Shout costs you twice. You overrule the agreement, and then everyone who watched you do it walks away believing something impossible happened - which is its own change to the world, and you're paying for that one too.

Which tier you're in is decided by who is watching, not by what you did. The same claim is a Whisper alone in a stairwell and a Shout in a crowded bar. Work out who can see it before you work out what it costs.

If nobody sees it at all, drop one tier, to a minimum of Whisper. The world still notices an open vault door. It just has to work out for itself what happened.

WHAT THAT ADDS UP TO

Magnitude, plus Range if you're reaching past yourself, plus Plausibility, plus a Duration surcharge if you want something other than permanent. Here's what that looks like on real claims.

1 - Your phone has signal down here - Magnitude 1, Whisper

1 - The key is under the mat - Magnitude 1, Whisper

2 - The key is under the mat, and nobody is around to see you use it - Magnitude 2, Whisper

2 - The fire door you're running for was propped open this morning - Magnitude 2, Whisper

3 - The camera on this corner happened to be pointed the other way - Magnitude 2, Murmur

4 - The patrol's nerve breaks, all at once - Magnitude 3, Murmur

4 - The vault door swings open, empty building - Magnitude 3, Murmur

6 - The vault door swings open, crowded lobby - Magnitude 3, Shout

7 - The building that should be coming down isn't - Magnitude 4, Shout

Pooled - Everyone who died in the fire is found alive - Magnitude 5, the GM sets the number

Pooled - The dead of that war were never dead - Magnitude 6+, the GM sets the number

Two pairs in there are worth sitting with. The key costs 1, and the key with nobody around costs 2 - that second fact is a second thing the world has to agree to, and you pay for it. And the same vault door is a 4 or a 6 depending on nothing but who is standing in the lobby.

That gap is the only lever in the whole system you can pull with planning instead of Tokens. Clear the room first.

THIN PLACES

Reality isn't equally solid everywhere.

SHAPE	SURCHARGE	DESCRIPTION
Transient	+1 token	Happens once, then unhappens - the door unlocks now, but it's an ordinary door again after
Intermittent	+2 tokens	Comes and goes, unpredictable - the lights flicker whenever it matters, not on any schedule
Cyclic	+2 tokens	Repeats on a dependable pattern - the gate opens every night at midnight, reliably

THE TIDES OF FATE

A stretch of agreement that has been overwritten enough times stops holding its shape. Think of a file saved over once too often, or a glitch in the matrix - the same cat through the same doorway twice, and nobody quite able to say why it bothered them. The consensus there is corrupted, and corrupted things are easy to change.

Kotodama costs less in a thin place. How much less is the GM's call, and there's no table for it, because how worn a place is isn't a number - it's a fact about the story you're all in. So ask. If you think you're standing somewhere the world has already been argued with, say so, and find out what it's worth.

Two things worth knowing before you go looking for one. A thin place is cheap for everyone, not just you, and whatever else has been leaning on that spot is finding it easy too. And it got thin because somebody did this before you arrived. Somewhere cheap to rewrite is somewhere that has already been rewritten, and it's fair to wonder by whom.

DURATION (OPTIONAL SURCHARGE)

Permanent is the free default - a spoken truth just sticks, no extra cost. Paying more buys a **controlled, non-permanent shape** instead:

Fate Tokens don't appear and disappear. They move.

They come to you from the world - your Nature when you play it at a cost, your Flaws when they bite, the sunrise, the moment the group gets past something that mattered. And they go back to the world when you spend them, into the GM's pool, where they become whatever the world has to say about what you just did.

So the table has a tide. While the party is holding Tokens and the GM's bowl is nearly empty, the world is quiet and you are the ones acting on it. Spend heavily and the tide turns - you got what you wanted, and now there is a pile of leverage sitting on the other side of the table with your name on it. Neither state lasts. The sunrise refills you, the GM spends theirs back down, and it goes out and comes in again.

Nothing is created and nothing is destroyed. It only ever changes sides.

THE GM'S OWN POOL

Rather than Fate Tokens just draining from players into nothing, **when a player spends a Fate Token, the GM gains one** in a separate GM-side pool - spending isn't just depletion, it's a transfer of leverage from the players' side of the table to the GM's.

A special NPC's own Tokens never reach the pool. An NPC who holds Fate Tokens of their own spends them the way a player does, but a Token an NPC spends is simply gone. If it went into the GM's pool, the GM could fill their own bowl.

The pool buys three things, and every one of them is the world acting rather than a bonus bolted onto somebody's die roll.

A Twist - 1, 3, or 5+ Tokens. Escalate what is already in motion. One Token is a small complication - the door was alarmed after all. Three is a real turn in the scene - the ambush was a distraction. Five or more reshapes the arc - the ally you saved owed somebody else a debt first, and they have come to collect.

A Claim - priced exactly like yours. The GM asserts a fact into the fiction, paying the same Magnitude, Range and Plausibility that a player would, off the same tables. The world is doing precisely what you do, by the same rules. This is what the pool is really for.

Hardening - 1 Token per point. The consensus digs in. Each Token raises the cost of the players' next Kotodama in this Scene by 1. It is the opposite number to a thin place, and it is what makes a claim somewhere the world is paying attention to genuinely expensive.

And the rule that outranks all three: the pool never undoes a claim that was paid for. A fact the players bought is true and stays true. The GM's Tokens buy what happens next, never a reversal. They asserted the guard was already asleep, so he is - and he was due to check in ten minutes ago, and somebody has just noticed he hasn't.

Since the GM gains a Fate Token for every one a player spends, a bigger Kotodama spend automatically hands the GM proportionally more leverage - no separate consequence math needed. Small edits barely move the GM's pool; massive pooled edits load it up considerably.

WEAPONS & EQUIPMENT

Gear is the part of your character you can lose in a river.

Everything else on the sheet travels with you. Equipment doesn't, and that's most of what makes it interesting. A rifle is a handful of dice you're carrying. Body armor is Soak you didn't have to be born with. Both can be taken, broken, left in the other car, or handed over at a door, and you underneath are still you.

Weapons set how many dice an attack rolls, independent of the Element behind it - a pistol does what a pistol does whether a soldier or an accountant is holding it. What changes is whether they hit, and what they can afford to spend making it count.

Buying gear at creation runs on creation-Wealth rather than the ordinary Push procedure. That lives in the Resources chapter, and it's worth reading before you go shopping.

Each weapon's **Damage** rating is how many d10 it rolls on a hit, resolved per-die against the defender's Soak, as described in How to Play.

Range is given as **Normal / Long**, in meters - the same unit as Movement Rate and the Range Bands. A weapon's Normal range tells you the band it is built for: a shotgun's 5m is Close, a handgun's 15m is Near, a hunting rifle's 100m is Far. Attacking a target within Normal range carries no penalty. Attacking at **Long** range imposes **Disadvantage** on the attack roll, stacking with any other source per the usual binary rule. Beyond Long range, the target can't be attacked with that weapon at all.

Reload is the action cost to refill a weapon's Ammo back to full once it runs dry.

Wealth is the **Wealth** Level an item sits at - how expensive it is, and nothing else. It applies the same way to every table on this page, not just weapons. What that Level gets you for free, what it costs you to reach past it, and how the whole purchase works is in **Wealth at Character Creation**.

Money is not always the hard part. Plenty of what follows is perfectly legal to own and still not simple to buy. A handgun means a background check and a dealer who writes your name down. Body armor is restricted in some states and off the table entirely for anyone with a record. A prescription is a conversation with a doctor who keeps records, and a pilot's licence is two years and a medical. None of that is a roll - it is a detail for you and your GM about what it cost you in time, in paperwork, and in who knows your name now. The things with no lawful route at all are gathered under [The Black Market](#), which has its own rating and its own rules.

WHAT YOU CAN CARRY

Owning it is not carrying it. A character walks out of creation with more than fits in a coat, and keeps accumulating after. Most of it stays where they left it.

Say what you have on you when a scene starts, and that is what you have - a weapon or two, a bag, whatever is in your pockets. Everything else is at home, in the car, in a locker, in the safehouse: genuinely yours, and genuinely an hour away. Nothing here is tracked by weight and nothing is counted in slots. The only question is whether a person could be walking around with all of it at once, and **Potence (Sub-Stat Division)** settles the rare case where the answer turns on how strong you are.

Some of it is never carried at all. Everything under **Property** has an address, and most of **Transport** is parked somewhere. A workshop, a safe, a server rack, a boat - those are places you go, not things you bring, and reaching one in a hurry is a scene of its own rather than a line on a sheet.

It cuts both ways. A character who said they were travelling light doesn't get to produce the breaching charge. A character who said they brought the duffel is carrying a duffel, and everybody can see it.

BASIC WEAPONS

BASEBALL BAT WR 1

Ash or aluminium, thirty-odd inches. The aluminium ones ring when they connect.

Improvised. Damage 3, Melee.

BATTLE SPEAR WR 1

A steel head on an ash shaft, taller than the person carrying it.

Polearm / two-handed. Damage 5, Melee.

BAYONET WR 1

A blade built to clamp onto a rifle, used off it more often than on.

Knife. Damage 3, Melee.

BLACK POWDER PISTOL WR 1

A single shot, loaded down the muzzle. Takes a minute and a steady hand.

Handgun. Damage 3, 10m / 25m. 1 round. Reload slow action.

BLOWGUN WR 1

A metre of hollow tube and a tin of darts.

Exotic (ranged). Damage 1, 8m / 15m. 1 per shot.

BOOMERANG WR 1

Shaped hardwood, flat on one face. The kind that comes back is not the kind built for hunting.

Returning. Damage 2, 10m / 20m. 1 per throw (returns).

BRASS KNUCKLES WR 1

Four finger holes cast in one piece. Illegal in more places than people assume.

Improvised. Damage 2, Melee.

CHAIN WHIP WR 1

Linked steel sections with a weight at the end, folded down to nothing in a pocket.

Exotic (melee). Damage 3, Melee.

CHAINSAW WR 1

Petrol, two-stroke, and loud enough that nothing in the building is unaware of you.

Two-handed. Damage 5, Melee.

COMBAT KNIFE WR 1

Seven inches, full tang, a blood groove nobody needs.

Knife. Damage 3, Melee.

COMPACT PISTOL WR 2

Polymer frame, short barrel, built to sit under a jacket and be forgotten about.

Handgun. Damage 3, 15m / 40m. 15 rounds.
Reload 1 action.

COMPOUND BOW WR 2

Cams and cables. Holds most of the draw weight for you once it is back.

Compound bow. Damage 4, 25m / 60m. 12 (quiver).
Reload free.

CROSSBOW WR 2

A bow lying on its side with a trigger. Slow to load and no harder to aim than a rifle.

Crossbow. Damage 4, 20m / 50m. 12 (quiver).
Reload 1 action.

DART PISTOL WR 2

Compressed gas and a magazine of darts. Quiet, and obviously not a firearm up close.

Exotic (ranged). Damage 1, 10m / 20m. 5 darts.
Reload 1 action.

DERRINGER WR 1

Two barrels, palm-sized. Meant for a range where missing is not the problem.

Handgun. Damage 2, 5m / 10m. 2 rounds. Reload 1 action.

ENGLISH LONGBOW WR 2

Six feet of yew. Pulling it properly deforms the bones of anyone who does it for years.

Warbow. Damage 5, 30m / 70m. 12 (quiver).
Reload free.

FISTS, FEET

What everybody brings.

Unarmed. Damage 1, Melee.

FLAIL WR 1

A head on a chain on a handle. Goes around a guard rather than through it.

One-handed blunt. Damage 4, Melee.

FLARE GUN WR 1

Fat-barrelled, bright orange, loaded with something meant to be seen for miles.

Exotic (ranged). Damage 2, 15m / 40m. 1 round.
Reload 1 action.

GARROTE WR 1

Wire between two handles, carried coiled in a pocket.

Improvised. Damage 2, Melee.

GLAIVE WR 1

A long single-edged blade on a shaft. Cuts at a distance most people misjudge.

Polearm / two-handed. Damage 5, Melee.

HALBERD WR 1

An axe, a spike and a hook on one pole, for three different problems.

Polearm / two-handed. Damage 5, Melee.

HAND AXE WR 1

A hatchet balanced to be thrown as well as swung.

Thrown axe. Damage 1, 5m / 15m. 1 per throw.

HAND CROSSBOW WR 1

A crossbow cut down to one hand. The draw weight comes down with it.

Hand crossbow. Damage 2, 10m / 25m. 5 (quick-load). Reload 1 action.

HARPOON GUN WR 2

A barbed head on a line, fired from a stock. Built for things in water.

Heavy. Damage 3, 15m / 30m. 1 (line-retrievable). Reload slow action.

HATCHET WR 1

A camp axe. Splits kindling and is always to hand.

One-handed blade. Damage 4, Melee.

HEAVY REVOLVER WR 2

Six chambers, a barrel long enough to be a nuisance, and no jams.

Handgun. Damage 3, 15m / 40m. 6 rounds. Reload 1 action.

HUNTING RIFLE WR 2

Bolt action, wooden stock, a scope somebody sighted in years ago.

Rifle. Damage 4, 100m / 250m. 5 rounds. Reload 1 action.

JAVELIN WR 1

A throwing spear, light, with the weight forward.

Shafted. Damage 3, 10m / 25m. 1 per throw.

KAMA WR 1

A short blade set at a right angle to the handle. It started as a rice knife.

One-handed blade. Damage 3, Melee.

KATANA WR 2

A curved single edge, folded steel, a grip for one hand or two.

One-handed blade. Damage 4, Melee.

KUKRI WR 1

A heavy forward-angled blade. Chops out of proportion to its size.

Large blade. Damage 4, Melee.

MACE WR 1

A flanged steel head on a short haft. Does not care what the armour is made of.

One-handed blunt. Damage 4, Melee.

MACHETE WR 1

Eighteen inches of soft steel. Cheap, everywhere, and sharpened on a stone.

Large blade. Damage 4, Melee.

METAL PIPE WR 1

A length of scaffold or plumbing, picked up on the way past.

Improvised. Damage 3, Melee.

MUZZLELOADER RIFLE WR 2

Powder, ball and ramrod. One shot and then a long wait.

Rifle. Damage 4, 80m / 200m. 1 round. Reload slow action.

NAIL GUN WR 1

Pneumatic, framing weight, with the safety nose removed by somebody.

Exotic (ranged). Damage 2, 5m / 10m. 30 nails.
Reload 1 action.

NET LAUNCHER WR 2

A weighted net in a compressed-gas launcher. Opens in the air.

Exotic (ranged). Damage 1, 10m / 20m. 1 net.
Reload 1 action.

NUNCHAKU WR 1

Two hardwood batons on a short chain.

Exotic (melee). Damage 3, Melee.

PUMP SHOTGUN WR 2

Twelve gauge, tube magazine, the sound of the action doing half the work.

Shotgun. Damage 4, 5m / 15m. 6 shells. Reload slow action.

RAPIER WR 2

A long narrow blade with a cage over the hand. Built entirely around the point.

One-handed blade. Damage 4, Melee.

RECURVE BOW WR 2

Limbs curving away at the tips. Takedown, so it travels in a bag.

Recurve bow. Damage 3, 20m / 50m. 12 (quiver).
Reload free.

REVOLVER RIFLE WR 2

A cylinder in a rifle stock. Rare, and it spits at the wrist that holds it.

Rifle. Damage 4, 60m / 150m. 9 rounds. Reload 1 action.

SAI WR 1

A blunt spike with two side prongs, carried in pairs. Built to trap a blade.

One-handed blade. Damage 3, Melee.

SAP WR 1

Lead shot in a leather pouch, flat enough for a back pocket.

Improvised. Damage 3, Melee.

SAWED-OFF SHOTGUN WR 2

Both barrels cut back to nothing. Fits under a coat and spreads immediately.

Shotgun. Damage 4, 5m / 15m. 2 shells. Reload slow action.

SERVICE PISTOL WR 2

Full-size automatic, fifteen rounds, what a duty holster is shaped for.

Handgun. Damage 3, 20m / 50m. 15 rounds.
Reload 1 action.

SHORT SWORD WR 1

Two feet of straight double edge. Indoors it beats anything longer.

One-handed blade. Damage 4, Melee.

SLEDGEHAMMER WR 1

Ten pounds on a hickory handle. Meant for masonry.

Two-handed. Damage 5, Melee.

SLING WR 1

A leather cradle and two cords. Older than everything else on this page.

Sling. Damage 2, 15m / 30m. 1 per throw.

SNUB-NOSE REVOLVER WR 1

Five rounds, two-inch barrel, no hammer spur to catch on a pocket.

Handgun. Damage 2, 10m / 20m. 5 rounds.
Reload slow action.

SPEARGUN WR 1

Rubber bands and a steel shaft. Works properly only underwater.

Exotic (ranged). Damage 3, 10m / 25m. 1 spear.
Reload slow action.

SWITCHBLADE WR 1

Four inches, spring-loaded, opens with a thumb.

Knife. Damage 3, Melee.

TACTICAL CARBINE WR 2

Short-barrelled semi-auto, adjustable stock, rails for whatever you bolt to it.

Rifle. Damage 4, 100m / 250m. 20 rounds. Reload 1 action.

THROWING KNIFE WR 1

No edge worth speaking of. All of it is balance.

Balanced blade. Damage 1, 5m / 15m. 1 per throw.

TONFA WR 1

A baton with a side handle. Guards the forearm as well as it strikes.

One-handed blunt. Damage 3, Melee.

TRANQUILIZER RIFLE WR 2

A single dart on compressed gas. The dose is a guess and the wait is worse.

Exotic (ranged). Damage 1, 40m / 80m. 1 dart.
Reload slow action.

TRENCH KNIFE WR 1

A blade with knuckles built into the grip. Exactly as old as the name suggests.

Knife. Damage 3, Melee.

TWO-HANDED SWORD WR 2

Five feet of it, and a grip long enough to need both hands honestly.

Polearm / two-handed. Damage 5, Melee.

WAR AXE WR 1

A bearded head on a two-foot haft. The beard is for pulling shields down.

One-handed blade. Damage 4, Melee.

WAR FAN WR 1

Steel ribs in a folding fan. Closed it is a baton, open it is a guard.

Exotic (melee). Damage 2, Melee.

WARHAMMER WR 1

A hammer face one side, a spike the other, on a long haft.

Two-handed blunt. Damage 5, Melee.

WHIP WR 1

Twelve feet of plaited leather. Everything it does is at the tip.

Exotic (melee). Damage 2, 3m / 6m.

ARMOR

ARMORED COAT WR 2

A long wool coat with panels sewn between the lining and the shell. Heavier than it looks on the hanger.

Center of Mass. Hardness 3, 2 Health Levels.
Reads as clothing; no penalty.

ARMORED SUIT LINING WR 2

Soft panels tailored into a two-piece. Somebody was paid well to make it hang right.

Center of Mass. Hardness 2, 2 Health Levels.
Tailored into a suit; survives a glance, not a pat-down.

BALLISTIC BRIEFCASE WR 2

Leather over rated panels. One tug on the handle and it drops open into a shield as long as your torso.

Center of Mass. Hardness 4, 2 Health Levels.
Front arc only, one hand; a Fast action to unfold, and folded it's a briefcase.

BALLISTIC CAP INSERT WR 1

A curved plate of hard fiber cut to sit inside an ordinary baseball cap.

Head. Hardness 2, 1 Health Level. Hidden in a baseball cap; no penalty.

BALLISTIC HELMET WR 2

A high-cut composite shell with a four-point harness and rails nobody has used.

Head. Hardness 4, 2 Health Levels.

BALLISTIC SHIELD WR 3

A slab of laminate with a viewport and two handles, about the size of a door panel.

Center of Mass. Hardness 6, 4 Health Levels.
Front arc only, requires both hands.

BRIGANDINE WR 2

Steel plates riveted between canvas and leather. The rivet heads show in rows.

Center of Mass. Hardness 4, 3 Health Levels.

CHAINMAIL WR 2

Riveted rings, twenty pounds of them, worn over padding because the alternative is bruising.

Center of Mass + Arms. Hardness 4, 3 Health Levels. Disadvantage on Stealth rolls while worn.

CHAINMAIL DIVE SUIT WR 2

Stainless steel mesh from scalp to ankle, made for divers who work among sharks.

All four. Hardness 4, 3 Health Levels. Blades, claws and teeth only, no bonus vs. firearms; worn in water without penalty.

CONCEALABLE VEST WR 2

Soft panels in a carrier that goes under a shirt. Hot, and everybody who wears one says so.

Center of Mass. Hardness 3, 2 Health Levels.
Worn under clothing, no penalty.

FULL TACTICAL RIG WR 2

Plate carrier, helmet, throat and groin protection. Everything, and it weighs everything.

Center of Mass + Head. Hardness 6, 5 Health Levels. Single item, sets both Zones;
Disadvantage on Stealth rolls; Movement Rate -2 while worn.

GAMBESON WR 1

Quilted linen stuffed with tow. Worn alone it is a coat; worn under steel it is the reason the steel works.

Center of Mass. Hardness 2, 2 Health Levels.
Worn under other armor without penalty.

GAUNTLETS WR 1

Articulated plates over leather gloves, fingers and all.

Arms. Hardness 2, 1 Health Levels. Advantage resisting disarm attempts.

GREAVES WR 1

Shaped plates strapped over the shins.

Legs. Hardness 2, 1 Health Levels.

HAZMAT SUIT WR 2

*Sealed coveralls, taped cuffs, a hood and a filter.
Single use if it is ever actually needed.*

All four. Hardness 3, 2 Health Levels. Negates Disadvantage from toxic/biological hazards; Movement Rate -2.

KNEE AND ELBOW PADS WR 1

Hard caps on neoprene sleeves, the kind a skater or a SWAT team buys in bulk.

Arms + Legs. Hardness 2, 1 Health Level. Worn over or under clothing; no penalty.

LEATHER CUIRASS WR 1

Hardened leather, front and back, laced at the sides.

Center of Mass. Hardness 2, 2 Health Levels. No Stealth penalty.

MOTORCYCLE ARMOR JACKET WR 2

Textile with CE armour in the shoulders, elbows and back. Reads as a jacket because it is one.

Center of Mass + Arms. Hardness 3, 2 Health Levels. Worn openly, no Stealth penalty, doesn't look like armor.

MOTORCYCLE LEATHERS WR 2

A one-piece race suit, armor sewn in at the spine, shoulders, elbows and knees, scuffed from the last time it met the road.

Center of Mass + Arms + Legs. Hardness 3, 2 Health Levels. One-piece; worn openly, no Stealth penalty, doesn't look like armor.

PLATE ARMOR WR 2

*Articulated steel over the whole body.
Distributes its weight properly and is still exhausting.*

Center of Mass + Arms + Legs. Hardness 6, 4 Health Levels. Movement Rate -2 while worn.

RIOT EXOSKELETON WR 4

A powered frame worn outside the armour, motors at the joints, a battery on the back.

Center of Mass + Arms + Legs. Hardness 5, 4 Health Levels. Powered frame; Advantage on any roll of raw physical force; Disadvantage on Stealth rolls.

RIOT HELMET WR 1

Full face, polycarbonate visor, neck guard hanging off the back.

Head. Hardness 4, 2 Health Levels. Full-face visor, Advantage resisting Blinded.

RIOT SHIELD WR 2

Clear polycarbonate, body length, with a horizontal grip and a forearm cuff.

Center of Mass. Hardness 6, 4 Health Levels. Front arc only, requires both hands.

SEALED ENVIRONMENT ARMOR WR 4

Hard shell, sealed seams, its own air on the back and a faceplate that fogs at the edges.

All four. Hardness 5, 4 Health Levels. Single item, sets all four Zones; own air supply, immune to gas, smoke and contaminated water; Movement Rate -1.

STAB VEST WR 2

Layered mail and laminate. Built for blades, and honest about it.

Center of Mass. Hardness 3, 2 Health Levels.
Blade-only protection, no bonus vs. firearms.

TACTICAL VEST WR 2

A plate carrier with hard plates front and back and pouches across the front.

Center of Mass. Hardness 5, 3 Health Levels.
Disadvantage on Stealth rolls while worn.

TURNOUT GEAR WR 2

Firefighter's bunker gear: coat, trousers, hood and helmet, heavy, reflective, and rated to walk into a fire.

All four. Hardness 3, 2 Health Levels. Movement Rate -2; Disadvantage on Stealth rolls; its Hardness also stands against Burning room and On fire dice, and it negates Exhausted from heat the way cold-weather gear negates cold (not from going without water).

AR CONTACT LENSES WR 3

Soft lenses with the display printed into them. They need charging overnight in a case.

The same display layer, invisible to anyone else. Nobody can tell you are reading.

BIOMETRIC SCANNER LOCK WR 2

A handheld reader with a gel pad, and a cable that goes somewhere it should not.

Required tool to bypass fingerprint/retina-locked systems; without one, at Disadvantage.

COMMS RELAY BEACON WR 2

A weatherproof box the size of a brick, with a magnet on one face and a stub aerial.

Once placed, extends an Encrypted comms set's range from Near-Far to Far-and-beyond.

COVERT GPS TRACKER WR 1

A puck with a magnet, a battery good for a fortnight, and no lights on it.

Real-time location on a person/vehicle until found and removed.

DRONE CONTROL RIG WR 3

A harness with a folding screen and two thumbsticks, worn across the chest.

A worn harness for flying several drones at once. Not an implant - it comes off.

ENCRYPTED COMMS SET WR 2

Earpiece, throat mic and a belt unit. Everything on the set is paired to everything else.

Silent team communication at Near-Far range, no roll.

ACTION / BODY CAMERA WR 1

A matchbox with a lens, clipped to a chest strap or a lapel.

Records hands-free footage; can serve as evidence or an Investigation aid later.

AI ASSISTANT EARPIECE WR 2

A bud that sits deep enough not to show, always listening for its name.

Real-time research/lookups hands-free, no roll for obvious queries.

TECH & ELECTRONICS

FARADAY SLEEVE WR 1

A padded pouch lined with silver mesh, with a roll-top closure.

Nothing inside it transmits, receives, or can be tracked.

HACKING MULTITOOL WR 2

A slab of ports and adaptors with a screen on it, small enough for a jacket pocket.

Required tool for a field Hacking roll away from a full rig; without one, at Disadvantage.

HANDHELD THERMAL CAMERA WR 2

A pistol-grip camera with a small screen showing everything warm in white.

Advantage on Perception rolls to find living things through smoke, darkness, or a wall.

LAPTOP / HACKING RIG WR 2

A heavy laptop with too many ports and a battery that has been replaced twice.

Required tool for Hacking Skill checks; without one, Hacking rolls are at Disadvantage.

LASER RANGEFINDER WR 2

Monocular, rubber-armoured, reads out distance in the eyepiece.

Advantage on the first ranged attack roll against a stationary target.

MOTION SENSOR WR 1

A palm-sized sensor on a peel-and-stick pad, paired to a phone.

Alerts when triggered within its zone; Advantage on Perception to notice an intrusion it caught.

NIGHT VISION GOGGLES WR 3

A head harness and two tubes. Everything through them is green and flat.

Negate Disadvantage from darkness on Perception rolls.

NIGHT-VISION DRONE WR 3

A quadcopter with a low-light camera under it, quiet enough to lose track of.

Remote Far-range low-light scouting, directed as a Fast action.

POLICE SCANNER WR 1

A handheld receiver with a rubber aerial, scanning preset ranges.

Advantage on rolls made to anticipate or track police response.

PORTABLE CHARGER / POWER BANK WR 1

A brick of cells that will charge a phone six times over.

Keeps electronics running indefinitely in the field, no roll.

RECON DRONE WR 2

A folding quadcopter in a hard case, with a camera on a gimbal.

Remote Far-range visual/audio scouting, directed as a Fast action.

SATELLITE PHONE WR 2

A handset with a thick hinged aerial, and it needs open sky to be any use at all.

Comms with no signal dependency, works anywhere.

SECURITY DRONE (TRACKED) WR 3

Waist-high, tracked, armoured, with a sensor mast and a speaker.

Waist-high and armoured. Patrols a perimeter, reports, and escalates without being told to.

SMART GLASSES WR 2

Ordinary frames with a projector in one arm and a camera in the other.

Overlays directions, faces and notes on what you are looking at. Everyone can see you are wearing them.

SMARTGUN LINK KIT WR 2

A rail sensor, a wire, and a reticle that goes wherever the muzzle is actually pointed.

Fitted to one firearm. Puts the reticle where the muzzle actually points - ignore the Disadvantage from firing at Long range.

SMARTPHONE WR 2

A phone. Everybody has one and everybody's is slightly out of date.

Comms, maps, research at a glance - no roll for obvious lookups.

SOLAR CHARGER WR 1

A folding panel that straps to a pack, with a regulator and two ports.

Keeps electronics running indefinitely with no power grid access.

TABLET / E-READER WR 2

A tablet in a knocked-about case, loaded with more than anybody could read.

Portable research and storage; no roll for obvious lookups, same as a Smartphone.

TECHNICAL SCANNER WR 3

A handheld unit with a probe on a coiled lead and a screen that is mostly menus.

Identifies an unfamiliar device, what it is doing, and where it is weakest.

THERMAL DRONE WR 3

A quadcopter carrying a thermal camera instead of an ordinary one.

Remote Far-range thermal scouting, directed as a Fast action.

THERMAL IMAGING SCOPE WR 3

A scope that clips ahead of an existing optic, showing heat rather than light.

Advantage on Perception through darkness, smoke, or light cover.

TWO-WAY RADIO WR 1

A pair of handhelds off a shelf. Anybody with the same set can hear you.

Short-range team comms (Close-Near), no roll - cheaper unencrypted alternative to an Encrypted comms set.

SURVIVAL & TOOLS

ANIMAL TRAPS WR 1

Wire snares and a few small spring traps, rolled in canvas.

Passive capture of small game over time, no roll to set.

ASCENDER / RAPPEL KIT WR 2

Two handled cams, a descender, slings and locking carabiners.

Required tool for safely rappelling down or ascending a fixed rope; without one, at Disadvantage.

AVALANCHE BEACON WR 2

A transceiver worn against the chest, transmitting until somebody switches it to search.

Real-time location if buried in snow, drastically speeds rescue.

BEAR TRAP WR 1

Forty pounds of sprung steel jaws on a chain and a stake.

Passive trap; Restrains and deals 3 damage to whoever triggers it.

BOLT CUTTERS WR 1

Thirty-six inch handles and hardened jaws. Nothing subtle about carrying them.

Required tool for cutting chains/padlocks; without one, at Disadvantage.

COMPASS WR 1

Baseplate, liquid-damped needle, a lanyard. No battery to go flat.

Never lost navigating with a map, no roll.

CROWBAR WR 1

A yard of forged steel, flat one end, curved the other.

Advantage on forced-entry rolls against doors/windows specifically (not a full Breaching kit).

DUCT TAPE WR 1

A roll of it. Everybody has an opinion about which brand.

No roll for trivial improvised repairs, restraint, or holding a dressing on.

FIELD RATIONS & WATER PURIFIER WR 1

Retort pouches, a pump filter and spare cartridges.

Keeps you fed and watered in the field, no roll, for an extended stretch.

FIRE AXE WR 1

Red, with a pick on the back, off a wall somewhere.

Advantage on forced-entry rolls against doors specifically - a low-tech cousin of the Breaching kit.

FIRE STARTER KIT WR 1

Ferro rod, striker, waxed tinder in a tin that seals.

Reliable fire in any weather, no roll.

FIRST AID KIT WR 1

A zip pouch of dressings, tape, gloves and scissors.

Consumed on use: Advantage on a roll to treat Health Levels.

GAS MASK / RESPIRATOR WR 1

Full-face, twin filters, straps that take a minute to get right.

Negates Disadvantage from smoke, gas, or airborne toxins.

GLOW STICKS WR 1

A dozen plastic tubes. Snap one and it cannot be switched off again.

Twelve hours of light that needs no battery and cannot be switched off.

GO-BAG WR 1

A packed holdall by the door. Clothes, cash, documents, a charger and a knife.

Packed and by the door. Leaving in under a minute costs no roll and nothing is forgotten.

GRAPPLING HOOK WR 1

Three folding flukes on a steel eye, with fifty feet of line.

Advantage on Climbing rolls to scale a ledge or wall within range.

HAND SAW WR 1

A bow saw with a spare blade taped to the frame.

No roll for trivial wood-cutting tasks.

ICE AXE WR 1

A steel head on a short shaft, pick one side, adze the other.

Required tool for climbing on ice or snow; Advantage on Climbing rolls in those conditions.

LOCKPICK SET WR 1

A leather wallet of rakes, hooks and tension wrenches.

Required tool for lockpicking; without one, bypass rolls are at Disadvantage.

MULTITOOL WR 1

Pliers, blades, drivers and a file, folded into a handle.

No roll for trivial improvised repairs.

NICE BACKPACK WR 1

Forty litres, a proper hip belt, and a lifetime guarantee somebody will honour.

+20kg Carrying Capacity while worn.

OXYGEN TANK WR 2

A small cylinder with a regulator and a mask, good for about twenty minutes.

Sustains breathing in a low-oxygen or toxic environment for an extended stretch.

PARACORD (100FT) WR 1

A hank of 550 cord. Seven inner strands, and people use those separately.

Advantage on improvised rigging or binding rolls.

PICKAXE WR 1

A point one side, a chisel the other, on a hickory haft.

Advantage on rolls to break through rock or hard earth.

PORTABLE CAMP STOVE WR 1

A burner that screws onto a gas canister, and a wind shield that never quite works.

Hot food and water in the field without an open fire.

ROAD FLARES WR 1

Fusees in a cardboard tube. Fifteen minutes each, and they burn in rain.

Burn in rain and wind. Advantage on rolls to signal, warn off, or start something.

ROPE & CLIMBING KIT WR 1

Fifty metres of dynamic rope, a harness, belay device and a rack of gear.

Advantage on Climbing-related rolls.

SEWING / REPAIR KIT WR 1

Needles, waxed thread, patches and a few buttons in a tobacco tin.

No roll for trivial gear or clothing repairs.

SNAKE BITE KIT WR 1

A suction pump, bandages and instructions most people have not read.

Consumed on use: Advantage resisting a venom effect.

SNOWSHOES WR 1

Aluminium frames with decking and a ratchet binding.

Negates Movement Rate penalties from deep snow.

STRAW WATER FILTER WR 1

A hollow-fibre tube you drink through directly.

Makes any water source safe to drink, no roll.

TACTICAL FLASHLIGHT WR 1

Anodised aluminium, a tail switch, and bright enough to be an argument.

Negates darkness Disadvantage within Close range.

TENT WR 1

Two-person, three-season, and the poles are colour-coded for a reason.

Field shelter for one to two; lighter and cheaper than the full Tent & sleeping gear kit.

TENT & SLEEPING GEAR WR 2

The tent, a bag rated lower than you need, and a mat that will deflate by morning.

Field shelter; avoids Exhausted accrual from a rough night outdoors.

THERMITE CHARGE WR 2

A shaped canister with an igniter. Burns through what it is sat on.

Consumed on use: burns through a locked or reinforced barrier, no roll needed - GM's call on collateral.

WATER DESALINATOR WR 2

A hand-pumped reverse osmosis unit. Slow, and heavier than the brochure said.

Makes seawater safe to drink, no roll.

WELDING TORCH WR 2

Oxy-acetylene on a trolley, with a striker on a chain.

Required tool for metal-cutting or joining tasks; without one, at Disadvantage.

MEDICAL & CHEMICAL

ADRENALINE SHOT (EPI-PEN) WR 1

An auto-injector in a plastic tube. Blue to the sky, orange to the thigh.

Consumed on use: clears one Exhausted level instantly and negates a severe allergic reaction, no roll.

ADVANCED TRAUMA KIT WR 2

A vacuum-packed roll of tourniquets, chest seals, airways and packing gauze.

Consumed on use: Advantage on treating Health Levels, usable even to stabilize someone at or below 0.

ANTITOXIN WR 2

A vial and a syringe in a cold pack, with the venom it answers written on the label.

Consumed on use: ends Envenomed from the venom it's made for.

BURN GEL / DRESSING WR 1

Sterile gel-soaked pads in foil, sized from a hand to a torso.

Consumed on use: Advantage on treating a burn injury specifically.

CHEMICAL ANALYSIS KIT WR 2

Reagent bottles, a spot plate and a card of colour references.

Required tool for identifying unknown substances; Advantage on related Research/Science rolls.

DEFIBRILLATOR (AED) WR 2

A hard case with two pads and a voice that talks you through it.

Consumed on use: can revive a target from Unconscious at 0 Health Levels, no roll, if used within the same Scene they went down.

FIELD AUTODOC WR 4

A case that opens into a frame over a patient, with arms that do the work themselves.

A case that performs surgery. Better than a paramedic, worse than a surgeon, and it never panics.

FIELD STIMULANT WR 1

Ampoules in a foam block. Whatever is in them is not sold over a counter.

Consumed on use: clear your current Exhausted levels, or grant Advantage on one Physical roll - GM's call on any crash afterward.

IV KIT & FLUIDS WR 1

Bags of saline, giving sets, cannulas and a length of tape.

Consumed on use: Advantage on treating Exhausted levels or blood loss.

MEDICAL SCANNER WR 3

A handheld unit run over a patient, reading out more than a pulse.

Handheld. Sees the break, the bleed and the poison without opening anything.

NALOXONE KIT WR 1

Two doses of nasal spray in a hard case, with the instructions printed on the lid.

Consumed on use: reverses an opioid overdose outright, no roll.

SAM SPLINT WR 1

A rolled aluminium and foam strip, bent to shape around a limb.

Required tool for field-splinting a broken limb; without one, at Disadvantage.

SEDATIVE DART WR 2

A single dart with a pressurised chamber behind the needle.

Ranged; a target Overwhelmed by its Stamina-based dice falls Unconscious instead of just losing Health Levels (GM's call on framing).

STIMULANT PATCH WR 2

An adhesive patch that goes on the neck and works through the skin.

Buys you a night. You pay for it over the following week.

SURGICAL KIT WR 2

A sterile roll of scalpels, forceps, clamps, needles and suture.

Required tool for treatment beyond field first aid; without one, at Disadvantage on major Health Level treatment.

TOURNIQUET WR 1

A windlass on a webbing strap, one-handed by design.

Consumed on use: Advantage on the next roll to treat Health Levels lost to a bleeding injury.

TRAUMA PATCH WR 2

A sealed dressing with a clotting agent already in the gauze.

Adhesive. Stops the bleeding and the panic for about an hour; buys time, not recovery.

TRAUMA SHEARS WR 1

Angled shears that cut a boot off without touching what is inside it.

No roll to quickly cut through clothing or restraints to treat an injury.

WATER PURIFICATION TABLETS WR 1

A strip of foil-wrapped tablets. Thirty minutes and it tastes of a swimming pool.

Makes questionable water safe to drink, no roll - lighter than a full purifier.

DISGUISE & INFILTRATION

BUMP KEY SET WR 1

Filed-down blanks in the common profiles, and a plastic mallet to tap them.

Advantage on Lockpicking rolls against standard pin-tumbler locks.

BURN BAG WR 1

A lined sack with a pull igniter in the seam. Everything in it goes to ash.

Destroys everything inside it in under a minute, unrecoverably.

COLLAPSIBLE RIFLE CASE WR 2

A padded case that breaks down into something a tennis racket would fit in.

A rifle that comes apart into something that reads as an instrument case.

COLORED CONTACT LENSES WR 1

Tinted soft lenses in a case, in three shades nobody would remark on.

Defeats a description or ID check based on eye color, no roll.

DEAD DROP CACHE WR 1

A weatherproof tube and a spot nobody watches. The spot is the expensive part.

A prepared spot nobody watches. Hand something over without meeting anybody.

DISGUISE KIT WR 1

Spirit gum, pigments, brushes, appliances and a mirror that folds flat.

Advantage on Deception rolls involving a physical disguise.

ENCRYPTED BURNER PHONE WR 1

A cheap handset with an encrypted messenger on it, bought for cash.

Untraceable, disposable comms; discard after use to leave no trail.

ENVIRONMENT-MATCHED CAMO WR 1

A pattern chosen for one specific place, not a general-purpose one.

Advantage on Stealth rolls in matching terrain.

FINGERPRINT GLOVES WR 1

Thin nitrile with textured pads. Leaves marks that are nobody's.

Leaves no fingerprints; negates related forensic Investigation against the wearer.

GHILLIE SUIT WR 1

A net oversuit hung with jute garnish, tied on in handfuls over weeks.

Advantage on Stealth rolls in matching natural terrain (doesn't stack with Environment-matched camo).

GRAPPLE GLOVES WR 2

Gloves with a launcher on the back of each wrist and a spool in the cuff.

Advantage on Climbing rolls on sheer or smooth surfaces.

PROSTHETIC SCARS / TATTOO KIT WR 1

Silicone appliances, transfer inks and remover, in a flat tin.

Advantage on Deception rolls impersonating a specific known individual.

UNIFORM DISGUISE WR 1

Somebody's actual work clothes, with the right boots and a laminated card.

Advantage on Deception rolls passing as a specific role or organization while worn.

UV FLASHLIGHT WR 1

A torch throwing almost nothing visible. Things on a floor light up under it.

Advantage on Investigation rolls at a scene with UV-reactive evidence.

VOICE CHANGER WR 1

An inline unit between a handset and an earpiece, with a dial.

Advantage on Deception rolls made over a phone or radio specifically.

WIG & MAKEUP KIT WR 1

Two wigs on blocks, pins, and a case of everything to go with them.

Advantage on Deception rolls for a full appearance change (doesn't stack with a Face-changing prosthetics kit).

SURVEILLANCE

BINOCULARS WR 1

Roof prism, ten by forty-two, rubber armoured.

Advantage on Perception rolls at Far range.

CONCEALABLE MICROPHONE WR 1

A microphone the size of a shirt button on a hair-thin lead.

Covert audio pickup, Close-Near broadcast range.

DIRECTIONAL MICROPHONE WR 2

A shotgun mic in a foam windshield, on a pistol grip.

Advantage on eavesdropping at Near-Far range.

HIDDEN CAMERA WR 1

A pinhole lens built into something ordinary, with a card slot in the back of it.

Covert visual feed, live or for later retrieval.

HIDDEN TRACKER DART WR 2

A tracker in a dart body, fired from a gas launcher and sticky on impact.

Ranged; attaches a Covert GPS tracker to a target or vehicle without them noticing (Stealth vs. Perception).

PARABOLIC MICROPHONE WR 2

A clear plastic dish with a microphone at the focus and headphones on a lead.

Advantage on eavesdropping at Far range specifically (line of sight required).

RF / BUG DETECTOR WR 2

A wand with a meter on it, swept slowly along a wall.

Advantage on Perception rolls made specifically to find a hidden microphone or tracker.

SATELLITE UPLINK WR 3

A folding dish in a hard case, with a terminal that takes ten minutes to find the sky.

Comms and data access with no signal dependency, works anywhere - a team-wide version of a Satellite phone.

SPY PEN CAMERA WR 1

A pen that writes, with a lens above the clip.

Covert visual recording, easily overlooked as an everyday object.

SURVEILLANCE MICRODRONE WR 3

Insect-sized. Flies in through the gap a window was left open and sends back what it sees.

Insect-sized. Flies in through the gap a window was left open and sends back what it sees.

TRAIL CAMERA WR 1

A camouflaged box strapped to a tree, motion-triggered, with infrared for night.

Unattended, motion-triggered; monitors a fixed location indefinitely.

TRANSPORT

AMPHIBIOUS CONVERSION VEHICLE WR 5

A four-wheel-drive with a sealed hull, a propeller and seams that need checking.

Road to water without stopping. Neither half is best in class.

ATV / DIRT BIKE WR 3

Knobbly tyres, long travel suspension, and no interest in roads.

Advantage on Chase rolls off-road; not street-legal.

BICYCLE WR 2

A bike. Quiet, cheap, and it goes where cars cannot.

Quiet, no fuel, no roll to operate.

CARGO VAN WR 4

*White, high roof, no windows in the back.
Nobody looks at it twice.*

Hauling capacity, inconspicuous.

ECONOMY SEDAN WR 3

*Four doors, grey, ten years old. The most invisible
object on this page.*

Ordinary car, 4-5 seats.

GYRO-STABILIZED SUPERBIKE WR 4

*A litre bike with active stabilisation. Stays upright
doing things that should not.*

Will not fall over. Will still throw you off.

HANG GLIDER / WINGSUIT WR 3

*A wing in a bag, or a suit with webbing between
the limbs. Both are one-way.*

Unpowered gliding flight from height, requires
Piloting.

HORSE & TACK WR 3

*A horse, a saddle, a bridle and the knowledge of
how to use all three.*

Ordinary mount, no fuel required.

HOT AIR BALLOON WR 3

*An envelope, a basket, burners and a truck to
collect you afterwards.*

Slow vertical/wind-drift flight, requires Piloting.

KAYAK / CANOE WR 2

*A hull, a paddle and a spray deck. Portable if two
people are willing.*

Water only, human-powered.

LIGHT HELICOPTER WR 5

*A four-seat turbine. Needs somewhere flat and
everybody knowing you have arrived.*

Full 3D movement, requires Piloting.

MINI-SUBMARINE WR 5

*A two-person hull with a battery bank, viewports
and eight hours of air.*

Full underwater movement, requires Piloting.

MOTOR YACHT WR 6

*Forty feet, twin diesels, berths for six and a
tender on the back.*

A house that leaves, and a jurisdiction you
choose.

MOTORCYCLE WR 3

*Six hundred cubic centimetres of it, and it fits
through traffic.*

Advantage on Chase rolls in dense
urban/congested terrain.

OFF-ROAD SUV WR 4

*Body on frame, locking differentials, and tyres
that hum on tarmac.*

Advantage on Chase rolls off-road or rough
terrain.

PARACHUTE WR 2

*A ram-air canopy, harness, reserve and an
automatic opener nobody argues with.*

Safe descent from height or an aircraft; single-
use per jump unless repacked.

PERSONAL WATERCRAFT WR 3

A jet-drive ski for two, fast in a straight line and no use in a swell.

Water only, Advantage on Chase rolls on open water.

PICKUP TRUCK WR 4

A bed, a tow hitch, and a cab that seats three at a push.

Real cargo/towing capacity.

PRIVATE JET WR 6

Light twin, six seats, and a crew who have been told not to file a passenger list.

Range, privacy, and a crew who know your name.

SKATEBOARD / SCOOTER WR 1

Board or kick scooter. Goes under an arm at the door.

Quiet, no fuel, folds for easy carry.

SLED / DOG SLED WR 2

A basket sled, a gangline and a team who know the route better than you do.

Snow or ice only, requires a team of sled dogs.

SMALL FIXED-WING AIRCRAFT WR 5

Four seats, one engine, and a strip short enough to be unofficial.

Requires Piloting (Fixed-Wing).

SPEEDBOAT WR 4

An open hull with far too much outboard on the back of it.

Water only.

SUPERCAR WR 5

Mid-engined, carbon, and every camera on the route will remember it.

Fast, loud, and remembered by everyone who saw it.

UTILITY TRAILER WR 2

A flatbed on a tow ball, with a ramp and a tarpaulin.

Real cargo capacity, requires a towing vehicle.

LESS-LETHAL & SELF-DEFENSE

BEAR SPRAY WR 1

A fire-extinguisher-sized canister with a safety clip and a belt holster.

Damage 1, 4m / 6m. 1 (canister). Same as pepper spray, but a Close-range cone hitting everyone in it.

BLINDING STROBE WR 1

A handheld lamp that pulses hard enough to be felt behind the eyes.

Damage 0, Close radius. Blinded for 1 round, no roll needed to trigger.

BOLA WR 1

Three weights on cords, spun and let go.

Damage 1, 8m / 15m. 1 per throw. Target's Movement Rate is halved until they break free.

COLLAPSIBLE BATON WR 1

Telescoping steel, twenty-one inches out, flicked open with a wrist.

Damage 2, Melee.

FLASHBANG WR 1

A perforated steel body. Light and pressure, no fragments.

Damage 1, 10m throw. 1 (thrown). Everyone in a Close radius is Blinded and at Disadvantage for 1 round.

FLEX CUFFS WR 1

Heavy zip ties, doubled, cut off rather than unlocked.

Damage 0, Melee. Restrains a compliant or already-subdued target; cut, not unlocked.

GRAPPLING SNARE WR 1

A spring-loaded loop on a ground plate, set and covered over.

Damage 1, Melee (trap). Restrains whoever triggers it.

HANDCUFFS WR 1

Chain-linked steel, double locked with the tip of the key.

Damage 0, Melee. Restrains a compliant or already-subdued target until unlocked.

LESS-LETHAL SHOTGUN (BEANBAG) WR 2

A shotgun with an orange stock, so nobody loads it wrong in a hurry.

Damage 3, 5m / 15m. 6 shells. Reload slow action. No Health Level loss from this weapon alone; Prone and Disadvantage next turn.

NET GUN WR 2

A weighted net folded into four barrels, fired by compressed gas.

Damage 1, 8m / 15m. 1 net. Reload 1 action. Target is Restrained until they break free (Potence check).

PEPPER SPRAY WR 1

A keyring canister with a flip cover, a stream rather than a mist.

Damage 1, 3m / 5m. 1 (canister). Blinded and Disadvantage on all rolls for 1 round.

PEPPER SPRAY GEL WR 1

A thicker formulation that goes where it is aimed and stays there.

Damage 1, 6m / 9m. 1 (canister). Same Blinded effect as pepper spray, less blowback risk.

RUBBER BULLET LAUNCHER WR 2

A break-action launcher with a wide bore and a padded stock.

Damage 2, 15m / 40m. 6 rounds. Reload 1 action. Same as the beanbag shotgun above.

SHOCK BATON WR 2

A baton with contacts at the tip and a trigger under the thumb.

Damage 2, Melee. Target is Stunned until the start of their next turn.

SHOCK DART GUN WR 2

A blocky handgun firing two barbs on wires, with a cartridge in the nose.

Damage 2, 5m / 8m. 1 cartridge. Reload 1 action. Prone, can't act until the start of their next turn.

SMOKE GRENADE WR 1

A canister that burns rather than bursts, throwing smoke for a minute.

Damage 0, 10m throw. 1 (thrown). Fills a Close radius with concealment; Advantage on Stealth to break contact.

SONIC DETERRENT DEVICE WR 2

A dish on a handle, projecting a tone in a cone in front of it.

Damage 1, Close-Near cone. Disadvantage on all rolls while in the cone.

STUN GUN WR 1

Two contacts and a trigger. It has to be touching to do anything.

Damage 1, Melee. Disadvantage on the target's next roll.

TEAR GAS GRENADE WR 1

A burning canister, hot enough that picking it up to throw back costs something.

Damage 1, 10m throw. 1 (thrown). Everyone in a Close radius is Blinded and at Disadvantage until they leave the area.

OCCULT

Money is not the hard part here either.

Everything in this section is cheap. Salt is salt, rosemary is rosemary, a horseshoe is eight dollars at a flea market, and a stone with a hole in it is free if you know which beach to walk. The Wealth rating buys the material. Material on its own does nothing whatsoever.

Every item here has to be **prepared** before it works. Preparation is an **Occult** roll against **Moire + Difficulty**, and it takes about an hour per item, or per batch of a consumable. The GM sets the Difficulty: a salt line is Easy, something that has to hold against one specific named thing is not.

On a failure the materials are spent and you have a jar of dirt. On a success it stays prepared until it is used, broken, or the ward it was holding gives way.

An unprepared ward is exactly what it looks like. Salt on a floor. A stone with a hole in it. Somebody's grandmother's horseshoe over a door.

You can buy them ready-made. Somebody prepares these for a living, and finding that somebody is a **Contacts** question rather than a money one. A prepared item costs **one Wealth rating higher** than the raw material below.

Check with your GM before any of this goes on a sheet. Whether a salt line holds, whether iron means anything, whether the thing in the house can be warded out at all - none of that is settled by the price of the salt. It is a question about the game you are playing, and it gets answered the same way **Beyond the Ordinary** does.

Electronics are exempt. Nothing in the Detection table needs preparing. A thermometer is a thermometer.

OCCULT - CONSUMABLES

BLESSED WATER WR 1

A vial of water out of a font, stoppered and sealed with wax. It looks like water.

Burns what should not be touching a person. Poured in a line, nothing crosses it unnoticed.

CLEANSING BUNDLE WR 1

Rosemary, lavender, juniper or mugwort, dried and bound with cotton thread.

Lit and left to smoulder. The smoke clears a room of what has been lingering in it.

CONSECRATED OIL WR 1

Olive oil in a small glass bottle, blessed and left to stand a week.

Anoints a person, a door or a blade. Lasts the night.

GRAVEYARD DIRT WR 1

A jam jar of soil taken off a grave.

Taken with permission, which is the difficult part.

INCENSE AND CENSER WR 1

A pierced brass bowl on three chains, and a box of cones.

Reusable. The cones are not.

IRON FILINGS WR 1

A pound of iron swarf in a tin. It rusts if the lid is left off.

Mixed into paint, scattered on a sill, or thrown.

RITUAL CANDLES WR 1

A dozen plain candles, unscented, wicks already trimmed.

Burn for six hours and go out together, whatever is left of them.

RITUAL CHALK WR 1

A box of soft white sticks. They mark anything, including things chalk should not mark.

Does not come off until you take it off.

SALT CIRCLE KIT WR 1

A tin holding measured salt, a length of cord and a stick of chalk.

One complete circle, once.

SALT, CANISTER WR 1

A cardboard canister of coarse salt. The cheap kind, off a supermarket shelf.

Enough for a circle around one room, or a line across four doorways.

SILVER DUST WR 2

A vial of silver ground finer than flour.

Puts silver where silver would not otherwise reach.

WARDING PAINT WR 1

A rattle can, or a brush and a tin. Both work.

One room's worth of sigils.

OCCULT - CHARMS & WARDS**BLANK AMULET** WR 1

A flat silver disc on a cord, unmarked on both faces.

Waiting for a ritual to put something in it.

CHARM BAG WR 1

A cloth bag the size of a plum, drawstring at the neck.

Filled to purpose. Carried, not hung.

COLD IRON NAIL WR 1

A hand-forged nail, black, square in section. Drawn wire will not do.

Driven into a threshold, or carried.

CONSECRATED IRON FRAGMENT WR 2

A shard off a church bell, thumb-sized and still curved.

Rare, and nobody who has one sells it cheaply.

EVIL EYE CHARM WR 1

Blue glass with a white and black eye in the middle. Sold on every market stall on the Mediterranean.

Worn where it can be seen, which is the point.

HAG STONE WR 1

A beach pebble with a hole worn through it by water. The hole has to be natural.

Hung over a bed on red ribbon, or nailed to the bedpost. Nothing sits on the sleeper's chest.

IRON HANDCUFFS WR 2

Hand-forged cuffs, heavier than police issue, with a key that fits nothing else.

What they hold cannot simply stop being solid.

IRON HORSESHOE WR 1

A used shoe off a working horse, nail holes and all.

Over a door, open end up. Everybody's grandmother had one.

KNOTTED CORD WR 1

A yard of cord with nine knots along it.

Untie them one at a time, and one at a time only.

ROWAN AND RED THREAD WR 1

Two rowan twigs bound into a cross with red wool.

Over a door, or on a person.

RUE SACHET WR 1

Dried rue in a linen bag, stitched shut.

Worn against the evil eye.

THRESHOLD WARD KIT WR 1

A canvas roll holding chalk, salt, iron filings and cord.

One doorway, complete.

WITCH BOTTLE WR 1

A glass bottle of pins, nail clippings and worse, sealed with wax.

Buried at a threshold. It takes what was meant for you.

OCCULT - WARDED AMMUNITION

BLESSED ROUNDS WR 2

A box of twenty, each round blessed before it was loaded.

Ordinary ammunition otherwise.

COLD IRON ROUNDS WR 2

A box of twenty, cast from wrought iron rather than lead. They foul a barrel.

Ordinary ammunition otherwise.

SALT-LOADED SHELLS WR 1

Ten shotgun shells packed with rock salt in place of shot.

Hurts enormously. Kills nothing.

SILVER BUCKSHOT WR 2

Ten shells loaded with cast silver balls.

Ordinary ammunition otherwise.

SILVER ROUNDS WR 2

A box of twenty, cast solid rather than plated.

Ordinary ammunition otherwise.

OCCULT - DETECTION

AUDIO SWEEP RADIO WR 1

A radio modified to sweep the band without stopping.

People hear words in it.

DIGITAL VOICE RECORDER WR 1

A pocket recorder with a better microphone than it needs.

Records the room, and sometimes more of it than was there.

DOWSING RODS WR 1

Two brass rods bent into L shapes, held loose in the fists.

They move. Nobody agrees why.

EMF METER WR 1

A handheld meter with a needle and five LEDs above it.

Reads electromagnetic fields. What that means is between you and your GM.

FULL-SPECTRUM CAMERA WR 2

A camera with the infrared filter taken out of it.

Stills and video, into ultraviolet and infrared.

INFRARED THERMOMETER WR 1

A pistol-grip thermometer with a laser dot on the front.

Surface temperature at a distance, to a tenth of a degree.

RESIDUE SAMPLE KIT WR 1

Swabs, vials, a UV lamp and a box of evidence bags.

Everything you need to take something away and nothing to tell you what it is.

PROPERTY

Somewhere to be, and somewhere to keep things. A property is bought like any other item - it is the one purchase a character makes that has an address.

A **Base** Resource is a different thing and worth having as well: the Resource is what the place is equipped and defended with, the item here is the deed. A **Safehouse Network** is different again - that Resource gives you sites with the basics in them and nothing more, while a property bought here comes properly outfitted.

ESTATE WR 6

A house with a name rather than a number, at the end of a drive nobody turns down by accident.

Grounds, staff, and enough distance that nobody hears anything. Name it as your repository and anything you own but are not carrying is in it. Somebody on the staff knows where, which is either convenient or a problem.

SAFE HOUSE (URBAN) WR 4

A flat on a middle floor, rented under a company, with the bills paid by standing order.

An address in nobody's name that nobody visits, kitted out and stocked for as long as you need to be there. Name it as your repository and anything you own but are not carrying is in it, rather than somewhere nobody has decided yet.

THE BLACK MARKET

Some things have no counter to walk up to. The price is the easy half - the hard half is knowing who to ask.

Buying here is gated twice. You need the Wealth to pay for it and **Black Market Access** to find it, and you need both to reach the item: your Wealth must meet its **Wealth** rating and your Black Market Access must meet its **Black Market** rating. A Wealth 5 character who knows nobody buys nothing on these pages. Neither does a Wealth 1 character who knows everybody.

The free items a character starts with don't apply here. Every purchase on these pages is a transaction, however cheap the thing is. Nobody hands you a jammer because you're rich.

In play, you can bring a friend. If another character has the half you are missing and is willing to spend it, the purchase goes through on their rating instead. One of you knows a guy. The other one pays. Both of you are in it now, which is generally how this turns into a problem later. This is a rule for the table once the game has started - at character creation everyone builds on their own ratings.

A Black Market rating is not a price. A jammer is cheap and everywhere; an anti-materiel rifle is barely more expensive and takes a supplier with something real to lose. The two numbers move independently on purpose.

Black Market 1 - grey market: legal to own, or legal right up until you use it. The seller is taking a margin, not a risk.

Black Market 2 - street: somebody in every city moves these. Stolen, counterfeit, or surplus that walked off a base.

Black Market 3 - vouched: you need the right person, and they need to have decided about you first.

Black Market 4 - serious supply: a real organisation with real exposure. They want to know what it's for.

Black Market 5 - the short list: a handful of people on earth can source this, and every one of them is dangerous to know.

THE BLACK MARKET - ARMOR

BOMB DISPOSAL SUIT WR 3

Ninety pounds of layered aramid and plate, with a fan in the helmet and a wire to a controller.

All four. Hardness 8, 6 Health Levels. Movement Rate -4; Disadvantage on all Physical rolls except resisting damage. Requires Black Market Access 2.

COVERT PLATE VEST WR 3

Thin rifle plates in a carrier cut to vanish under a jacket, bought from a man who does not ask what size you are.

Center of Mass. Hardness 5, 2 Health Levels. Worn under a jacket, no penalty; survives a glance, not a pat-down. Requires Black Market Access 2.

THE BLACK MARKET - BASIC WEAPONS

ANTI-MATERIEL RIFLE WR 3

Fifty calibre, a bipod, and a muzzle brake that hurts everyone nearby more than the shooter.

Damage 5, 300m / 800m. 5 rounds. Reload 1 action. Requires Black Market Access 4.

COMPACT SMG WR 3

A folding stock and a thirty-round magazine in a package the size of a laptop.

Damage 3, 25m / 60m. 30 rounds. Reload 1 action. Requires Black Market Access 3.

CONCEALED WRIST BLADES WR 3

Spring blades in forearm sheaths, released by turning the wrist against a catch.

Damage 3, Melee. Requires Black Market Access 3.

GRENADE LAUNCHER WR 3

Single shot, break action, a fat forty-millimetre bore and a ladder sight.

Damage 5, 30m / 80m. 1 round. Reload 1 action. Requires Black Market Access 4.

GYROJET PISTOL WR 3

Fires rocket rounds rather than bullets. Harmless up close and unpleasant at distance.

Damage 4, 25m / 60m. 6 rounds. Reload 1 action. Requires Black Market Access 4.

MONOFILAMENT BLADE WR 4

A handle with nothing coming out of it until the light catches the line. It is all edge.

Damage 5, Melee. Requires Black Market Access 4.

MONOFILAMENT GARROTE WR 3

The same filament between two handles, on a spool in a cigarette packet.

Damage 5, Melee. Requires Black Market Access 5.

SQUAD AUTOMATIC WEAPON WR 3

Belt-fed, bipod, a spare barrel in a bag because you will need it.

Damage 5, 300m / 800m. 100 rounds. Reload 1 action. Requires Black Market Access 4.

THE BLACK MARKET - DISGUISE & INFILTRATION

RFID CLONER WR 2

A reader and a writer in one case, with a stack of blank fobs.

Advantage on bypassing keycard/RFID-secured locks specifically. Requires Black Market Access 1.

DNA-SCRUBBING WIPES WR 1

Foil sachets of enzyme wipes that leave a surface less clean than empty.

Consumed on use: removes DNA evidence from a scene, no roll. Requires Black Market Access 2.

SAFECRACKING KIT WR 3

An autodialler, a borescope, a magnetic mount and a great deal of patience.

Required tool for cracking a combination safe; without one, at Disadvantage. Requires Black Market Access 2.

FACE-CHANGING PROSTHETICS KIT WR 2

Cast silicone appliances, adhesive and pigments, keyed to one specific face.

Advantage on Deception rolls sustained over a longer con (doesn't stack with a Wig & makeup kit). Requires Black Market Access 3.

FORGED BADGE / CREDENTIALS WR 2

A badge and a card wallet, correct down to the holographic overlay.

Passes routine authority checks with no roll; GM's call under real scrutiny. Requires Black Market Access 3.

FORGED DOCUMENTS WR 3

Passport, licence and supporting paper, made by somebody who checks their own work.

Passes routine identity checks with no roll; GM's call under real scrutiny. Requires Black Market Access 4.

THE BLACK MARKET - SURVEILLANCE

LONG-RANGE PARABOLIC DISH WR 3

A metre of dish on a tripod, with a preamp and a recorder in the case.

Advantage on eavesdropping at Far range, wider coverage than a handheld Parabolic microphone. Requires Black Market Access 2.

LASER LISTENING DEVICE WR 3

A laser and a receiver on a tripod, aimed at a windowpane from across the street.

Reads conversation through a window via glass vibration, no physical entry needed. Requires Black Market Access 3.

WIRETAP KIT WR 3

Alligator clips, a recorder and a lineman's handset in a battered bag.

Required tool for tapping a landline or network line; without one, at Disadvantage. Requires Black Market Access 3.

FACIAL RECOGNITION TABLET WR 3

A tablet with a camera and a database on it that nobody is supposed to have.

Advantage on Investigation rolls to identify a known individual from a photo or footage. Requires Black Market Access 4.

THE BLACK MARKET - SURVIVAL & TOOLS

BREACHING KIT WR 2

A hooligan bar, a hydraulic ram, cutting charges and hearing protection.

Advantage on forced-entry rolls; treat your Potence as +2 for that Break Threshold check. Requires Black Market Access 3.

WIRE ASCENT RIG WR 4

A powered ascender that climbs a fixed line faster than a person can.

Anchored lines and powered reels. Turns a city into handholds. Requires Black Market Access 5.

THE BLACK MARKET - TECH & ELECTRONICS

CAMERA JAMMER WR 2

A box that fills a camera's sensor with light nobody in the room can see.

Disables nearby camera feeds within Close range. Requires Black Market Access 2.

COMBAT DRONE (ROTOR) WR 4

A quadcopter with a weapon mount under it and armour over the motors.

Armed and airborne. Illegal in every jurisdiction that has noticed it exists. Requires Black Market Access 4.

DATA CLONER WR 2

A write-blocked duplicator that takes a drive image and leaves no timestamps behind.

Required tool for certain rapid digital-copy Hacking tasks. Requires Black Market Access 1.

EMP DEVICE WR 3

A capacitor bank and a coil in a flight case. One shot, and then it is scrap too.

One-time consumable; disables nearby unshielded electronics within Close range. Requires Black Market Access 4.

GPS JAMMER WR 2

A cigarette packet with an aerial, putting noise across the satellite band.

Disables GPS tracking on anyone/anything within Close range. Requires Black Market Access 2.

INTRUSION DECK WR 3

A purpose-built machine with its own radios and an operating system nobody sells.

A purpose-built machine for being somewhere you have no account. Advantage on Systems Operation against a defended system. Requires Black Market Access 3.

PORTABLE JAMMER ARRAY WR 4

Four transmitters on stands, covering everything from a room to a street.

Disables nearby wireless comms/cameras within Near range - wider coverage than a Signal jammer. Requires Black Market Access 4.

RFID SKIMMER WR 1

A reader in a satchel, picking up cards through a coat at walking distance.

Advantage cloning or bypassing RFID-secured credentials. Requires Black Market Access 1.

SIGNAL JAMMER WR 2

A handheld unit with three stubby aerials and a bank of switches.

Disables nearby wireless comms/cameras within Close range. Requires Black Market Access 2.

SIGNAL TRIANGULATOR WR 3

Three receivers and a tablet, drawing a shrinking circle around a transmitter.

Advantage locating the source of a specific radio or wireless signal. Requires Black Market Access 3.

THE BLACK MARKET - TRANSPORT

ARMORED SEDAN WR 4

A factory car with the doors, pillars and glass replaced. It sits low on its springs.

Hardness 4, 3 Health Levels (executive-protection grade). Requires Black Market Access 2.

ARMORED TRANSPORT VAN WR 4

A cash-in-transit van with gun ports and a door nobody opens from outside.

Hardness 6, 4 Health Levels (per the materials table), several passengers ride behind that Hardness. Requires Black Market Access 2.

ARMORED PERSONNEL CARRIER WR 5

Eight wheels, a hull, and no explaining it to anybody who sees it.

Hardness 7, 5 Health Levels (per the materials table), several passengers ride behind that Hardness. Requires Black Market Access 4.

BEYOND THE ORDINARY

Check with your GM before taking anything on this page. Everything else in this chapter exists, or is a plausible custom job. What follows is not assumed to exist in every 20 Below game, and a table running a modern story about people with Gifts may reasonably decide none of it is real.

Where a GM does allow it, it is bought like anything else - and where a Black Market rating is given, it is bought the hard way, by both gates.

BEYOND THE ORDINARY - ARMOR

ABLATIVE SHIELD HARNESS WR 5

A harness of emitter pods that throws a shell which burns away as it is hit.

Center of Mass. Hardness 7, 4 Health Levels. A projected barrier on a worn rig; spent for the Scene once its Health Levels are gone. Requires Black Market Access 5.

DEPLOYABLE ARMOR CASE WR 5

A hard-shell case the size of carry-on luggage that unfolds around you, plate by plate, and seals at the throat.

All four. Hardness 6, 4 Health Levels. Single item, sets all four Zones; carried as a hard case, a Slow action to climb into, a Normal action to shed; Movement Rate -1. Requires Black Market Access 5.

REACTIVE PLATE VEST WR 4

Tiles of explosive laminate over a steel back plate. It stops the round by throwing itself at it.

Center of Mass. Hardness 8, 2 Health Levels. Each time it loses a Health Level it blows outward: everyone else in Melee range takes 1 die against Soak; Disadvantage on Stealth rolls. Requires Black Market Access 5.

SHEAR-THICKENING SUIT WR 4

A suit of ordinary-looking cloth soaked in a fluid that goes hard as stone the instant anything hits it.

Center of Mass + Arms + Legs. Hardness 5, 3 Health Levels. Soft as cloth until it's struck; reads as clothing, no penalty. Requires Black Market Access 4.

BEYOND THE ORDINARY - WEAPONS

ENERGY RIFLE WR 4

A rifle with no chamber and no brass, drawing from a cell in the stock.

Damage 6, 150m / 400m. 20 shots. Reload 1 action. Requires Black Market Access 5.

BEYOND THE ORDINARY - GEAR

AERODYNE (FLYING CAR) WR 6

A car-sized airframe on ducted fans, with doors and a boot like anything else.

Vertical takeoff, four seats, and a landing fee everywhere worth landing.

BIO-REGENERATION TANK WR 6

A filled cylinder with a lid, a pump stack and a body suspended inside it.

You go in ruined and come out months of healing later, in days.

BRAINDANCE RECORDER WR 3

A headset that records everything a person saw, heard and felt, for somebody else to wear.

Records an experience whole - sight, sound, and what it felt like to be there.

JET PACK WR 5

Two ducted fans on a frame, with a harness and about ninety seconds of fuel.

Minutes of flight, deafening, and it lands harder than it takes off.

NANITE REPAIR KIT WR 5

An ampoule of grey fluid and an applicator. It works on the machine, not the pilot.

Injected machines that close what surgery would have to open you for.

OPTICAL CAMOUFLAGE CLOAK WR 5

A weighted cloak that shows whatever is behind it, a half-second late.

Bends light around the wearer. Works until you move quickly. Requires Black Market Access 5.

SURGICAL POD WR 5

An enclosed table with arms above it, which does not need anybody in the room.

A room-sized autodoc. Handles what the field case cannot.

UNDERGROUND FACILITY WR 6

Excavated, powered, and on no plan ever filed with the city.

Excavated, powered, and on no plan ever filed with the city. Requires Black Market Access 5.

STARTING PACKAGES

Every character starts with these. At character creation you take **one package from every Level up to and including your creation-Wealth**, free and with no roll - one from each Level, not several from the top. A creation-Wealth 3 character takes a Level 1 package, a Level 2 package and a Level 3 package. A creation-Wealth 1 character takes a single Level 1 package. Level 0 is reachable only at creation-Wealth 0, which today means the **Destitute** Flaw, and a Destitute character takes one of those whatever else they bought. Everything in **Wealth at Character Creation** happens after this.

Level 0 (creation-Wealth 0 - Destitute)

Whatever's Left - the clothes on your back, a bedroll, a pocketknife (Switchblade), less than a day's food.

One Bag, Ready to Move - a packed duffel bag, a Multitool, a hand-me-down phone (Smartphone) barely holding a charge.

Borrowed Roof - a key to somewhere that isn't really yours, a Tactical flashlight, one good coat.

Shelter Queue - a sleeping bag, a Switchblade, a Straw water filter, and the schedule of which places still take you after nine.

Car That Runs, Mostly - a car you sleep in more than you drive, a Multitool, a Portable charger, and a blanket that smells like the car.

Day Labor - steel-toed boots, a Hand saw, work gloves, and a phone number that sometimes calls back.

Off the Grid - a Tent, a Fire starter kit, Water purification tablets, and a Compass older than you are.

Busker - an instrument worth more than everything else you own, a Skateboard, a hat to put down, and a corner that's yours by nine a.m.

Just Out - a paper bag of your own returned belongings, a Sewing / repair kit, a Two-way radio, and a list of people you're not supposed to call.

Kitchen Back Door - an apron nobody asked for back, a Combat knife you call a kitchen knife, Field rations & water purifier, and a manager who looks the other way.

The Squat - Bolt cutters, a Tactical flashlight, Paracord (100ft), and a building the city has forgotten about.

Scrapper - a Pickaxe, a Utility trailer with one good wheel, work gloves, and a route through every alley worth walking.

Everything in the Backpack - a backpack that goes where you go, a Snake bite kit, a Fire starter kit, and no fixed address.

Level 1 (Financially comfortable)

Steady Job Kit - Smartphone, Multitool, Field rations & water purifier (a well-stocked kitchen), a wardrobe good enough for interviews and dates.

Weekend Warrior - Bicycle, Tent & sleeping gear, Rope & climbing kit, Binoculars.

City Renter's Setup - Smartphone, Lockpick set (the front door sticks), Field rations & water purifier, Tactical flashlight (the power's spotty).

Night Class - Tablet / e-reader, Portable charger / power bank, Compass, and a bus pass with your name worn off it.

Line Cook - Combat knife (a real knife roll), Trauma shears, Burn gel / dressing, and shoes that never come clean.

The Handy One - Multitool, Hand saw, Crowbar, and a garage full of other people's unfinished projects.

Weekend Medic - Tourniquet, SAM splint, Naloxone kit, and a volunteer badge with the training behind it.

Neighborhood Watch - Binoculars, Two-way radio, Trail camera, Tactical flashlight.

Angler - Kayak / canoe, Field rations & water purifier, Paracord (100ft), and a spot you don't tell people about.

Trailhead Regular - Tent & sleeping gear, Fire starter kit, Snake bite kit, Ice axe.

Amateur Radio - Two-way radio, Solar charger, Action / body camera, and an antenna the neighbors have complained about twice.

Locked Out Again - Lockpick set, Bolt cutters, Switchblade, and a reputation for getting into things.

Quiet Apartment - Smartphone, Tablet / e-reader, Sewing / repair kit, and a door with three locks on it.

Level 2 (Well-off)

Home & Hearth - Economy sedan, First aid kit, Laptop/hacking rig, a paid-off lease.

Home Defense - Compact pistol (licensed), First aid kit, Tactical flashlight, a home security system (flavor).

Weekend Traveler - Motorcycle, Satellite phone, Field stimulant, Rope & climbing kit.

Field Researcher - Laptop / hacking rig, Laser rangefinder, Nice backpack, Chemical analysis kit.

Paramedic Off Shift - First aid kit, IV kit & fluids, Antitoxin, Cargo van.

Contractor - Cargo van, Welding torch, Breaching kit, Gas mask / respirator.

Courier - Motorcycle, Encrypted burner phone, Nice backpack, and a route through the city nobody else knows.

Private Investigator - Hidden camera, Directional microphone, Economy sedan, Forged documents.

Backcountry Guide - ATV / dirt bike, Avalanche beacon, Oxygen tank, Ascender / rappel kit.

Hobby Shooter - Hunting rifle (licensed), Recurve bow, Laser rangefinder, and a range membership older than some of the staff.

Home Studio - Laptop / hacking rig, AI assistant earpiece, Encrypted comms set, and a spare room with foam on the walls.

Small Boat, Big Water - Personal watercraft, Water desalinator, Straw water filter, Paracord (100ft).

Fixer's Little Black Book - Encrypted burner phone, Forged documents, Uniform disguise, RFID cloner.

Level 3 (Wealthy)

Executive Traveler - Armored sedan, Forged documents, Satellite phone, Encrypted comms set.

Serious Collector - Tactical carbine (licensed), Night vision goggles, Concealable vest, a proper home range/vault.

Weekend Estate - Off-road SUV, Speedboat, Advanced trauma kit, a private dock.

Investigative Journalist - Armored sedan, Laser listening device, Facial recognition tablet, Forged badge / credentials.

Trauma Surgeon - Advanced trauma kit, Surgical kit, Defibrillator (AED), Off-road SUV.

Security Consultant - Concealable vest, Compact SMG, Biometric scanner lock, Signal jammer.

Mountain Rescue - Off-road SUV, Recon drone, Thermal imaging scope, Oxygen tank.

Cat Burglar - Safecracking kit, Grapple gloves, Night vision goggles, Camera jammer.

Bounty Hunter - Armored sedan, Tactical carbine (licensed), Stab vest, Hidden tracker dart.

Balloonist - Hot air balloon, Satellite phone, Binoculars, and a landowner who tolerates the early mornings.

Demolition Crew - Thermite charge, Breaching kit, Hazmat suit, Fire axe.

Wire Man - Wiretap kit, Signal triangulator, Long-range parabolic dish, Police scanner.

Riverboat - Speedboat, Harpoon gun, Water desalinator, and a dock nobody inspects.

Level 4 (Very wealthy)

Corporate Backing - Armored transport van, Encrypted comms set, Laptop/hacking rig, a small trusted staff (flavor).

Private Security Contract - Tactical vest, Compact SMG, Signal jammer, a retained security team (flavor).

Serious Insulation - EMP device, Ballistic shield, Forged documents, a legal team on retainer (flavor).

Corporate Extraction - Armored transport van, Portable jammer array, Tactical vest, Forged badge / credentials.

Air Surveillance - Thermal drone, Night-vision drone, Recon drone, Satellite uplink.

Diplomatic Detail - Armored sedan, Ballistic helmet, Encrypted comms set, Riot shield.

Ordnance Disposal - EMP device, Hazmat suit, Breaching kit, Thermite charge.

Heavy Support - Squad automatic weapon, Tactical vest, Ballistic helmet, Two-way radio.

Black Site Logistics - Armored transport van, Satellite uplink, Forged documents, and a manifest that doesn't match the cargo.

Signals Intelligence - Portable jammer array, Signal triangulator, Wiretap kit, Satellite uplink.

Field Hospital - Advanced trauma kit, Surgical kit, Defibrillator (AED), Armored transport van.

Traditionalist - English longbow, Plate armor, Warhammer, and a family that has been doing this a long time.

Grenadier - Grenade launcher, Tactical vest, Ballistic helmet, Gas mask / respirator.

Level 5 (A fortune)

Old Money - Concealable vest, Antitoxin, a name that opens doors, staff to handle logistics (flavor).

Fortress - Full tactical rig, EMP device, Ballistic shield, private security on retainer (flavor).

Untouchable - Advanced trauma kit, Forged documents, Satellite phone, the kind of wealth that solves most problems with a phone call rather than gear (flavor).

Air Wing - Light helicopter, Satellite uplink, Encrypted comms set, and a pilot on retainer (flavor).

Deep Water - Mini-submarine, Water desalinators, Oxygen tank, and a research charter nobody reads past the first page (flavor).

Own Airfield - Small fixed-wing aircraft, Satellite phone, Parachute, and a strip that isn't on the charts.

Column - Armored personnel carrier, Full tactical rig, Squad automatic weapon, and a crew who have done this before (flavor).

Countersniper - Anti-materiel rifle, Thermal imaging scope, Ghillie suit, Laser rangefinder.

Hazard Team - Bomb disposal suit, Hazmat suit, EMP device, Portable jammer array.

Clean Hands - Forged documents, DNA-scrubbing wipes, Face-changing prosthetics kit, and a firm that bills by the hour and asks nothing (flavor).

Private Clinic - Surgical kit, Advanced trauma kit, Defibrillator (AED), and a doctor who doesn't file paperwork (flavor).

The Collection - Katana, Two-handed sword, Plate armor, and a climate-controlled room with the provenance to match (flavor).

Quiet Money - Armored sedan, Encrypted comms set, Biometric scanner lock, and the kind of accountant who is never surprised (flavor).

ADVANCEMENT

Your character walks out of the first session a little different from the one who walked in. After thirty sessions, they are somebody else. This chapter is how that happens: you earn XP for playing, and you spend it to make your character more powerful.

There are no classes and no levels in 20 Below, so nothing tells you what you're allowed to improve next. You earn XP and you spend it on whatever you want, in whatever order you want. A character who only ever raises one Skill is making a choice, not a mistake.

What that turns into at the table is a budgeting problem, and a pleasant one. Some things are

SESSION XP - THE FIVE CATEGORIES

CATEGORY	XP	WHAT IT IS FOR
Attendance and Participation	1	Showed up and played.
Good Roleplaying	1	You played them well.
Heroism and Risk Faced	1	Took a real risk in character.
Learning and Discovery	1	You learned something significant about your character, the plot, or the world.
Standout Moment	1	The GM's discretion - a beat somebody brings up again three sessions later.

Four is a good session. Five is a great one. If your table is handing out five every week, the categories have stopped meaning anything, and your players will notice before you do.

Story Awards sit outside that cap: lump sums for finishing a major arc, putting down a significant villain, or reaching a milestone the campaign was built around. There's no formula for them. A GM who hands out ten at the end

cheap enough to buy on the drive home. Some things you save for across a season. One of them - raising an Attribute - is a purchase you plan a whole campaign around. Knowing which is which is most of what this chapter is for.

EARNING XP

Up to **5 XP a session**, across five categories worth 1 each. The GM awards them independently, so a session can land anywhere from 0 to 5.

of a two-month arc hasn't done anything wrong.

SPENDING IT

XP is awarded at the end of a session and spent before the next one starts. That's the whole procedure. You don't need to explain where the training happened, find a teacher, or account for downtime. Your character survived something and came out of it better at something. Write it down and come back next week.

That's deliberate. A justification requirement sounds great in the abstract, and then it turns into a twenty-minute argument about whether nine days of in-game travel is enough to explain a Skill tier. Nobody has ever enjoyed that argument.

WHAT EVERYTHING COSTS

Every number in this chapter comes out of the same file the character creator reads, so the app and the book can't disagree about a price.

SKILLS

- New Skill, Untrained to Trained: **3 XP**
- Raising a tier after that: **current tier x 2 XP**

RESOURCES

- New Resource: **4 XP**
- Raising a level after that: **current level x 3 XP**

BOONS

- Trivial: **2 XP** - Lesser: **6 XP**
- Greater: **10 XP** - Legendary: **14 XP**

GIFTS

- A new Gift, at Level 1: **7 XP**, minus 1 per Limiter, never below 1

- Raising a Gift: current level x 5, minus 1 per Limiter, never below 1
- Lesser Adder: **6 XP** - Greater Adder: **12 XP**

ATTRIBUTES

- Raising one: **current rating x 9 XP**

FLAWS

- Shedding one: three times the points it granted

A note on how those multipliers read: you pay for the rung you're leaving, not the one you're stepping onto. Trained to Adept costs 2, because Trained is tier 1. Earth 6 to Earth 7 costs 54, because you're standing on 6.

WHAT THAT ACTUALLY BUYS

Prices don't mean much on their own. Here's what they look like against a real calendar.

Call it 4 XP a session, which is a good table on an ordinary week. A weekly game earns about 200 XP a year.

- A new Resource - **4 XP** - one session
- A Resource, Level 1 to 2 - **3 XP** - one session
- A Skill tier, Trained to Adept - **2 XP** - one session
- A new Skill, up to Trained - **3 XP** - one session
- A Greater Boon - **10 XP** - three sessions
- A new Gift at Level 1 - **7 XP** - two sessions
- One Skill, Untrained to Master - **15 XP** - four sessions
- A Gift from Level 1 to 5 - **50 XP** - three months
- An Attribute, 5 to 6 - **45 XP** - three months
- An Attribute, 7 to 8 - **63 XP** - four months

So: Skills and Resources are what you buy this month. Boons and Gifts are what you buy this season. An Attribute is what you save for while doing something else, and it will still be the largest single thing your character ever bought.

That spread is the point. If everything cost about the same, every character would end the campaign looking like every other character. Instead you get people who are wide and people who are deep, because they made different bets a year ago.

SKILLS

Skills are the cheapest thing on the sheet and they always will be. This is where a new character should spend most of their first fifty XP.

The one purchase worth calling out is the first one. Untrained isn't the bottom rung of the ladder - it's the ground the ladder is standing on. An Untrained roll doesn't get your Attribute at all; your target number is the Difficulty by itself. Trained gets you the Attribute.

Watch what that does. Ronan has Earth 8 and wants to climb a knotted rope, Difficulty 7. Untrained, he needs a 7 or under, which the dice give him about one time in five. Trained, he needs 15 or under, which lands about six times in seven.

Three XP. That is the best purchase in this book, and it stays the best purchase every time you make it.

BOONS - CREATION COST AND WHAT IT COSTS LATER

TIER	CREATION COST	ADVANCEMENT (XP)
Trivial	1	2
Lesser	3	6

Everything after it is the same ladder Skills always describe, one tier at a time, no skipping. Trained to Adept is 2. Adept to Expert is 4. Expert to Master is 6. **Fifteen XP** takes any Skill from nothing to Master, which is under four sessions of a single player's XP, and it is entirely reasonable to spend a whole campaign never doing it once.

RESOURCES

Four XP to take a Resource you don't have at all. After that, three times the level you're leaving: Level 1 to 2 is 3, Level 4 to 5 is 12. Thirty-four takes one from nothing to its ceiling.

STEP	XP
None to Level 1	4
Level 1 to 2	3
Level 2 to 3	6
Level 3 to 4	9
Level 4 to 5	12

Resources are the quietest purchase on the sheet and the one players forget. A Level 2 Contacts network becoming Level 4 costs fifteen XP and changes what kinds of problems you're allowed to solve off-screen. Consider that before you spend forty-five on an Attribute.

BOONS

Twice what the Boon cost at creation. **Trivial 2, Lesser 6, Greater 10, Legendary 14.**

BOONS - CREATION COST AND WHAT IT COSTS LATER (CONTINUED)

TIER	CREATION COST	ADVANCEMENT (XP)
Greater	5	10
Legendary	7	14

Buying a Boon in play is buying a rule exception, so it wants a moment of thought about where it came from. Not a justification - I said you don't need one and I meant it - just an eye toward whether Iron Will showing up in session twelve says something true about what your character has been through. Usually it does. That's the fun part.

GIFTS

Gifts are the most expensive per-point thing you can buy, and the pricing has a shape worth understanding before you commit.

A Gift you've never had costs 7 to acquire at Level 1. After that, each level costs the level

GIFT ADDERS - CREATION COST AND WHAT IT COSTS LATER

TIER	CREATION COST	ADVANCEMENT (XP)
Lesser	3	6
Greater	6	12

Limiters, on the other hand, are forever. There is no price to remove one, because removing one isn't a thing you can do. A Limiter isn't a debt you took on to afford the Gift - it's part of the description of what the Gift is. The Gift that only works in moonlight is a different ability from the one that works anywhere, and no amount of XP turns the first into the second.

you're leaving times five: 5 to reach Level 2, 10 for Level 3, 15 for Level 4, 20 for Level 5. **Fifty-seven XP** takes a Gift from nothing to its ceiling.

Limiters discount both formulas by 1 XP each, the same way they discount the creation price, and neither formula ever drops below 1 XP no matter how many you've stacked. A heavily limited Gift is cheap to buy and cheap to climb, and it is still limited every single session.

Adders are flat: 6 for a Lesser, 12 for a Greater, whether you buy them the day you take the Gift or two years later. Unlike levels, they don't get more expensive with time.

ATTRIBUTES

Current rating times nine. Earth 5 to 6 is 45. Earth 7 to 8 is 63. Earth 9 to 10 is 81.

This is the long game, and it is priced to be. Raising an Attribute is the only purchase that moves every roll you make with that Element at once, and the curve is steep enough that you raise two or three of them across an entire campaign, not ten.

Every Attribute point also grants one sub-stat point, to put in either of that Attribute's two sub-stats, and one Descriptor for whichever one you chose. Exactly like creation. Raising Water gives you a point to spend on Stamina or Health and a new word describing how this character, specifically, endures.

That is also the only way sub-stats ever go up. There's no separate price for Soak or Psyche or Atropos; they climb when the Attribute above them climbs.

PAST TEN

Ten is a creation cap, not a ceiling. XP takes an Attribute higher.

What it doesn't take higher is the roll. **An Element contributes at most 10 to any target number, ever.** Earth 18 makes the same roll Earth 10 does.

Every point past ten is still a sub-stat point and a Descriptor. Since no sub-stat can exceed 10, **an Attribute of 20 is precisely the point at which both its sub-stats are full** - the ceiling isn't a number I picked, it's where the arithmetic runs out.

PAST TEN - WHAT ACCUMULATES

EVERY	GRANTS	AT ATTRIBUTE 20
3 points past 10	+1 to your Fate Token ceiling, above the usual (Stamina x 3) + 1. Stacks across Attributes.	+3
4 points past 10	One automatic success per scene on a roll using that Element, at Difficulty 6 or better. Each Element tracks its own.	2 per scene
5 points past 10	+1 to your critical success band on any roll using that Element.	Critical on 2-4

So past ten, an Element stops making you accurate and starts making you formidable. Soak 10 means every attack that reaches you finds a wall. Health 10 means fifteen Health Levels. Both of the formulas that read the Attribute directly keep climbing with it, uncapped: Ki is your strongest Element plus 8, and Movement Rate is 5 plus Air in meters. Earth 20 is a Ki pool of 28. Air 20 is a twenty-five meter stride.

Three more things accumulate as you climb, each on its own step.

Every 3 points past ten raises your Fate Token ceiling by 1 above the usual (Stamina x 3) + 1. These stack across Attributes: one Element at 20 and another at 15 is four extra Tokens you can hold.

Every 4 points past ten grants one automatic success per scene on a roll using that Element, at Difficulty 6 or better. You don't roll; the easy thing simply works. Hard rolls still get rolled. Each Element tracks its own.

Every 5 points past ten widens your critical success band by one on any roll using that Element. Critical on a 2 becomes critical on 2 or 3 at fifteen, and 2 through 4 at twenty.

That last one is the sharpest, and it is the only thing in the game that widens a critical on an attack. Skill tiers can't - an attack is a straight Attribute against Defense with no Skill in it - so a natural 2 is a critical for everybody, and a critical sends half your damage dice through free. A 1% chance becomes 6%. That is what a lifetime spent inside one Element looks like from the other end of it.

None of this is reachable quickly. Ten to eleven alone is 90 XP, and the full climb from ten to twenty is 1,305. Nobody finishes it. Somebody in a long campaign buys three points of it and becomes the reason the table is still alive.

SHEDDING A FLAW

Three times the points the Flaw granted you at creation. A Minor Flaw that gave you 1 costs 3 to be rid of. A Major that gave you 5 costs 15. A leveled Flaw costs three per level, and comes off one level at a time - Amnesia at 4 can become Amnesia at 2 for six XP, and you can stop there.

Think about it before you do it. Flaws pay you. Every time one gets invoked, by you or the GM, you collect a Fate Token, and shedding your Flaws quietly cuts your own income. There's also already a way out of a single bad moment: spend a Token to Overcome a Flaw and it doesn't apply for the rest of the scene.

Buy off the Flaw when the story has finished with it. Not when it's inconvenient.

A YEAR OF THIS

Ronan's table plays most weeks and averages a little under four XP a session. Across a year he banked **170**.

- Athletics, Trained to Expert - **6 XP**
- Contacts, Level 2 to 4 - **15 XP**
- Danger Sense, a Greater Boon - **10 XP**
- Second Sight, a new Gift, to Level 3 **22 XP**
- A Lesser Adder on it - **6 XP**
- Shedding a Moderate Flaw - **9 XP**
- Earth 6 to 7 - **54 XP**
- Banked toward Earth 7 to 8 - **43 XP**

Look at the bottom two lines. More than half of Ronan's year went into one Attribute, and he isn't finished. The other half bought him a gun he can actually use, a network that answers the phone, a supernatural ability he didn't have in session one, and the end of something that had been following him since character creation.

That's a year. Most of it was cheap. The expensive thing was worth waiting for.

- Firearms, Untrained to Adept - **5 XP**

RUNNING THE GAME

Everything up to here has been for everyone at the table. This chapter is for the one running it.

WHAT THIS GAME ASKS OF YOU

Most of running 20 Below is just running a game, and you already know how to do that, or you'll learn it the way the rest of us did - badly, for a while, in front of your friends. I'm not going to spend a chapter on that. What follows is the part that's specific to this system. Five things it wants from you that another game might not ask for at all.

Let it go wrong. The system is built to reward players for letting things go badly. Flaws pay out. Natures pay out when acting on them costs something. Catastrophic failures are supposed to happen and they're supposed to be memorable. Run this game protecting players from consequences and you've quietly switched off half the engine - and worse than that, you've made their currency worthless. A Flaw that never bites is just free points.

You are the other half of the consensus. The world holds its shape because everyone in it agrees on what's normal, and you play everyone. When a player spends Fate Tokens to assert something into the fiction, you're not the referee of that transaction. You're the thing on the other end of it - the accumulated weight of a world that had a different opinion. So push back. Not by saying no, but by having the world notice.

Rule fast, and rule out loud. You'll be making judgement calls all night. Whether that Descriptor really argues for Earth here. What a Kotodama claim costs. Whether that's a 6 or a

7. Make the call, give one sentence of why, and move on. A table that watches you deliberate learns to stop asking you things, and a table that has stopped asking is a table that has stopped reaching.

No is a complete answer. Players will argue for a different Element, for a bigger claim, for the reading that helps them. That's the game working as intended - the challenged-Element rule exists to be used. You're still allowed to just say no, and you don't owe anybody a paragraph explaining it. The rules hand you the final say everywhere it comes up. This is me telling you to actually use it.

Every Token they spend, you get one. Fate Tokens transfer rather than drain - when a player spends one, your own pool gains one. Which means you want them spending. A GM who quietly discourages Kotodama, or who never lets a Flaw come up, is starving their own side of the table. Hand Tokens out when a Nature costs somebody something. Let the Flaws bite. The economy only does anything while it's moving.

SESSION ZERO

Before anybody rolls anything, sit down together and work out what game you are all in. This matters more here than it does in most systems, because 20 Below doesn't come with a world attached. A game with a setting baked into it has already answered half of these questions before the GM opens the book. This one hands you all of them at once.

Say what the game is, in one sentence. Not a pitch and not a plot. A sentence that tells five people what kind of night this is going to be. Cops and cryptids in a rust-belt town nobody leaves. A generation ship where the crew have started dreaming the same dream. If you can't get it into a sentence, the table can't hold it in their heads either, and every character they build will be aimed somewhere slightly different.

Set the Everyman list. This one is mechanical, and the Skills chapter deliberately leaves it to you. Every character gets a short list of Skills free at Trained, and what counts as ordinary depends entirely on where and when you are playing. Driving is unremarkable now and unthinkable in 1840. Decide the list here, with everyone in the room, because it changes what every character at the table is quietly assumed to be able to do.

Decide what the consensus is like here. This is the one nobody else's session zero asks about, and it changes how the whole Fate system feels. How thin is the agreement in this world? In a setting where everybody still believes in the things in the woods, a Kotodama claim about something in the woods is barely a push. In a setting where the consensus has been sanded flat by three centuries of people checking, the same claim is a shove against the whole species. Somewhere in between is a world where something is actively managing what people believe - and the players will feel that long before they can name it.

Find out what your players actually want. Ask them, out loud, one at a time. Somebody at that table wants a fight scene every session. Somebody wants to talk their way past the fight. Somebody built a character entirely so

they could have one specific conversation with an NPC who doesn't exist yet. You can't serve all of that equally, but you can serve all of it sometimes, and you can only do that if you know what it is.

And the harder version of the same question.

Ask what nobody wants. What shouldn't turn up at this table, what should happen off-screen, what somebody would rather you just didn't describe. Do it plainly and without ceremony, take the answers, and don't negotiate about them. This costs you ten minutes once and saves an evening you can't get back.

If somebody is making the game worse, say so early. Not every problem at a table is a rules problem. A player who argues every ruling, or who steers every scene back onto themselves, or who is quietly making somebody else not want to come back - none of that gets better by being ignored, and none of it gets fixed by a mechanic. Say something, once, in private, kindly and specifically. Most of the time that's the entire fix. When it isn't, you already know what the other option is, and the table will be better for it. This is the least fun paragraph in this book and I'd rather write it than have you find out the long way.

WHEN TO ROLL

Setting the number is the easy half. Deciding whether there should be a roll at all is the job, and it's the call you'll make most often without noticing you made it.

Three questions, and then a fourth that belongs to this game specifically.

Is failure interesting? If the answer is no, don't roll. Let them have it. A locked door with nothing behind it and all night to work on it isn't a Larceny check, it's a description of a door that takes a while. Roll when the failure would change the scene, and hand it over when it wouldn't.

Can they actually fail? A Trained character doing the ordinary version of their own job, unhurried and unwatched, isn't rolling to find out whether they're competent. You already decided that when you let them buy the Skill. Make them roll for it often enough and the dice will eventually tell your table that their expert isn't an expert, which is both untrue and yours to have prevented.

Can they actually succeed? If the answer is no, say no. Don't make somebody roll to discover that you had already decided. Rolling untrained against a hard Difficulty is a long way to travel for a foregone conclusion, and it teaches the table that your yeses and your noes are both just dice, which is the opposite of what you want them to learn.

And the one that's particular to 20 Below.

Every roll you call for carries a flat one in a hundred chance of a catastrophic failure, and that chance doesn't care how trivial the task was. Ask for six unnecessary rolls in a night and you haven't just slowed the game down. You have imported a disaster into a scene with no room for one, and sooner or later somebody rolls a 20 climbing through a window they had all evening to climb through.

WHAT A TARGET NUMBER PAYS OUT

TARGET	SUCCEEDS
5	succeeds one time in ten
8	a bit better than one in four

That last one is the argument I'd make if the first three hadn't already convinced you. Rolls aren't free here. They are the mechanism by which things go wrong, and they should be pointed at the moments where things going wrong is the point.

When a player asks to roll. They will, constantly, and usually they are really asking whether the thing is possible. Answer that question instead. Tell them what they already know without rolling, tell them what a roll would actually be for, and let them decide whether they still want to make it. Half the time they don't, because what they wanted was the information.

SETTING DIFFICULTY

You set the Difficulty for every roll, and the ladder in the How to Play chapter is the whole tool. Pick the row that sounds like what the character is attempting and move on. A game where the GM deliberates over whether something is a 6 or a 7 is a slower game, and the difference is one point on a curve that spans twenty.

WHAT THE CURVE DOES

Two ten-sided dice don't give you a flat spread, and that changes what your Difficulty choices are actually worth. A target number is the character's Element plus the Difficulty you set, and this is what the targets pay out.

WHAT A TARGET NUMBER PAYS OUT (CONTINUED)

TARGET	SUCCEEDS
11	a coin flip, and the exact middle of the curve
14	about four times in five
17	nineteen times in twenty

Look at the gaps rather than the numbers. From 8 to 11 is three points of target and twenty-seven points of probability. From 14 to 17 is also three points of target, and fifteen points of probability. Same three steps. Half the work done.

THE WHOLE LESSON

In the middle of the curve, one point of Difficulty is worth about ten points of probability. Out at either end it's worth two.

That's the whole lesson, and it's why the same adjustment lands completely differently on two characters sitting at the same table.

Which means the ladder does most of its work in the middle. Nudging a Difficulty by one against a character whose target was already 17 is barely doing anything - you've taken them from ninety-four in a hundred to ninety. They won't feel it and neither will you. The same single point against somebody sitting on 11 has moved them from a coin flip to worse than one, and they will absolutely feel it.

So to actually pressure somebody who is good at this, change the situation instead.

Disadvantage takes a target of 15 from eighty-five percent down to sixty-seven. That is a real problem arriving, and it didn't require you to invent a harder version of the task. Bad footing, bad light, no time, somebody shooting at them - all of that is Disadvantage, and all of it is easier to justify out loud than quietly deciding that this particular lock is unusually difficult.

Advantage is worth about two points of Difficulty, in the middle. Less than that at the top, where there isn't much room left to improve. If you're wondering whether to grant Advantage or knock a point off the Difficulty, Advantage is the bigger gift almost everywhere, and it's the one that reads as the world helping rather than the task shrinking.

And the practical version of all of this: don't fine-tune. Pick the row on the ladder that sounds like the thing and move on. If the roll still feels wrong to you after that, the answer is almost never one more point of Difficulty. It's Advantage, or Disadvantage, or no roll at all.

RULING ON THE FLY

Most of what you do at the table isn't in any chapter. Somebody tries a thing the book didn't anticipate, or argues for a reading that helps them, or asks what happens when a car hits you. You decide, out loud, in about four seconds. These are the five that come up most.

A player argues for a different Element. This is the challenged-Element rule doing its job, and the condition is the whole of it - the argument has to come out of a Sub-Stat Descriptor they already wrote down, not a sentence they invented thirty seconds ago. Hold that line and the rest takes care of itself, because nobody has an unlimited supply of Descriptors. If the argument is good, say yes and let them roll it. If it isn't, no is a complete answer, and you've already read that paragraph.

Somebody wants to do a thing with no Skill attached. Pick the Element that the attempt actually runs on, set a Difficulty, and roll it untrained. Untrained is a real option in this system rather than a punishment - Difficulty alone, no Element - and it's the honest answer when a character is doing something nobody trains for. Don't invent a Skill on the spot. If it turns out to be a thing they do often, that's what the next Advancement is for.

Something hurts somebody and it isn't a weapon. Damage is a count of d10 resolved one die at a time against Soak, so improvising it means picking a number of dice, and the weapon tables are the scale you already have. Fists are 1. A knife or a handgun is 3. A grenade launcher or an anti-materiel rifle is 5. So a bad fall down a stairwell sits near a knife. A car at speed sits at the top of the scale and probably past it. A burning room isn't one big number, it's a smaller one arriving every round until somebody leaves.

Something costs somebody their mind. Sanity takes dice against Psyche the same way Health takes them against Soak, so improvising it means picking a number - but the scale is smaller, because Sanity is smaller and most people's Psyche is thin. One die is a bad thing

witnessed. Two or three is something that shouldn't exist, seen clearly, in good light. More than that and you aren't setting a hazard, you're deciding to take somebody out of the scene, which is a fine thing to do on purpose and a bad thing to do by arithmetic.

TWO RULES OF THUMB

Two rules of thumb. Nothing costs Sanity twice - the second time you see it, you have seen it. And a character who chooses to look should get something for looking; if there is no information in it, don't charge for it.

SAY IT FIRST

Say the number out loud before the dice come out. A table will accept almost any ruling made in advance and almost none made afterward.

There are more enemies than you want to roll for. Don't roll for all of them. Decide how many connect - two of the six, say, because the other four are in each other's way - and roll only those. Unnamed opposition is out of the fight at zero, so a crowd of them is a threat that shrinks fast once the party starts landing hits, and the interesting question is almost never which specific guard hit whom. If the fiction says a mob overwhelms somebody, let it overwhelm them and spend your dice on the part the players can still change.

And when none of that helps. Rule in the direction that keeps the scene moving, tell the table it's a ruling rather than a rule, and write it down if you liked it. A ruling you make twice the same way has become a house rule, and a house rule you can name is worth more than a page of mine.

NAMED AND UNNAMED

Player characters and named NPCs are extraordinary. Everyone else isn't, and the rules treat them differently at exactly one point: what happens at zero.

Unless an NPC has a name, zero is the end of them. A nameless guard who drops is done - out of the fight and out of the story. Whether they're dead or just not getting up again is yours to decide, and the rules can't tell the difference: nobody tracks a nameless guard's recovery. That's what makes a critical hit decisive against ordinary opposition.

Named NPCs and player characters get the full treatment instead: unconscious at zero, dying below it, and every rule about recovery, Scars and lasting harm applies to them. Giving an NPC a name is therefore a mechanical decision as much as a narrative one. Name the ones who should be able to survive.

ANTAGONISTS

The section above covers what an antagonist costs you mechanically. This one is about what makes one worth the trouble.

Give them something they want, and make it reasonable. Not sympathetic - reasonable. Somebody who wants the same thing the players want, or wants something that can only be had by taking something the players need, is an antagonist. Somebody who wants suffering is a weather event with a face. The first kind generates scenes on its own. The second one needs you to keep inventing reasons for it to turn up.

The best ones are mirrors. Take a thing a player character is, and build somebody who is

that same thing without the brakes. The Avenger who never stopped. The Caregiver who decided the only way to protect people was to decide things for them. It works because the player recognises it before you explain it, and because every scene with that antagonist is quietly a scene about the player's own character. You don't have to say any of this out loud. They will get there.

Give them a Nature. It's free, it takes ten seconds, and it does most of your improvising for you. An antagonist with a Nature written down will behave consistently in scenes you didn't plan, because you already know what they do when the pressure is on. It also means they can be predicted, which is what makes a recurring antagonist satisfying to finally beat - the players worked out how they think.

A Gifted antagonist is not just a strong one. They're a fulcrum, the same as the player characters, which means they can lean on the consensus too. That is a different kind of threat from somebody who is dangerous in a fight. A rival who can assert things into the world is competing with the players over what is true, and the evidence of them turns up as coincidence rather than as violence - records that don't match, a witness whose account keeps changing, a building the party is certain was on the other side of the street.

Organizations are antagonists too, and the good ones believe in themselves. An institution that thinks it's doing the right thing, staffed by people who also think that, is harder to fight and far more interesting than one that knows it is evil. The people at the desk aren't lying to the players. The gap is usually between what the organization tells its own staff and what the people at the top actually want, and the players finding that gap is a whole campaign.

Name the ones who should survive, and only those. This is the mechanical decision from the section above, arriving as a storytelling one. A recurring antagonist has to be Named or the first good critical hit ends them. Decide that before the fight, not during it, and be honest with yourself about which it is - naming somebody mid-combat because you didn't want to lose them is the moment a table stops believing the dice matter.

RUNNING THE CONSENSUS

The Fate chapter tells the players what the consensus is. This is your half of it, and it's the part of running 20 Below that has no equivalent in another game.

The consensus is something you play, not a rule you enforce. When a player spends Tokens to assert a fact, the transaction is already settled by the time it reaches you - they paid, it's true. Your job starts after that. The world has just been told something it disagreed with, and the world is the thing you're playing.

A Shout leaves witnesses, and witnesses are the mechanism. Anybody who watched a locked vault door swing open on its own now believes something impossible happened. That

belief doesn't go anywhere. It's a small permanent change to the agreement, made by the players, and it's how a campaign accumulates. Six months of quiet Whispers change nothing about the world. One Shout in a crowded bar changes that bar forever, and everyone who drinks there.

Decide who notices, every time. Not whether - who. Most people rationalize, that's what the consensus is made of, and it's why Whisper and Murmur cost so little. But somebody in that room is going to be the one who doesn't. A child. A drunk nobody will believe anyway. Somebody who has seen this before and went quiet about it. That person is a scene you now have for free, and you didn't have to plan it.

Pressure comes from attention, not from price. When you want a Kotodama to cost more, the instinct is to raise the number. Don't. The number is the players' side of the deal and it's already fair. What you have is the world - the guard who files a report, the camera nobody knew about, the person who starts asking around. Raise attention and you've made a claim expensive without touching a rule.

A place that has been pushed on feels wrong. Where reality has been leaned against repeatedly, it stops sitting flat. Coincidences start arriving slightly too punctually. Two people remember the same evening differently and neither of them is lying. A room won't hold a memory - people leave it and can't quite say what was discussed. None of this is a mechanic and none of it needs a roll. It's the texture of somewhere that has been argued with, and it's the best warning you can give a table that they have been noticed.

And a thin place is easier to push again.

Overwrite the same stretch of agreement often enough and it stops holding its shape - a file saved over once too often, a glitch in the matrix. The consensus there is corrupted, and corrupted things are easy to change. Charge less for a claim made somewhere that has already been rewritten. How much less is yours to decide, and it should follow how badly the place has been worn rather than any number I could put in a table.

Which cuts both ways, and that's the interesting part.

A thin place is cheap for your players and cheap for everything else. Whatever else has been leaning on that spot is finding it easy too, and a neighbourhood where reality has stopped being reliable isn't a good place to live. Thin places make excellent destinations and terrible homes.

Small claims should feel free, because they are. Don't let any of this make you stingy. The consensus genuinely has no opinion about whether that door latched, and a game where the GM makes a face every time somebody spends a Token is a game where nobody spends Tokens. Save the weight for the Shouts.

AWARDING XP AND FATE

Both of the currencies your players run on come from you, and the rules for both are already written down - five XP categories in Advancement, seven sources of Fate in the Fate chapter. This is about actually using them.

Award XP for what you want more of. The five categories are deliberately not about winning. Nobody gets XP for killing the thing or finding the treasure. They get it for showing up, playing the character, taking a risk, learning something, and doing one thing everyone

remembers. That's the game telling your table what it values, once a week, in public. If you hand out Standout Moment to the same person every session, you've told the other four something you probably didn't mean to.

Say what each point was for. Out loud, by name, at the end of the session. It takes ninety seconds and it's the single best teaching tool you have - a player who hears why somebody else earned Heroism and Risk Faced now knows what that category is worth, and you'll see it in their play next week.

Three of the seven Fate sources are yours.

Nature, voluntary Disadvantage, daily regeneration and the Lucky Number all happen without you. Invoking a Flaw, the Milestone Award and plain discretion are your call, and they're the ones that go unused when a GM is busy.

Invoking a Flaw is a gift, not a punishment. It looks like you're making somebody's night worse, and it pays them a Token for the trouble. New GMs sit on this because it feels mean. It isn't - it's the mechanism by which a Flaw stops being free points, and a player who took Short Fuse wants you to use it. Ask them once at session zero how hard they want it pushed, then push it that hard.

Take the Milestone seriously, including the weeks it feels small. One Token to every player, roughly once a session, when the group clears a real hurdle. The temptation is to skip it when the session was quiet, but a quiet session that ends with a decision made is a milestone. Skip it too often and the daily regeneration becomes the whole economy, which is a slower and worse game.

Watch the cap. A character holds at most $(\text{Stamina} \times 3) + 1$, and Tokens earned at the cap are gone rather than banked. A player sitting at cap is a player who isn't spending, and that's worth saying out loud to them - not as a rule reminder but as an invitation. They are holding a resource that is currently earning them nothing.

And remember which way the transfer runs.

Every Token they spend lands in your pool. Being generous with Fate isn't charity. It's how you get paid.

THE GM'S OWN POOL

Every Token a player spends lands in your pool, and the Fate chapter gives you three things to buy with it - a Twist, a Claim, or Hardening. This is how to use them without wrecking anything.

It's a budget for consequences, and it balances itself. A one-Token edit hands you one. A five-Token pooled claim hands you five. The size of the pushback scales with the size of the push, and you never have to sit there working out what a big Kotodama ought to cost the party - they already told you.

Never spend it to undo what they bought.

This is the one that matters, and getting it wrong kills the whole economy. A claim that has been paid for is true, and your pool does not buy it back. What it buys is what happens next. They asserted the guard was already asleep - fine, he is, and he was due to check in ten minutes ago, and somebody has just noticed he hasn't. The claim stands. The world responds. Do it the other way once and you have taught your table that Fate Tokens purchase nothing, and they will never spend one again.

Spend it near where it came from. The best complication is the one that grew out of the claim that funded it. They rewrote the records, so somebody is now looking for who rewrote the records. They made the storm arrive on time, so the storm is still there in the morning and the roads are gone. It costs you nothing to connect the two, and it makes the world feel like it noticed rather than like the GM did.

Spend it, and reasonably soon. A pool that only ever grows tells the players their spending has no visible effect, and hoarding a dozen Tokens to dump in one evening reads as being punished for having played the game. Spend in ones and twos, close to when you earn them, and the table will feel a rhythm instead of an ambush.

Keep it where they can see it. Actual tokens, in an actual bowl, in the middle of the table. Watching the pile grow as they spend does more for the tension of a session than anything you could say, and it makes the transfer real rather than something you've promised is happening on your side of the screen.

An overflowing pool means you're not pressing. If you're sitting on fifteen and can't think what to do with them, the game is too comfortable. That number is a measure of how much the players have been reshaping the world, and if the world hasn't answered any of it, you have a setting that does not push back and a table that will eventually stop finding it interesting.

And this is the consensus, mechanically.

That's all the pool is. Every Token in it is a place where somebody overruled the agreement, and the pile in front of you is how much the world has to say about it. Spending it is the world getting its turn.

CATASTROPHIC FAILURE

A 20 - both dice showing 10 - is a catastrophic failure. That's one roll in a hundred, which sounds like nothing until you count how many rolls a table makes in a night. In a session with real fighting in it, expect to see one.

That rate is deliberate. Rare enough to land like an event, common enough to actually land.

Outside combat the rule is the one the book has already given you. The attempt fails, and something else goes wrong on top of it. The GM decides what.

The something else has to come out of what the character was doing. That's the whole craft of it, and it's the part most games get wrong. A catastrophic failure picking a lock snaps the pick off in the barrel, or wakes the dog, or sends the keyring down the stairwell. It doesn't bring the ceiling down. If the GM is reaching for a consequence that has nothing to do with the action, they have reached too far - the failure was in the lock, so put the trouble in the lock.

IN COMBAT

A catastrophic failure in combat does two things at once. The attack misses, **something goes badly wrong**, and the character is **Off Balance** until the end of their next turn.

Off Balance. You roll everything at Disadvantage. It doesn't stack - you're either Off Balance or you're not - and it clears on its own. A character can spend a Fate Token to Shrug Off an Effect and clear it immediately.

That Fate Token does not touch the other half. Whatever went wrong stays wrong. You

can get your feet back under you. You can't un-drop the magazine.

WHAT WENT WRONG

The GM picks it, and it comes out of what the character was actually doing. Here's the shape of the thing, with enough examples to get the idea. It isn't a table, and there's never going to be one, because I can't write a table that accounts for every situation, or even most of them. The GM was there. The table wasn't.

Your weapon. Dropped. Sent skittering across the floor. Jammed. Stuck fast in a doorframe, a shield, a rib. The magazine out and gone under the car.

Your footing. Flat on your back. An ankle that will hold your weight and complain about it all week. Down a half-flight of stairs you meant to be standing at the top of.

Your position. You're somewhere worse than you were. Out of cover. Inside the reach of someone who wanted you there. Between two people who are both now looking at you.

Your gear. A strap gone. A pouch open and its contents across the floor. Something you were counting on later, broken now.

The room. You hit something that wasn't the target. The light. The window. The pipe. The one beam that was holding the rest of it up.

Attention. You were quiet and now you're not. The alarm. The dog. The one guard who had not looked this way yet, and has now.

That last one is worth more than it looks in a game about consensus. A fight nobody witnessed is a very different problem from a fight forty people saw.

Match the weight to the situation. A dropped weapon in a bar fight is an inconvenience. A dropped weapon on a catwalk is gone. Same fumble, same roll, wildly different night - and that difference is the fiction doing its job, not the dice.

A catastrophic failure in combat can get somebody killed. Off Balance is a round at Disadvantage in the middle of a fight, and that's exactly how people die in this game. Add a lost weapon or a lost position on top of it and you've a genuinely bad few seconds. That's the cost, and it's real. Don't soften it because you feel bad - the system is built to reward the table for letting things go badly, and this is one of the places it collects.

Two things it deliberately doesn't do.

It does not get worse the more you swing. Off Balance doesn't stack, so a character taking two actions a round is in exactly as much trouble as one taking a single Slow action. Systems that charge per fumble quietly punish the characters who act most, which means they punish the ones who fight for a living. This one doesn't.

It does not put a sword through your own foot, or the person beside you. A character who trained for years doesn't do that because two dice came up ten. What they do is lose their weapon, their footing or their advantage, and then live with the next few seconds.

Two things reach this roll. On a Skill roll, Master Training Tier lets you roll again, and a second success turns the disaster into an ordinary miss. An attack uses no Skill, so no tier reaches it - that's what the Never Off Balance Boon is for: attack rolls at its first tier, every roll in combat at its second, and every roll at all at its third.

PACING

Most of this is true of running any game and you will have heard versions of it before. One piece of it is specific to this one, and it's the piece GMs get wrong.

A Scene is a mechanical unit here, not just a way of talking. Fate spends are capped per Scene. Gift abilities reset once per Scene. Flustered clears when the Scene does. There are more than forty separate rules in this book hanging off that word. So when you say "right, new scene" you're not just changing the subject - you are handing everybody their per-Scene Fate capacity back and refreshing every once-per-Scene ability at the table. Do that three times during one fight and you have quietly made the fight much easier without deciding to.

Which cuts the other way too. A long grinding sequence that is honestly several Scenes should be several Scenes. If the party fights through the lobby, regroups on the stairwell, and then hits the penthouse, that isn't one Scene because it happened in one building. Being stingy with Scene breaks is its own kind of ruling, and it's the one that makes players feel like their once-per-Scene abilities are decorative.

Cut a scene the moment the interesting thing has happened. Not when the conversation ends. Not when everyone has had a turn. The moment the thing the scene was about has landed - the decision made, the lie caught, the door opened - say what happens and move. Almost every slow session is slow because scenes ran past their own endings.

Start late. You don't need the walk to the building, the drive over, or the part where they decide who knocks. Begin with somebody already knocking. Players fill in the approach themselves and they do it faster than you can narrate it.

Vary what a scene is for. The XP categories are quietly telling you this - somebody has to be able to earn Learning and Discovery, and they can't if every scene is a fight. A session that alternates between something to solve, somebody to talk to, and something that goes wrong will hand out four and five XP honestly. A session of five fights will hand out two, and you will find yourself inventing reasons to be generous.

Let downtime actually pass. This system spends real time between the interesting bits. XP is spent between sessions. A pushed Resource stays reduced until the start of the next Month. Scars heal on their own schedule. If your campaign never advances the calendar, none of that machinery does anything, and a player who pushed a Resource to the wall is carrying a penalty forever. Move the clock. It costs one sentence.

And end the session on something unresolved. Not a cliffhanger every week - that gets tiring and everyone can feel it being done to them. Just stop while something is still open. A session that ends with every thread tied off is a session nobody thinks about until next week, and the thinking-about-it is half of what you're actually making here.